

The Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines

Āryāṣṭasāhasrikā Prajñāpāramitā · Toh 12 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་རལ་དྲུག་པ་བརྒྱ་སྟོད་པ།

This text is the Āryāṣṭasāhasrikā Prajñāpāramitā, known in Tibetan as the Phags pa shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa brgyad stong pa, or in English The Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, one of the most celebrated and historically significant scriptures of the Mahāyāna Prajñāpāramitā literature. Catalogued as Toh 12 in the Kangyur, it belongs to the Prajñāpāramitā section of sūtras attributed to the Buddha's discourses on the perfection of wisdom, emphasizing the nature of emptiness, non-attachment, and the bodhisattva path. The opening scene situates the teaching at Vulture Peak Mountain near Rājagṛha, where the Buddha addresses a vast assembly of realized arhats and bodhisattvas, establishing the setting for an extended and profound exposition on wisdom that unfolds across many chapters. As one of the foundational and earliest expressions of the Prajñāpāramitā tradition, this sūtra had immense influence on the development of Mahāyāna philosophy and practice throughout India and Tibet.

In the language of India: Āryāṣṭasāhasrikā Prajñāpāramitā. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The first section.

Homage to all buddhas, bodhisattvas, noble śrāvakas, and pratyekabuddhas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain, together with a great Saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks. All of them were arhats: their defilements exhausted, without mental affliction, self-mastered, supremely and utterly liberated in mind, supremely and utterly liberated in wisdom, thoroughbreds, great elephants, who had done what was to be done, accomplished what was to be accomplished, laid down the burden, attained their own highest aim, entirely exhausted the bonds of existence, and who, through complete and perfect knowledge, had attained supreme and utter liberation of mind, having reached the far shore of the highest mastery over all minds. There was but one exception among these individuals, and that was the Venerable Ānanda.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Elder, the Venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, beginning from the Perfection of Wisdom of the great bodhisattvas, speak with

confidence in the very way that great bodhisattvas would come to enter into the Perfection of Wisdom."

Then the Venerable Śāriputra thought to himself: "Will the Venerable Subhūti expound the Perfection of Wisdom to the great bodhisattvas by generating the power of his own personal confidence in wisdom, and by virtue of the power of his own personal confidence in wisdom being blessed? Or will it be by the power of the Buddha?"

Then, by the power of the Buddha, the Venerable Subhūti perceived the thought of the Venerable Śāriputra's mind thinking in just such a way, and spoke to the Venerable Śāriputra as follows: "Venerable Śāriputra, whatever the hearers of the Blessed One speak, teach, explain, express, clarify, and make perfectly clear — all of that is to be understood as the power of the Tathāgata. Why is that? Because, when they train in the Dharma that the Tathāgata has taught, they directly realize and hold to the nature of reality (dharmatā). And whatever they, having directly realized and held to the nature of reality, then expound, teach, explain, express, clarify, and make perfectly clear in any and all ways — all of that is in accord with the nature of reality. Venerable Śāriputra, the fact that those sons of good family who thus expound the nature of reality are in accord with the nature of reality is itself concordant with the teaching of Dharma by the Tathāgata."

Then, by the power of the Buddha, the Venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One as follows: "Blessed One, you have said: 'Subhūti, beginning from the Perfection of Wisdom of the great bodhisattvas, speak with confidence in the very way that great bodhisattvas would come to enter into the Perfection of Wisdom.' Blessed One, as for what is called 'bodhisattva' — this very word 'bodhisattva': of which phenomenon is it the name? Blessed One, I do not see the phenomenon designated by the name 'bodhisattva' as truly existing anywhere at all."

"Blessed One, likewise the phenomenon called 'the Perfection of Wisdom' — this too I do not find anywhere as truly existing. Blessed One, neither the bodhisattva nor the phenomena of a bodhisattva do I seek out, apprehend, or find as truly existing; and the Perfection of Wisdom likewise I do not seek out, apprehend, or find as truly existing. If this is so, then which bodhisattva shall I instruct and guide in which Perfection of Wisdom? Blessed One, yet if, even when it is spoken of, taught, and explained in this way, a bodhisattva, a great being, does not lose heart, does not shrink back entirely, does not feel shame

or embarrassment, does not become dismayed, does not let his mind turn away and waver, does not become broken and turn back, is not frightened, does not become altogether terrified, does not fall into a state of utter dread — then this itself is what I shall teach as the Perfection of Wisdom for the bodhisattva, the great being. This itself I shall recognize as the Perfection of Wisdom of that bodhisattva, that great being. This itself is the instruction in the Perfection of Wisdom. If one abides in just that way, then that itself is the instruction and guidance in it.

"Blessed One, furthermore, when a bodhisattva, a great being, is engaging in the Perfection of Wisdom and cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom, he should train in such a way that he does not make even the awakening mind (bodhicitta) itself into an object of conceit. Why? Because this mind is no-mind: the intrinsic nature of mind is luminosity (prabhāsvara)."

Then the Venerable Śāriputra said to the Venerable Subhūti: "Venerable Subhūti, does that mind which is no-mind actually exist?"

When this was said, the Venerable Subhūti replied to the Venerable Śāriputra: "Venerable Śāriputra, can the very fact of being no-mind — that no-mind-ness itself — be apprehended as existing or not existing, or be cognized at all?"

Śāriputra said: "Venerable Subhūti, it cannot."

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, if in that very no-mind-ness there is nothing that exists or does not exist, and nothing to be apprehended — then, Venerable Śāriputra, is the question you asked, 'Does that mind which is no-mind exist?' — is that question at all proper?"

When this was said, the Venerable Śāriputra said to the Venerable Subhūti: "Venerable Subhūti, then what is this no-mind-ness itself?"

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, that no-mind is unchanging and free from conceptual thought."

Then the Venerable Śāriputra gave his approval to the Venerable Subhūti, saying: "Excellent! Venerable Subhūti, you have taught well — just as the Blessed One has declared you foremost among those who abide in freedom from affliction. Excellent, excellent! Therefore, one should also examine whether a bodhisattva, a great being, is irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And one should also recognize that a bodhisattva, a great being, is inseparable from the Perfection of Wisdom. Even those who wish to train in the stage of the śrāvakas should listen to this very

Perfection of Wisdom, take it up, retain it, read it, thoroughly master it, and proclaim it widely. They should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom and take it as their practice."

Those who wish to train in the stage of the pratyekabuddha should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, take it up, retain it, read it, thoroughly master it, and proclaim it widely. They should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom and take it as their practice. Those who wish to train in the stage of the bodhisattva should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, take it up, retain it, read it, thoroughly master it, and proclaim it widely. They should take this very Perfection of Wisdom as their practice, endowed with skillful means, in order to attain all the qualities of a bodhisattva. Why is that? Because it is from this very Perfection of Wisdom that all the qualities of a bodhisattva in which a bodhisattva, a great being, should train and take as practice are taught in full. Those who wish to train in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, take it up, retain it, read it, thoroughly master it, and proclaim it widely. They should take this very Perfection of Wisdom as their practice, endowed with skillful means, in order to attain all the qualities of a buddha. Why is that? Because it is from this very Perfection of Wisdom that all the qualities of a buddha in which a bodhisattva, a great being, should train and take as practice are taught in full.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I have not sought, not apprehended, and not rightly perceived this very name 'bodhisattva.' Nor have I sought, not apprehended, and not rightly perceived the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, since I have not sought, not apprehended, and not rightly perceived this very name 'bodhisattva,' and have not sought, not apprehended, and not rightly perceived the Perfection of Wisdom either — to which bodhisattva, and in which Perfection of Wisdom, should I give instruction and guidance? Blessed One, when I have not sought any thing, not apprehended it, and not rightly perceived it, to gather and arrange under the mere label 'bodhisattva' — this, it seems to me, would be a presumption on my part. Blessed One, yet even that name neither abides nor does not abide; it is neither separated from abiding nor not separated from abiding. Why so? Because that name is not found to exist. In just that way, the name neither abides nor does not abide, and is neither separated from abiding nor not separated from abiding.

Blessed One, if, when the profound Perfection of Wisdom is being explained, taught, and expounded in this way, the mind of a bodhisattva, a great being, does not sink, does not shrink entirely, does not feel ashamed, does not become dejected, does not turn away in thought, does not collapse and turn back, is not timid, is not altogether frightened, and does not become thoroughly fearful — then one should know that such a bodhisattva, a great being, who is devoted with a superior aspiration, is inseparable from the Perfection of Wisdom. They abide on the stage of an irreversible bodhisattva — abiding well, in the manner of non-abiding.

Blessed One, furthermore, a bodhisattva, a great being, who practices the Perfection of Wisdom and cultivates the Perfection of Wisdom does not take up abiding in form. Likewise, they do not abide in feeling, nor in perception, nor in formations, nor in consciousness. Why is that?"

If one abides in form, one moves in the fabrication of form — and that is not practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise, if one abides in feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness, one moves in the fabrication of consciousness — and that is not practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. Why is that? Because one who moves in fabrication neither fully grasps the Perfection of Wisdom, nor practices yoga in the Perfection of Wisdom, nor brings the Perfection of Wisdom to complete fulfillment. And if the Perfection of Wisdom is not brought to complete fulfillment, then through grasping at what is not to be grasped, one will not come to emerge definitively into omniscience.

Why is that? Because in the Perfection of Wisdom there is no grasping at form. Likewise, in the Perfection of Wisdom there is no grasping at feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. That which is the non-grasping of form — that is not form. Likewise, that which is feeling, that which is perception, those which are formations, and that which is the non-grasping of consciousness — that is not consciousness. And this Perfection of Wisdom itself is likewise without grasping.

It is in just this way that a bodhisattva, a great being, should practice this Perfection of Wisdom. This, moreover, is called the meditative absorption of the bodhisattva, the great being, known as "the non-grasping at all phenomena" — one that is vast, limitless in its certainty and scope, and not shared in common with all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

Omniscience itself is also without grasping and is not to be held as a defining mark. Were it to be held as a mark, Kuntu Gyupa Threngwacan would not have

faith in it. Yet Kuntu Gyupa Threngwacan, having generated devoted interest in this wisdom of omniscience, follows it with faith, enters it with one-pointed wisdom, and upon entering, does not grasp at form. Likewise, one does not grasp at feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness.

That knowing awareness is not found to follow delight and pleasure. That knowing awareness is not found to follow interior form. That knowing awareness is not found to follow exterior form. That knowing awareness is not found to follow interior-and-exterior form. Nor is that knowing awareness found to follow anything other than form. Likewise, that knowing awareness does not follow the interior feeling, perception, and formations. That knowing awareness is not found to follow interior consciousness. That knowing awareness is not found to follow exterior consciousness. That knowing awareness is not found to follow interior-and-exterior consciousness. Nor is that knowing awareness found to follow anything other than consciousness. It is in this enumeration of expressions that Kuntu Gyupa Threngwacan generates devoted interest.

He follows this wisdom of omniscience with complete faith in every respect, and taking the nature of reality as his measure, he is said to be thus devoted. He does not grasp at any phenomenon whatsoever. He perceives no phenomenon that he would grasp or release. And he does not conceive of himself as having attained nirvāṇa.

Blessed One, this too should be understood as the Perfection of Wisdom of a bodhisattva, a great being: one who does not fully grasp at form, and likewise does not fully grasp at feeling, perception, and formations, and does not fully grasp at consciousness; and who, without abandoning midway the ten powers of the Tathāgata, the four fearlessnesses of the Tathāgata, and the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, does not pass into nirvāṇa before they are fully perfected. Therefore, Blessed One, this too should be understood as the Perfection of Wisdom of a bodhisattva, a great being.

Blessed One, furthermore, a bodhisattva, a great being, who is engaged in the Perfection of Wisdom and who cultivates the Perfection of Wisdom should closely examine and carefully reflect in this way: "What is this Perfection of Wisdom? Whose is this Perfection of Wisdom? Is that which is without any phenomenon and without any referential object the Perfection of Wisdom?" If one examines closely and reflects carefully in this way, and yet does not grow despondent, does not lose heart, feels no embarrassment, does not become

dismayed, does not let one's mind turn away, does not become broken and turn away, does not tremble, does not become frightened, does not fall into continual fear — then it should be understood that such a bodhisattva, a great being, has not parted from the Perfection of Wisdom.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said this to the venerable Subhūti: "Venerable Subhūti, when form itself is devoid of the essential nature of form, and likewise when feeling itself and perception itself and formations themselves are devoid of their essential nature, and likewise when consciousness itself is also devoid of the essential nature of consciousness, when the Perfection of Wisdom itself is also devoid of the essential nature of the Perfection of Wisdom, and when omniscience itself is also devoid of the essential nature of omniscience — for what reason should it be understood that the bodhisattva, the great being, has not parted from the Perfection of Wisdom?"

When he had spoken thus, the venerable Subhūti replied to the venerable Śāriputra: "Venerable Śāriputra, just so, just so. Śāriputra, form itself is devoid of the essential nature of form. Likewise, feeling itself and perception itself and formations themselves are devoid of their essential nature, and likewise, venerable Śāriputra, consciousness itself is also devoid of the essential nature of consciousness. Venerable Śāriputra, the Perfection of Wisdom itself is also devoid of the essential nature of the Perfection of Wisdom. Venerable Śāriputra, omniscience itself is also devoid of the essential nature of omniscience. The Perfection of Wisdom is moreover devoid of the defining mark of the Perfection of Wisdom. The defining mark is moreover devoid of the essential nature of a defining mark. The basis of the defining mark is moreover devoid of the essential nature of the basis of a defining mark. Essential nature is moreover devoid of the defining mark of essential nature."

When he had spoken thus, the venerable Śāriputra said this to the venerable Subhūti: "Venerable Subhūti, will every bodhisattva, every great being, who trains in this surely arrive at omniscience?"

The venerable Subhūti replied: "Venerable Śāriputra, just so, just so. Every bodhisattva, every great being, who trains in this will surely arrive at omniscience. And why is that?"

"Venerable Śāriputra, all phenomena are without definitive arising and are unborn. Venerable Śāriputra, the bodhisattva, the great being, who practices in that way will draw near to omniscience. And to whatever degree they draw near to omniscience, to that very degree, for the sake of bringing sentient

beings to full maturation, they will also draw near to purity of body and mind, purity of the major marks, purity of the buddha-field, and proximity to the buddhas. Venerable Śāriputra, a bodhisattva, a great being, who practices the Perfection of Wisdom in that way is drawing near to omniscience."

Then the venerable Subhūti, turning to the bodhisattvas, the great beings, said this: "If one practices with regard to form, one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with regard to the sign of form, one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with the thought 'form is a sign,' one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with regard to the arising of form, one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with regard to the cessation of form, one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with regard to the disintegration of form, one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with the thought 'form is empty,' one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with the thought 'I am practicing,' one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with the thought 'I am a bodhisattva,' one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one thinks 'I am a bodhisattva,' one is practicing with regard to an observed object itself.

"Likewise, if one practices with regard to feeling, perception, and formations, or if one practices with regard to consciousness, one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with regard to the sign of consciousness, one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with the thought 'consciousness is a sign,' one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with regard to the arising of consciousness, one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with regard to the cessation of consciousness, one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with regard to the disintegration of consciousness, one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with the thought 'consciousness is empty,' one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with the thought 'I am practicing,' one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one practices with the thought 'I am a bodhisattva,' one is practicing with regard to a sign. If one thinks 'I am a bodhisattva,' one is practicing with regard to an observed object itself.

"Furthermore, if someone thinks 'whoever practices in that way is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom — that one is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom' — if they think thus, they are practicing with regard to signs, and this bodhisattva should be understood as one who is unskillful in means."

Then the venerable Śāriputra said this to the venerable Subhūti: "Venerable Subhūti, how then should a bodhisattva, a great being, practice in order to be practicing the Perfection of Wisdom?"

When he had spoken thus, the venerable Subhūti said this to the venerable Śāriputra: "Venerable Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva, a great being, does not practice with regard to form, does not practice with regard to the sign of form, does not practice with the thought 'form is a sign,' does not practice with regard to the arising of form, does not practice with regard to the cessation of form, does not practice with regard to the disintegration of form, does not practice with the thought 'form is empty,' does not practice with the thought 'I am practicing,' does not practice with the thought 'I am a bodhisattva,' does not practice with regard to the observed object of the thought 'I am a bodhisattva' — and likewise does not practice with regard to feeling, does not practice with regard to perception, does not practice with regard to formations, does not practice with regard to consciousness, does not practice with regard to the sign of consciousness, does not practice with the thought 'consciousness is a sign,' does not practice with regard to the arising of consciousness —

does not practice with regard to the cessation of consciousness, does not practice with regard to the destruction of consciousness, does not practice with the thought 'consciousness is empty,' does not practice with the thought 'I am practicing,' does not practice with the thought 'I am a bodhisattva,' and does not practice with regard to the observed object of the thought 'I am a bodhisattva.'

And if someone were to think, 'One who practices in that very way is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom, and is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom' — one does not think even that. The bodhisattva, the great being, who is practicing right now in this way, is indeed practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. Yet even while practicing, one does not conceive 'I am practicing.' One does not conceive 'I am not practicing.' One does not conceive 'I am both practicing and not practicing.' One does not conceive 'I am neither practicing nor not practicing.' One does not conceive 'There is something to be practiced.' One does not conceive 'There is nothing to be practiced.' One does not conceive 'There is something to be practiced and also something not to be practiced.' One does not conceive 'There is neither something to be practiced nor something not to be practiced.' Why is that? Because all phenomena are not conceived and not grasped.

This is the meditative absorption of the bodhisattva, the great being, called 'the non-appropriation of all phenomena' — vast, open, definite, and not shared in common with any śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha. The bodhisattva, the great being, who abides in this meditative absorption will swiftly awaken to the unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening.

Thereupon, the venerable Subhūti, sustained by the power of the Buddha, spoke these words: 'Blessed One, the bodhisattva, the great being, who abides in this meditative absorption — has that one not been prophesied to unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening by the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas of the past? That one does not rightly perceive even that meditative absorption; that one does not conceive pride on account of the meditative absorption. I am in meditative equipoise; I am entering into meditative absorption; I am established in meditative absorption; I have entered into meditative absorption — no such thoughts arise in any way, from any direction, in any aspect whatsoever.'

When he had said this, the venerable Śāriputra spoke to the venerable Subhūti: 'Venerable Subhūti, can you point out that meditative absorption — the meditative absorption abiding in which a bodhisattva, a great being, is prophesied to unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening by the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas?'

Subhūti replied: 'Venerable Śāriputra, I cannot. Why is that? Because that son of good family does not know that meditative absorption, does not know it rightly.'

The venerable Śāriputra said: 'Venerable Subhūti, do you say that one does not know it, does not know it rightly?'

The venerable Subhūti said: 'Venerable Śāriputra, yes, I do say that one does not know it, does not know it rightly. Why is that? Because that meditative absorption is not to be found — therefore one does not know it, does not know it rightly. Indeed, even that meditative absorption itself, one does not know, does not know rightly.'

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Subhūti: 'Excellent!' — and declared: 'Just as you have taught this, Subhūti, empowered by the Tathāgata's might and blessed by the Tathāgata's blessing — excellent, Subhūti, excellent! Subhūti, it is just so, it is exactly so.'

The bodhisattva, the great being, must train in exactly this way. Why is that? Because when a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in this way, he trains in the Perfection of Wisdom.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to the Blessed One: 'Blessed One, when a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in this way, is he indeed training in the Perfection of Wisdom?'

When he had said this, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Śāriputra: 'Śāriputra, when a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in this way, he is indeed training in the Perfection of Wisdom.'

When the Blessed One had said this, the venerable Śāriputra said to him: 'Blessed One, when a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in this way, in what phenomenon is he training?'

When he had said this, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Śāriputra: 'Śāriputra, when a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in this way, he is not training in any phenomenon whatsoever. Why is that? Because those phenomena do not exist in the way that ordinary childlike persons without learning cling to them. The venerable Śāriputra asked: 'Blessed One, then in what way do they exist?' The Blessed One declared: 'Śāriputra, they exist truly in the way that they do not exist, and because they are absent in that way, this is called ignorance. To those phenomena, ordinary childlike persons without learning become attached, and they conceptualize all phenomena as nonexistent. Having so conceptualized them, clinging to the two extremes, they do not know and do not see those phenomena. Therefore, even as those phenomena are absent, they conceptualize all phenomena. Having conceptualized them, they become attached to the two extremes. Abiding in that attachment with its basis in reference points, they conceptualize past phenomena, they conceptualize future phenomena, they conceptualize present phenomena. Having so conceptualized, they become fixated on name and form. They conceptualize all phenomena as nonexistent. And having conceptualized all those phenomena as nonexistent, they do not know and do not see the true path as it really is. Not knowing and not seeing the true path as it really is, they do not emerge with certainty from the three realms and do not enter into the true end of reality — and for that reason they are counted among those called childlike. They do not place their trust in the true Dharma. Śāriputra, great bodhisattvas, great beings, do not become attached to any phenomenon whatsoever.'

When the Blessed One had said this, the venerable Śāriputra said to him: 'Blessed One, when a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in this way, is he training in omniscience (sarvākārajñatā)?'

The Blessed One declared: 'Śāriputra, when a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in this way, he trains in omniscience. Śāriputra, when a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in this way, he trains in all phenomena. Śāriputra, when a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in this way, he will come to train in omniscience, he will draw near to omniscience, and he will with certainty emerge into omniscience.'

Then the venerable Subhūti said to the Blessed One: 'Blessed One, if someone were to ask this: "Will this illusory person train in omniscience? Will he draw near to omniscience? Will he with certainty emerge into omniscience?" — if someone were to ask in those words, Blessed One, how should I explain this to them?'

The Blessed One then spoke these words to the venerable Subhūti: 'Therefore, Subhūti, I turn the question back to you. Explain it as best you can.'

'Very well, Blessed One,' said Subhūti, and he listened attentively to the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One declared: 'Subhūti, what do you think — is the illusion one thing and its form another? Is the illusion one thing and its feeling another, its perception another, its formations another?'

And again: 'Subhūti, what do you think — is the illusion one thing and its consciousness another?'

Subhūti replied: 'That is not so, Blessed One. The illusion is not one thing and form another. Blessed One, form itself is illusion, and illusion itself is form. Likewise, Blessed One, the illusion is not one thing and feeling another, perception another, formations another. Blessed One, feeling, perception, and formations themselves are illusion, and illusion itself is feeling, perception, and formations. Blessed One, the illusion is not one thing and consciousness another. Blessed One, consciousness itself is illusion, and illusion itself is consciousness.'

The Blessed One then declared: 'Subhūti, what do you think — do these five appropriated aggregates (skandhas) carry the perception, the full recognition, the discernment, and the designation "bodhisattva"?'

When this was said, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One thus: 'It is so, Blessed One; it is just so, O Sugata. Blessed One, a bodhisattva, a great being, training in the Perfection of Wisdom, trains in unsurpassed, complete, perfect awakening just as an illusory person would. Why is that? Blessed One, those very five appropriated aggregates are to be held as the illusory person. Why is that? Because, Blessed One, as the Blessed One has declared, form is like an illusion — and form, whatever it may be, is precisely those five aggregates together with the six sense faculties. Blessed One, as the Blessed One has declared, feeling, perception, and formations are like an illusion; and as the Blessed One has declared, consciousness too is like an illusion — and consciousness, whatever it may be, is precisely those five aggregates together with the six sense faculties.

Blessed One, when newly entered bodhisattvas, great beings, hear this teaching, will they not be overcome with fright, utter terror, and dread?'

The Blessed One declared: 'Subhūti, if newly entered bodhisattvas, great beings, have come under the sway of an evil companion, then they will indeed be overcome with fright, utter terror, and dread. But, Subhūti, if newly entered bodhisattvas, great beings, have come under the guidance of a spiritual friend, they will not be frightened, not utterly terrified, and will not be overcome with dread.'

When this was said, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One thus: 'Blessed One, how shall we recognize who the spiritual friends of bodhisattvas, great beings, are?'

The Blessed One declared: 'They are those who teach and guide such bodhisattvas in the perfections; and they are those who point out to such bodhisattvas the deeds of Māra —'

and that the faults of Māra are to be recognized as such, that these are the faults of Māra, and that these are the deeds of Māra — one should recognize these as such, and having recognized these deeds of Māra, you should abandon them. Subhūti, these are to be known as the spiritual friends of bodhisattvas, great beings — those who have donned the great armor, who have rightly entered the Great Vehicle, and who rightly abide in the Great Vehicle.'

When this was said, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One thus: 'Blessed One, you have declared: "Subhūti, these are to be known as the spiritual friends of bodhisattvas, great beings — those who have donned the

great armor, who have rightly entered the Great Vehicle, and who rightly abide in the Great Vehicle." Blessed One, when you also declared "bodhisattva, great being," what is the underlying meaning of the word "bodhisattva"?

When this was asked, the Blessed One addressed the venerable Subhūti thus: 'Subhūti, the underlying meaning of "bodhisattva" is that there is no underlying meaning. Why is that? Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in non-attachment to all phenomena. Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, in being non-attached for the sake of fully comprehending all phenomena, fully and perfectly awakens to unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening. Subhūti, because one strives for awakening, one is called a bodhisattva, a great being.'

The venerable Subhūti asked: 'Blessed One, you have declared "bodhisattva, great being." Blessed One, for what reason is one called a bodhisattva, a great being?'

The Blessed One declared: 'It is because one aspires to be the foremost among the great multitude of sentient beings, the supreme of the great assemblies of sentient beings. For that reason, one is called a bodhisattva, a great being.'

Then the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One thus: 'Blessed One, I too venture to offer a reason why one is called a bodhisattva, a great being.'

The Blessed One declared: 'Śāriputra, if you know that the time is right, venture to speak.'

The venerable Śāriputra said: 'It is because the Dharma is taught for the purpose of abandoning such views as the view of a self, the view of a sentient being, the view of a living soul, the view of a person, the view of arising, the view of perishing, the view of annihilation, the view of permanence, and this great view pertaining to one's own body, and other such views. For that reason, one is called a bodhisattva, a great being.'

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One thus: 'Blessed One, I too venture to offer a reason why one is called a bodhisattva, a great being.'

The Blessed One declared: 'Subhūti, if you know that the time is right, venture to speak.'

The venerable Subhūti said: 'Blessed One, one is called a bodhisattva, a great being because that awakening mind — the mind of omniscience, the undefiled mind, the unequalled mind, the mind that is equal to the unequalled, the mind not shared in common with any śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha — toward that

very mind one is not attached and does not cling to it. Why is that? It is because that very mind of omniscience is itself undefiled and unclung-to.'

That very mind of omniscience — the undefiled mind, unclung-to — is itself not attached to and not clung to, and it is for that reason that one is counted among those called a bodhisattva, a great being.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said this to the venerable Subhūti: 'Venerable Subhūti, for what reason is there no attachment to and no clinging to that mind?'

Subhūti replied: 'Venerable Śāriputra, because mind is without mind, there is no attachment to and no clinging to that mind.'

Śāriputra said: 'Venerable Subhūti, but then, does that mind — the mind that is without mind — actually exist?'

Subhūti replied: 'Venerable Śāriputra, could that which is without mind be apprehended as existing or non-existing?'

Śāriputra said: 'Venerable Subhūti, it could not.'

Subhūti replied: 'Venerable Śāriputra, if that which is without mind has in it neither existence nor non-existence, and is not apprehended at all, then how could one speak of a mind that is without mind as existing?'

Śāriputra said: 'Venerable Subhūti, you teach just as the Blessed One has declared: you are the foremost among those who abide without affliction. Excellent!'

Then the venerable Maitreya, son of Maitrā, addressed the Blessed One in these words: 'Blessed One, as for what is called a great being, a great being — that bodhisattva has donned the great armor, and that bodhisattva has entered the Great Vehicle rightly and dwells in the Great Vehicle rightly. It is for that reason that one is counted among those called a great being, a great being.'

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One in these words: 'Blessed One, when one speaks of "donning the great armor, donning the great armor," to what extent, Blessed One, has a bodhisattva, a great being, donned the great armor?'

The Blessed One declared: 'Subhūti, here a bodhisattva, a great being, thinks: "I shall lead immeasurable, innumerable sentient beings to complete nirvāṇa. I shall lead countless sentient beings to complete nirvāṇa." And yet those very

sentient beings who are thus led to complete nirvāṇa — even those do not exist. Nevertheless, that bodhisattva leads all those vast numbers of sentient beings to complete nirvāṇa, while neither those who are led to complete nirvāṇa nor the one who leads them to complete nirvāṇa exist as anything whatsoever. Why is that? Subhūti, it is because the nature of reality of an illusion applies here, for this is the nature of reality of all phenomena. Subhūti, consider, for example, a skilled illusionist, or the apprentice of an illusionist, who at the great crossroads of a broad highway conjures up a great multitude of people, conjures them up and then makes that great multitude disappear. Subhūti, what do you think? Was there anyone who killed or died or was destroyed or was made to disappear?'

Subhūti replied: 'Blessed One, there was not.'

The Blessed One declared: 'Subhūti, in just the same way, a bodhisattva, a great being, leads immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings to complete nirvāṇa, yet there is no one whatsoever who is led to complete nirvāṇa and no sentient being who is led to complete nirvāṇa by anyone.'

'If, upon hearing a teaching such as this, a bodhisattva, a great being, is not terrified, not utterly frightened, does not fall into utter fear — by this alone, Subhūti, that bodhisattva, that great being, is to be understood as one who has donned the great armor.'

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: 'Blessed One, how wonderful! Blessed One, according to the meaning of what the Blessed One has declared, as I understand it, this bodhisattva, this great being, is to be understood as one who has donned armor that is without armor.'

The Blessed One declared: 'Subhūti, it is exactly so. This bodhisattva, this great being, is to be understood as one who has donned armor that is without armor. Why is that? Subhūti, omniscience itself is uncreated, untransformed, and unconstructed. And the sentient beings for whose sake this armor has been donned — those sentient beings too are uncreated, untransformed, and unconstructed.'

When this was declared, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: 'Blessed One, it is just so. Sugata, it is just so. Why is that? Blessed One, form is neither bound nor liberated. Likewise, feeling, perception, and formations — and, Blessed One, consciousness is neither bound nor liberated. Blessed One, the suchness of form too is neither bound nor

liberated. Likewise, the suchness of feeling, the suchness of perception, the suchness of formations — and, Blessed One, the suchness of consciousness too is neither bound nor liberated.'

Then the venerable Gaṅgaputra Maitrāyaṇīputra said to the venerable Subhūti: 'Venerable Subhūti, do you say that form is neither bound nor liberated? Likewise, do you say that feeling, perception, and formations — and, venerable Subhūti, that consciousness is neither bound nor liberated? Do you say, venerable Subhūti, that the suchness of form too is neither bound nor liberated? Likewise, do you say that the suchness of feeling, the suchness of perception, the suchness of formations — and, venerable Subhūti, that the suchness of consciousness too is neither bound nor liberated?

Venerable Subhūti, then what is that form which you call neither bound nor liberated? What is that feeling, that perception, those formations — and, venerable Subhūti, what is that consciousness which you call neither bound nor liberated? Venerable Subhūti, what is that suchness of form which you call neither bound nor liberated? Likewise, what is that suchness of feeling, that suchness of perception, that suchness of formations? And, venerable Subhūti, what is that suchness of consciousness which you call neither bound nor liberated?'

When this was said, the venerable Subhūti replied to the venerable Gaṅgaputra Maitrāyaṇīputra with these words: 'Venerable Gaṅgaputra, the form of an illusory person — whatever that is — is neither bound nor liberated. Likewise, the feeling of an illusory person — whatever that is — the perception of an illusory person, the formations of an illusory person; and, venerable Gaṅgaputra, the consciousness of an illusory person — whatever that is — is neither bound nor liberated. Venerable Gaṅgaputra, the suchness of the form of an illusory person — whatever that is — is neither bound nor liberated.

Likewise, the suchness of the feeling of an illusory person, the suchness of the perception of an illusory person, the suchness of the formations of an illusory person — whatever those are — and, venerable Gaṅgaputra, the suchness of the consciousness of an illusory person — whatever that is — is neither bound nor liberated. And why is that? Because it is not real, it is neither bound nor liberated. Because it is solitary and apart, it is neither bound nor liberated. Because it is unborn, it is neither bound nor liberated. These, then, constitute the great armor of the bodhisattva, the great being — an armor without armor, of one who has rightly entered the Great Vehicle and rightly abides in the

Great Vehicle.

When this was said, the venerable Gaṅgaputra Maitrāyaṇīputra was silent and said nothing.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, what then is this Great Vehicle — the Great Vehicle in which the bodhisattva, the great being, has donned the great armor, rightly entered, and rightly abides? How is one to understand that one has rightly entered the Great Vehicle? From where does one emerge through the Great Vehicle? By means of what has one rightly entered the Great Vehicle? Where does one come to abide through the Great Vehicle? And from what does one emerge through the Great Vehicle?

When this was asked, the Blessed One replied to the venerable Subhūti with these words: Subhūti, this called 'the Great Vehicle' — that is an expression whose meaning is immeasurable. Subhūti, the reason it is called immeasurable is that it is without measure. Subhūti, as for one who asks: how is one to understand that one has rightly entered the Great Vehicle, from where does one emerge through it, by means of what has one rightly entered it, where does one come to abide through it, and from what does one emerge through it — the answer is this: one rightly enters through the perfections, one emerges from the three realms, and one abides in omniscience by entering through non-apprehension. The bodhisattva, the great being, thus emerges — and yet there is no place from which one emerges, no means by which one has rightly entered, no place where one comes to abide; yet by way of non-abiding, one comes to abide in omniscience. And through the Great Vehicle one has not drawn anything out, will not emerge from anything, and there is no emergence — for the phenomenon that emerges and the phenomenon by means of which it emerges are both absent and unapprehended. This being so, when all phenomena are absent and unapprehended, what phenomenon could emerge from what phenomenon?

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, what is referred to as 'the Great Vehicle, the Great Vehicle' is that from which one emerges having overwhelmed the world together with its gods, humans, and asuras. Because it is equal to space, it is the Great Vehicle. Just as space affords room for sentient beings beyond measure, beyond count, beyond limit, so too, Blessed One, the Great Vehicle affords room for sentient beings beyond measure,

beyond count, beyond limit. By this reasoning, Blessed One, this is the Great Vehicle of bodhisattvas, the great beings. In it no coming is seen, no going is seen, and no abiding in it exists.

Blessed One, in this Great Vehicle no former limit is perceived, no latter limit is perceived, and no middle is perceived either. Blessed One, this vehicle is equal throughout the three times. For that reason it is called the Great Vehicle, the Great Vehicle.

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the Venerable Subhūti, saying: "Excellent! Excellent, Subhūti! That is so, that is exactly so. This, then, is the Great Vehicle of bodhisattvas, the great beings. Through training in it, bodhisattvas, the great beings, have attained omniscience, have attained it, and will attain it."

Then the Venerable Gaṅgadevīputra addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, does the Elder Subhūti intend to teach the Great Vehicle through the blessing of the Perfection of Wisdom?"

Then the Venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, would I not be presenting the Great Vehicle in a manner contrary to the Perfection of Wisdom?"

The Blessed One declared: "Not so, Subhūti. You are presenting the Great Vehicle in accordance with the Perfection of Wisdom."

When this was declared, the Venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One once more: "Blessed One, it is by the power of the buddhas. Blessed One, furthermore, a bodhisattva does not apprehend the former limit, a bodhisattva does not apprehend the latter limit, and a bodhisattva does not apprehend a middle. Why does the bodhisattva not apprehend them? Because form is without limit, a bodhisattva too is to be known as without limit. Likewise, because feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are without limit, a bodhisattva too is to be known as without limit. One does not apprehend 'form is the bodhisattva' — that too is absent, unperceived. Likewise, one does not apprehend 'feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are the bodhisattva' — that too is absent, unperceived.

"Blessed One, since in this way I do not perceive any phenomenon of a bodhisattva, from any direction, in any aspect, in any respect whatsoever — Blessed One, I do not correctly see the very dharma that bears the name bodhisattva. I do not correctly see, do not perceive, the Perfection of Wisdom. I

do not correctly see, do not perceive, omniscience. Blessed One, since in every direction, in every aspect, in every respect, I have not correctly seen and not perceived any phenomenon, what dharma, by means of what dharma, to what dharma, would I be advising and instructing?

"Blessed One, the word 'buddha' is a mere name. Blessed One, the word 'bodhisattva' too is a mere name. Blessed One, the word 'Perfection of Wisdom' too is a mere name. That name also is not ultimately established. Blessed One, it is just as with the word 'self' — though one speaks of 'self,' Blessed One, the self is exceedingly unestablished. Likewise all phenomena are without essential nature: what, then, is form that is not to be grasped and is unestablished? What are feeling, perception, and formations? And what is consciousness that is not to be grasped and is unestablished?"

That which is the absence of essential nature in all those phenomena is itself not ultimately established. And that which is the non-ultimate-establishment of all phenomena is itself not a phenomenon. Therefore, since the Perfection of Wisdom is not ultimately established, and that which is not ultimately established is not ultimately established, what instruction and guidance is there to give? Blessed One, apart from what is not ultimately established, I perceive no phenomenon whatsoever — no qualities of a buddha, no qualities of a bodhisattva, and no engagement in awakening.

Blessed One, if, when one teaches, instructs, and thoroughly explains in this way, the mind of a bodhisattva, a great being, does not falter, does not shrink back, does not become ashamed, does not become discouraged, does not turn away in thought, does not become broken and turn aside, does not tremble, does not become frightened, does not become seized by terror — then know that this bodhisattva, this great being, is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. This bodhisattva, this great being, is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. This bodhisattva, this great being, is reflecting closely upon the Perfection of Wisdom. This bodhisattva, this great being, is directing the mind resolutely toward the Perfection of Wisdom. So it should be understood.

Why is that? Blessed One, when a bodhisattva, a great being, reflects closely upon all these phenomena in the Perfection of Wisdom, at that time he does not apprehend form, does not grasp at form, does not truly follow after the arising of form, and does not truly follow after the ceasing of form. Likewise he does not apprehend feeling, does not apprehend perception, does not apprehend formations; he does not apprehend consciousness, does not grasp

at consciousness, does not truly follow after the arising of consciousness, and does not truly follow after the ceasing of consciousness.

Why is that? Because that which is the absence of arising of form is not form, and that which is the absence of ceasing of form is not form. Therefore the absence of arising and what is called form are not two and are not to be made two. Likewise the absence of ceasing and what is called form are not two and are not to be made two. And so what is spoken of as form belongs to the category of non-duality.

In the same way, whatever is feeling, whatever is perception, whatever is formations — and likewise that which is the absence of arising of consciousness is not consciousness, and that which is the absence of ceasing of consciousness is not consciousness. Therefore the absence of arising and what is called consciousness are not two and are not to be made two. Likewise the absence of ceasing and what is called consciousness are not two and are not to be made two. And so what is spoken of as consciousness belongs to the category of non-duality.

Blessed One, when in the Perfection of Wisdom one reflects closely upon all phenomena in every respect, at that time one does not apprehend form, does not grasp at form, does not truly follow after the arising of form, and does not truly follow after the ceasing of form. Likewise one does not apprehend feeling, does not apprehend perception, does not apprehend formations.

One does not apprehend consciousness, does not grasp at consciousness, does not truly follow after the arising of consciousness, and does not truly follow after the ceasing of consciousness. Why is that? Because that which is the absence of arising of form is not form, and that which is the absence of ceasing of form is not form. Therefore the absence of arising and what is called form are not two and are not to be made two. Likewise the absence of ceasing and what is called form are not two and are not to be made two. And so what is spoken of as form belongs to the category of non-duality. In the same way, whatever is feeling, whatever is perception, whatever is formations — and likewise, that which is the absence of arising of consciousness is not consciousness, and that which is the absence of ceasing of consciousness is not consciousness. Therefore the absence of arising and what is called consciousness are not two and are not to be made two. Likewise the absence of ceasing and what is called consciousness are not two and are not to be made two. And so what is spoken of as consciousness belongs to the category

of non-duality.

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The Second Fascicle.

Then the Venerable Śāriputra said this to the Venerable Subhūti: "Therefore, as I understand the meaning of what the Venerable Subhūti has said, a bodhisattva too is without arising."

The Venerable Subhūti replied: "Venerable Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva is indeed without arising, then what enthusiasm could there be for a bodhisattva to engage in austerities, or to undergo all those sufferings on behalf of sentient beings?"

When this was said, the Venerable Subhūti then spoke to the Venerable Śāriputra as follows: "Venerable Śāriputra, I do not wish for a bodhisattva, a great being, to engage in austerities. Whoever practices with the perception of hardship will not even become a bodhisattva. Why is that? Venerable Śāriputra, one who has generated the perception of hardship will be unable to accomplish the aims of immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings. Rather, making it a perception of ease, one should generate toward all sentient beings the perception of them as mother, the perception of them as father, the perception of them as son, and the perception of them as daughter — and in the same way generating those perceptions toward men and women alike — and thus the bodhisattva, the great being, carries out the bodhisattva's practice. Therefore a bodhisattva, a great being, should generate toward all sentient beings the perception of mother, the perception of father, the perception of son, the perception of daughter, and even the perception of oneself, thinking: just as I am to be liberated from all suffering in every way and in every respect, so are all sentient beings to be liberated from all suffering in every way and in every respect. One should thus generate that perception toward all sentient beings, thinking: I will not abandon any of these sentient beings. I will liberate all these sentient beings from the immeasurable mass of suffering. Even if my body were cut into a hundred pieces and I were small and weak, I would not even give rise to a harmful thought toward them. Thus should a bodhisattva, a great being, arouse the mind."

If a sentient being abides in this way, such a one does not act with a perception of hardship, nor does one abide with a perception of hardship. Furthermore, venerable Śāriputra, a bodhisattva, a great being, should arouse the mind by thinking: just as I myself am, in every way and in every respect, utterly empty and without object of observation, so too are all phenomena, in

every way and in every respect, utterly empty and without object of observation. One should arouse just such a perception toward all inner and outer phenomena. If the mind acts in this way, one does not act with a perception of hardship, nor does one abide with a perception of hardship.

When venerable Śāriputra said, "A bodhisattva too is without arising," Subhūti replied: "That is so, venerable Śāriputra, that is indeed so. A bodhisattva is without arising."

Śāriputra said: "Venerable Subhūti, is it only the bodhisattva that is without arising, or are the phenomena of the bodhisattva also without arising?"

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, the phenomena of the bodhisattva too are without arising."

Śāriputra said: "Venerable Subhūti, is it only the phenomena of the bodhisattva that are without arising, or is omniscience too without arising?"

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, omniscience too is without arising."

Śāriputra said: "Venerable Subhūti, is it only omniscience that is without arising, or are the phenomena of omniscience also without arising?"

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, the phenomena of omniscience too are without arising."

Śāriputra said: "Venerable Subhūti, is it only the phenomena of omniscience that are without arising, or are ordinary persons too without arising?"

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, ordinary persons too are without arising."

Śāriputra said: "Venerable Subhūti, is it only the ordinary person that is without arising, or are the phenomena of ordinary persons also without arising?"

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, the phenomena of ordinary persons too are without arising."

When this was said, venerable Śāriputra spoke to venerable Subhūti as follows: "Venerable Subhūti, if the bodhisattva is without arising, the phenomena of the bodhisattva are without arising, omniscience is without arising, the phenomena of omniscience are without arising, ordinary persons are without arising, and the phenomena of ordinary persons are without arising — then, venerable Subhūti, how does a bodhisattva, a great being, attain omniscience?"

When this was said, venerable Subhūti spoke to venerable Śāriputra as follows: "Venerable Śāriputra, I do not wish to attain what has the nature of non-arising, nor do I realize it. What is attained by means of what has the nature of non-arising does not, being non-arising, come to attain the non-arisen."

Śāriputra said: "Venerable Subhūti, does what has the nature of non-arising attain what is arisen, or does what has the nature of what is arisen attain what is non-arisen?"

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, can what has the nature of non-arising be arisen?"

"But what has the nature of non-arising is itself non-arisen."

Śāriputra said: "Venerable Subhūti, is what has the nature of what is arisen itself non-arisen, or is what has the nature of what is non-arisen itself non-arisen?"

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, I do not presume to speak of a 'nature of what is arisen' or a 'nature of what is non-arisen.'"

Śāriputra said: "Venerable Subhūti, do you not presume even to speak of non-arising?"

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, it is precisely non-arising itself that I speak of. Venerable Śāriputra, it is precisely non-arising itself that is clearly apparent. Venerable Śāriputra, it is non-arising itself that I am confident to speak of; for, venerable Śāriputra, it is exactly as it is — clearly apparent as such."

When this was said, venerable Śāriputra spoke to venerable Subhūti as follows: "Venerable Subhūti is to be placed foremost among those who teach the Dharma. And why is that? Because the elder venerable Subhūti, in whatever matter he is thoroughly questioned, arrives at a definitive answer on that very matter, does not deviate from the nature of reality, and does not contradict that nature of reality."

When this was said, venerable Subhūti spoke to venerable Śāriputra as follows: "Venerable Śāriputra, this is the nature of reality of the Blessed One's śrāvakas who are without fixed abiding: in whatever matter they are thoroughly questioned, they arrive at a definitive answer on that very matter, do not contradict the nature of reality, and do not stray from the nature of reality. And why is that? Because all phenomena are without fixed abiding."

When this was said, venerable Śāriputra spoke to venerable Subhūti as follows: "Excellent, excellent, venerable Subhūti! What is this perfection of non-abiding in all phenomena belonging to the great bodhisattvas, the great beings?"

Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, it is precisely the Perfection of Wisdom that is the perfection of non-abiding in all phenomena for all vehicles, because all phenomena are without fixed abiding. Thus, when this profound Perfection of Wisdom is explained, taught, and demonstrated in this way, that great bodhisattva, the great being, whose mind does not shrink, does not become anxious, is not bewildered, and does not turn elsewhere — know that such a one abides in this abiding of the Perfection of Wisdom and is inseparable from this mental engagement."

Then venerable Śāriputra spoke to venerable Subhūti as follows: "Venerable Subhūti, how does the great bodhisattva, the great being, who abides in the abiding of the Perfection of Wisdom, remain inseparable from that mental engagement? Venerable Subhūti, if the great bodhisattva, the great being, is inseparable from that mental engagement, then in that case he would be separated from the abiding of the Perfection of Wisdom. And venerable Subhūti, if the great bodhisattva, the great being, is inseparable from abiding in the Perfection of Wisdom, then in that case he would be separated from that mental engagement."

"Venerable Subhūti, even if the great bodhisattva, the great being, were to be inseparable from that mental engagement and at the same time inseparable from the abiding of the Perfection of Wisdom, were that indeed the case, then all sentient beings too would be inseparable from the abiding of the Perfection of Wisdom. Why so? Because all sentient beings abide inseparably from mental engagement."

When this was said, venerable Subhūti spoke to venerable Śāriputra as follows: "Venerable Śāriputra, excellent, excellent! And yet you too will receive a counter-argument. For this very matter has been expressed in correct terms and is to be fully accepted as it stands. Why so? Venerable Śāriputra, because sentient beings have no essential nature, mental engagement too is to be understood as having no essential nature. Venerable Śāriputra, because sentient beings have no substantial existence, mental engagement too is to be understood as having no substantial existence. Venerable Śāriputra, because sentient beings are empty of inherent content, mental engagement too is to

be understood as empty of inherent content. Venerable Śāriputra, because sentient beings are inconceivable, mental engagement too is to be understood as inconceivable. Venerable Śāriputra, because sentient beings have not attained manifest perfect awakening, mental engagement too is to be understood as not having attained manifest perfect awakening. Venerable Śāriputra, because sentient beings have attained manifest perfect awakening for the sake of what is not reality as it truly is, mental engagement too is to be understood as having attained manifest perfect awakening for the sake of what is not reality as it truly is. Venerable Śāriputra, the great bodhisattva, the great being, wishes to abide in this mental engagement of such a nature and in this very abiding."

This concludes the first chapter, entitled "The Practice of Omniscience," from the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines.

At that time, Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, gathered in that very assembly together with forty thousand divine sons of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. The four great divine kings who guard the world also assembled there, accompanied by twenty thousand divine sons of the realm of the Four Great Kings. Brahmā, lord of the world of endurance, likewise assembled there, accompanied by ten thousand divine sons of the Brahma realms. Five thousand divine sons of the Pure Abodes also gathered in that very assembly. Whatever radiance had arisen from the karmic maturation of the gods' own actions was entirely overwhelmed by the power of the Buddha, the majesty of the Buddha, and the blessing of the Buddha.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, spoke to venerable Subhūti, the elder, as follows: "Noble Subhūti, these many thousands of divine sons who have assembled in this retinue wish to hear from noble Subhūti the close exposition, the instruction, and the sequential teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom for great bodhisattvas, the great beings. How should that great bodhisattva, that great being, abide in the Perfection of Wisdom? How should he train? How should he practice yoga?"

Venerable Subhūti replied: "Kauśika, therefore the close exposition is to be given by the power of the Buddha, the majesty of the Buddha, and the blessing of the Buddha. Those divine sons who have not yet aroused the mind aimed at unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening should arouse it. As for those who have entered into the certainty of the real, they have no share in arousing the mind aimed at unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Why

so?"

Because they have cut the stream of saṃsāra, they no longer turn again and again through cyclic existence, and so they have no share in arousing the mind aimed at unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Nevertheless, if they too were to arouse the mind aimed at unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, one should rejoice in that as well. As for me, I place no obstacle to their virtue; rather, one should direct one's attention above all to those qualities that are supremely excellent, transcending even the noble qualities.

Then the Blessed One declared to Venerable Subhūti: "Excellent, Subhūti, excellent! That you inspire enthusiasm in the great bodhisattvas, the great beings — in that too, Subhūti, you have done well."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, we shall indeed repay the kindness of the Blessed One; we shall not fail to repay it. Why so? Blessed One, just as you yourself, when you had formerly become a bodhisattva in the presence of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas of the past, practised the holy life for the sake of awakening on behalf of beings such as us, and the śrāvakas at that time instructed you and guided you in the perfections — and through that practice the Blessed One aroused the unsurpassed gnosis — in exactly that same way, we too shall attend upon the great bodhisattvas, the great beings, following them and encompassing them, following them completely and encompassing them completely. Why so? Blessed One, because by our following them, attending upon them, following them completely and encompassing them completely and rightly, they will swiftly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Thereupon Venerable Subhūti said to Śakra (Indra), the lord of the gods: "Kauśika, therefore listen well and hold this in mind, for I shall explain to you how a great bodhisattva, a great being, should abide in the Perfection of Wisdom. Kauśika, a great bodhisattva, a great being, should abide in the Perfection of Wisdom by abiding in emptiness. Therefore, Kauśika, a great bodhisattva, a great being, should don the great armor. One should not abide in form. One should not abide in feeling, nor in perception, nor in formations, nor in consciousness. One should not abide in the eye, nor in form, nor in eye-consciousness, nor in eye-contact, nor in the feelings that arise from eye-contact. Likewise, one should not abide in the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, or the mind; nor in sounds, smells, tastes, tactile objects, or mental

phenomena; nor in ear-consciousness through to mind-consciousness; nor in mind-contact; nor in the feelings that arise from mind-contact. One should not abide in the earth element, nor in the water element, the fire element, the wind element, the space element, or the consciousness element. One should not abide in the close applications of mindfulness (skt. *smṛtyupasthāna*), nor in the thorough abandonments, nor in the bases of miraculous power, nor in the faculties, nor in the powers, nor in the limbs of awakening, nor in the path. One should not abide in the fruit of stream-entry.

One should not abide in the fruit of once-returning, the fruit of non-returning, or in arhathood itself. One should not abide in pratyekabuddhahood itself. One should not abide in buddhahood itself.

One should not abide thinking "this is form." One should not abide thinking "this is feeling," "this is perception," "these are formations," or "this is consciousness." One should not abide thinking "this is the eye" through to "this is feeling born of mind-contact." One should not abide thinking "this is the earth element" through to "this is the consciousness element." One should not abide thinking "this is the close application of mindfulness." One should not abide thinking "these are the thorough abandonments, the bases of miraculous power, the faculties, the powers, the limbs of awakening," or "this is a limb of the path." One should not abide thinking "this is the fruit of stream-entry." One should not abide thinking "this is the fruit of once-returning," "this is the fruit of non-returning," or "this is arhathood." One should not abide thinking "this is a pratyekabuddha." One should not abide thinking "this is a buddha."

One should not abide thinking "form is permanent" or "form is impermanent." Likewise, one should not abide thinking that feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are permanent or impermanent. One should not abide thinking "form is pleasurable" or "form is suffering." Likewise, one should not abide thinking that feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are pleasurable or suffering. One should not abide thinking "form is empty" or "form is not empty." Likewise, one should not abide thinking that feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are empty or not empty. One should not abide thinking "form has a self" or "form is selfless." Likewise, one should not abide thinking that feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness have a self or are selfless. One should not abide thinking "form is pleasant" or "form is unpleasant." Likewise, one should not abide thinking that feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are pleasant or

unpleasant.

One should not abide by attending closely to form as empty. Likewise, one should not abide by attending closely to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as empty.

One should not abide thinking "the fruit of stream-entry is distinguished by the unconditioned." Likewise, one should not abide thinking that the fruit of once-returning, the fruit of non-returning, and arhathood are distinguished by the unconditioned. One should not abide thinking "pratyekabuddhahood is distinguished by the unconditioned." One should not abide thinking "buddhahood is distinguished by the unconditioned."

One should not abide thinking "a stream-enterer is a fitting recipient of generosity." One should not abide thinking "a stream-enterer, if obstructed for a time, will undergo seven existences." One should not abide thinking "a once-returner is a fitting recipient of generosity." One should not abide thinking "a once-returner, because of not having fully reached the end, will return to this world once more and there make an end of suffering." One should not abide thinking "a non-returner is a fitting recipient of generosity." One should not abide thinking "a non-returner will pass completely into nirvāṇa in that very realm, never returning to this world." One should not abide thinking "an arhat is a fitting recipient of generosity." One should not abide thinking "an arhat will, right here, pass completely into nirvāṇa in the element of nirvāṇa without remainder, without any residue of the aggregates." One should not abide thinking "a pratyekabuddha is a fitting recipient of generosity."

One should not abide thinking "a pratyekabuddha will pass completely into nirvāṇa, having transcended the stage of the śrāvaka yet without having attained the stage of a buddha." One should not abide thinking "a buddha is a fitting recipient of generosity." And one should not abide thinking in this way either: "A buddha, having transcended the stage of the ordinary person, the stage of the śrāvaka, and the stage of the pratyekabuddha, works for the welfare of immeasurable, countless sentient beings — leading immeasurable, countless sentient beings, hundreds of thousands of koṭis and niyutas of them, completely into nirvāṇa; establishing immeasurable, countless sentient beings definitively as śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, and perfectly and fully awakened buddhas; abiding on the buddha-stage; performing the deeds of a buddha — and then, through the complete nirvāṇa of a buddha, passes completely into

nirvāṇa in the element of nirvāṇa without remainder, without any residue of the aggregates."

Then the venerable Śāriputra thought to himself: "If one should not abide thinking in this way either — that a buddha, having transcended the stage of the ordinary person, the stage of the śrāvaka, and the stage of the pratyekabuddha, works for the welfare of immeasurable, countless sentient beings; leads immeasurable, countless sentient beings, hundreds of thousands of koṭis and niyutas of them, completely into nirvāṇa; establishes immeasurable, countless sentient beings definitively as śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, and perfectly and fully awakened buddhas; abides on the buddha-stage; performs the deeds of a buddha; and then passes completely into nirvāṇa in the element of nirvāṇa without remainder, through the complete nirvāṇa of a buddha — then in what way should one abide in this? In what way should one train?"

Then, by the power of the Buddha, the venerable Subhūti knew with his mind the thought that had arisen in the mind of the venerable Śāriputra, and he said to the venerable Śāriputra the following: "Venerable Śāriputra, what do you think? In what does a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha abide?"

The venerable Śāriputra replied: "Venerable Subhūti, a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha does not abide in anything whatsoever. Why is that? Because the mind of a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha is utterly without abiding: it does not abide in the conditioned element, nor does it abide in the unconditioned element, nor has it arisen from either."

Then the venerable Subhūti said to the venerable Śāriputra: "Venerable Śāriputra, it is in precisely this way that a bodhisattva, a great being, should abide and train: just as a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha does not abide in anything whatsoever — neither abiding nor not-abiding, neither abiding in a contrary manner nor not-abiding in a contrary manner — one should abide in just that way. One should think: 'I will abide and train in whatever way the Tathāgata abides.' And one should think: 'If I abide as the Tathāgata abides, then I will dwell in the mode of knowing through non-abiding.' This is how one should train in this."

In this way a bodhisattva, a great being, should abide and train accordingly. A bodhisattva, a great being, who trains in this way is inseparable from this

abiding of the Perfection of Wisdom and from this mental engagement.

Thereupon, some of the gods (devas) in that assembly thought to themselves:

"What the yakṣas speak — the sounds of yakṣas, the voices of yakṣas, the words of yakṣas, the speech of yakṣas, the declarations of yakṣas — all that can be understood. But what the Elder Subhūti expounds, proclaims, teaches, and fully explains cannot be understood at all."

Then the Elder Subhūti, through the power of the Buddha, discerned with his mind the precise nature of those sons of gods' mental thoughts, and said to them: "Sons of gods, as for the words 'cannot be understood, cannot be understood' — there is not even the slightest thing spoken here, and not even the slightest thing heard here."

Then those sons of gods again thought to themselves: "How wonderful! The noble Subhūti will make this clear. How wonderful! The noble Subhūti will make this clear. For the noble Subhūti enters into what is more distant than the distant, the noble Subhūti enters into what is more subtle than the subtle and more profound than the profound — and he teaches and expounds this."

Then again, through the power of the Buddha, the Elder Subhūti discerned with his mind those sons of gods' mental thoughts, and spoke to them thus: "Sons of gods, therefore, one who wishes to attain the fruit of stream-entry and who wishes to abide in the fruit of stream-entry cannot accomplish this without relying upon this patience. Likewise, one who wishes to attain the fruit of once-returning and who wishes to abide in the fruit of once-returning, one who wishes to attain the fruit of non-returning and who wishes to abide in the fruit of non-returning, one who wishes to attain arhatship and who wishes to abide in arhatship, one who wishes to attain solitary awakening and who wishes to abide in solitary awakening — none of these can be accomplished without relying upon this patience. One who wishes to attain unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening and who wishes to abide in unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening cannot accomplish this without relying upon this patience."

Then those sons of gods again thought: "What manner of hearing the Dharma should one seek from the noble Subhūti?"

Then, through the power of the Buddha, the Elder Subhūti discerned with his mind those sons of gods' mental thoughts, and said to them: "Sons of gods, one should seek to hear the Dharma from me as one seeks something like an

illusion and an emanation. Why so? Because they neither hear nor directly realize."

Then those sons of gods said to the Elder Subhūti: "Noble Subhūti, do you mean that those sentient beings are like an illusion, while the illusion is not those sentient beings?"

When this was said, the Elder Subhūti spoke to those sons of gods thus: "Sons of gods, those sentient beings are like an illusion; sons of gods, those sentient beings are like a dream. Sons of gods, therefore, illusion and sentient beings are not two and cannot be made into two. Likewise, dream and sentient beings are not two and cannot be made into two. Sons of gods, all phenomena too are like an illusion and like a dream. A stream-enterer too is like an illusion and like a dream. The fruit of stream-entry too is like an illusion and like a dream. Likewise, the once-returner and the fruit of once-returning, the non-returner and the fruit of non-returning,

the arhat too is like an illusion and like a dream. Arhathood too is like an illusion and like a dream. The pratyekabuddha too is like an illusion and like a dream. Pratyekabuddhahood too is like an illusion and like a dream. A perfectly and fully awakened buddha too is like an illusion and like a dream. Perfect and full buddhahood too is like an illusion and like a dream.

Then those sons of gods said this to the Venerable Subhūti: "Noble Subhūti, are you saying that a perfectly and fully awakened buddha too is like an illusion and like a dream, and that perfect and full buddhahood too is like an illusion and like a dream?"

Subhūti replied: "Sons of gods, if I were to speak of nirvāṇa as like an illusion and like a dream, what need is there to speak of other phenomena? Those sons of gods said: "Noble Subhūti, are you saying that nirvāṇa too is like an illusion and like a dream?"

The Venerable Subhūti replied: "Sons of gods, even if there were some phenomenon more exalted than nirvāṇa, I would say of that too that it is like an illusion and like a dream. Sons of gods, therefore, illusion and nirvāṇa are not two and cannot be made into two. Likewise, dream and nirvāṇa are not two and cannot be made into two."

Then the Venerable Śāriputra, the Venerable Maudgalyāyana, the Venerable Mahākāśyapa, the Venerable Mahākatyāyana, the Venerable Mahākauṣṭhila, and other great śrāvakas, together with many hundreds of thousands of

bodhisattvas, all said this to the Venerable Elder Subhūti: "Venerable Subhūti, who will come to properly hold this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom as it has been set forth here?"

Then the Venerable Ānanda said this to those elders: "Venerable ones, it will be the irreversible bodhisattvas, the great beings, or persons whose view is perfected, or the arhats in whom all defilements are exhausted — it is they who will come to properly hold this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom as it has been set forth here."

Then the Venerable Subhūti said this to those elders: "Venerable ones, no one whatsoever will come to properly hold this Perfection of Wisdom as it has been thus expounded. Why is that? Because in this teaching not a single phenomenon has been spoken of, not a single phenomenon has been made to appear, and not a single phenomenon has been posited. Therefore, just as not a single phenomenon has been spoken of, not a single phenomenon has been made to appear, and not a single phenomenon has been posited, so in exactly that way no one whatsoever will come to properly hold this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom as it has been set forth here."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), thought to himself: "As the noble Subhūti has thus taught this category of Dharma, I too shall, for the sake of making offering, miraculously conjure flowers and scatter them before the noble Subhūti." And so Śakra, lord of the gods, at that moment miraculously conjured flowers and scattered them before the Venerable Subhūti.

Then the Elder Venerable Subhūti, wishing to commend Śakra, lord of the gods, thought to himself: "These flowers that Śakra, lord of the gods, has scattered — such as these I have not seen even in the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods. These flowers are conjured."

"These flowers that have been miraculously scattered by Śakra, lord of the gods, are not born from trees, creepers, or climbing plants — they are flowers born from the mind." With that thought in his heart, Śakra, lord of the gods, read the intention within the mind of the Venerable Subhūti, and spoke to the Venerable Subhūti these words: "Noble Subhūti, these flowers are unborn. And why? Because there are no flowers born from the mind, nor are they born from trees, creepers, or climbing plants."

Then the Venerable Subhūti spoke to Śakra, lord of the gods, these words: "Kauśika, you have said that these flowers are unborn — that they are born neither from the mind, nor from trees, creepers, nor climbing plants. Kauśika,

that which is unborn is not a flower."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, thought to himself: "How wonderful! The noble Subhūti's wisdom is profound. He teaches even what is merely designated by name and word, yet he does not contradict it either. He illuminates suchness itself and directly reveals suchness itself."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, spoke to the Venerable Subhūti these words: "Noble Subhūti, it is so, it is indeed so. Just as the noble Subhūti has here taught, so too should the bodhisattvas, the great beings, train in this."

When this was said, the Venerable Subhūti spoke to Śakra, lord of the gods, these words: "Kauśika, it is so, it is indeed so. In this way should the bodhisattvas, the great beings, train. Kauśika, when a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in this way, he does not train toward the fruit of stream-entry. He does not train toward the fruit of once-returning. He does not train toward the fruit of non-returning. He does not train toward arhathood. He does not train toward pratyekabuddhahood. He does not train toward buddhahood — for whoever does not train in these grounds, that one trains in buddhahood and omniscience itself. And whoever trains in buddhahood and omniscience itself trains in the immeasurable and incalculable qualities of a buddha. And whoever trains in the immeasurable and incalculable qualities of a buddha does not train for the sake of increasing or diminishing form. Likewise, that one does not train for the sake of increasing or diminishing feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. Whoever does not train for the sake of increasing or diminishing form, and whoever does not train for the sake of increasing or diminishing feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness — such a one does not train for the sake of fully grasping or abandoning form. Likewise, that one does not train for the sake of fully grasping or abandoning feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. One does not train for the sake of fully grasping any phenomenon whatsoever. One does not train for the sake of arising, and one does not train for the sake of ceasing. Whoever does not train for the sake of fully grasping any phenomenon, and does not train for the sake of arising or ceasing — that one also does not train for the sake of fully grasping omniscience itself, and does not train for the sake of its arising or ceasing. A bodhisattva, a great being, training in this way, trains in omniscience itself and shall assuredly emerge into omniscience itself."

Then the venerable Śāriputra said this to the venerable Subhūti: "Venerable Subhūti, if a bodhisattva, a great being, does not train for the sake of fully

grasping any phenomenon whatsoever, and does not train for the sake of arising, and does not train for the sake of ceasing — then does that one train in omniscience itself, and will that one assuredly emerge into omniscience itself?"

The venerable Subhūti replied: "Venerable Śāriputra, it is exactly so, it is exactly so. Venerable Śāriputra, a bodhisattva, a great being, who does not train for the sake of fully grasping any phenomenon whatsoever, and does not train for the sake of arising, and does not train for the sake of ceasing — that one also does not train for the sake of fully grasping omniscience itself, and does not train for the sake of its arising or ceasing; and that one likewise does not train for the sake of fully grasping the qualities of a buddha, and does not train for the sake of their arising or ceasing. Venerable Śāriputra, a bodhisattva, a great being, who trains in this way, trains in omniscience itself and shall assuredly emerge into omniscience itself."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra, king of the devas), said this to the venerable Śāriputra: "Noble Śāriputra, from where should a bodhisattva, a great being, seek the Perfection of Wisdom?"

Śāriputra replied: "Kauśika, a bodhisattva, a great being, should seek the Perfection of Wisdom from the chapter of the venerable Subhūti."

When he had said this, Śakra, lord of the gods, said again to the venerable Śāriputra: "Noble Śāriputra, this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom that the noble Subhūti is expounding — whose power should it be understood as, and whose blessing should it be recognized as?"

The venerable Śāriputra replied: "Kauśika, this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom that the venerable Subhūti is expounding should be understood as the power of the Tathāgata. It should be recognized as the blessing of the Tathāgata."

Then the venerable Subhūti said this to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, you ask: 'This teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom that the noble Subhūti is expounding — whose power should it be recognized as, and whose blessing should it be understood as?' Kauśika, I say that this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom that I am expounding should be understood as the power of the Tathāgata, and should be recognized as the blessing of the Tathāgata."

"And Kauśika, you also ask: 'From where should a bodhisattva, a great being, seek the Perfection of Wisdom?' Kauśika, a bodhisattva, a great being, should

not seek the Perfection of Wisdom from form, nor should one seek it apart from form. Likewise, one should not seek it from feeling, nor from perception, nor from formations, nor from consciousness, nor should one seek it apart from consciousness.

"Why is that? Kauśika, it is because form itself is not the Perfection of Wisdom, and yet apart from form the Perfection of Wisdom does not exist."

"Likewise, feeling is not the Perfection of Wisdom, perception is not the Perfection of Wisdom, formations are not the Perfection of Wisdom, consciousness is not the Perfection of Wisdom, and yet apart from consciousness the Perfection of Wisdom does not exist."

When this was said, Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra, king of the divine realm), spoke these words to the venerable Subhūti: "Noble Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a great perfection. Noble Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a perfection beyond measure. Noble Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a perfection without limit. Noble Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a perfection of infinite extent."

The elder Subhūti replied: "So it is, Kauśika. So it is indeed. Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a great perfection. Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection beyond measure. Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection without limit. Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent.

"And why is that? Because form is vast, Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a great perfection. Likewise, because feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are vast, Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a great perfection.

"Because form is beyond measure, Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection beyond measure. Likewise, because feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are beyond measure, Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection beyond measure.

"Because form is without limit, Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection without limit. Likewise, because feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are without limit, Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection without limit.

"Because form is of infinite extent, Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent. Likewise, because feeling, perception, formations,

and consciousness are of infinite extent, Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent.

"Kauśika, one does not cling to it as being called 'a great perfection,' nor does one cling to it as being called 'a perfection beyond measure,' nor as 'a perfection without limit,' nor as 'a perfection of infinite extent.' Kauśika, therefore this Perfection of Wisdom is a great perfection. It is a perfection beyond measure. It is a perfection without limit. Kauśika, it is a perfection of infinite extent.

"Kauśika, because its objects are of infinite extent, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent. Kauśika, because sentient beings are of infinite extent, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent.

"And Kauśika, in what way is the Perfection of Wisdom a perfection of infinite extent because its objects are of infinite extent?"

"Kauśika, since the beginning, middle, and end of all phenomena are not apprehended, therefore, Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent. Kauśika, by this category as well, because its objects are of infinite extent, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent.

"Furthermore, Kauśika, because all phenomena are infinite and boundless, and their beginning, middle, or end is likewise not apprehended, therefore, Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent. Why is that? Kauśika, the beginning, middle, or end of form is not apprehended. And likewise, Kauśika, the beginning, middle, or end of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness is not apprehended. Kauśika, by this category as well, because its objects are of infinite extent, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent.

"Furthermore, Kauśika, sentient beings are infinite and boundless. Why is that? Because the beginning, middle, or end of sentient beings is not apprehended. Kauśika, therefore, because sentient beings are of infinite extent, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent."

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, spoke these words to the venerable Subhūti: "Noble Subhūti, in what way is this Perfection of Wisdom a perfection of infinite extent because sentient beings are of infinite extent?"

The elder Subhūti replied: "Kauśika, because sentient beings are of infinite extent in a way that surpasses all counting or manifold counting, this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent."

Śakra said: "Noble Subhūti, but then in what way should one speak of this Perfection of Wisdom as a perfection of infinite extent because sentient beings are of infinite extent?"

The elder Subhūti replied: "Kauśika, what do you think? This expression 'sentient being, sentient being' — of which phenomenon is it a word-designation?"

Śakra said: "Noble Subhūti, this expression 'sentient being, sentient being' is neither a word-designation of a phenomenon nor a word-designation of a non-phenomenon. This designation has arisen adventitiously. This designation is without any real thing. This designation has no basis in a self. This designation 'sentient being, sentient being' is without any apprehensible referent."

The elder Subhūti said: "Kauśika, what do you think? Is there any thing here that has been firmly established as a sentient being?"

Śakra replied: "Noble Subhūti, there is not."

Subhūti said: "Kauśika, when there is nothing that has been established as a sentient being, can there be sentient beings of infinite extent? Kauśika, even if a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha were to dwell for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges River, and were to proclaim the word 'sentient being, sentient being' in a voice of boundless reach, deep and resonant — would there in that time be any sentient being that had been born, will be born, or is being born, or that had ceased, will cease, or is ceasing?"

Śakra replied: "Noble Subhūti, there would not."

"Why is that?"

"Because sentient beings are pure from the very beginning, and perfectly pure from the very beginning."

Subhūti said: "Kauśika, by this category as well, it is because sentient beings are of infinite extent that this Perfection of Wisdom is a perfection of infinite extent."

"Kauśika, in this way as well, it is because sentient beings are of infinite extent that the Perfection of Wisdom is to be understood as a perfection of infinite extent."

Then the gods together with Indra (Śakra), together with Brahmā, together with Prajāpati (the Lord of Creatures), together with the seers, and together with the assemblies of men and women, three times made this solemn proclamation: "How wonderful are phenomena! How wonderful are phenomena! How wonderful are phenomena! The nature of reality of all phenomena — that which is the arising of Tathāgatas — has been well spoken, declared, taught, and properly established by the noble elder Subhūti."

"Blessed One, from this day forward we shall regard whichever bodhisattvas, great bodhisattvas, are inseparable from this Perfection of Wisdom, and whichever bodhisattvas, great bodhisattvas, abide in this abiding of the Perfection of Wisdom — we shall regard these as Tathāgatas."

Then the Blessed One declared to those gods together with Indra, together with Brahmā, together with Prajāpati, together with the seers, and together with the assemblies of men and women: "Sons of the gods, so it is, so it is. Sons of the gods, when in the past, in the marketplace called Dīpaṃkara within the royal palace's surrounding city, I was in the presence of the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened Buddha Dīpaṃkara, and was inseparable from this Perfection of Wisdom — at that time the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened Buddha Dīpaṃkara, gave me, a brahmin youth, the prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, saying: 'In the future, after innumerable aeons, you shall become the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened Buddha named Śākyamuni — one endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a Blessed One.'"

Then those sons of the gods addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, it is wonderful that this Perfection of Wisdom of the bodhisattvas, the great bodhisattvas, accomplishes and thoroughly sustains them all the way to omniscience. Sugata, it is most wonderful."

This concludes the second chapter, called "The Chapter of Śakra," from the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines.

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The Third Fascicle.

Then the Blessed One, knowing that in that assembly there had gathered and seated themselves sons of the gods, and knowing that the assembly of monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen had gathered and seated themselves, and knowing that those sons of the gods were gathered and seated there, and

knowing also that the entire fourfold assembly had gathered and was seated — with the sons of the gods who move in the desire realm and the sons of the gods who move in the form realm, together with the sons of the gods of the Brahma class, and the sons of the gods of Ābhāsvara, Śubhakarṣna, and Akaniṣṭha as witnesses, he declared to the sons of the gods of the desire realm such as Śakra, lord of the gods, and to the sons of the gods of the Brahma class such as Great Brahmā, and to the sons of the gods of Ābhāsvara: "Sons of the gods, if some son of good family or daughter of good family holds, bears, recites, masters, or proclaims aloud this Perfection of Wisdom, no māra or god of the māra class who is watching and seeking an opportunity shall find any opportunity against that person. Nor shall those humans or non-humans who are watching and seeking an opportunity find any opportunity against that son of good family or daughter of good family."

That son of good family or daughter of good family shall not die an untimely death while still having left things undone.

Sons of the gods, furthermore, those sons of the gods who have genuinely entered into the path toward unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening, but who have not yet held, borne, recited, mastered, or proclaimed aloud this Perfection of Wisdom — they shall wish to come into the presence of that son of good family. They shall come to listen to that son of good family who holds, bears, recites, masters, and proclaims aloud this Perfection of Wisdom. And having listened, they shall hold it, bear it, recite it, master it, and proclaim it aloud.

Sons of the gods, furthermore, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family holds, bears, recites, masters, and proclaims aloud this Perfection of Wisdom — whether they go to a forest hermitage, or to the foot of a tree, or to an empty house, or to an unsheltered place, or along a road, or down a side path, or to a remote wilderness, or to the great ocean — wherever they go, whether walking, standing, sitting, or lying down: no fear, no terror shall arise or come to be.

Then the four great kings addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, it is wonderful that any son of good family or daughter of good family who holds, bears, recites, masters, and proclaims aloud this Perfection of Wisdom thereby disciplines sentient beings by the three vehicles, and yet does not give rise to the perception of them as sentient beings. Blessed One, we shall guard, protect, and shelter whatever son of good family or daughter

of good family holds, bears, recites, masters, and proclaims aloud this Perfection of Wisdom."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra, king of the divine beings), addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I too shall guard, protect, and shelter whatever son of good family or daughter of good family holds, bears, recites, masters, and proclaims aloud this Perfection of Wisdom."

Then Great Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, together with the sons of the gods of the Brahma class, also addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, we too shall guard, protect, and shelter whatever son of good family or daughter of good family holds, bears, recites, masters, and proclaims aloud this Perfection of Wisdom."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One once more with these words: "Blessed One, it is wonderful that any son of good family or daughter of good family who holds, bears, recites, masters, and proclaims aloud this Perfection of Wisdom shall certainly attain and fully retain these qualities in this very life. Blessed One, and further — if one holds this Perfection of Wisdom, shall one thereby come to hold all six perfections?"

When this was asked, the Blessed One spoke to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, it is exactly so, exactly so. Kauśika, by holding the Perfection of Wisdom one shall come to hold all six perfections."

"Kauśika, furthermore, whoever holds, bears, recites, masters, and proclaims aloud this Perfection of Wisdom — all the qualities that such a son of good family or daughter of good family shall come to hold in this very life: listen well and take this to heart, for I shall explain it to you."

Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), replied to the Blessed One, "Excellent!" and then turned attentively toward the Blessed One. And the Blessed One declared as follows:

"Kauśika, as for anyone who wishes to dispute, challenge, or contradict this Dharma — whatever disputes, challenges, and contradictions they have raised or may raise shall in turn come to nothing and shall not persist; the intentions of those who wish to dispute, challenge, or contradict it shall not be fulfilled. Why is that? Kauśika, it is because of this: wherever a son of good family or daughter of good family holds, bears, recites, masters, proclaims aloud, teaches, extensively teaches, recites by transmission, and chants this Perfection of Wisdom — whatever grounds for dispute have arisen or are

raised in that very setting shall in turn come to nothing and shall not persist; the intentions of those who wish to dispute, challenge, or contradict it shall not be fulfilled.

Kauśika, a son of good family or daughter of good family who holds, bears, recites, masters, proclaims aloud, teaches, extensively teaches, recites by transmission, and chants this Perfection of Wisdom shall in this very life come to hold all these qualities fully.

Kauśika, consider this example. There is a plant called Mā-ghi which pacifies every poison entirely. Now, a venomous serpent, hungry and seeking food and wishing to eat, comes upon some living creature and pursues it, following the scent of that creature. But then that creature happens to be where the Mā-ghi plant is and goes there and settles. Thereupon the serpent turns back from the mere fragrance of that plant. Why? Because, just as the venom of the serpent is overpowered in that way, this is to be understood as the medicinal power of that plant — so great is its potency.

Kauśika, in the same way, for a son of good family or daughter of good family who holds, bears, recites, masters, proclaims aloud, teaches, extensively teaches, recites by transmission, and chants this Perfection of Wisdom — whatever grounds for dispute, challenge, and contradiction have arisen or are raised shall swiftly vanish from that very place by the radiance, power, strength, and force of the Perfection of Wisdom, subsiding and ceasing to grow; wherever they arose, from that very place they shall be checked, subside, and not persist. Why? Because the Perfection of Wisdom pacifies all that is grasped at — from attachment all the way to that which has not yet passed beyond sorrow (nirvāṇa) — and does not cause it to proliferate.

Kauśika, the four great kings, Śakra lord of the gods, Brahmā lord of the Sahā world, the buddhas who are Blessed Ones, and all the bodhisattvas —"

any son or daughter of good family who upholds, bears, reads, thoroughly masters, recites aloud, teaches, explains in detail, chants by rote, and proclaims this Perfection of Wisdom — it shall protect, shelter, and guard them, and in this very life they shall fully come to possess these qualities. Kauśika, furthermore, any son or daughter of good family who upholds, bears, reads, thoroughly masters, recites aloud, teaches, explains in detail, chants by rote, and proclaims this Perfection of Wisdom — their speech shall become worthy of being heeded, their speech shall become gentle, their speech shall become fitting, and their speech shall be free from error. They shall not be

overcome by anger, and they shall not be overcome by pride. Why? Because the Perfection of Wisdom thoroughly tames and thoroughly subdues: it does not allow anger to increase, does not allow pride to increase, does not allow resentment to be harbored, does not allow malice to be harbored, and does not allow underlying tendencies to take hold. In the son or daughter of good family who practices in this way, mindfulness and loving-kindness shall arise, and they shall think to themselves: "If I were to give rise to malice, my sense faculties would be disturbed and the color of my face would change — and for one who has genuinely entered upon the path toward unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening and wishes to train in it, to fall under the power of anger would be improper." Thinking thus, they shall swiftly recover their mindfulness. Kauśika, any son or daughter of good family who upholds, bears, reads, thoroughly masters, recites aloud, teaches, explains in detail, chants by rote, and proclaims this Perfection of Wisdom — they too shall fully come to possess these qualities in this very life.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, it is wonderful that the Perfection of Wisdom dwells in this way so as to thoroughly tame the great bodhisattvas and free them from arrogance."

The Blessed One then declared: "Kauśika, furthermore, any son or daughter of good family who shall uphold, bear, read, thoroughly master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by rote, and proclaim this Perfection of Wisdom — if that son or daughter of good family, engaging in this way with the Perfection of Wisdom — upholding it, bearing it, reading it, thoroughly mastering it, reciting it aloud, teaching it, explaining it in detail, chanting it by rote, and proclaiming it — were to enter first into battle at the time of going to war, whether they enter battle, have entered battle, have passed through battle, or are going, standing, or sitting within the battle — Kauśika, for any son or daughter of good family who holds this Perfection of Wisdom in mind, bears it, reads it, thoroughly masters it, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, chants it by rote, and proclaims it, the possibility of their life being cut short does not exist and the opportunity for that does not arise. Nor does the possibility exist that harm from another could cut their life short.

Kauśika, furthermore, if anyone were to hurl a club, a weapon, a stone, or anything else whatsoever at such a person, it will not strike their body. Why is that? Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a great knowledge-mantra (vidyā). Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a knowledge-mantra without measure.

Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a knowledge-mantra beyond reckoning.
Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is an unsurpassed knowledge-mantra.
Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is an unequalled knowledge-mantra.
Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is a knowledge-mantra equal to the unequalled.

Why is that? Kauśika, a son or daughter of good family who trains in this knowledge-mantra does not think of doing harm to themselves, does not think of doing harm to others, and does not think of doing harm to both.

Kauśika, a bodhisattva, a great being, who trains in this knowledge-mantra will awaken to the unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, will attain the gnosis of omniscience, and having fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, will behold the minds of all sentient beings. Why is that? Kauśika, for the bodhisattva, the great being, who has trained in this knowledge-mantra, there is nothing whatsoever that has not been attained, not been known, or not been made directly apparent. Therefore it is called the gnosis of omniscience.

Kauśika, whatever son or daughter of good family holds this Perfection of Wisdom in mind, bears it, reads it, thoroughly masters it, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, chants it by rote, and proclaims it — that person will fully embrace this very quality in the present life.

Kauśika, furthermore, wherever this Perfection of Wisdom is written out in a small form, placed within a book, set down with offerings made before it, and revered — even if one neither holds it in mind, nor bears it, nor reads it, nor thoroughly masters it, nor recites it aloud, nor teaches it, nor explains it in detail, nor chants it by rote, nor proclaims it — still, Kauśika, apart from the ripening of former karma, no human or non-human being seeking an opportunity against sentient beings will find that opportunity, for there is no such possibility. Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family too will fully embrace this very quality in the present life.

Kauśika, consider this example: those humans, non-humans, and even animals who are seated at the seat of awakening (Vajrāsana), or who are in the vicinity of the seat of awakening, or who are within the seat of awakening, or who are at the root of the awakening tree — apart from the ripening of former karma, no human or non-human being is able to harm them, injure them, or bring them low. Why is that? Because it is there that the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas of the past, future, and present have perfectly

and completely awakened, are perfectly and completely awakening, and will perfectly and completely awaken — they who cultivate and proclaim fearlessness, harmlessness, and freedom from terror toward all sentient beings.

Likewise, Kauśika, wherever a son or daughter of good family holds, bears, reads, thoroughly masters, recites aloud, teaches, explains in detail, proclaims by rote, and chants this very Perfection of Wisdom — there too, Kauśika, apart from the ripening of former karma, no human or non-human being is able to harm them, injure them, or bring them low. Why is that? Because this very Perfection of Wisdom has caused that place to become a shrine for sentient beings — a place to be venerated, revered, honored, decorated, served with devotion, and esteemed as supreme — and has caused it to become a protector, refuge, shelter, and ally for sentient beings who approach it.

Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family thereby fully grasps all these benefits in this very lifetime.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra, king of the divine realm), addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, if a son or daughter of good family were to write down this Perfection of Wisdom, place it within a book, and keep it there — honoring it with divine flowers, divine incense, divine perfume, divine garlands, divine ointments, divine powders, divine garments, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, divine pennants, and all around it a garland of divine lamps, along with many other divine offerings — venerating it, esteeming it as supreme, revering it, honoring it, decorating it, and serving it with devotion — and if another were to honor with veneration and to esteem as supreme, revere, worship, decorate, and serve with devotion the bodily relics of the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas who have passed beyond sorrow (nirvāṇa), placed and kept within stūpas — honoring those stūpas likewise with divine flowers, divine incense, divine perfume, divine garlands, divine ointments, divine powders, divine garments, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, divine pennants, and all around them a garland of divine lamps, along with many other divine offerings — venerating them, esteeming them as supreme, revering them, honoring them, decorating them, and serving them with devotion — then of those two, the son or daughter of good family, which one generates the greater merit?

When he had thus inquired, the Blessed One said to Śakra, lord of the gods: Kauśika, it is precisely for this that I put the question to you yourself — prophesy it as best you are able. Kauśika, what do you think? That through which the omniscience that is the very essence of a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha is fully accomplished — by training in which path did the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha attain and fully, perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening and omniscience?

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Śakra, lord of the gods, said to the Blessed One: Blessed One, it is by training in this very Perfection of Wisdom that the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha attained and fully, perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening and omniscience.

The Blessed One then declared:

Kauśika, that being so, it is not by obtaining this physical body of mine that one comes to be counted among those called Tathāgata. It is by obtaining omniscience that one comes to be counted among those called Tathāgata. Kauśika, this omniscience of the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha arises from the Perfection of Wisdom. And Kauśika, this obtaining of the Tathāgata's physical body also arises from the Perfection of Wisdom and from skillful means, and it serves as the support for the wisdom of omniscience. Relying upon this support, the wisdom of omniscience is fully revealed. The body of a buddha is fully revealed. The body of Dharma is fully revealed. The body of the Saṅgha is fully revealed. Thus, since this obtaining of the physical body — which is the cause of the wisdom of omniscience — serves as the support for the wisdom of omniscience, it becomes a stūpa worthy of veneration, homage, honor, reverence, offerings, praise, and service by all sentient beings. In just the same way, even after I have passed into nirvāṇa, those bodies will continue to be venerated with offerings. Therefore, Kauśika, whatever son or daughter of good family writes out this Perfection of Wisdom, has it compiled into a book, and then venerates it with divine flowers, divine incense, divine fragrances, divine garlands, divine unguents, divine powders, divine garments, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, and divine pennants, and surrounds it with rows of divine lamps, and honors it with many kinds of divine offerings — paying it homage, honoring it, revering it, making offerings to it, praising it, and serving it — Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family will generate very great merit. Why is that? Kauśika, because that son or daughter of good family will have made offerings to the

wisdom of omniscience. And whatever son or daughter of good family, when seeking to learn this Perfection of Wisdom, honors, reveres, and venerates this very book, makes offerings to it, praises it, and serves it with many kinds of offerings — that person generates even more merit than the former. Why is that? Kauśika, because whoever makes offerings to the Perfection of Wisdom will have made offerings to the wisdom of omniscience.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One: Blessed One, those people of this Jambudvīpa who do not seek out this Perfection of Wisdom, do not take hold of it, do not retain it, do not read it, do not master it thoroughly, do not recite it aloud, do not teach it, do not explain it in detail, do not transmit its scriptural reading, do not commit it to recitation by heart — and who do not venerate this Perfection of Wisdom with flowers, incense, fragrances, garlands, unguents, powders, garments, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, with rows of lamps surrounding it, and with many kinds of offerings — who do not pay it homage, honor it, revere it, make offerings to it, praise it, or serve it —

"Blessed One, was not the offering made to the Perfection of Wisdom as proclaimed by the Blessed One thereby of great meaning? Blessed One, was it not understood that the offering made to this Perfection of Wisdom as proclaimed by the Blessed One is attended with great benefit? Was it not known by that person that it brings great fruit and great karmic maturation? Yet even so, they came to hold it, understand it, and know it — and then turned back from it and did not come to have faith."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods: "Kauśika, what do you think? Among the people of Jambudvīpa, how many are there who are endowed with faith through understanding the Buddha, who are endowed with faith through understanding the Dharma, and who are endowed with faith through understanding the Saṅgha?"

When this was said, Śakra, lord of the gods, replied to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, among the people of Jambudvīpa, those who are endowed with faith through understanding the Buddha, endowed with faith through understanding the Dharma, and endowed with faith through understanding the Saṅgha — these are few."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, it is so, it is so. Among the people of Jambudvīpa, those who are endowed with faith through understanding the Buddha, endowed with faith

through understanding the Dharma, and endowed with faith through understanding the Saṅgha — such persons are indeed few. Kauśika, those who have attained the fruit of stream-entry are fewer still than these. Those who have attained the fruit of once-returning and the fruit of non-returning are fewer still than these. Those who have attained arhatship are fewer still than these. Those who actualize solitary awakening are fewer still than these. Those who have aroused the mind set upon unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening are fewer still than these. Those who have aroused the mind set upon unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening and cause that mind of awakening to flourish and expand are fewer still than these. Those who have aroused the mind set upon unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, caused it to flourish, and then taken up diligent effort and abide in that are fewer still than these. Those who practice the Perfection of Wisdom as a discipline of yoga are fewer still than these. Those who engage in the Perfection of Wisdom are fewer still than these. Those who engage in and strive in the Perfection of Wisdom and abide upon the bodhisattva ground of non-retrogression are fewer still than these. Those who engage in and strive in the Perfection of Wisdom and will come to perfectly and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening are fewer still than these. Those who engage in and strive in the Perfection of Wisdom and do perfectly and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — these are fewer still than all of these.

"Kauśika, as for those great bodhisattvas who, abiding on the bodhisattva ground of non-retrogression, have perfectly and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and who thereafter, with excellent and complete superior intention, themselves train in and strive in the Perfection of Wisdom, and at the same time introduce others to this Perfection of Wisdom, presenting it close at hand, transmitting its reading aloud to them, and drawing those others as well into taking it up —"

— leading others to carry it, to read it, to master it fully, to recite it aloud, to teach it, to teach it in detail, to transmit its oral reading, and to chant it — those persons worship this very Perfection of Wisdom with divine flowers, divine incense, divine fragrance, divine garlands, divine unguents, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, and divine pennants, and all around it with strings of divine lamps, and with many kinds of divine offerings. They pay it honor, revere it as supreme, hold it in esteem, worship it, adorn it with ornament, and pay it homage.

Kauśika, as for those sentient beings who have generated the awakening mind, and who, having generated the awakening mind, cause that awakening mind to expand and cause it to fully flourish, and who then practice in accordance with awakening — such sentient beings are immeasurable, beyond counting. Yet, Kauśika, from among those immeasurable, innumerable sentient beings practicing for the sake of awakening, perhaps only one or two will come to abide on the bodhisattva ground of non-retrogression. Why is that? Kauśika, unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening is difficult to accomplish for those of weak diligence, those who are lazy, those of inferior aspiration, those of inferior mind, those of inferior perception, those of inferior devotion, and those of inferior wisdom.

Kauśika, therefore, any son or daughter of good family who wishes to swiftly and easily realize, manifest, and awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening should, without interruption, listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, take hold of it, retain it, read it, master it fully, recite it aloud, teach it, teach it in detail, transmit its oral reading, chant it, and inquire into it thoroughly. Why is that? Kauśika, such sons and daughters of good family understand thus: the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — when formerly they were practicing the conduct of bodhisattvas, they trained in this Perfection of Wisdom. Therefore we too shall train in it, for this Perfection of Wisdom is our Teacher. Kauśika, whether the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened Buddha is present or whether he has fully passed into nirvāṇa, the bodhisattva, the great being, should rely on this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Kauśika, therefore, if a son or daughter of good family, for the purpose of venerating a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened Buddha who has fully passed into nirvāṇa, were to have many tens of millions of stūpas made of the seven precious materials, containing within them relics of the Tathāgata as their essence, and having had them built were then, for as long as they lived, to worship those stūpas with divine flowers, divine incense, divine fragrance, divine garlands, divine unguents, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, and divine pennants, and all around with strings of divine lamps, and with many kinds of divine offerings — paying them honor, revering them as supreme, holding them in esteem, worshiping them, adorning them with ornament, and paying them homage — then, Kauśika, what do you think? Does that son or daughter of good family generate much merit on that basis?" Śakra (Indra, lord of the

gods) replied:

"Very many, O Blessed One! Very many, O Sugata!" The Blessed One then declared: "Kauśika, even more merit than that is generated by that son or daughter of good family who, with sincere faith in this Perfection of Wisdom, reflects upon it, takes delight in it, and, with a devoted mind, arouses the awakening mind toward full awakening — and then, with elevated intention, listens to it, takes it up, retains it, reads it, masters it thoroughly, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, chants it from scripture, commits it to memory, and expounds it fully and correctly to others; who also elucidates the meaning of this teaching, reflects upon it in the mind, and, with wisdom that accords with how things are established, thoroughly investigates this teaching; who, thinking 'May the lineage of the buddhas not be severed, may the sublime Dharma not decline,' acts to establish the sublime Dharma so that it abides for a long time; and who, without departing from proper conduct, brings about benefit for the great bodhisattvas — having, even in a small way when young, caused this to be entered into a volume, whether carrying or placing it, then worshiping that very Perfection of Wisdom with flowers, incense, fragrance, garlands, unguents, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, and pennants, and all around with strings of lamps, and with many kinds of offerings — paying it honor, revering it as supreme, holding it in esteem, worshiping it, adorning it with ornament, and paying it homage. Kauśika, that very son or daughter of good family generates an even greater accumulation of merit than the other.

"Now, Kauśika, let alone stūpas of the nature of the seven precious substances containing relics of Tathāgatas in their multitudes of tens of millions — Kauśika, if a son or daughter of good family were to cause this entire Jambudvīpa to be filled throughout with stūpas of the nature of the seven precious substances containing the essential relics of Tathāgatas, and having done so were to worship those stūpas with divine flowers, divine incense, divine fragrance, divine garlands, divine unguents, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, and divine pennants, and all around with strings of divine lamps, and with many kinds of divine offerings — paying them honor, revering them as supreme, holding them in esteem, worshiping them, adorning them with ornament, and paying them homage — for as long as they live, then, Kauśika, what do you think? Does that son or daughter of good family generate much merit on that basis?" Śakra replied: "Very many, O Blessed One! Very many, O Sugata!" The Blessed

One then declared: "Kauśika, even more merit than that is generated by that son or daughter of good family who, with sincere faith in this Perfection of Wisdom, reflects upon it, takes delight in it, and, with a devoted mind, arouses the awakening mind toward full awakening — and then, with elevated intention, listens to it, takes it up, retains it, reads it, masters it thoroughly, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, chants it from scripture, commits it to memory, and expounds it fully and correctly to others; who also elucidates the meaning of this teaching, reflects upon it in the mind, and, with wisdom that accords with how things are established, thoroughly investigates this teaching; and who, thinking 'May the lineage of the buddhas not be severed, may the sublime Dharma not decline,' acts to establish the sublime Dharma so that it abides for a long time;

and in that way, without diverging from proper conduct, accomplishes the task of benefiting the great bodhisattvas — even if only in the smallest measure, by placing this teaching within a volume and keeping or preserving it, and then honoring that Perfection of Wisdom with flowers, incense, fragrant substances, garlands, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, and garlands of lamps encircling it all around, and with many other kinds of offerings; paying it homage, exalting it, revering it, venerating it, making prostrations before it, and attending upon it —

Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates even more merit than that.

Kauśika, let us suppose that this continent of Jambudvīpa were entirely filled with stūpas made of the seven precious substances, each containing relics of the Tathāgatas as their heart and essence. Kauśika, and now suppose further that in the world-realm of the four great continents, every single sentient being that exists — each one of them — were to have one such stūpa made of the seven precious substances, containing Tathāgata relics at its heart, and that for the duration of their lives they were to honor those stūpas with divine flowers, divine incense, divine fragrant substances, divine garlands, divine ointments, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, divine pennants, divine garlands of lamps encircling them all around, and many other kinds of divine offerings; paying them homage, exalting them, revering them, venerating them, making prostrations before them, and attending upon them —

Kauśika, what do you think? Would all those sentient beings thereby generate a great amount of merit from that basis?

Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods) replied: They would, Blessed One. They would, Sugata.

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, a son or daughter of good family who generates merit in this way generates even greater merit still — that is, one who, with deep faith in this Perfection of Wisdom, who contemplates and inclines toward it, who arouses the mind set on awakening with wholeheartedness, and with elevated intention listens to it, takes it up, retains it, reads it, masters it thoroughly, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, chants it from scripture, commits it to memory, expounds it fully and correctly to others, elucidates the meaning of this teaching, reflects upon it in the mind, and with wisdom that accords with how things are established thoroughly investigates it; and who, thinking "May the lineage of the buddhas not be severed, may the sublime Dharma not decline," acts to establish the sublime Dharma so that it abides for a long time; and who, without diverging from proper conduct, accomplishes the task of benefiting the great bodhisattvas — even if only in the smallest measure, by placing this teaching within a volume and keeping or preserving it, and then honoring that Perfection of Wisdom with flowers, incense, fragrant substances, garlands, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, and garlands of lamps encircling it all around, and with many other kinds of offerings; paying it homage, exalting it, revering it, venerating it, making prostrations before it, and attending upon it —

Kauśika, this son or daughter of good family thereby generates far greater merit from that basis.

Kauśika, let all the sentient beings of the world-realm of the four great continents be set aside. Kauśika, now suppose further that all the sentient beings that exist in a thousand world-systems — each one of them — were to have one stūpa made of the seven precious substances, containing Tathāgata relics at its heart,

and who, for as long as they live, were to make offerings to them with divine flowers, divine incense, divine fragrances, divine garlands, divine unguents, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, and divine pennants, and who, encircling them all around, were to offer divine strings of lamps and many other kinds of divine offerings; paying them

homage, exalting them, revering them, venerating them, making prostrations before them, and attending upon them —

Kauśika, what do you think? Do all those sentient beings thereby generate great merit from that basis?

Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) replied: Greatly so, Blessed One. Greatly so, Sugata.

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, even so, this son or daughter of good family generates far greater merit than that — one who, with faith and devotion, with thought and aspiration, having aroused the awakening mind toward awakening, with elevated intention listens to this Perfection of Wisdom, retains it, bears it, reads it, masters it fully, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it, transmits the scriptural text, chants it, and teaches it to others in full and correctly; who expounds the meaning of this text, follows it with discerning thought, and with wisdom established just as it truly is thoroughly investigates it here; who, with the intention that the stream of the Buddha's way not be cut off and the sacred Dharma not decline, strives to establish the sacred Dharma so that it may long endure; and who, not departing from proper conduct, works to accomplish benefit for the great bodhisattvas — even if only in the smallest measure, having compiled it into a volume, and either bearing it or setting it down, were to make offerings to that Perfection of Wisdom with flowers, incense, fragrances, garlands, unguents, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, and pennants, and, encircling it all around, were to offer strings of lamps and many other kinds of offerings; paying it homage, exalting it, revering it, venerating it, making prostrations before it, and attending upon it —

Kauśika, this son or daughter of good family thereby generates far greater merit from that basis.

Kauśika, let all the sentient beings of a thousand world-systems be set aside. Kauśika, now suppose further that all the sentient beings that exist in a two-thousand middling world-system — each one of them — were to have one stūpa made of the seven precious substances, containing Tathāgata relics at its heart, and for as long as they live were to make offerings to them with divine flowers, divine incense, divine fragrances, divine garlands, divine unguents, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, and divine pennants, and who, encircling them all around, were to offer divine strings of lamps and many other kinds of divine

offerings; paying them homage, exalting them, revering them, venerating them, making prostrations before them, and attending upon them —

Kauśika, what do you think? Do all those sentient beings thereby generate great merit from that basis?

Śakra replied: Greatly so, Blessed One. Greatly so, Sugata.

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, even so, this son or daughter of good family generates far greater merit — one who, with faith and devotion, with thought and aspiration, having aroused the awakening mind toward awakening,

listens with earnest aspiration, retains it, upholds it, reads it, masters it completely, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, intones the scriptural transmission, chants it by heart, and also teaches others extensively and correctly; who explains the meaning of this text, reflects on it mentally, and thoroughly examines it here with wisdom that is established just as it is; who, thinking "may the way of the buddhas never be cut off, may the sacred Dharma never decline," strives to make the sacred Dharma long endure; and who, without departing from proper conduct, undertakes to bring benefit to the bodhisattvas, the great beings — even if only a small portion of this has been compiled into a volume and is held or preserved; and who offers to that Perfection of Wisdom flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, and encircling strings of lamps, together with many other kinds of offerings; paying homage to it, exalting it, revering it, venerating it, making artistic representations of it, and attending upon it —

Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family thereby generates far greater merit from that basis.

Kauśika, let alone all the sentient beings of a two-thousandfold intermediate world system. Kauśika, imagine further that all the sentient beings there are in a great three-thousandfold world system — that each and every one of those sentient beings causes to be made, one each, a stūpa of seven precious substances containing relics of a Tathāgata at its heart; and that for as long as they live, they offer to those stūpas divine flowers, divine incense, divine perfume, divine garlands, divine ointments, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, divine pennants, and encircling divine strings of lamps, together with many other kinds of divine offerings; paying them homage, exalting them, revering them, venerating

them, making artistic representations of them, and attending upon them —

Kauśika, what do you think? Do all those sentient beings thereby generate great merit from that basis?

Śakra replied: Greatly so, Blessed One. Greatly so, Sugata.

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, even so, this son or daughter of good family generates far greater merit — one who, with faith and devotion, with thought and aspiration, having aroused the awakening mind toward awakening, listens with earnest aspiration, retains it, upholds it, reads it, masters it completely, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, intones the scriptural transmission, chants it by heart, and also teaches others extensively and correctly; who explains the meaning of this text, reflects on it mentally, and thoroughly examines it here with wisdom that is established just as it is; who, thinking "may the way of the buddhas never be cut off, may the sacred Dharma never decline," strives to make the sacred Dharma long endure; and who, without departing from proper conduct, undertakes to bring benefit to the bodhisattvas, the great beings — even if only a small portion of this has been compiled into a volume and is held or preserved; and who offers to that Perfection of Wisdom flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, and encircling strings of lamps, together with many other kinds of offerings; paying homage to it, exalting it, revering it, venerating it, making artistic representations of it, and attending upon it —

Kauśika, this son or daughter of good family generates far greater merit from that basis alone. Kauśika, consider: every single sentient being throughout the great trichiliocosm has each caused to be made one stūpa of the seven precious substances, containing the relics of the Tathāgata as its essential core, and each of them makes offerings to those stūpas for as long as they live — with divine flowers, divine incense, divine perfume, divine garlands, divine ointments, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, divine pennants, and encircling strings of divine lamps, together with many other kinds of divine offerings; paying homage to them, exalting them, revering them, venerating them, making artistic representations of them, and attending upon them. Let that stand as it is.

Kauśika, now suppose further that every single sentient being there may be throughout the great trichiliocosm — all of them, surveyed and counted without exception, having in succession obtained a human body — and from

among them, too, each sentient being causes to be made one stūpa of the seven precious substances, containing the relics of the Tathāgata as its essential core; and having caused them to be made, each of those sentient beings then takes their position before all those stūpas and, for a kalpa or more than a kalpa, makes offerings with every kind of music, every kind of song, every kind of dance, all manner of instruments and all manner of percussion, divine flowers, divine incense, divine perfume, divine garlands, divine ointments, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, all divine pennants, encircling strings of divine lamps, and all the many kinds of offerings of both gods and humans; paying homage to them, exalting them, revering them, venerating them, making artistic representations of them, and attending upon them; and all those sentient beings, by such meritorious deeds as these, cause to be made immeasurable and countless stūpas and cause such offerings as these to be made as well — Kauśika, what do you think? Would all those sentient beings generate a great deal of merit from that basis?

Śakra replied: Greatly so, Blessed One. Greatly so, Sugata.

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, even surpassing that, this son or daughter of good family generates far greater merit still — namely, one who, with faith directed toward this Perfection of Wisdom, with reflection and devoted attention, with a heart full of sincere feeling, having aroused the mind of awakening, and with heightened intention, listens to it, holds it, expounds it, reads it, fully masters it, recites it aloud, teaches it, demonstrates it in detail, proclaims its transmission, chants it by heart, teaches it extensively and correctly to others, explains its meaning, follows it through in reflective thought, and investigates it thoroughly here with whatever level of wisdom one has attained; who aspires that the stream of the Buddha's way not be cut off and that the sacred Dharma not decline, thus working to make the sacred Dharma long endure; and who, without departing from proper conduct, undertakes to bring benefit to the bodhisattvas, the great beings — even if only a small portion of this has been compiled into a volume and is held or preserved; and who offers to that Perfection of Wisdom flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, and encircling strings of lamps, together with many other kinds of offerings;

honoring it, holding it supreme, revering it, venerating it, making symbolic representations of it, and showing it devoted respect — such a son or daughter

of good family, O Kauśika, generates thereby far more merit than from that former basis.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "It is so, Blessed One; it is so, Sugata. Blessed One, the son or daughter of good family who honors this Perfection of Wisdom, holds it supreme, reveres it, venerates it, makes symbolic representations of it, and shows it devoted respect — that person thereby greatly honors, holds supreme, reveres, venerates, makes symbolic representations of, and shows devoted respect to all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — past, future, and present — dwelling in all the world-systems, whom all the buddhas fully know by their buddha-gnosis. Blessed One, to say nothing of all the sentient beings of this great trichiliocosm — even if all the sentient beings of as many great trichiliocosmic world-systems as there are grains of sand in the Gaṅgā River were each to be granted permission to build a stūpa of the seven precious substances enshrining the relics of a Tathāgata, and having built them, every one of those sentient beings were to establish all those stūpas and venerate them for a kalpa or more with every kind of music and melody, every song and dance, every instrument and rhythmic clapping, and all divine flowers, divine incense, divine perfumes, divine garlands, divine ointments, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, divine pennants, encircling strings of divine lamps, and many other varieties of divine offerings — honoring them, holding them supreme, revering them, venerating them, making symbolic representations of them, and showing devoted respect — yet, Blessed One, this son or daughter of good family who, with genuine faith in this Perfection of Wisdom, who reflects upon it, who is devoted and earnest in mind, who has aroused the awakening mind toward full enlightenment, and who with heightened intention listens to it, grasps it, retains it, reads it, brings about thorough understanding, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, transmits its wording, chants it, teaches it fully and accurately to others, comments upon its meaning, mentally investigates it as an object of contemplation, and with the wisdom of what has been truly established examines it thoroughly here; and who, aspiring that the stream of the Buddha's way not be cut off and the sacred Dharma not decline, thus works to make the sacred Dharma long endure; and who, without departing from proper conduct, undertakes to bring benefit to the bodhisattvas, the great beings — even if only a small portion has been compiled into a volume and is held or preserved; and who offers to that

Perfection of Wisdom flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, encircling strings of lamps, and many other varieties of offerings, honoring it, holding it supreme, revering it, venerating it, making symbolic representations of it, and showing it devoted respect — Blessed One, this son or daughter of good family thereby generates far more merit than all of that."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, it is so, it is so.

Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates far more merit than from that basis. Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates immeasurable merit from that basis. Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates incalculable merit from that basis. Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates inconceivable merit from that basis. Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates incomparable merit from that basis. Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates boundless merit from that basis.

Why is that? Kauśika, the omniscience of the Tathāgatas, arhats, and perfectly awakened buddhas is born from the Perfection of Wisdom, and the veneration of the Tathāgatas' bodies is likewise born from omniscience. Therefore, Kauśika, when a son or daughter of good family has faith in this Perfection of Wisdom and reflects upon it with delight, with a mind of deep engagement arouses the awakening mind oriented toward awakening, and then with elevated aspiration listens to it, grasps it, retains it, reads it, fully masters it, proclaims it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, recites it by transmission, chants it, and broadly and correctly teaches it to others — and further elucidates its meaning, reflects upon it with the mind, investigates it thoroughly here with wisdom commensurate with what has been established, acts to ensure that the stream of the buddhas' way is not severed and that the sacred Dharma does not decline, striving to make the sacred Dharma long endure, and, without parting from proper conduct, works to bring about benefit for bodhisattvas, those great beings — and who, even if they did all this only in a small way, compiled it into a volume and holds or preserves it, and offers to that Perfection of Wisdom flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, encircling strings of lamps, and many other varieties of offerings, honoring it, holding it supreme, revering it, venerating it, making symbolic representations of it, and showing it devoted respect — Kauśika, the merit accumulated by this

person does not approach even a hundredth part of the merit previously accumulated by honoring that reliquary of the seven precious materials enshrining the Tathāgata's relics; not a thousandth part, not a hundred-thousandth part, not a ten-millionth part, not a billion-part, not a trillion-part, not a hundred-trillion-part, not a ten-quadrillion-part — it does not come close even by a hundred thousand trillions, it does not come close numerically, it cannot be reckoned, illustrated by example, demonstrated by analogy, or borne as a basis or cause.

Then forty thousand divine sons who had gathered and assembled in that retinue together with Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Friend, seize the Perfection of Wisdom! Friend, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be grasped. Friend, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be retained. Friend, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be read. Friend, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be fully mastered. Friend, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be proclaimed aloud. Friend, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be taught. Friend, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be explained in detail. Friend, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be recited by transmission. Friend, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be chanted."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, seize the Perfection of Wisdom! Kauśika, carry the Perfection of Wisdom! Kauśika, retain the Perfection of Wisdom! Kauśika, master the Perfection of Wisdom fully! Kauśika, proclaim the Perfection of Wisdom aloud! Kauśika, teach the Perfection of Wisdom! Kauśika, explain the Perfection of Wisdom in detail! Kauśika, recite the Perfection of Wisdom by transmission! Kauśika, chant the Perfection of Wisdom!

And why is this? Kauśika, whenever thoughts of this kind arise in the minds of the asuras — 'We shall go to battle against the gods of the Thirty-Three! We shall wage war together against the gods of the Thirty-Three!' — at that very moment, Kauśika, you should call this Perfection of Wisdom to mind and chant it, and those very thoughts arising in the minds of those asuras will be extinguished."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is a great vidyā-mantra. Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is a vidyā-mantra without measure. Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is a vidyā-mantra without limit. Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is a vidyā-mantra without

superior. Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is an unsurpassed vidyā-mantra. Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is a vidyā-mantra without equal. Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is a vidyā-mantra equal to the unequalled."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said this to Śakra, lord of the gods: "So it is, Kauśika, so it is. This Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a great vidyā-mantra. Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a vidyā-mantra without measure. Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a vidyā-mantra without limit. Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a vidyā-mantra without superior. Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed an unsurpassed vidyā-mantra. Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a vidyā-mantra without equal. Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a vidyā-mantra equal to the unequalled.

And why is this? Kauśika, it is in reliance upon this vidyā-mantra of the Perfection of Wisdom that the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas of former times fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening."

Kauśika, however many Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas shall arise in future times and fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — all of those as well, Kauśika, shall fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening in reliance upon this very vidyā-mantra of the Perfection of Wisdom. Kauśika, the buddhas, Blessed Ones, who at this very moment fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening in the immeasurable and innumerable world-systems of the great trichiliocosm — all of those as well, Kauśika, fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening in reliance upon this very vidyā-mantra of the Perfection of Wisdom. Kauśika, I too have fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening in reliance upon this very vidyā-mantra of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Kauśika, in reliance upon this very vidyā-mantra, the paths of the ten virtuous actions are fully revealed in the world. The four meditative concentrations endowed with the branches of awakening are fully revealed in the world. The four immeasurables endowed with the branches of awakening are fully revealed in the world. The four formless absorptions endowed with the branches of awakening are fully revealed in the world. The six higher

knowledges endowed with the branches of awakening are fully revealed in the world. The thirty-seven factors concordant with awakening are fully revealed in the world. In brief, the eighty-four thousand aggregates of Dharma are fully revealed in the world. The wisdom of the buddhas, self-arisen wisdom, and inconceivable wisdom are fully revealed in the world.

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The Fourth Fascicle.

Kauśika, at whatever time Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas do not arise in the world, at that time too, Kauśika, in reliance upon this very vidyā-mantra of the Perfection of Wisdom, the bodhisattvas, great beings, having previously heard what is concordant with the Perfection of Wisdom as its cause, will come to be endowed with skillful means. Those who are endowed with loving care for sentient beings, out of that very loving care, relying upon this world, fully reveal the paths of the ten virtuous actions in the world. The four meditative concentrations not endowed with the branches of awakening are fully revealed in the world. The four immeasurables not endowed with the branches of awakening are fully revealed in the world. The four formless absorptions not endowed with the branches of awakening are fully revealed in the world. The five higher knowledges not endowed with the branches of awakening are fully revealed in the world.

Kauśika, consider this example: in dependence upon the orb of the moon, all medicinal herbs and stars manifest whatever power and might they possess, and the constellations too appear with whatever power and might they have. Kauśika, in just the same way, when a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha has passed away and the sacred Dharma has fallen into decline, and when Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas have not yet arisen in the world —

— in that time, whatever practices of Dharma-conformity, of peaceful conduct, and of virtuous conduct are established and cultivated in the world — all of these are born from the bodhisattva and are fully set forth by the bodhisattva. They issue from the bodhisattva's skillful means, and it should be understood that this skillful means of the bodhisattvas is itself born from the Perfection of Wisdom.

Kauśika, furthermore, those sons of good family and daughters of good family who hold, bear, recite, make thoroughly complete, proclaim, teach, explain, transmit by oral tradition, chant, commit to writing, attend to with the mind, and keep in memory this Perfection of Wisdom — from that basis they may

hope for many benefits in this very life.

When this had been declared, Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One thus: Blessed One, with what benefits of this life will those sons of good family and daughters of good family be endowed?

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, those sons of good family and daughters of good family will not meet their end through hunger and thirst. They will not meet their end through poison. They will not meet their end through weapons. They will not meet their end through fire. They will not meet their end through water. They will not meet their end through clubs. They will not meet their end through harm inflicted by others. Even should harm arise and befall them at the hands of a king, a king's son, a king's great minister, or a king's ministers, those who recollect and recite this Perfection of Wisdom will not be made to appear before them. And if a king, a king's son, a king's great minister, or a king's ministers who have come to seek an opening against them and search for a vulnerability should draw near, those ministers and kings will not find any opening — and this is because this Perfection of Wisdom has been thoroughly held. Even should a king, a king's son, a king's great minister, or a king's ministers draw near, those persons will find themselves wishing to speak and desiring to converse, thinking: "May we truly gladden them."

Why is this? Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom abides in proximity to all sentient beings, cultivating loving-kindness through a mind of loving-kindness and cultivating compassion through a mind of compassion toward them all.

Kauśika, for this very reason, even if sons of good family or daughters of good family have entered into a wilderness thronged with venomous creatures and many poisonous serpents, those humans or non-humans who seek an opening against them and look for a vulnerability will, Kauśika, find no opening against them — except through the maturation of previous karma.

Now at that time, certain wandering tīrthikas (non-Buddhists), their minds set on seeking a pretext for fault-finding, came to where the Blessed One was.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, seeing those wandering tīrthikas approaching from afar, examined their minds and thought: "These wandering tīrthikas have come to where the Blessed One is with the intention of seeking a pretext for fault-finding. By all means I must prevent these wandering tīrthikas from drawing near into the presence of the Blessed One."

"Whatever portion of this Perfection of Wisdom I have retained from the Blessed One's presence — that much I shall call to mind, reflect upon, recite, and proclaim aloud. Having done so, there will be no obstacles to the teaching of this Perfection of Wisdom." With that thought, Śakra, lord of the gods, called to mind however much of this Perfection of Wisdom he had retained from the Blessed One's presence, reflected upon it, recited it, and proclaimed it aloud.

Then those wandering tīrthikas, from a distance even greater than before, circumambulated the Blessed One and departed by that same gate and that same road.

Then the venerable Śāriputra thought to himself: "Why is it that those wandering tīrthikas, from a distance even greater than before, circumambulated the Blessed One and then departed by that same gate and that same road?"

The Blessed One, knowing with his mind the nature of the venerable Śāriputra's thought, spoke to the venerable Śāriputra as follows: "Śāriputra, Śakra, lord of the gods, saw the minds of those wandering tīrthikas who had come with the intention of seeking a pretext for fault-finding, and thought: 'It would not be right for them to create obstacles to the teaching of this Perfection of Wisdom; by all means let those wandering tīrthikas not come while the Perfection of Wisdom is being taught.' In order to turn back those wandering tīrthikas who wished to argue, who wished to dispute, and who wished to contradict, he called to mind this Perfection of Wisdom, reflected upon it, recited it, and proclaimed it aloud. And just as Śakra, lord of the gods, did, so too have I permitted it. Why is that? Śāriputra, I do not see even one wholesome quality in any of those wandering tīrthikas. Śāriputra, every one of them came wishing to do so with minds bent on fault-finding and filled with hostility."

Then Māra the Evil One thought to himself: "These four assemblies of the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, are gathered and assembled in the presence of the Tathāgata, and the sons of the gods dwelling in the desire realm and the form realm are also present here. Surely bodhisattvas, great beings, will here be prophesied to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. I shall draw near to disrupt this with my eyes."

Then Māra the Evil One conjured forth a fourfold army host and drew near to where the Blessed One was.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, thought: "Alas! These are Māra the Evil One, who has conjured forth a fourfold army host and come to where the Blessed One is. Yet this array of the fourfold army host is not the array of the fourfold army host of King Prasenarasāra, nor the array of the fourfold army host of King Prasenajit, nor the array of the fourfold army host of the Śākyas, nor the array of the fourfold army host of the Licchavīs. This has been conjured forth by Māra the Evil One.

Māra the Evil One has, from time without beginning, been watching for an opportunity against the Blessed One, seeking out a vulnerability, and has been bound up with the intention to cause harm to sentient beings. Now, by calling this Perfection of Wisdom to mind, I shall contemplate it, recite it, and proclaim it aloud."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, called this very Perfection of Wisdom to mind, contemplated it, recited it, and proclaimed it aloud. And in exact proportion as Śakra, lord of the gods, called the Perfection of Wisdom to mind, contemplated it, recited it, and proclaimed it aloud, so in that same proportion Māra the Evil One turned back through that very gate and by that very road and departed.

Then the sons of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three manifested divine flowers, the māṇḍārava blossoms, and remaining in the sky amid the air, scattered and strewed those divine māṇḍārava flowers upon the Blessed One. And they proclaimed aloud: "How wonderful! This Perfection of Wisdom has come among the people of Jambudvīpa after such a long interval of time!" Having thus made that solemn declaration, they again took up the divine flowers and scattered and strewed them upon the Blessed One, and spoke these words:

"Blessed One, those sentient beings who expound the Perfection of Wisdom, who meditate upon it, and who practise the Perfection of Wisdom — these cannot be found vulnerable by Māra or by the gods of Māra's host. Blessed One, those sentient beings who listen to this Perfection of Wisdom, who having heard it retain it, uphold it, read it, master it thoroughly, proclaim it aloud, teach it, explain it in detail, recite its scriptural transmission, and make it a recitation — those sentient beings, Blessed One, are not without roots of virtue accumulated from former times. And those sentient beings in whose ear-passages this Perfection of Wisdom has come to resound — they too have surely served the Victors of the past. How much more, then, those who retain it, uphold it, read it, master it thoroughly, proclaim it aloud, teach it, explain it

in detail, recite its scriptural transmission, make it a recitation, train in it as suchness, realize it as suchness, and practise it in yoga as suchness! Blessed One, those sentient beings have paid homage and service to the Tathāgatas. Why? Because it is from this Perfection of Wisdom that omniscience is fully revealed, and it is from this Perfection of Wisdom that omniscience is sought. Blessed One, consider this: just as every jewel and great jewel whatsoever is revealed by the great ocean, and all of them are sought from the great ocean — so too, Blessed One, the great jewel of omniscience is sought from this great ocean of the Perfection of Wisdom of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas."

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke thus to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, it is so, it is indeed so. The great jewel of omniscience of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas arises from none other than this great ocean of the Perfection of Wisdom."

Then the venerable Ānanda spoke to the Blessed One and said:

"Blessed One, you do not praise the perfection of generosity nor proclaim its name in full. Nor do you praise the perfection of moral discipline, nor the perfection of patience, nor the perfection of diligence. Blessed One, you do not praise the perfection of meditative concentration nor proclaim its name in full. And yet, Blessed One, you praise the Perfection of Wisdom alone in full and proclaim its name in full."

The Blessed One declared: "It is so, Ānanda, it is indeed so. Ānanda, I praise and proclaim in full the name of the Perfection of Wisdom alone, and not the other perfections. And why is that? Ānanda, the Perfection of Wisdom goes before the five perfections, and it is for that reason that they obtain the name 'perfection.'

"Ānanda, what do you think — would giving that has not been dedicated to omniscience obtain the name 'perfection of generosity'?"

Ānanda replied: "Blessed One, it would not."

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, what do you think — would moral discipline that has not been so dedicated, patience that has not been so dedicated, diligence that has not been so dedicated, and meditative concentration that has not been so dedicated obtain that name? And Ānanda, what do you think — would wisdom that has not been dedicated to omniscience obtain the name 'Perfection of Wisdom'?"

Ānanda replied: "Blessed One, it would not."

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, what do you think — is the wisdom by which all roots of virtue are dedicated, dedicating them fully to omniscience, inconceivable?"

Ānanda replied: "Blessed One, it is so. Blessed One, that wisdom by which all roots of virtue are dedicated, dedicating them fully to omniscience, is indeed inconceivable. Blessed One, it is supremely inconceivable."

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, therefore, because it is supreme in that way, it obtains the name 'Perfection of Wisdom.' Those who have dedicated all roots of virtue to omniscience obtain the name 'perfection.' Ānanda, therefore, because the roots of virtue are dedicated fully to omniscience, the Perfection of Wisdom goes before the five perfections, leads them, and leads them completely. In this way, the five perfections are all subsumed within the Perfection of Wisdom alone. Ānanda, the very name 'Perfection of Wisdom' is the supreme expression for the complete fulfillment of all six perfections. Ānanda, therefore, when the Perfection of Wisdom is proclaimed in full, all six perfections are proclaimed in full.

"Ānanda, consider this analogy: seeds planted in the great earth will sprout when they meet with the right conditions, for the great earth is the ground of those seeds — it is in dependence upon the great earth that those seeds sprout. Ānanda, in just the same way, the five perfections, when properly taken up by the Perfection of Wisdom, are grounded in omniscience, and it is in dependence upon the Perfection of Wisdom that the five perfections arise. It is because they are fully taken up by the Perfection of Wisdom that they obtain the name 'perfection.'"

"Ānanda, therefore this very Perfection of Wisdom goes before the five perfections, leading and guiding them completely."

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, all the qualities that a son of good family or a daughter of good family would fully acquire through holding, retaining, reading, mastering, reciting aloud, teaching, expounding, receiving scriptural transmission of, and memorizing this Perfection of Wisdom — all of these qualities of the Perfection of Wisdom have not been proclaimed in full by the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha. Rather, what I myself have done is to take up and recite aloud just one portion of this Perfection of Wisdom as it comes from the Blessed One."

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent, excellent, Kauśika! And yet the qualities described are not limited to arising only in those who hold, retain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, expound, receive scriptural transmission of, and memorize this Perfection of Wisdom. Kauśika, any son of good family or daughter of good family who, wishing that the line of the buddhas may not be broken and that the sacred Dharma may not decline — wishing that the sacred Dharma may long endure — and who, without departing from proper conduct, acts to accomplish benefit for great bodhisattvas, writes out this Perfection of Wisdom, places it in a volume, and keeps or enshrines it; who then makes offerings to that Perfection of Wisdom with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, unguents, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, garlands of lamps encircling it all about, and manifold other offerings; who pays it homage, honors it, venerates it, worships it, makes painted images of it, and renders it service — Kauśika, it is the qualities accruing to such a son of good family or daughter of good family in this very life that I have described."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed him with these words: "Blessed One, I too shall write out this Perfection of Wisdom, place it in a volume, keep or enshrine it, wishing that the line of the buddhas may not be broken and that the sacred Dharma may not decline — wishing that the sacred Dharma may long endure — and without departing from proper conduct, to accomplish benefit for great bodhisattvas. And I shall make offerings to that Perfection of Wisdom with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, unguents, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, garlands of lamps encircling it all about, and manifold other offerings; I shall pay it homage, honor it, venerate it, worship it, make painted images of it, and render it service. And if I shall protect, guard, and shelter any son of good family or daughter of good family who does the same — who asks about, holds, retains, reads, masters, recites aloud, teaches, expounds, receives scriptural transmission of, and memorizes this Perfection of Wisdom, and who likewise makes offerings with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, unguents, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, garlands of lamps encircling it all about, and manifold other offerings, paying homage, honoring, venerating, worshipping, making painted images, and rendering service — then how much more need be said?"

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent, excellent, Kauśika! Moreover, Kauśika, when any son of good family or daughter of good family recites this Perfection

of Wisdom aloud, many hundreds of divine sons will come to that very place. Many thousands of divine sons, and many hundreds of thousands of divine sons, will draw near in order to hear the Dharma. As those divine sons listen to the Dharma, they will think to themselves: 'We shall lend our support to the confidence of this Dharma-speaker.' And even at a moment when the Dharma-speaker wishes to stop speaking, those divine sons, moved by that very reverence for the Dharma, will think to lend their support to the confidence of that son of good family or daughter of good family, just as they aspire that he or she continue speaking.

Kauśika, any son of good family or daughter of good family who holds, retains, reads, masters, recites aloud, teaches, expounds, receives scriptural transmission of, and memorizes this Perfection of Wisdom — they too will fully possess these virtues in this very life.

Kauśika, furthermore, when that son of good family or daughter of good family is expounding this Perfection of Wisdom, even if someone approaches with the intention of seeking out a fault in them, that person will not become faint-hearted before the assembly, thinking: 'This is not right.' Why is that? Because the Perfection of Wisdom guards, shelters, and conceals them. One who abides in the Perfection of Wisdom cannot truly be found to have any fault. One who abides in the Perfection of Wisdom cannot truly be found to be seeking out faults. The one in whom a fault is to be sought cannot truly be found. The Perfection of Wisdom itself cannot truly be found. Thus, through this category of reasoning, no refutation whatsoever will arise against a son of good family or daughter of good family who is fully upheld by the Perfection of Wisdom. And this will not cause fear and trembling — neither in people nor in me.

Kauśika, any son of good family or daughter of good family who holds, retains, reads, masters, recites aloud, teaches, expounds, receives scriptural transmission of, and memorizes this Perfection of Wisdom will fully possess these virtues in this very life.

Kauśika, furthermore, such sons of good family or daughters of good family will become pleasing and agreeable to their parents, friends, ministers, relatives, kinsmen by birth, as well as to renunciants (śramaṇas) and brahmins. When opponents arise and men present challenges, they will have the power and ability to refute those opponents through the Dharma; and when questioned by others, they will be able to respond with scriptural

authority.

Kauśika, any son of good family or daughter of good family who holds, retains, reads, masters, recites aloud, teaches, expounds, receives scriptural transmission of, and memorizes this Perfection of Wisdom will fully possess these virtues in this very life.

Kauśika, moreover, in whatever direction that son of good family or daughter of good family has written out this Perfection of Wisdom and placed it as a volume, preceded by offerings — in that very place, Kauśika, whichever divine sons among the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings have genuinely entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening will think to come there.

They too will come there and will gaze upon this Perfection of Wisdom as it has been committed to a volume, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it. Having gazed upon it, paid homage, bowed down, held it, retained it, read it, mastered it, recited it aloud, taught it, expounded it, received scriptural transmission of it, and memorized it, they will then think to depart.

Kauśika, moreover, whichever divine sons among the gods of the Thirty-Three have genuinely entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening will think to come there. They too will come there and will gaze upon this Perfection of Wisdom as it has been committed to a volume, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it. Having gazed upon it, paid homage, bowed down, held it, retained it, read it, mastered it, recited it aloud, taught it, expounded it, received scriptural transmission of it, and memorized it, they will then think to depart.

Kauśika, moreover, whichever divine sons among the gods of the Heaven Free from Strife have genuinely entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening will think to draw near and come there. They too will come there and will gaze upon this Perfection of Wisdom as it has been committed to a volume, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it. Having gazed upon it, paid homage, bowed down, held it, retained it, read it, mastered it, recited it aloud, taught it, expounded it, received scriptural transmission of it, and memorized it, they will then think to

depart.

Kauśika, moreover, whichever divine sons among the gods of the Joyous Heaven have genuinely entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening will think to come there. They too will come there and will gaze upon this Perfection of Wisdom as it has been committed to a volume, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it. Having gazed upon it, paid homage, bowed down, held it, retained it, read it, mastered it, recited it aloud, taught it, expounded it, received scriptural transmission of it, and memorized it, they will then think to depart.

Kauśika, moreover, whichever divine sons among the gods of the Heaven of Delight in Creation have genuinely entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening will think to come there. They too will come there and will gaze upon this Perfection of Wisdom as it has been committed to a volume, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it.

gaze upon it, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it, they will then think to depart.

Kauśika, moreover, whichever divine sons among the gods of the Heaven of Wielding Others' Creations have genuinely entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening will think to come there. They too will come there and will gaze upon this Perfection of Wisdom as it has been committed to a volume, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it, and having gazed upon it, paid homage to it, bowed down before it, held it, retained it, read it, mastered it, recited it aloud, taught it, expounded it, received scriptural transmission of it, and memorized it, they will then think to depart.

Kauśika, likewise, among all the divine sons dwelling in the form realm gods, from whatever number there may be up to those in the Brahma world — whichever divine sons of the Brahmā class have genuinely entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening will think to come there. They too will come there and will gaze upon this Perfection of Wisdom as it has been committed to a volume, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it,

read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it, and having gazed upon it, paid homage to it, bowed down before it, held it, retained it, read it, mastered it, recited it aloud, taught it, expounded it, received scriptural transmission of it, and memorized it, they will then think to depart.

Kauśika, you should not think of this place merely in terms of the Brahmā class alone. Just as with the Brahmā class, so too apply the same in full, as before, for whichever divine sons there may be among the gods called Brahmaḥpurohita. And likewise for Great Brahmā, the gods of Minor Radiance, of Immeasurable Radiance, of Resplendent Light, of Minor Virtue, of Immeasurable Virtue, of Abundant Virtue, of Cloudless Heaven, of Increasing Merit, of Great Fruit, of the Beings Without Perception, of Non-Turbulent, of Unafflicted, of Superb Appearance, of Clarity of Vision — and, Kauśika, among the gods of Akaniṣṭha, whichever divine sons have genuinely entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening will think to come there. They too will come there and will gaze upon this Perfection of Wisdom as it has been committed to a volume, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it, and having gazed upon it, paid homage to it, bowed down before it, held it, retained it, read it, mastered it, recited it aloud, taught it, expounded it, received scriptural transmission of it, and memorized it, they will then think to depart.

Kauśika, a son of good family or a daughter of good family should generate the following thought: toward all those gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (dri za), asuras, garuḍas (nam mkha' lding), kinnaras (mi 'am ci), mahoragas, and non-human beings dwelling in the immeasurable and innumerable world-systems in the ten directions —

"Look upon the Perfection of Wisdom in this volume, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it." Having gazed upon it, paid homage to it, bowed down before it, held it, retained it, read it, mastered it, recited it aloud, taught it, expounded it, received scriptural transmission of it, and memorized it, they will then think to return to their own abodes. One should think: "May this very gift of Dharma be given to all of them."

Kauśika, you should not think that only those sons of the gods dwelling in the desire realm and the form realm within this very world-system of the four

great continents who have genuinely entered into unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening will come there. Kauśika, one should not regard it in that way.

Kauśika, rather, however many sons of the gods dwelling in the desire realm and the form realm throughout the great trichiliocosm who have genuinely entered into unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening — all of them too will think to come there. And having come there, they will gaze upon this Perfection of Wisdom as it abides in the volume, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it. Having gazed upon it, paid homage to it, bowed down before it, held it, retained it, read it, mastered it, recited it aloud, taught it, expounded it, received scriptural transmission of it, and memorized it, they will then think to depart.

Kauśika, the home, dwelling place, and mansion of that son of good family or daughter of good family will be most excellently protected, and no one will cause harm to that person — save for the maturation of previous karma. Kauśika, this is because gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-human beings come there, drawn by the thought that there is great splendor, great splendor — called "Great Splendor" — in that place. Kauśika, that son of good family or daughter of good family will fully possess these qualities in this very life as well.

When this was said, Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods) addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how may a son of good family or a daughter of good family arrange for gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-human beings to come there in order to listen to this Perfection of Wisdom, to gaze upon it, pay homage to it, bow down before it, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, receive scriptural transmission of it, and memorize it?"

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke to Śakra, lord of the gods, as follows: "Kauśika, if a son of good family or a daughter of good family sees great illuminations there, that son of good family or daughter of good family should understand: 'Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-human beings have surely come and arrived here.' Kauśika, furthermore, if that son of good family or daughter of good family smells a fragrance of non-human beings never smelled before,

having smelled that fragrance, that son of good family or daughter of good family should understand: "Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-human beings have surely come and arrived here."

Kauśika, furthermore, if that son of good family or daughter of good family should find their conduct becoming pure and their conduct becoming clean, then by reason of that pure and clean conduct, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-human beings will wish to come there. And those gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-human beings who have come there will be pleased, delighted, and gladdened by that pure and clean conduct, and joy and happiness will arise in them. Then those gods of lesser splendor who dwell there will feel moved to depart. Why is that? Because those gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-human beings of great splendor — those very ones of great splendor — with their glory, majesty, and dignity being unbearable, those gods of lesser splendor will accordingly feel moved to depart.

Kauśika, furthermore, just as those gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-human beings of great splendor — those of great splendor — always wish to come, so too that son of good family or daughter of good family will come to have many devoted followers. Kauśika, that son of good family or daughter of good family will also fully possess these qualities in this very life.

Kauśika, furthermore, that son of good family or daughter of good family, in order to honour, revere, and make complete offerings in that place of the Dharma, should not engage in conduct that is impure or unclean in the environs of that place of the Dharma.

Kauśika, furthermore, that son of good family or daughter of good family will not become fatigued in body or weary in mind. They will sleep comfortably and move about comfortably. Even when they lie down to sleep, they will not see evil dreams. And if they do see something, they will see none other than Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. They will see none other than stūpas. They will see none other than bodhisattvas. They will see none other than the śrāvakas of the Tathāgata. When they hear sounds, they will hear none other than the sounds of the perfections. They will hear the

Dharma teachings of the factors of awakening. They will see none other than trees of awakening, and at those very trees they will see Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas, achieving complete and perfect awakening. Likewise they will see those who have become completely and perfectly awakened turning the wheel of Dharma. They will see great bodhisattvas, great beings, many in number, who delight in discoursing on the Perfection of Wisdom, themselves discoursing on this very Perfection of Wisdom and demonstrating with skillful means how omniscience is to be fully taken up and how buddha-fields are to be completely purified. They will also hear the great sound of the Blessed One buddhas achieving manifest awakening.

They will also hear the great sound of the buddhas — the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha named "The Very Great One" — who, in a certain direction, in a certain quarter of that direction, in a certain world-system, is teaching the Dharma surrounded by and attended upon by many śrāvakas and bodhisattvas, by many hundreds of śrāvakas and bodhisattvas, by many thousands, by many hundreds of thousands, by many tens of millions, by many hundreds of tens of millions, by many thousands of tens of millions, by many hundreds of thousands of tens of millions, and by many hundreds of thousands of hundreds of millions of śrāvakas and bodhisattvas.

O Kauśika, that son of good family or daughter of good family will see dreams of this kind and nature. They will sleep comfortably and wake comfortably. Radiance will suffuse their body from within. They will experience very pleasant food, and they will experience a sense of lightness and spaciousness. No stream of craving thoughts toward food arising at an unsuitable time will arise in them, and their perception of food will grow slight. O Kauśika, just as a monk who is a practitioner of Yogācāra, whose mind is thoroughly saturated with the intention that arises from meditative absorption, does not experience fierce craving for food and his perception of food grows slight — so too, O Kauśika, in that son of good family or daughter of good family, fierce craving for food will not arise, and their perception of food will grow slight. Why is that? O Kauśika, it is because, however that son of good family or daughter of good family strives in the yoga of cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom, to that same degree non-human beings will set their minds on replenishing the radiance of that person's body.

O Kauśika, that son of good family or daughter of good family will also come to fully possess these qualities in this very lifetime.

O Kauśika, furthermore, a son of good family or daughter of good family who writes out this Perfection of Wisdom, has it put into a volume, places it having preceded it with offerings, and venerates it — yet does not take it up, does not bear it, does not read it, does not master it thoroughly, does not recite it aloud, does not teach it, does not explain it in detail, does not chant it from scripture, and does not commit it to recitation — even so, O Kauśika, that son of good family or daughter of good family generates abundant merit. But the son of good family or daughter of good family who has faith and confidence in this Perfection of Wisdom, who reflects on it and is devoted to it with a wholehearted mind, who has generated the awakening mind oriented toward awakening, and who with elevated aspiration listens to it, takes it up, bears it, reads it, masters it thoroughly, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, chants it from scripture, commits it to recitation, teaches it to others as well in its full extent and correctly, elucidates its meaning, reflects on it with the mind, and thoroughly investigates it here with the wisdom of understanding just how things are established — who, with the thought "May the stream of the buddhas' tradition not be cut off! May the noble Dharma not decline!" acts to make the noble Dharma abide for a long time, and, without being separated from the proper conduct, accomplishes the work of bringing benefit to bodhisattvas, great beings — even if that person has the text put into a volume while still young and merely bears or places it —

that person also makes offerings to the Perfection of Wisdom with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, and surrounding garlands of lamps in all directions, together with many other kinds of offering. One who pays honor, homage, reverence, veneration, and worship to the Perfection of Wisdom, and shows devotion to it — that very son or daughter of good family will on that basis generate merit far more abundantly. Therefore, Kauśika, a son or daughter of good family who wishes to fully possess in this very life these remarkable qualities should arouse faith in this Perfection of Wisdom itself, thoroughly examine it, cultivate deep aspiration for it, and generate the awakening mind wholeheartedly. With elevated intention one should listen to it, take it up, retain it, read it, master it thoroughly, recite it aloud, teach it, explain it in detail, transmit it through scriptural authority, recite it by heart, and expound it fully and correctly to others; one should elucidate its meaning, reflect on it

with the mind, and thoroughly investigate it here with the wisdom of understanding just how things are established. With the thought "May the stream of the buddhas' tradition not be cut off! May the noble Dharma not decline!" one should act to make the noble Dharma abide for a long time, and without being separated from proper conduct, accomplish the work of bringing benefit to bodhisattvas, great beings — even if as a young person one has the text put into a volume and merely bears or places it. It should also be properly distributed to those sons and daughters of good family who are earnestly seeking its meaning. For oneself and for other virtuous sentient beings, it will bring the result of not being separated from the great eye of the buddhas' tradition. Therefore one should at all times make offerings to it with divine flowers, divine incense, divine perfume, divine garlands, divine ointments, divine powders, divine robes, divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, divine pennants, surrounding garlands of divine lamps, and many other kinds of offering. One should honor it, pay homage to it, revere it, venerate it, worship it, and show it devotion.

This concludes the third chapter, called "Holding the Immeasurable Qualities of Honoring the Perfection of Wisdom and Stūpas," from the Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines.

Furthermore, the Blessed One declared to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, suppose this entire Jambudvīpa were filled to overflowing with the physical forms of Tathāgatas and someone gave them to you; and suppose this Perfection of Wisdom were also written out and entrusted to you, and then someone were to take away either portion while leaving the other — Kauśika, which of the two portions would you take?"

Śakra replied: "Blessed One, if this entire Jambudvīpa were filled to overflowing with the physical forms of Tathāgatas and bestowed upon me, and this Perfection of Wisdom were also written out and entrusted to me, and then either portion were taken away while the other remained — Blessed One, I would take this very Perfection of Wisdom itself. And why? Because it is for the sake of depicting the Tathāgata's tradition in image. This is the true body of meaning of the Tathāgata. And why so? Because the Blessed One has declared that buddhas, Blessed Ones, are the dharmakāya — the truth body. He has said, 'Monks, do not cling to this as the supreme body; monks, look upon me as the dharmakāya, perfectly complete.' Therefore this physical form of the Tathāgata too should be regarded as fully analyzed by true reality — that is to say, as the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, nor do I fail to show reverence

to those physical forms of the Tathāgata."

"Blessed One, it is indeed I who show reverence to those physical forms of the Tathāgata. Blessed One, yet it is from this Perfection of Wisdom that the physical forms of the Tathāgata have arisen and have thereby come to receive honor. Blessed One, therefore, by paying reverence to this Perfection of Wisdom itself, one will also have completely fulfilled reverence to those physical forms of the Tathāgata. And why so? Because the physical forms of the Tathāgata have arisen from the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, consider this analogy. When I, Dharmasubha the god, am present on my own divine throne in my own abode, the sons of the gods come to render service to me. But when I am absent, those sons of the gods, out of reverence for me, bow to that throne of mine, circumambulate it, and then withdraw. And why so? Because they think, 'Śakra, lord of the gods, sits upon this throne and teaches the Dharma to the gods of the Thirty-Three.'

Blessed One, in precisely the same way, the Perfection of Wisdom — which has come to be renowned for its great power and which serves as the cause and condition — brings about omniscience for the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. The physical forms of the Tathāgata have become the abode of omniscience; yet those forms are not themselves the cause that gives rise to wisdom, nor are they its condition. Blessed One, thus it is that reverence paid to the physical forms of the Tathāgata arises from the cause of omniscient wisdom.

Blessed One, therefore, between those two portions, I choose this Perfection of Wisdom itself. Blessed One, I am not without reverence for those physical forms of the Tathāgata — Blessed One, it is indeed I who show reverence to those physical forms of the Tathāgata. Yet those physical forms of the Tathāgata have come to receive honor through being completely nourished by the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, let alone Jambudvīpa filled brimful with physical forms of the Tathāgata — let alone the world-system of the four great continents filled brimful with physical forms of the Tathāgata, let alone a thousand world-systems filled brimful with physical forms of the Tathāgata, let alone the two-thousand middling world-systems filled brimful with physical forms of the Tathāgata. Blessed One, suppose this very great trichiliocosm — the three-thousand-great-thousand world-system — were filled brimful with physical forms of the Tathāgata, gathered together and set on one side, and

this Perfection of Wisdom were written out and placed as the second portion, and one were then told, 'Of these two portions, take whichever you wish.' Blessed One, in that case I would choose this Perfection of Wisdom itself. Blessed One, I am not without reverence for those physical forms of the Tathāgata — Blessed One, it is indeed I who show reverence to those physical forms of the Tathāgata. Yet those physical forms of the Tathāgata too have come to receive honor through being completely nourished by the Perfection of Wisdom. The physical forms of the Tathāgata have become the abode of omniscient wisdom, and that omniscient wisdom itself issues forth definitively from the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, therefore, between those two portions, I choose this Perfection of Wisdom itself."

Blessed One, I am not without reverence for those physical forms of the Tathāgata — Blessed One, it is indeed I who show reverence to those physical forms of the Tathāgata. Yet, Blessed One, those physical forms of the Tathāgata have also arisen from this Perfection of Wisdom itself, and the honor those physical forms of the Tathāgata have come to receive is precisely this: they have been completely nourished by the Perfection of Wisdom.

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The Fifth Fascicle.

Blessed One, consider, for example, a precious jewel of priceless value, possessed of qualities such as these: wherever it is placed, neither humans nor non-humans can find an opening to cause harm. In whatever place a man or woman has been seized by a non-human, the moment that great precious jewel is given there, the non-human departs at once from that place. When placed upon a body afflicted and swollen with bile-fever, it cuts off that bile and prevents it from spreading, and brings it to peace. When placed upon a body that has become hot with bile, it cuts off that bile too and prevents it from spreading, and brings it to peace. When placed upon one swollen and seized throughout with phlegm, it cuts off that phlegm as well and prevents it from spreading, and brings it to peace. When placed upon a body suffering from a wind-disorder, it cuts off that wind-disorder too and prevents it from spreading, and brings it to peace. In the darkness of a dark night, it causes light to shine. In time of heat, whatever region it is placed in becomes cool. In time of cold, whatever region it is placed in becomes warm. In whatever region there are venomous snakes and likewise other small creatures, if it is held and placed there, those venomous snakes and those small creatures will depart.

Blessed One, if a man or a woman has been seized by a venomous snake and that precious jewel is shown to them, the moment they see the precious jewel their poison is overcome and ceases to exist. Blessed One, that precious jewel is also endowed with those qualities and other such natures as well.

Blessed One, for those whose eyes are afflicted with cataracts, or dimness of sight, or eye-disease, or film over the eye, if that precious jewel is placed upon their eyes, the moment it is placed there those eye-defects are cleared away and become pacified. Blessed One, that precious jewel is endowed with those qualities and with others like them as well.

Whatever water it is placed into takes on a single color, its own color. If it is wrapped in white cloth and placed in water, that water also becomes white. Likewise, if it is wrapped in blue cloth, or yellow cloth, or red cloth, or crimson cloth, or any other of the many various kinds of cloth — whatever cloth it may be wrapped or bound in and placed in water — that water also takes on the respective natural color of those cloths, and whatever turbidity there is in that water also becomes clear. Blessed One, that precious jewel is endowed with qualities of just such a nature.

Then the venerable Ānanda spoke these words to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, are those precious jewels found only in the world of the gods, or are those precious jewels also found among the humans of Jambudvīpa?"

Śakra replied:

"Noble Ānanda, those precious jewels are indeed found among the gods. The humans of Jambudvīpa also have precious jewels, yet those jewels are heavy, small, and coarse, and their qualities are incomplete — they do not possess qualities of that kind of nature. They do not come even close to a hundredth part of those precious jewels of the gods, not to a thousandth, not to a hundred-thousandth, not to a ten-millionth, not to a billion, not to a hundred billion, not to a trillion, not to a hundred trillion. They cannot be reached by counting, by analogy, by illustration through example, by serving as a basis of comparison, or by serving as a proximate cause. Those precious jewels of the gods are perfectly and completely endowed with every quality and dimension.

When that precious jewel is placed into a casket or taken out of it, even after it has been removed, that casket becomes exceedingly dear and beloved — the qualities of that precious jewel cause the casket to become supremely cherished.

Blessed One, in just the same way, one who venerates the physical relics of a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and completely awakened buddha who has passed into nirvāṇa — that veneration is a quality of the Perfection of Wisdom and of the wisdom of omniscience. These physical relics of the Tathāgata have become vessels of the wisdom of omniscience.

Blessed One, just as the teaching of Dharma by all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, in every world-realm is venerated because it arises from the Perfection of Wisdom, so too the teaching of Dharma by a Dharma-preacher is to be venerated because it arises from the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, consider how a king's man, by the power of the king, is paid reverence without fear by great multitudes of people. In just the same way, a Dharma-preacher, by the power of the Dharma body, is paid reverence without fear by great multitudes of beings.

In the manner that a Dharma-preacher who teaches the Dharma obtains veneration, in that same manner veneration is obtained through those physical relics of the Tathāgata.

Blessed One, therefore, let alone a great trichiliocosm filled to the brim with the physical relics of the Tathāgata — Blessed One, even if world-realms as numerous as the grains of sand of the Ganges River, all filled to the brim with physical relics of the Tathāgata, were placed on one side, and this Perfection of Wisdom, written out, were placed on the other side, and if someone were to say to me, 'Of these two portions set before you, take whichever one you wish' — of those two portions, I myself would take this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, it is not that I am disrespectful toward those physical relics of the Tathāgata — Blessed One, I do indeed hold reverence for those physical relics of the Tathāgata. However, Blessed One, omniscience itself is clearly derived from the Perfection of Wisdom, and the veneration of the physical relics of the Tathāgata arises from the wisdom of omniscience.

Blessed One, therefore, when one venerates this Perfection of Wisdom, one thereby venerates all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — those of the past, those yet to come, and those of the present."

"Blessed One, furthermore, sons of good family or daughters of good family who wish to behold the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, who at this very moment dwell, live, and abide in immeasurable, incalculable world-systems — those persons should practice this Perfection of Wisdom, should devote themselves

to yoga in this Perfection of Wisdom, should meditate upon this Perfection of Wisdom."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke to Śakra (Indra), Lord of the Gods, as follows:

"Kauśika, it is exactly so, it is exactly so. Kauśika, all the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas who arose in times past — they too, Kauśika, relying upon this very Perfection of Wisdom, manifestly and fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Kauśika, all the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas who shall arise in times to come — they too, Kauśika, relying upon this very Perfection of Wisdom, shall manifestly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Kauśika, all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, who at this very present time dwell, live, and abide in immeasurable, incalculable world-systems — they too, Kauśika, relying upon this very Perfection of Wisdom, manifestly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Kauśika, I myself, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha of the present, have also, relying upon this very Perfection of Wisdom, manifestly and fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening."

When this was declared, Śakra, Lord of the Gods, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed the great perfection. Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha thoroughly knows and rightly beholds the mental conduct of all sentient beings."

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, it is exactly so, it is exactly so. Kauśika, when a bodhisattva, a great being, practices the Perfection of Wisdom for a long time, that one also rightly knows and rightly beholds the mental conduct of all sentient beings through the Perfection of Wisdom."

Then Śakra, Lord of the Gods, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, does a bodhisattva, a great being, practice only the Perfection of Wisdom alone, and not the other perfections?"

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, a bodhisattva, a great being, practices all six perfections. However, Kauśika, it is none other than this Perfection of Wisdom of the bodhisattva, the great being, that leads the way before all of them. It is this very Perfection of Wisdom of the bodhisattva, the great being — the one who practices generosity, upholds moral discipline, cultivates

patience, undertakes diligent effort, enters into meditative concentration, and views phenomena rightly — that goes ahead of all these."

Kauśika, among these six perfections, when they are gathered up by skillful means and dedicated through the Perfection of Wisdom, and dedicated toward omniscience, no distinction whatsoever is perceived among them, nor is any separateness to be found.

Kauśika, here is an analogy: the many and various trees of Jambudvīpa differ in color, differ in shape, differ in their leaves, differ in their flowers, differ in their fruits, and differ in the fullness of their canopies — yet the shadows of those trees show no distinction among themselves, nor is any separateness apparent. In other respects they go by the single term "shadow, shadow." In just the same way, Kauśika, among these six perfections, when they are gathered up by skillful means and dedicated through the Perfection of Wisdom, and dedicated toward omniscience, no distinction whatsoever is perceived among them, nor is any separateness to be found.

When this had been declared, Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is endowed with great qualities. Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is endowed with immeasurable qualities. Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is endowed with qualities without limit."

This has been the fourth chapter, entitled "A Full Account of the Qualities," from the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family, with genuine faith in this Perfection of Wisdom, reflects upon it, aspires to it, arouses the mind toward awakening with wholehearted engagement, and then, with elevated intention, listens to it, retains it, upholds it, reads it, makes it fully comprehensible, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it, transmits it by scriptural reading, chants it, and teaches it in full and correctly to others — and who also explicates its meaning, considers it with the mind, and investigates it here with the wisdom of established understanding as it truly is — and who, thinking 'may the lineage of the buddhas not be cut off, may the holy Dharma not decline,' works to establish the holy Dharma's long abiding, and, without departing from proper conduct, strives to accomplish benefit for bodhisattvas, great beings — even if, while still young, they have had it written into a book and carry it or preserve it, and having heard this teaching so set

forth, think: 'How great is the meaning of this Perfection of Wisdom! How great are its benefits! How great is its fruit! How great is its karmic ripening! How great are its many qualities! I will not abandon this Perfection of Wisdom. I will guard this Perfection of Wisdom. I will cherish this Perfection of Wisdom. This Perfection of Wisdom is exceedingly difficult to find' — and who, with such intensified aspiration, themselves venerate this Perfection of Wisdom with flowers, incense, fragrance, garlands, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, pennants, and rings of butter-lamp garlands surrounding it, along with offerings of many kinds — and who honor it, exalt it, revere it, venerate it, worship it, and serve it —

And if another were to have it copied into a book and offer veneration to it, and if a son or daughter of good family, aspiring and seeking for the benefit of others, were to give it away, present it, and make a complete gift of it, then, Blessed One, which of these two — a son or daughter of good family who possesses the resolve to give, and one who does not possess the resolve to give — which of the two generates the greater merit?

When this was asked, the Blessed One spoke these words to Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods: "Kauśika, on this very point I put the question to you — declare it as best you can. Kauśika, what do you think? There is a son or daughter of good family who honors and venerates, holds and reveres a Tathāgata's reliquary that they themselves have treated with honor — who honors it, exalts it, reveres it, worships it, has it depicted, and venerates it. And there is another son or daughter of good family who likewise honors, exalts, reveres, worships, has depicted, and venerates a Tathāgata's reliquary, thinking 'May the offerings become vast' — and out of loving affection for sentient beings, broadly and correctly teaches others as well, gives it to them, and distributes it fully. Of these two sons or daughters of good family, Kauśika, which generates the greater merit? Is it the one who makes offerings themselves and also broadly and correctly teaches others, gives it to them, and distributes it fully? Or is it the one who alone, on their own, makes offerings only for themselves?"

Śakra replied: "Blessed One, a son or daughter of good family who themselves honors, exalts, reveres, worships, has depicted, and venerates the Tathāgata's reliquary, thinking 'May the offerings become vast,' and who out of loving affection for sentient beings also broadly and correctly teaches others, gives it to them, and distributes it fully — of these two, this very one generates far greater merit."

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, it is so — it is indeed so. Kauśika, a son or daughter of good family who writes out this Perfection of Wisdom, has it put into a book, retains it, bears it, reads it, thoroughly masters it, recites it aloud, teaches it, explains it in detail, transmits it through scriptural recitation, and chants it — and who, aspiring and seeking for the benefit of other sons and daughters of good family, even has it put into a small book and gives it, presents it, and makes a complete gift of it — Kauśika, of these two sons or daughters of good family, the one who cares for other sons and daughters of good family and who possesses the resolve of complete giving generates far greater merit thereby than the former basis.

Furthermore, Kauśika, a son or daughter of good family who goes to wherever any son or daughter of good family who has become a vessel for this Perfection of Wisdom may be staying, and there gives this Perfection of Wisdom to them and distributes it correctly — this very one, Kauśika, generates far greater merit than that."

"Furthermore, Kauśika, suppose some son or daughter of good family were to establish and settle all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa — however many there may be — perfectly on the path of the ten virtuous actions of karma. Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family thereby generate a great deal of merit?"

Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) replied: "A great deal, Blessed One. A great deal, Sugata."

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, yet this son or daughter of good family generates even more merit than that — namely, whoever takes even a small portion of this Perfection of Wisdom and commits it to a volume, and then, to one who has genuine faith, gives with genuine faith; to one who has clear investigation, gives with clear investigation; to one who has deep aspiration, gives with deep aspiration; to one who has a pure mind, gives with a pure mind; to one who has excellent superior intention, gives with excellent superior intention — and who, with superior intention, gives it to a bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind toward awakening; and who, even in a small amount, works without laziness at questioning and reading it; and who diligently leads that person to uphold it, correctly teaches it, correctly sets it forth, correctly praises it, correctly causes delight in it, expounds it in words, illustrates it fully, and points it out again and again; and who correctly teaches the meaning of this to that person and speaks to them thus: 'Come here, son

of good family. Learn this path of the bodhisattva in the following way. If you train in this path, practice it, and apply yourself, you will swiftly come to fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed and complete awakening. And having fully and perfectly become a buddha, you will guide the immeasurable realm of sentient beings — in this supreme manner, which is the complete exhaustion of the aggregates — to taming through the complete analysis of the true limit'; and who in this way purifies that person's mind and makes them free from doubt — Kauśika, this son or daughter of good family who possesses the resolve of complete giving generates far greater merit than the former.

Kauśika, now set aside all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa. Kauśika, in this same way, consider all the sentient beings — however many there may be — in the world-system of the four great continents: some son or daughter of good family who perfectly establishes and settles all of them on the path of the ten virtuous actions of karma — and Kauśika, now set aside all the sentient beings of the world-system of the four great continents.

Kauśika, in that same way, consider all the sentient beings — however many there may be — in the world-system of a thousand worlds, the first of a thousand: some son or daughter of good family who perfectly establishes and settles all of them on the path of the ten virtuous actions of karma — and Kauśika, now set aside all the sentient beings of the world-system of a thousand worlds.

Kauśika, in that same way, consider all the sentient beings — however many there may be — in the world-system of the two-thousand middling worlds: some son or daughter of good family who perfectly establishes and settles all of them on the path of the ten virtuous actions of karma — and Kauśika, now set aside all the sentient beings of the world-system of the two-thousand middling worlds.

Kauśika, in that same way, consider all the sentient beings — however many there may be — in the world-system of the great trichilocosm of three-thousand worlds: some son or daughter of good family who perfectly establishes and settles all of them on the path of the ten virtuous actions of karma — and Kauśika, now set aside all the sentient beings of the world-system of the great trichilocosm of three-thousand worlds."

"Kauśika, in that same way, consider however many sentient beings there may be in as many world-systems of the great trichilocosm of three-thousand

worlds as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges: if some son or daughter of good family were to perfectly establish and settle each and every one of them on the path of the ten virtuous actions of karma — Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family thereby generate great merit?"

Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods) replied: "Greatly so, Blessed One. Greatly so, Sugata."

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, yet even greater merit is generated by a son or daughter of good family who — having committed even a small portion of this Perfection of Wisdom to a volume — gives it with an excellent intention to a bodhisattva who has given rise to the awakening mind and who approaches it with conviction, who examines it with thorough reflection, who is drawn to it with heightened aspiration, who is clear of heart with a clear heart, and who is endowed with an excellent and heightened resolve; or who engages without fatigue in even a little copying and reciting of it; who with diligence leads another to take it up; who properly teaches it, properly sets it forth, properly extols it, and properly causes delight in it; who illuminates it in word, thoroughly illuminates it, and illuminates it in all its aspects; who properly expounds its meaning; and who speaks thus to another: 'Come here, son of good family — train in this path of the bodhisattva! If you train and practise and strive on this path, you will swiftly come to full and perfect awakening of unsurpassed, complete enlightenment. And having fully and perfectly awakened, you will lead immeasurable realms of sentient beings — bringing their aggregates to complete exhaustion — to tame them in this unsurpassed way: the thorough discernment of the genuine limit' — and who in this way purifies that person's mind and removes all doubt. Kauśika, this son or daughter of good family who is endowed with a mind of complete relinquishment generates far greater merit than the earlier son or daughter of good family.

Kauśika, furthermore, if there are however many sentient beings in Jambudvīpa and some son or daughter of good family were to establish each and every one of them in the four meditative concentrations (dhyāna) — Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family thereby generate great merit?"

Śakra replied: "Greatly so, Blessed One. Greatly so, Sugata."

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, yet even greater merit is generated by a son or daughter of good family who — having committed even a small portion of this Perfection of Wisdom to a volume — gives it with an excellent intention to a bodhisattva who has given rise to the awakening mind, who approaches it with conviction, who examines it with thorough reflection, who is drawn to it with heightened aspiration, who is clear of heart, who is endowed with an excellent and heightened resolve; or who engages without fatigue in even a little copying and reciting of it; who with diligence leads another to take it up; who properly teaches it, properly sets it forth, properly extols it, and properly causes delight in it; who illuminates it in word, thoroughly illuminates it, and illuminates it in all its aspects; who properly expounds its meaning; and who speaks thus to another: 'Come here, son of good family — train in this path of the bodhisattva!'"

"If you train and practice and strive upon this path, you will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. And once you have fully awakened, you will discipline an immeasurable realm of sentient beings — those whose aggregates have completely exhausted — in this supreme opening of the true limit, the unsurpassed."

Speaking thus, one purifies that other's mind and makes it free of doubt.

"Kauśika, set aside all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa. Kauśika, if in the world-realm of the four great continents, however many sentient beings there are — all of them were to be established in the four meditative concentrations by some son or daughter of good family; and, Kauśika, set aside all the sentient beings of the world-realm of the four great continents — Kauśika, if in the world-realm of a thousand-fold universe, however many sentient beings there are — all of them were to be established in the four meditative concentrations by some son or daughter of good family; and, Kauśika, set aside all the sentient beings of the world-realm of the thousand-fold universe — Kauśika, if in the world-realm of a twice-thousand middling universe, however many sentient beings there are — all of them were to be established in the four meditative concentrations by some son or daughter of good family; and, Kauśika, set aside all the sentient beings of the world-realm of the twice-thousand middling universe — Kauśika, if in the world-realm of a great trichiliocosm, however many sentient beings there are — all of them were to be established in the four meditative concentrations by some son or daughter of good family; and, Kauśika, set aside all the sentient beings of the world-realm of the great trichiliocosm — Kauśika, if in world-realms as

numerous as the sands of the Ganges River, however many great trichiliocosms there are, and however many sentient beings dwell within them — all of them were to be established in the four meditative concentrations by some son or daughter of good family: Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family thereby generate a great amount of merit?"

Śakra replied: "A great amount, Blessed One. A great amount, Sugata."

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, even more merit than that will be generated by a son or daughter of good family who — even with only a small portion of this Perfection of Wisdom committed to a book — approaches with clear faith the one who has clear faith, approaches with heightened reflection the one who engages in heightened reflection, approaches with heightened aspiration the one who has heightened aspiration, approaches with clarity of heart the one who is clear of heart, approaches with excellent and heightened resolve the one who is endowed with excellent and heightened resolve, and with the awakening mind that has been aroused for awakening, approaches with heightened resolve the bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind; who engages without fatigue in even a little copying and reciting of it; who with diligence leads another to take it up; who properly teaches it, properly sets it forth, properly extols it, and properly causes delight in it; who illuminates it in word, thoroughly illuminates it, and illuminates it in all its aspects; who properly expounds its meaning; and who speaks thus to another: 'Come here, son of good family — train in this path of the bodhisattva! If you train and practice and strive upon this path, you will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.'"

— and who, after fully awakening, then tames the immeasurable realm of sentient beings, leading them to that unsurpassed complete exhaustion of the aggregates, namely the thorough discernment of the true end of reality — who speaks thus and in that way purifies that person's mind and frees it from all doubt.

Kauśika, there is yet another point. However many sentient beings there are in Jambudvīpa, if some son or daughter of good family were to establish all of them in the four immeasurables, and likewise, as with the immeasurables, were to establish them in the four formless absorptions and the five higher knowledges — from meditative concentration through the immeasurables, the formless absorptions, and all the higher knowledges without exception — Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family

generate great merit from that basis?

Śakra replied: "A great amount, Blessed One. A great amount, Sugata."

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, far greater still is the merit generated by that son or daughter of good family who, having committed even so much as a small portion of this Perfection of Wisdom to a book, then, with earnest faith, engages one of earnest faith; with thorough examination, engages one of thorough examination; with heightened aspiration, engages one of heightened aspiration; with a gladdened mind, engages one of gladdened mind; with perfect superior intention, engages one of perfect superior intention; and who, by arousing the mind of awakening, gives even a little to a bodhisattva whose mind of awakening has been aroused — who engages without fatigue in even a little copying and reciting of it; who with diligence leads another to take it up; who properly teaches it, properly sets it forth, properly extols it, and properly causes delight in it; who illuminates it in word, thoroughly illuminates it, and illuminates it in all its aspects; who properly expounds its meaning; and who speaks thus to another: 'Come here, son of good family — train in this path of the bodhisattva! If you train and practice and strive upon this path, you will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.' And who, after fully awakening, then tames the immeasurable realm of sentient beings, leading them to that unsurpassed complete exhaustion of the aggregates, namely the thorough discernment of the true end of reality — who speaks thus and in that way purifies that person's mind and frees it from all doubt.

Kauśika, never mind the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa in meditative concentration, the immeasurables, the formless absorptions, and the higher knowledges. Kauśika, in the same way, never mind the merit accumulated by some son or daughter of good family who establishes all the sentient beings — however many there are — throughout a world-system of four great continents in meditative concentration, the immeasurables, the formless absorptions, and the higher knowledges. Kauśika, again, never mind the merit accumulated by some son or daughter of good family who establishes all the sentient beings — however many there are — throughout a world-system of four great continents in meditative concentration, the immeasurables, the formless absorptions, and the higher knowledges. Kauśika, never mind the merit accumulated by some son or daughter of good family who establishes all the sentient beings — however many there are — in a world-system of a thousand worlds

Kauśika, never mind the merit accumulated by some son or daughter of good family who establishes all the sentient beings — however many there are — throughout a world-system of a thousand worlds, the chief among thousands, in meditative concentration, the immeasurables, the formless absorptions, and the higher knowledges. Kauśika, never mind the merit accumulated by some son or daughter of good family who establishes all the sentient beings — however many there are — in a world-system of two thousand middle worlds in meditative concentration, the immeasurables, the formless absorptions, and the higher knowledges. Kauśika, never mind the merit accumulated by some son or daughter of good family who establishes all the sentient beings — however many there are — in a great trichiliocosm in meditative concentration, the immeasurables, the formless absorptions, and the higher knowledges. Kauśika, if, in the same way and by that same measure, some son or daughter of good family were to establish all the sentient beings — however many there are — throughout world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, each being a great trichiliocosm, in meditative concentration, the immeasurables, the formless absorptions, and the higher knowledges — Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family thereby accumulate much merit?

Śakra replied: "Greatly, O Blessed One! Greatly, O Sugata!"

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, even more merit than that is accumulated by the son or daughter of good family who, having committed even a brief portion of this Perfection of Wisdom to a book, gives it — moved by sincere faith to one who has sincere faith, with thorough reflection to one who reflects thoroughly, with keen devotion to one who is keenly devoted, with a clear and joyful mind to one who has a clear and joyful mind, with a perfectly excellent superior intention to one who has a perfectly excellent superior intention, and to a bodhisattva who has generated the awakening mind with an excellent superior intention; and who, even in brief, applies themselves with tireless effort to the writing and reading of it; and who causes others to take it up, who teaches it correctly, sets it forth correctly, extols it correctly, and occasions correct delight in it; who illustrates it with words, makes it clear, and clarifies it further, and teaches correctly the meaning of this text — saying to someone: 'Come here, son of good family, train on this path of the bodhisattva! If you train on this path, practice it, and apply yourself to it, you will swiftly achieve manifest and perfect awakening of unsurpassed, complete enlightenment. And having become fully and perfectly awakened,

you will then tame immeasurable numbers of sentient beings by perfectly exhausting the aggregates — the uttermost perfection, the utter laying bare of the true limit' — and thus purifies that person's mind and frees them of doubt.

Kauśika, furthermore, whatever son or daughter of good family writes out this Perfection of Wisdom and both reads it themselves and gives it to others as written, just as before —

Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates far more merit than the one before. Kauśika, furthermore, whatever son or daughter of good family, with skill in meaning, reads this Perfection of Wisdom, and just as before writes it out and gives it to others, and then teaches it with full clarity — explaining both the meaning and the words — Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates far more merit still.

Then Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), the ruler of the gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, shall this Perfection of Wisdom also be taught nearby and made accessible?"

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One replied to Śakra, ruler of the gods, with these words: "Kauśika, this Perfection of Wisdom should indeed be taught nearby and made accessible to those who have not yet understood it. And why? Because in the time to come, a counterfeit image of the Perfection of Wisdom will appear. If those sons or daughters of good family who have not yet understood it, who wish to achieve manifest and perfect awakening of unsurpassed, complete enlightenment, were to hear a counterfeit image of the Perfection of Wisdom and be misled by it, that would be most improper."

Then Śakra, ruler of the gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how shall one recognize in the time to come what counts as the teaching of a counterfeit image of the Perfection of Wisdom? How is one to know that it is a counterfeit image of the Perfection of Wisdom?"

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One replied to Śakra, ruler of the gods, with these words: "Kauśika, in the time to come, certain monks will appear who have not cultivated the body, have not cultivated moral discipline, have not cultivated mind, have not cultivated wisdom — monks whose wisdom is corrupt, dull and sheeplike by nature, their wisdom utterly deteriorated. These monks, claiming to teach the Perfection of Wisdom, will instead present a counterfeit image of it.

Kauśika, how will they present a counterfeit image of the Perfection of Wisdom? They will teach: 'The disintegration of form is the very impermanence of form,' and likewise: 'The disintegration of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness is the very impermanence of consciousness.' They will further teach: 'Whoever seeks in that way is engaging in the Perfection of Wisdom.' Kauśika, this is to be recognized as a counterfeit image of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Kauśika, in contrast, the disintegration of form is not to be viewed as the impermanence of form. Likewise, the disintegration of feeling, perception, and formations — and Kauśika, the disintegration of consciousness is not to be viewed as the impermanence of consciousness. If one views things in that latter way, that is engaging in a counterfeit image of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Therefore, Kauśika, a son or daughter of good family should teach the meaning of this Perfection of Wisdom accessibly and clearly. And when they do teach the meaning of the Perfection of Wisdom, that son or daughter of good family generates extremely abundant merit.

Kauśika, furthermore, consider a son or daughter of good family who establishes all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa, however many there may be, in the fruit of stream-entry. Kauśika, what do you think? Does that son or daughter of good family generate much merit on that account?"

Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) replied: "Blessed One, that is a great deal of merit. Sugata, that is a great deal of merit."

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, even more merit than that is generated by a son or daughter of good family who, even in a small way, puts this Perfection of Wisdom into a volume of scripture, and then, with faith, gives it to one with faith; with thorough discernment, gives it to one with thorough discernment; with keen aspiration, gives it to one with keen aspiration; with a clear and open mind, gives it to one with a clear and open mind; with excellent and elevated intention, gives it to one with excellent and elevated intention; and with elevated intention gives it to a bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind in order to attain awakening. And even in a small way, that son or daughter of good family applies themselves without rest to writing it and reading it, and with diligence leads others to take it up, teaches it correctly, presents it correctly, praises it correctly, causes others to rejoice in it correctly, illustrates it with words, explains it fully, and illuminates it again and again. They teach the meaning of it correctly, and they speak these very

words: 'Come here, son of good family. Train in this path of the bodhisattva. If you train in this path and practice it and strive, you will swiftly attain full and perfect awakening, unsurpassed and completely perfect.' And once you are fully and perfectly awakened, you will bring the immeasurable realm of sentient beings to complete mastery in the unsurpassed thorough exhaustion of the aggregates — that is, to the clear discernment of the true limit.' Speaking in this way, they purify that person's mind, free them from doubt, and say these words: 'Son of good family, you — just so — should attain those very qualities endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom.' Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates far more merit than the former one.

And why is that? Kauśika, because from this the fruit of stream-entry is clearly distinguished.

Kauśika, never mind the merit of establishing all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa in the fruit of stream-entry. Kauśika, never mind the merit of establishing all the sentient beings in the world-system of the four great continents in the fruit of stream-entry — let that much merit be set aside. Kauśika, never mind the merit of establishing all the sentient beings in the world-system of a thousand worlds headed by their single supreme in the fruit of stream-entry — let that much merit be set aside. Kauśika, never mind the merit of establishing all the sentient beings in the world-system of the two-thousand middling worlds in the fruit of stream-entry — let that much merit be set aside. Kauśika, as for all the sentient beings there may be in the world-system of the great trichiliocosm of three thousand worlds — however many there are — and a son or daughter of good family who establishes every one of them in the fruit of stream-entry —

Kauśika, let the merit of establishing all the sentient beings in the world-system of the great trichiliocosm of three thousand worlds in the fruit of stream-entry be set aside. Kauśika, suppose that in a series of world-systems of the great trichiliocosm of three thousand worlds as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River there are sentient beings — however many there may be — and some son or daughter of good family establishes every single one of them in the fruit of stream-entry. Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family generate much merit on that basis?" Śakra replied: "Much, O Blessed One; much, O Sugata." The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, even more merit than that does this son or daughter of good family generate — namely, whoever has committed this Perfection of Wisdom, even in brief, to a book, and then with faith gives to one who has faith, with earnest

reflection gives to one who reflects earnestly, with keen aspiration gives to one who has keen aspiration, with a serene mind gives to one whose mind is serene, with an excellent and exalted intention gives to one who has an excellent and exalted intention, and with the awakening mind thus aroused gives with an exalted intention to a bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind toward awakening; or who, even in brief, strives without laziness and with diligence in the writing and reading of it, causes another to take it up, teaches it correctly, arranges it correctly, extols it correctly, causes delight in it correctly, indicates it through words, clarifies its meaning through exposition, and traces it further; and who teaches the correct meaning of this to another; and who says these words: 'Come here, son of good family — train yourself on this path of the bodhisattva. Having trained and practised on this path and made the effort, you will swiftly come to fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, complete, perfect awakening. And having fully and perfectly awakened, you will bring the immeasurable multitude of sentient beings to perfect exhaustion of the aggregates — that is to say, you will lead them to the full discernment of the true ultimate end'; and who thus purifies that person's mind and dispels all doubt; and who says these words: 'Son of good family, attain for yourself these very qualities that belong to the Perfection of Wisdom' — Kauśika, this son or daughter of good family generates far more merit than the former. And why is that? Kauśika, because from this the fruit of stream-entry is fully discerned.

Kauśika, furthermore, suppose some son or daughter of good family establishes all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa — however many there are — in the fruit of once-returning at a single stroke. Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family generate much merit on that basis?" Śakra replied: "Much, O Blessed One; much, O Sugata." The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, even more merit than that does this son or daughter of good family generate — namely, whoever has committed this Perfection of Wisdom, even in brief, to a book, and then with faith gives to one who has faith, with earnest reflection gives to one who reflects earnestly, with keen aspiration gives to one who has keen aspiration, with a serene mind gives to one whose mind is serene, with an excellent and exalted intention gives to one who has an excellent and exalted intention, and with the awakening mind thus aroused gives with an exalted intention to a bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind toward awakening; or who, even in brief, strives without laziness

to engage another in holding it, to teach it correctly, to expound it correctly, to extol it correctly, to cause another to rejoice in it correctly, to illuminate it with words, to illustrate it with examples, to point it out in accordance with the text, and to teach another its meaning correctly; and who speaks thus: "Come here, son of good family! Train yourself in this path of the bodhisattva. If you train in this path, practice it, and strive at it, you will swiftly attain the manifest, complete, and perfect awakening of unsurpassed, truly perfected buddhahood. And having fully and perfectly awakened, you will bring to complete mastery the immeasurable realm of sentient beings in the utterly supreme cessation of the aggregates — that is to say, the unsurpassed, which is the perfect disclosure of the ultimate limit of reality" — speaking thus, purifying that person's mind, and making them free of doubt; and who further says these words: "Son of good family, obtain for yourself these very qualities endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom" — Kauśika, such a son or daughter of good family generates far more merit than the former. And why is that? Kauśika, this disclosure leads to the fruit of once-returning.

Kauśika, set aside the merit accumulated by establishing all sentient beings of Jambudvīpa in the fruit of once-returning. Kauśika, if some son or daughter of good family were to establish all the sentient beings there are in the world-system of the four great continents in the fruit of once-returning — Kauśika, set aside even the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of the world-system of the four great continents in the fruit of once-returning. Kauśika, if some son or daughter of good family were to establish all the sentient beings there are in the world-system of one thousand worlds in the fruit of once-returning — Kauśika, set aside even the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of the world-system of one thousand worlds in the fruit of once-returning. Kauśika, if some son or daughter of good family were to establish all the sentient beings there are in the world-system of two thousand middling worlds in the fruit of once-returning — Kauśika, set aside even the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of the world-system of two thousand middling worlds in the fruit of once-returning. Kauśika, if some son or daughter of good family were to establish all the sentient beings there are in the great trichilocosm, the world-system of three thousand great thousands, in the fruit of once-returning — Kauśika, set aside even the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of the great trichilocosm in the fruit of once-returning. Kauśika, if some son or daughter of good family were to

establish all the sentient beings there are in as many great trichiliocosms as there are grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā in the fruit of once-returning — Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family generate great merit on that basis?

Śakra replied: Greatly so, Blessed One! Greatly so, Sugata!

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, far more than even that does this son or daughter of good family generate merit.

Whoever, having even so much as committed this Perfection of Wisdom to a volume in abbreviated form, then with faith directs that faith, with thorough examination directs that thorough examination, with keen devotion directs that keen devotion, with a clear mind directs that clear mind, with perfect superior intention directs that perfect superior intention, and with the awakening mind aroused toward awakening gives with superior intention to a bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind toward awakening — and who, even in abbreviated form, diligently applies themselves without laziness to writing and reading it, and with earnestness causes others to take it up, teaches it correctly, sets it forth correctly, praises it correctly, causes delight in it correctly, elucidates it with words, explains it thoroughly, demonstrates it in full, and teaches its meaning properly — and says to that person: "Come here, son of good family! Train on this path of the bodhisattva! If you train and practice on this path and apply yourself, you will swiftly come to fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. And having fully and perfectly awakened, you will lead the immeasurable realm of sentient beings — in this supreme manner, through the complete exhaustion of their aggregates — to taming them in the thorough discernment of the true limit." Speaking thus, and in that way purifying that person's mind and freeing it from doubt, and saying these words: "Son of good family, may you attain precisely those qualities of the Perfection of Wisdom" — Kauśika, this son or daughter of good family generates far more merit than the former. And why is that? Kauśika, it is because this very text discerns the fruit of once-returning.

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, the sixth fascicle.

Kauśika, furthermore, if some son or daughter of good family were to establish all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa in the fruit of non-returning — Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family generate great merit on that basis?

Śakra replied: Greatly so, Blessed One! Greatly so, Sugata!

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, far more than even that does this son or daughter of good family generate merit — whoever, having even so much as committed this Perfection of Wisdom to a volume in abbreviated form, then with faith directs that faith, with thorough examination directs that thorough examination, with keen devotion directs that keen devotion, with a clear mind directs that clear mind, with perfect superior intention directs that perfect superior intention, and with the awakening mind aroused toward awakening gives with superior intention to a bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind toward awakening — and who, even in abbreviated form, diligently applies themselves without laziness to writing and reading it, and with earnestness causes others to take it up, teaches it correctly, sets it forth correctly, praises it correctly, causes delight in it correctly, elucidates it with words, explains it thoroughly, demonstrates it in full, and teaches its meaning properly — and says to that person: "Come here, son of good family! Train on this path of the bodhisattva! If you train and practice on this path and apply yourself, you will swiftly come to fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening."

"And having fully and perfectly awakened, one will guide the immeasurable realm of sentient beings to thoroughly realize this unsurpassed complete exhaustion of the aggregates — that is, the perfect opening of the true and real limit." Speaking thus, one who in that way purifies another's mind, frees them from doubt, and says the words: "Son of good family, you should attain those very teachings endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom" — Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates far more merit than the first. And why is that? Kauśika, because this opens up the fruit of non-return.

Kauśika, set aside the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa in the fruit of non-return. Kauśika, set aside even the merit accumulated by any son or daughter of good family who establishes in the fruit of non-return all the sentient beings that exist throughout the world-system of the four great continents. Kauśika, set aside even the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of the world-system of the four great continents in the fruit of non-return.

Kauśika, set aside the merit accumulated by any son or daughter of good family who establishes in the fruit of non-return all the sentient beings that exist throughout the world-system of one thousand worlds. Kauśika, set aside even the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of that

world-system of one thousand worlds in the fruit of non-return.

Kauśika, set aside the merit accumulated by any son or daughter of good family who establishes in the fruit of non-return all the sentient beings that exist throughout the intermediate world-system of two thousand worlds. Kauśika, set aside even the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of that intermediate world-system of two thousand worlds in the fruit of non-return.

Kauśika, set aside the merit accumulated by any son or daughter of good family who establishes in the fruit of non-return all the sentient beings that exist throughout the great thousandfold world-system of three thousand worlds. Kauśika, set aside even the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of that great thousandfold world-system of three thousand worlds in the fruit of non-return.

Kauśika, if any son or daughter of good family were to establish in the fruit of non-return all the sentient beings that exist in as many great thousandfold world-systems as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges — Kauśika, what do you think: would that son or daughter of good family generate great merit from that basis?

Śakra replied: "Greatly, Blessed One! Greatly, O Sugata!"

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, yet more merit than even that is generated by the son or daughter of good family who, even in a small way, has this Perfection of Wisdom put into a book, and who then, with fervent faith, gives to one of fervent faith; with discerning reflection, gives to one of discerning reflection; with keen aspiration, gives to one of keen aspiration; with a joyful mind, gives to one of joyful mind; with excellent and exalted intention, gives to one of excellent and exalted intention; with an awakening mind aroused toward awakening, gives with exalted intention to a bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind — even in a small way diligently applies themselves without laziness to writing and reading it, and with earnestness causes others to take it up, teaches it correctly, sets it forth correctly, praises it correctly, and causes delight in it correctly.

illustrates it with words, illustrates it in detail, and illustrates it repeatedly — and correctly teaches the meaning of this to another person — and furthermore says to that person these very words: "Come here, son of good family! Train in this path of the bodhisattva. If you train, practice, and apply yourself to this path, you will quickly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect,

complete awakening. And having fully and perfectly awakened, you will tame the immeasurable realm of sentient beings — those whose aggregates are utterly exhausted in the unsurpassed way — leading them to the complete discernment of the true end." And speaking thus, one purifies that person's mind and frees them from doubt. And if one says to them these words: "Son of good family, obtain for yourself precisely those qualities endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom" — Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates far more merit than the former. Why is that? Because, Kauśika, from this very teaching the fruit of non-return is fully discerned.

Furthermore, Kauśika, if some son or daughter of good family were to establish all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa — however many there may be — in the state of arhatship, Kauśika, what do you think: would that son or daughter of good family thereby generate much merit? Śakra replied: "A great deal, Blessed One. A great deal, Sugata." The Blessed One declared: "Yet more merit than that, Kauśika, does that son or daughter of good family generate — the one who has committed this Perfection of Wisdom, even in brief, to a book; who, with keen aspiration, gives to one of keen aspiration; with discerning reflection, to one of discerning reflection; with keen aspiration, to one of keen aspiration; with a joyful mind, to one of joyful mind; with excellent and exalted intention, to one of excellent and exalted intention; with an awakening mind aroused toward awakening, gives with exalted intention to a bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind — and who diligently applies themselves without laziness even in a small way to writing and reading it, with earnestness causes others to take it up, teaches it correctly, sets it forth correctly, praises it correctly, causes delight in it correctly, illustrates it with words, illustrates it in detail, and illustrates it repeatedly, and correctly teaches the meaning of this to another — and furthermore says these very words: 'Come here, son of good family! Train in this path of the bodhisattva. If you train, practice, and apply yourself to this path, you will quickly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And having fully and perfectly awakened, you will tame the immeasurable realm of sentient beings — those whose aggregates are utterly exhausted in the unsurpassed way — leading them to the complete discernment of the true end.' And speaking thus, one purifies that person's mind and frees them from doubt, and says to them these words: 'Son of good family, obtain for yourself precisely those qualities endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom.'"

Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family generates far more merit than the former. Why is that? Because, Kauśika, from this very teaching even arhatship itself is fully discerned. And in this regard it is as follows: son of good family, however much and in whatever way you train in the Perfection of Wisdom, in exactly that measure and in that very way you will ultimately come to attain the qualities of a buddha and draw ever closer to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

If you train in this training, practice it, and apply yourself to it, you will fully discern the fruit of stream-entry. You will fully discern the fruit of once-returning. You will fully discern the fruit of non-returning. You will fully discern arhatship itself. You will fully discern the state of a pratyekabuddha. And you will fully discern perfect, complete buddhahood — thus one should stir up and increase your enthusiasm.

Kauśika, set aside the merit accumulated by establishing all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa in arhatship. Kauśika, set aside even the merit accumulated by some son or daughter of good family who establishes all sentient beings — however many there are — in the world-system of the four great continents in arhatship, and the merit accumulated by establishing all sentient beings of that world-system of the four great continents in arhatship. Kauśika, set aside the merit accumulated by some son or daughter of good family who establishes all sentient beings — however many there are — in the world-system of a thousand worlds in arhatship, and the merit accumulated by establishing all sentient beings of that thousand-world world-system in arhatship. Kauśika, set aside the merit accumulated by some son or daughter of good family who establishes all sentient beings — however many there are — in the world-system of the two-thousand middle worlds in arhatship, and the merit accumulated by establishing all sentient beings of that two-thousand middle world-system in arhatship. Kauśika, set aside the merit accumulated by some son or daughter of good family who establishes all sentient beings — however many there are — in the world-system of the great three-thousand-fold world in arhatship, and the merit accumulated by establishing all sentient beings of that great three-thousand-fold world-system in arhatship. Kauśika, if a son or daughter of good family were to establish in arhatship all sentient beings — however many there are — in world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River multiplied by the number of great three-thousand-fold world-systems, Kauśika, what do you think — would that son or daughter of good family generate great merit from that

basis?

Śakra replied: Blessed One, it would be great indeed. Sugata, it would be great indeed. Blessed One, it would not be easy to count that mass of merit. Blessed One, that mass of merit cannot be counted, cannot be illustrated by example, cannot be demonstrated by analogy, cannot serve as a basis or a proximate cause for comparison.

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, even so, this son or daughter of good family generates far more merit — whoever, having committed this Perfection of Wisdom, even in condensed form, to a written volume, then gives it to a bodhisattva who has aroused the mind of awakening, giving it with faith to one of faith, with discernment to one of discernment, with keen aspiration to one of keen aspiration, with a clear mind to one of clear mind, with excellent superior intention to one of excellent superior intention; or whoever diligently pursues its copying and reading without intermission, even in condensed form; or whoever applies diligence to retaining it; or whoever teaches it correctly, sets it forth correctly, extols it correctly, causes others to rejoice in it correctly; or whoever expounds it in words, elucidates it fully, explains it by way of its meaning, and correctly teaches its meaning —

And to that person one says the following: "Come here, son of good family. Train on this path of the bodhisattva. If you train on this path, practise it, and apply yourself with diligence, you will swiftly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And having fully and perfectly awakened, you will then guide the immeasurable realm of sentient beings — through the supreme exhaustion of the aggregates, namely the thorough discernment of the true limit — to complete and perfect taming." Speaking thus, and thereby purifying that person's mind and freeing it from doubt, and saying these words: "Son of good family, you yourself — obtain these very qualities endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom" — this generates far more merit than all the foregoing. And why is that? Kauśika, from this very teaching the state of arhatship is thoroughly discerned.

In this regard, son of good family, however and in whatever manner you train in the Perfection of Wisdom, in just that manner and to just that extent you will come to obtain the qualities of a buddha, and you will draw near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. If you train on this path, practise it, and apply yourself with diligence, you will thoroughly discern the fruit of stream-entry. You will thoroughly discern the fruit of once-returning. You will

thoroughly discern the fruit of non-returning. You will thoroughly discern the state of arhatship. You will thoroughly discern the state of pratyekabuddhahood. You will thoroughly discern the state of perfect, complete buddhahood. Saying this, one will increase the other's enthusiasm.

Moreover, Kauśika, consider all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa — every single one of them. If some son of good family or daughter of good family were to establish them all in the state of pratyekabuddhahood — Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son of good family or daughter of good family generate much merit on account of that basis?" Śakra (Indra, ruler of the gods) replied: "Much, Blessed One. Much, O Sugata." The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, more than that does a son of good family or daughter of good family generate merit — one who, even in condensed form, once the Perfection of Wisdom has been committed to a volume, gives it with faith to one of faith, with discernment to one of discernment, with keen aspiration to one of keen aspiration, with a clear mind to one of clear mind, with excellent superior intention to one of excellent superior intention, or to a bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind with superior intention; or whoever diligently pursues its copying and reading without intermission, even in condensed form; or whoever applies diligence to retaining it; or whoever teaches it correctly, sets it forth correctly, extols it correctly, causes others to rejoice in it correctly; or whoever expounds it in words, elucidates it fully, explains it by way of its meaning, and correctly teaches its meaning to it — and to that person says the following: 'Come here, son of good family. Train on this path of the bodhisattva. If you train on this path, practise it, and apply yourself with diligence, you will swiftly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And having fully and perfectly awakened, you will then guide the immeasurable realm of sentient beings — through the supreme exhaustion of the aggregates, namely the thorough discernment of the true limit — to complete and perfect taming.' Speaking thus, and thereby engaging that person's mind and freeing it from doubt, and saying these words: 'Son of good family, you yourself — obtain these very qualities endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom.' This generates far more merit than all the foregoing. And why is that? Kauśika, from this very teaching the state of pratyekabuddhahood is thoroughly discerned.

In this way, the instruction is given: "Son of good family, to whatever degree and in whatever manner you train in the Perfection of Wisdom, to that very degree and in that very manner you will gradually attain the qualities of a

buddha. You will draw ever closer to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. Training and practicing in this discipline, striving in it, you will thoroughly discern the fruit of stream-entry. You will thoroughly discern the fruit of once-returning. You will thoroughly discern the fruit of non-returning. You will thoroughly discern arhathood itself. You will thoroughly discern pratyekabuddhahood itself. You will thoroughly discern perfectly complete buddhahood itself." Saying thus, one generates and increases enthusiasm in that person.

Kauśika, set aside the merit of establishing all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa in pratyekabuddhahood. Kauśika, set aside even the merit of one son or daughter of good family establishing all the sentient beings of the world-system of four great continents in pratyekabuddhahood, and then accumulating the merit of establishing all the sentient beings of that very world-system of four great continents in pratyekabuddhahood. Kauśika, set aside the merit of one son or daughter of good family establishing all the sentient beings of a thousandfold world-system in pratyekabuddhahood, and then accumulating the merit of establishing all the sentient beings of that very thousandfold world-system in pratyekabuddhahood. Kauśika, set aside the merit of one son or daughter of good family establishing all the sentient beings of a two-thousandfold intermediate world-system in pratyekabuddhahood, and then accumulating the merit of establishing all the sentient beings of that very two-thousandfold intermediate world-system in pratyekabuddhahood. Kauśika, set aside the merit of one son or daughter of good family establishing all the sentient beings of a three-thousandfold great world-system in pratyekabuddhahood, and then accumulating the merit of establishing all the sentient beings of that very three-thousandfold great world-system in pratyekabuddhahood. Kauśika, suppose that some son or daughter of good family were to establish in pratyekabuddhahood all the sentient beings found in as many three-thousandfold great world-systems as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges — Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family generate much merit on that basis?

Śakra — Indra, lord of the gods — replied: "Greatly, Blessed One. Greatly, Sugata."

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, far more merit than that is generated by this son or daughter of good family — whoever, with even so little as a single volume of this Perfection of Wisdom written down, gives it out of genuine faith to one of genuine faith, out of thorough discernment to one of thorough

discernment, out of keen aspiration to one of keen aspiration, out of a clear and open mind to one of a clear and open mind, out of excellent elevated intention to one of excellent elevated intention, or gives it to a bodhisattva who has aroused the awakening mind toward awakening with elevated intention — and who, even in so small a matter as copying it out and reading it, strives at this without distraction, and with energy takes it up and holds it, teaches it correctly, sets it forth correctly, praises it correctly, causes delight in it correctly, points to it with words, demonstrates it through analysis, elucidates it in detail, and correctly teaches its meaning —

And to that person one would speak thus: "Come here, son of good family — train yourself on this path of the bodhisattva. If you train on this path, practice it, and strive at it, you will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And having fully and perfectly awakened, you will then lead the immeasurable realm of sentient beings to the thorough cutting through of this highest goal — the complete exhaustion of the aggregates — to perfect discipline in the utter end of reality." Speaking thus, one purifies that person's mind and frees them from doubt. And if one says the words: "Son of good family, obtain for yourself these very Dharmas of the Perfection of Wisdom" — this generates far more merit than what came before.

Why is that? Kauśika, from this very Perfection of Wisdom the state of a pratyekabuddha is thoroughly distinguished. And it is thus: son of good family, in whatever measure and manner you come to train in the Perfection of Wisdom, in that same measure and manner you will in due course attain the Dharmas of a buddha. You will draw near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. If you train in this training, practice it, and strive at it, you will thoroughly distinguish the fruit of stream-entry. You will thoroughly distinguish the fruit of once-returning. You will thoroughly distinguish the fruit of non-returning. You will thoroughly distinguish the state of arhat. You will thoroughly distinguish the state of pratyekabuddha. You will thoroughly distinguish the state of a perfectly complete buddha — thus one increases enthusiasm and joy.

Kauśika, consider further: however many sentient beings there are in Jambudvīpa, and some son or daughter of good family causes them all to arouse the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — and Kauśika, another son or daughter of good family causes all of those same beings to arouse the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening and then gives them this Perfection of Wisdom written

out — and Kauśika, some son or daughter of good family, thinking "I will train in this Perfection of Wisdom and practice it as yoga, and through this very Perfection of Wisdom I will meditate upon, increase, extend, and expand the Perfection of Wisdom, and thereby perfectly complete all the Dharmas of a buddha" — if they then entrust this Perfection of Wisdom to a non-retreating bodhisattva, a great being, this son or daughter of good family generates far more merit than the former.

Why is that? Because this one will certainly, having fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, bring the suffering of sentient beings to its final end.

Kauśika, let alone the merit that is accumulated by all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa arousing the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — Kauśika, let alone the merit accumulated by all the sentient beings of a world-system of four great continents arousing the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening through the efforts of some son or daughter of good family — and Kauśika, let alone further the merit accumulated by all sentient beings of that same world-system of four great continents arousing the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening —

Kauśika, let alone the merit accumulated by all the sentient beings — however many there may be — in a world-system of one thousand worlds (a minor chiliocosm) arousing the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening through the efforts of some son or daughter of good family — and Kauśika, let alone further the merit accumulated by all the sentient beings of that same world-system of one thousand worlds arousing the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — Kauśika, let alone the merit accumulated by all the sentient beings — however many there may be — in a world-system of two thousand worlds (a middling chiliocosm) arousing the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening through the efforts of some son or daughter of good family — and Kauśika, let alone further the merit accumulated by all the sentient beings of that same world-system of two thousand worlds arousing the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — Kauśika, let alone the merit accumulated by all the sentient beings — however many there may be — in a great trichiliocosm world-system arousing the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening through the efforts of some son or daughter of good family — and Kauśika, let alone

further the merit accumulated by all the sentient beings of that same great trichiliocosm world-system arousing the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Kauśika, suppose that in world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, however many sentient beings there may be, some son or daughter of good family were to cause all of them to arouse the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And then another son or daughter of good family, having caused all of those same beings to arouse the awakening mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, were to write out this Perfection of Wisdom and give it to them as a gift — and thinking, "By training and practicing in this Perfection of Wisdom in this way, this Perfection of Wisdom will be greatly cultivated, will grow, will expand, and will become vast, and will thereby be brought to complete fulfillment," were to entrust this Perfection of Wisdom to an irreversible great bodhisattva — Kauśika, that son or daughter of good family would generate far more merit than the former. Why is that? Because it is through this that one will assuredly attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and having done so will bring the suffering of sentient beings to its final end.

Kauśika, furthermore, suppose all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa — however many there may be — were to become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and then some son or daughter of good family were to write out this Perfection of Wisdom in a volume and give it as a gift and entrust it to those very beings, teaching them both its meaning and its letters. Kauśika, what do you think — would that son or daughter of good family generate abundant merit from that basis?

Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods) replied: Blessed One, it would be vast. Sugata, it would be vast. Blessed One, that mass of merit is not easy to count. Blessed One, that mass of merit is not easy to enumerate, not easy to illustrate with analogies, not easy to exemplify, not easy to use as a basis for comparison, not easy to trace to its causes.

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, all the more so — that son or daughter of good family would generate far greater merit still.

For those non-retrogressing bodhisattvas, great beings, who wish to swiftly manifest perfect, unsurpassed, complete awakening, one who writes out this Perfection of Wisdom in a volume, presents it, entrusts it, and teaches it nearby with its meaning and its letters — and who recites and expounds this

Perfection of Wisdom — that person generates merit beyond compare. Set aside, Kauśika, the merit of entrusting this Perfection of Wisdom to all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa who have become non-retrogressing. Kauśika, suppose all the sentient beings in the world system of the four great continents were likewise to become non-retrogressing from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and then some son or daughter of good family were to write out this Perfection of Wisdom in a volume, present it, entrust it, and teach it nearby with its meaning and its letters — set aside, Kauśika, even the merit of entrusting this Perfection of Wisdom to all the sentient beings of that world system of the four great continents who have become non-retrogressing.

Kauśika, suppose all the sentient beings in a world system of one thousand worlds were likewise to become non-retrogressing from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and then some son or daughter of good family were to write out this Perfection of Wisdom in a volume, present it, entrust it, and teach it nearby with its meaning and its letters — set aside, Kauśika, even the merit of entrusting this Perfection of Wisdom to all the sentient beings of that world system of one thousand worlds who have become non-retrogressing.

Kauśika, suppose all the sentient beings in a world system of two thousand middle worlds were likewise to become non-retrogressing from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and then some son or daughter of good family were to write out this Perfection of Wisdom in a volume, present it, entrust it, and teach it nearby with its meaning and its letters — set aside, Kauśika, even the merit of entrusting this Perfection of Wisdom to all the sentient beings of that world system of two thousand middle worlds who have become non-retrogressing.

Kauśika, suppose all the sentient beings in a great trichilocosm were likewise to become non-retrogressing from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and then some son or daughter of good family were to write out this Perfection of Wisdom in a volume, present it, entrust it, and teach it nearby with its meaning and its letters — set aside, Kauśika, even the merit of entrusting this Perfection of Wisdom to all the sentient beings of that great trichilocosm who have become non-retrogressing.

Kauśika, suppose there were as many sentient beings in a great trichilocosm as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges, and all of them were to become non-retrogressing from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening,

and then some son or daughter of good family were to write out this Perfection of Wisdom in a volume, present it, entrust it, and teach it nearby with its meaning and its letters — Kauśika, what do you think? Would that son or daughter of good family generate much merit from that basis? Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods) replied: Blessed One, very much indeed. Sugata, very much indeed. Blessed One, it would not be easy to count that mass of merit. Blessed One, that mass of merit could not easily be counted, illustrated by example, shown by analogy, or made the basis of a calculation.

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, a son or daughter of good family generates even more merit than that — one who writes out this Perfection of Wisdom in a volume, presents it, entrusts it, and teaches it nearby with its meaning and its letters to those non-retrogressing bodhisattvas, great beings, who wish to swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and who recites and expounds this Perfection of Wisdom. And then, Kauśika, suppose another bodhisattva, a great being, should arise and say: "I will fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening even more swiftly than these." Kauśika, whatever son or daughter of good family recites and expounds this Perfection of Wisdom to that bodhisattva, that great being of very swift higher knowledge — that person generates even more merit than the former son or daughter of good family.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, however closely a bodhisattva, a great being, has drawn near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, to just that degree one should instruct and teach them in the Perfection of Wisdom. For by instructing and teaching in the Perfection of Wisdom in just that way, they will draw close to suchness. And when they have drawn close to suchness, those who have fully made use of their robes, alms food, bedding, seats, medicines for curing illness, and requisites — the acts performed for them will yield great fruit and great reward. That is why one generates exceedingly much merit. And why is that? Blessed One, it is because this is just what it means for a bodhisattva, a great being, to draw near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Then the venerable Subhūti said to Śakra, lord of the gods: Kauśika, it is excellent, truly excellent, that you inspire, fully embrace, and follow close upon those persons who belong to the bodhisattva vehicle. Kauśika, this is indeed your task: that any noble śrāvaka who wishes to fully embrace all sentient beings should inspire, fully embrace, and follow close upon the bodhisattvas, those great beings, in their enthusiasm for unsurpassed, perfect,

complete awakening — that is what such a one should do. And why is that?

It is from this very source that unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening arises for the bodhisattvas, those great beings. For if those bodhisattvas, those great beings, were to leave this awakening mind unraised, they would not train in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, nor would they train in the six perfections; and without training, they would not fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. It is because bodhisattvas, those great beings, train in these very trainings of a bodhisattva — the six perfections — that they raise the mind set on awakening, and it is for this reason that they fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

This concludes the fifth chapter, entitled "The Enumeration of Merit," from the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines.

Then the bodhisattva, that great being, Maitreya spoke thus to the elder, the venerable Subhūti: Noble Subhūti, furthermore, among all the bases of merit — those accompanied by rejoicing in the bodhisattvas, those great beings, together with the dedication of that rejoicing — and among all the bases of merit arising from the generosity of all sentient beings, and the bases of merit arising from moral discipline, and the bases of merit arising from meditation — of all these, this very basis of merit accompanied by rejoicing in the bodhisattvas, those great beings, together with its dedication, is to be called supreme, excellent, foremost, finest, best of all, distinguished, highest, unsurpassed, unexcelled, incomparable, and equal to the incomparable.

When he had spoken these words, the elder, the venerable Subhūti, said this to the bodhisattva, that great being, Maitreya: Maitreya, consider the bodhisattva, that great being, who rejoices and dedicates in this way. In the world-systems of the great trichiliocosm pervading all ten directions — those that are immeasurably immeasurable, incalculably incalculable, immeasurably vast, inconceivably inconceivable, boundlessly infinite — in each and every one of those great trichiliocosmic world-systems, in the time that has passed, there existed Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas who were immeasurably immeasurable, incalculably incalculable, immeasurably vast, inconceivably inconceivable, and boundlessly infinite in number: those whose path was cut off and whose entering upon it was cut off; whose conceptual elaboration and their drawing onward into existence were cut off; whose tears were dried and whose thorns were broken; who had utterly cast down the

heavy burden; who had achieved their own goal; whose binding to existence was wholly exhausted; who, through perfect and complete knowledge, were utterly liberated in mind; who had gone to the far shore of the supreme mastery over all minds; who had passed into final nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of aggregates. From the very first moment those Tathāgatas raised the awakening mind, all the way up through their fully and perfectly awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, through their passing into final nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of aggregates, and up to the point where the sacred Dharma had not yet declined —

during that entire interval — the aggregate of moral discipline, the aggregate of meditative absorption, the aggregate of wisdom, the aggregate of liberation, and the aggregate of the wisdom that sees liberation belonging to those blessed buddhas, the Tathāgatas; the roots of virtue endowed with the six perfections; the roots of virtue endowed with the magnificent qualities of buddhahood; the roots of virtue endowed with the perfection of the powers and fearlessnesses; likewise the roots of virtue endowed with the perfection of direct knowledge and the perfection of thorough knowledge; the roots of virtue endowed with the perfection of aspiration; the roots of virtue endowed with the magnificent gnosis of omniscience; whatever was their intention to benefit beings; whatever was their great loving-kindness; whatever was their great compassion; whatever were the immeasurable, countless, magnificent qualities of buddhahood; whatever was unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening; whatever was the bliss of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening; whatever was the perfection of sovereignty over all phenomena; whatever was the supreme magical display of inexhaustibly subjugating what is immeasurable and subduing all things; whatever was the power of the Tathāgata's genuine, exact gnosis — unobscured, unattached, unobstructed, without equal, equal to the unequal, incomparable, immeasurable; whatever was the power of the buddha's gnosis among all powers; whatever was the buddha's gnosis and vision; whatever was the perfection of the ten powers; whatever was the realization of the supreme and perfect fulfillment of the four fearlessnesses; whatever was the knowledge of Dharma arising from the ultimate establishment of all phenomena; whatever was the supreme turning of the wheel of Dharma; the holding aloft of the lamp of Dharma, the beating of the drum of Dharma, the blowing of the conch of Dharma, the sounding of the conch of Dharma, the wielding of the sword of Dharma, the raining down of

the rain of Dharma, the offering of the burnt offering of Dharma, and the thoroughly satisfying and nourishing of all sentient beings through the gift of Dharma —

and whatever roots of virtue belong to all those who, through such teaching of Dharma, were tamed, trained, inspired, made certain, and turned toward perfect awakening, whether through the Dharma of buddhas, or the Dharma of solitary buddhas, or the Dharma of hearers; and whatever roots of virtue belong to those bodhisattvas, great bodhisattvas, whom those blessed buddhas, the Tathāgatas, prophesied to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, endowed as they were with the six perfections; and whatever roots of virtue belong to all those persons of the pratyekabuddha vehicle whom they prophesied to the awakening of a solitary buddha; and whatever is the merit-producing basis arising from generosity, the merit-producing basis arising from moral discipline, and the merit-producing basis arising from meditation, belonging to persons of the śrāvaka vehicle; and whatever are the roots of virtue that are undefiled and belong to those in training; and whatever are the roots of virtue that are undefiled and belong to those beyond training; and whatever roots of virtue were generated in relation to those teachings by ordinary persons —

the four-fold retinue of those Blessed One buddhas — the monks, the nuns, the laymen, and the laywomen — and whatever are the merit-producing bases arising from their generosity, the merit-producing bases arising from their moral discipline, and the merit-producing bases arising from meditation; and whatever roots of virtue were generated in relation to those Blessed One buddhas teaching the Dharma by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great serpents, humans, non-humans, and whatever sentient beings have gone to birth in the animal realm; and whatever roots of virtue were generated by those who generated virtue in relation to those Blessed One buddhas as they passed into final nirvāṇa; and whatever roots of virtue were generated in relation to those Blessed One buddhas after they had passed into final nirvāṇa; and whatever roots of virtue were generated in dependence upon the buddhas, in dependence upon the Dharma, in dependence upon the Saṅgha, and in dependence upon persons who cultivated these mentally —

all of those roots of virtue, without exception and without remainder, are gathered together into one, summed up, and measured, and then one rejoices in them with the supreme rejoicing, rejoicing in them as excellent, foremost,

superior, supremely superior, distinguished, highest, without superior, without anything above, without equal, and incomparable — and having so rejoiced, having come to possess that rejoicing, one then declares aloud, "I dedicate all of these merit-producing bases to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening," with the thought, "May I accomplish unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Now in that regard: when persons of the bodhisattva vehicle dedicate and generate the awakening mind with certain things, certain referential objects, and certain aspects, do they apprehend those very things, those referential objects, and those aspects just as they have been taken as signs?

When this was said, the bodhisattva, the great being Maitreya spoke to the elder, the venerable Subhūti, as follows: "Venerable Subhūti, they do not apprehend those things, those referential objects, and those aspects just as they have been taken as signs."

When this was said, the elder, the venerable Subhūti spoke to the bodhisattva, the great being Maitreya as follows: "If one apprehends and takes as a sign what has no thing and no referential object, how would this not become a distorted perception, a distorted mind, and a distorted view? And why? It is because attachment, though without a thing, thinks of the impermanent as permanent, of what is suffering as bliss, of the selfless as self, and of the unattractive as attractive — constructing and elaborating in that way — and from this arise distorted perception, distorted mind, and distorted view. Moreover, just as the things are, just as the referential objects are, just as the aspects are, so too is awakening, and so too is the mind — and if that is so, then all phenomena and all elements are likewise so. But if just as the things are, just as the referential objects are, just as the aspects are, awakening is likewise so, and the mind is likewise so — then with what things, what referential objects, and what aspects does a mind dedicate to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?"

— what meritorious deed accompanied by rejoicing does one dedicate to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya said this to the Elder, the Venerable Subhūti: "Noble Subhūti, this teaching should not be expounded or demonstrated before a bodhisattva, a great being, who has newly entered the vehicle. Why is that? All those in whom there is only faith, only joy, only devotion, only reverence toward it will be ruined. Noble Subhūti, this should be

expounded and closely taught before a non-regressing bodhisattva, a great being. A bodhisattva, a great being, who has been made firm by a virtuous spiritual friend — such a one will not retreat before this, will not be discouraged in any way, will not be embarrassed, will not be ashamed, will not turn their mind away from it, will not be broken and turn away, will not be terrified, will not be frightened in any way, will not come to be filled with any kind of fear. In this way, having rejoiced, the bodhisattva, the great being, should dedicate all meritorious deeds accompanied by rejoicing to omniscience itself."

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The seventh fascicle.

Then the Elder, the Venerable Subhūti, said this to the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya: "Maitreya, the very mind with which one rejoices and with which one dedicates — that mind has become exhausted and ceased, separated and transformed. Therefore, what is the mind with which one dedicates to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening? And what is the mind that is the meritorious deed accompanied by rejoicing that one dedicates to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening? And when the two minds do not meet, and that mind is by its very nature incapable of dedicating — how then could mind be capable of dedicating mind?"

Then Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), said this to the Elder, the Venerable Subhūti: "Noble Subhūti, if those bodhisattvas, those great beings, who have newly entered the vehicle were to hear this teaching and become terrified, frightened in every way, and filled with fear — that would not be right. Noble Subhūti, how then should a bodhisattva, a great being, dedicate that meritorious deed accompanied by rejoicing to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening? And how, through holding fast to the meritorious deed accompanied by rejoicing and through dedicating the mind accompanied by rejoicing, does the mind accompanied by rejoicing come to be well held and well dedicated?"

Then the Elder, the Venerable Subhūti, addressed the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya, taking the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya as his basis, and spoke to the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya:

"Maitreya, in this regard a bodhisattva, a great being, should consider the following. In the ten directions of the world there are immeasurable and innumerable great trichiliocosms — world-systems of a thousand times a thousand times a thousand worlds. In each and every one of those directions,

in each and every one of those great trichiliocosmic world-systems, there have been past buddhas, Blessed Ones — whose path is cut off, who have entered in, whose arising has ceased, who have gone beyond proliferation, who no longer lead beings into existence, whose tears are exhausted, whose thorns are broken, whose burden is thoroughly cast down, who have attained their own goal, whose binding to existence is entirely exhausted, who know all things rightly, whose minds are utterly and completely liberated, who have gone entirely beyond the dominion of all minds — immeasurable and innumerable buddhas, Blessed Ones, who have completely passed into nirvāṇa.

From the moment those buddhas, Blessed Ones, first aroused the mind of awakening, up until they manifestly and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and up until they completely passed into nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates, and up until the holy Dharma had not yet declined — throughout all of that span:

whatever wholesome roots accompanied by the perfections belong to those buddhas, Blessed Ones; whatever they accumulated of merit and whatever they accumulated of wholesome roots; whatever were their aggregates of moral discipline, of meditative absorption, of wisdom, of liberation, and of the gnosis and vision of liberation; whatever was their aspiration to benefit beings, whatever was their great loving-kindness, whatever was their great compassion, whatever were their immeasurable and innumerable buddha-qualities; whatever Dharma was taught by those buddhas, Blessed Ones, and whatever wholesome roots were produced by those who trained in, were devoted to, and abided in that Dharma; whatever wholesome roots accompanied by the six perfections belong to those bodhisattvas, those great beings, who were prophesied by those buddhas, Blessed Ones, to attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening; whatever wholesome roots belong to those individuals of the pratyekabuddha vehicle who were prophesied to attain their own awakening; whatever wholesome roots belong to those individuals of the śrāvaka vehicle arising from generosity, arising from moral discipline, arising from cultivation, whatever are the undefiled wholesome roots of those in training and whatever are the undefiled wholesome roots of those beyond training; whatever wholesome roots were generated in that Dharma by ordinary people; whatever wholesome roots were generated, upon hearing that Dharma, by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas,

kiṃnaras, great serpents, humans, and non-humans; whatever wholesome roots were generated, upon hearing that Dharma, by sentient beings born in the animal realm; and whatever wholesome roots were generated by sentient beings toward those buddhas, Blessed Ones, as they were passing into nirvāṇa and after they had passed into nirvāṇa —

all of those wholesome roots, every single one, gathered together, summed up, measured, and made complete without remainder: one rejoices in all of that without remainder that is to be rejoiced in, and having rejoiced, if one dedicates that meritorious deed accompanied by rejoicing to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, how then does the bodhisattva, that great being who dedicates it, not fall into wrong perception, not fall into wrong mind, not fall into wrong view?"

When he had spoken these words —

The bodhisattva, that great being, Maitreya, spoke these words to the elder, the venerable Subhūti:

"Noble Subhūti, if the bodhisattva, that great being, does not come to perceive as mind the very mind by which he dedicates — if he does not take that mind to be mind — then in that way the bodhisattva, that great being, will have dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening the meritorious deed accompanied by rejoicing. For just as that mind does not rightly know that this mind is such-and-such, so in that way the bodhisattva, that great being's perception will not fall into wrong perception, his mind will not fall into wrong mind, and his view will not fall into wrong view.

But if he rightly knows and comes to perceive that the very mind by which he dedicates is this — that this mind is such-and-such — then in that way the bodhisattva, that great being's perception will fall into wrong perception, his mind will fall into wrong mind, and his view will fall into wrong view.

If, however, the bodhisattva, that great being, rightly knows and reflects on the mind by which he dedicates in the following way — knowing: 'When one attends to that mind, what has ceased has ceased, and it is thus known as ceased; it is free from arising, and it is transformed' — and knowing it in that way, he cannot dedicate what has ceased; and the nature of reality of the mind by which one dedicates is that very thing; the nature of reality of the phenomena by which one dedicates is that very thing; and the nature of reality of the phenomena to which one dedicates is also that very thing — if one dedicates in that way, then it is a true dedication and not a wrong

dedication. That is how the bodhisattva, that great being, should dedicate.

Furthermore, noble Subhūti, the bodhisattva, that great being, just as with the past, so also with the future — those Blessed One buddhas whose stream of teaching has been cut off, whose entry into teaching has been cut off, whose conceptual elaboration has been cut off, and whose leading into continued existence has been cut off, immeasurable and innumerable — from the time those buddhas first aroused the awakening mind, up through the point at which they fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and up through the point at which they utterly pass into nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of aggregates, and up through the point at which the true Dharma has not yet declined — all the wholesome roots of those Blessed One buddhas throughout that span that are accompanied by the perfections, and the aggregates of moral discipline, the aggregates of meditative absorption, the aggregates of wisdom, the aggregates of liberation, and the aggregates of the gnosis of the vision of liberation of those Blessed One buddhas, and whatever constitutes their aspiration to benefit, and whatever constitutes their great loving-kindness, and whatever constitutes their great compassion, and whatever constitutes the immeasurable and innumerable excellent qualities of those buddhas, and the Dharma that those Blessed One buddhas will teach, and those who will train in that Dharma, and those who will hold it with deep aspiration, and those who will abide in it — whatever constitutes the wholesome roots of all of these — and whatever constitutes the wholesome roots of those bodhisattvas endowed with the six perfections whom those Blessed One buddhas will prophesy to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — and whatever constitutes the wholesome roots of those individuals of the pratyekabuddha vehicle to whom those Blessed One buddhas will prophesy awakening as pratyekabuddhas —"

— and whatever constitutes the merit-producing basis that arises from generosity, and whatever constitutes the merit-producing basis that arises from moral discipline, and whatever constitutes the merit-producing basis that arises from meditation, on the part of those individuals belonging to the śrāvaka vehicle — and whatever constitutes the wholesome roots of the undefiled virtue belonging to those in training, and whatever constitutes the wholesome roots of the undefiled virtue belonging to those beyond training — and whatever wholesome roots ordinary persons will plant through that Dharma — and whatever gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas,

kiṃnaras, great serpents, humans, and non-humans will hear that Dharma and, having heard it, will plant wholesome roots — and whatever sentient beings reborn in the animal realm will hear that Dharma and, having heard it, will plant wholesome roots — and whatever wholesome roots sentient beings will plant in relation to the blessed one buddhas as they pass completely into nirvāṇa, and in relation to those who have completely passed into nirvāṇa —

all of these wholesome roots, every single one, are gathered together, summed up, measured, and made complete and without remainder; and then, rejoicing in all that is to be rejoiced in, without leaving anything out, having rejoiced — how is it that the bodhisattva, the great being, who dedicates to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening that merit-producing basis endowed with such rejoicing, does not fall into distorted perception, distorted mind, or distorted view?

If the bodhisattva, the great being, does not perceive as mind the very mind by which something is being dedicated, then in that way the bodhisattva, the great being, has genuinely dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening that merit-producing basis endowed with rejoicing. Because just as mind does not truly know that mind to be "this is that mind," in that very way the bodhisattva, the great being, does not fall into distorted perception, distorted mind, or distorted view.

However, if the bodhisattva, the great being, were to know and perceive as mind the very mind by which something is being dedicated, taking it to be "this is that mind," then in that case the bodhisattva, the great being, would fall into distorted perception, distorted mind, and distorted view.

If the bodhisattva, the great being, knows and thinks about the mind by which something is dedicated in this way — that when one thinks about that mind, one truly knows it as "exhausted in exhaustion," and understands it as having ceased, as freed from arising, as having undergone transformation — and if that which is exhausted also cannot itself be dedicated, and the nature of reality of the very mind by which one dedicates is also just that, and the nature of reality of the dharmas by means of which one dedicates is also just that, and the nature of reality of the dharmas to which one dedicates is also just that — if dedication proceeds in that way, it is genuine dedication and not false dedication. That is how the bodhisattva, the great being, should dedicate.

Moreover, noble Subhūti, the bodhisattva, the great being, should take up — from the first arousing of the mind right up through the manifest, perfect,

complete awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — those immeasurable and innumerable blessed one buddhas who are presently living, dwelling, and abiding throughout immeasurable and innumerable world-systems of great trichiliocosms, those whose stream of teaching has not been cut off, whose practice is uninterrupted, whose conceptual elaboration has been cut off, and whose leading into existence has been cut off —

until they pass into the nirvāṇa (Skt. nirvāṇa) that is the expanse free of any remainder of aggregates, and until the sublime Dharma has not yet declined — the wholesome roots accompanied by the perfections of those blessed one buddhas throughout that entire interval; the aggregates of moral discipline, the aggregates of meditative absorption, the aggregates of wisdom, the aggregates of liberation, and the aggregates of the wisdom-vision of liberation of those blessed one buddhas; whatever constitutes their intention to benefit beings; whatever constitutes their great loving-kindness and their great compassion; whatever constitutes the immeasurable and innumerable qualities of buddhahood; the wholesome roots of those who have trained in, are specially devoted to, and abide in the Dharma that those blessed one buddhas have taught; the wholesome roots accompanied by the six perfections of those bodhisattvas, those great beings, whom those blessed one buddhas have prophesied to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening; the wholesome roots of those individuals of the pratyekabuddha vehicle whom those blessed one buddhas have prophesied to the awakening of a pratyekabuddha; the bases of meritorious action arising from generosity, the bases of meritorious action arising from moral discipline, and the bases of meritorious action arising from cultivation of those individuals who belong to the śrāvaka vehicle; whatever constitutes the undefiled wholesome roots of those in training; whatever constitutes the undefiled wholesome roots of those beyond training; whatever wholesome roots ordinary persons have generated through that Dharma; whatever wholesome roots gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (Skt. gandharva), asuras, garuḍas (Skt. garuḍa), kinnaras (Skt. kinnara), mahoragas (Skt. mahoraga), humans, and non-humans have generated upon hearing that Dharma and, having heard it, acting accordingly; whatever wholesome roots sentient beings who have taken birth in the animal realm have generated upon hearing that Dharma and, having heard it, acting accordingly; and whatever wholesome roots have been generated in relation to those blessed one buddhas as they pass into final nirvāṇa and after they have passed into final nirvāṇa —

all of those wholesome roots, without exception, gathered together, combined, measured, and reckoned in their entirety, one should rejoice in all of them, leaving none out. Then, having thus rejoiced, that bodhisattva, that great being, who dedicates to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening that basis of meritorious action accompanied by rejoicing — how is it that their perception does not become inverted, their mind does not become inverted, and their view does not become inverted?

If the bodhisattva, the great being, does not come to regard that very mind by which they dedicate as being a mind, then in that way the bodhisattva, the great being, dedicates that basis of meritorious action accompanied by rejoicing to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Just as that mind does not truly know of itself "this mind is such-and-such," in that same way the bodhisattva, the great being, does not fall into inverted perception, does not fall into inverted mind, and does not fall into inverted view.

But if the bodhisattva, the great being, were to truly know and perceive that very mind by which they dedicate as being "this is a mind" — if they were to recognize it as a mind — then in that way the bodhisattva, the great being, would fall into inverted perception, inverted mind, and inverted view.

On the other hand, if the bodhisattva, the great being, knows and thinks in this way: when attending to that very mind by which one dedicates, one truly knows "what is exhausted is exhausted," and one knows it to be ceased, separated from arising, and transformed — then that which has been exhausted cannot be dedicated at all. The nature of reality of the very mind by which one dedicates is just that. The nature of reality of the phenomena by which one dedicates is also just that. The nature of reality of the phenomena to which one dedicates is also just that. If one dedicates in that way, it is a correct dedication and not a wrong dedication. That is how the bodhisattva, the great being, should dedicate.

Noble Subhūti, furthermore, the bodhisattva, the great being, beginning from the first arousal of the awakening mind by all buddhas, Blessed Ones of the past, future, and present — those who are immeasurable and innumerable, whose path is unbroken, whose entry is unbroken, whose conceptual elaboration is cut off, who have cut off what leads to continued existence — up to their unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, their complete and perfect awakening, and the interval of their complete and perfect awakening; and their complete and perfect passage into nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa

without remainder of aggregates, the interval of their complete and perfect passage into nirvāṇa; and the sacred Dharma not declining, not coming to decline, and the interval before it has declined — the wholesome roots that are the perfections of those buddhas, Blessed Ones throughout that entire span; and the heaps of moral discipline, heaps of meditative absorption, heaps of wisdom, heaps of liberation, and heaps of the gnosis of the vision of liberation belonging to those buddhas, Blessed Ones; and whatever is their intention to benefit, whatever is their great loving-kindness, whatever is their great compassion, and whatever are the immeasurable and innumerable qualities of those buddhas; and whatever Dharma those buddhas, Blessed Ones have taught, will teach, and are teaching, and whoever has trained, will train, and is training in that Dharma, whoever has aspired to it, will aspire to it, and is aspiring to it, whoever has abided in it, will abide in it, and is abiding in it — all their wholesome roots; and whatever are the wholesome roots belonging to all those bodhisattvas, great beings, whom those buddhas, Blessed Ones have prophesied, will prophesy, and are prophesying to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening; and whatever are the wholesome roots belonging to all those individuals of the pratyekabuddha vehicle whom those buddhas, Blessed Ones have prophesied, will prophesy, and are prophesying to their own awakening; and whatever are the wholesome roots arising from generosity, arising from moral discipline, and arising from cultivation belonging to individuals of the śrāvaka vehicle, along with whatever are their wholesome roots that are the undefiled roots of those still in training, and whatever are the undefiled wholesome roots of those beyond training;

and whatever wholesome roots have been, will be, and are being cultivated in these teachings by ordinary beings; and whatever gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-humans have heard, will hear, and are hearing these teachings, and having heard them have generated, will generate, and are generating wholesome roots; and whatever sentient beings born in the realms of animals have heard, will hear, and are hearing this noble Dharma, and having heard it have cultivated, will cultivate, and are cultivating wholesome roots; and whatever wholesome roots have been, will be, and are being cultivated by sentient beings in relation to those buddhas, Blessed Ones who have passed, will pass, and are passing into complete nirvāṇa — all those wholesome roots of all of these, gathered and summed together, measured and made complete without remainder, are to be rejoiced in without exception. With the supreme

rejoicing, with that highest and most excellent rejoicing, one rejoices in them as the most excellent, the chief, the supreme, the highest, the sublime, the great, the unsurpassed, the without-superior, the peerless, the incomparable, the equal of the equal. Having so rejoiced and possessing the merit arising from that rejoicing, one then dedicates the unsurpassed meritorious basis to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, thinking: "May this serve to perfectly accomplish unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Now when one dedicates in this way by expressing it in words, thinking, "I dedicate so that these phenomena, being exhausted, ceased, departed, and transformed, will be dedicated to a place where they will not be exhausted," how is it that a bodhisattva, a great being, does not fall into perversion of perception, does not fall into perversion of mind, does not fall into perversion of view?

If the one who is dedicating thinks: "These phenomena are exhausted, ceased, departed, and transformed; therefore I shall dedicate to that into which they will not become exhausted" — thinking in that way, one has dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

And if again one reflects, thinking: "It is not that a phenomenon is dedicated by a phenomenon" — thinking in that way as well, one has dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Venerable Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being who dedicates in this manner does not fall into perversion of perception, does not fall into perversion of mind, does not fall into perversion of view. And why? Because that one has no clinging in relation to that dedication.

Furthermore, if one correctly understands, thinking: "Mind does not know mind, and a phenomenon does not know a phenomenon" — thinking in that way as well, one has dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. This is the unsurpassed dedication of a bodhisattva, a great being.

However, if a bodhisattva, a great being, apprehends the formation of merit, then that is not a dedication to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And why? Because that one has clinging in relation to that dedication.

But if one thinks: "That very formation of merit is empty and peaceful, and the meritorious basis that is endowed with rejoicing is likewise empty and peaceful" — thinking in that way, one has dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

But if one does not even know in this way — thinking "all formations are empty and peaceful" — then this too is the Perfection of Wisdom of that bodhisattva, that great being.

Whatever roots of virtue were dedicated by those blessed buddhas (bhagavat) who have passed completely into nirvāṇa, whatever that dedication was like, this root of virtue is exactly like that. And whoever has dedicated it in this way is one who belongs to that class, who has that characteristic mark, who is included in that category, who has that intrinsic nature. If one knows it in this way, then it has not been dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And why? Because the blessed buddhas do not make their dedication in the manner of apprehending signs. The past is spent, ceased, departed, and transformed. The future has not yet been reached. In what has arisen in the present, no abiding is perceived. And what is not perceived is not a sign and is not an object. If one makes it a sign and thinks of it in that way, then it has not been dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

If, freed from mindfulness, one does not make it a sign and does not think of it — or if, freed from mindfulness or lacking comprehension, one does not take it to mind — then in that case too it has not been dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. But if one takes that sign to mind while not apprehending it as a sign, then in that way the bodhisattva, the great being, has dedicated that root of virtue to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

This is how a bodhisattva, a great being, should train in this. This should be understood as the skillful means (upāya) of that bodhisattva, that great being. This dedication of roots of virtue through these skillful means is close to omniscience.

A bodhisattva, a great being, who wishes to train in these skillful means should, without interruption, listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, hold it, retain it, read it, master it thoroughly, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it, transmit it as scripture, chant it, and inquire into it completely. And why? Because one who has not heard the Perfection of Wisdom, relying upon it, cannot enter into this activity of dedicating through the Perfection of Wisdom.

If someone were to say: "Even without relying on the Perfection of Wisdom, one is able to dedicate that meritorious basis to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening" — one should tell that person not to speak in such a way. And why? Because those very things, those material entities, have

ceased, and those very formations have also ceased — they are peaceful, empty, and free from any object of apprehension. And yet that person, having apprehended and examined what is genuine reality as a sign, perceives what is not genuinely reality as if it were genuinely reality — and thus dedicates, apprehending what is without object as though it had an object. Such a dedication of that root of virtue to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening is not something the blessed buddhas would sanction. And why? Because whatever constitutes the apprehending of signs, conceptual proliferation, and focused objectification with regard to the complete nirvāṇa of the blessed buddhas — that itself is the great object of apprehension for that one.

The Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas do not declare that a dedication accompanied by the perception of an object accomplishes great purpose. And why? Because such a dedication is poisonous and painful — like a fine food that is poisoned. Just as such food, though attractive in its colour, fragrance, taste, and texture, ought to be cast aside, yet because it is poisonous the wise must utterly abandon it and must not consume it. But one who by nature is childish and by nature deficient in wisdom thinks to enjoy it, and when he eats that food, through its colour, fragrance, taste, and texture it gives him pleasure in the tasting — yet when it dissolves inside him, its karmic maturation becomes one of suffering, and he suffers from that very basis unto death, or to a degree of suffering that is like death.

Noble Subhūti, in just the same way there are those here who, having grasped wrongly, cognized wrongly, and recited wrongly, neither know the meaning of what has been well spoken nor have rightly understood the genuine meaning as it truly is. These people say the following: "Come here, son of good family! Gather together in one sum all the roots of virtue of all those blessed buddhas of the past, future, and present who dwell in immeasurable, incalculable world-realms of all worlds — from the first arousing of their awakening mind right up through their manifesting complete and perfect awakening in unsurpassed, perfect, complete enlightenment, and onward through their passing fully into nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa that leaves no remainder of aggregates, and through the interval of their passing; all of this during whatever period the noble Dharma has not yet declined, is not yet declining, and has not declined — the roots of virtue of the blessed buddhas of the past, future, and present during that interval, together with those of their śrāvakas: their aggregate of moral discipline, their aggregate of meditative absorption,

their aggregate of wisdom, their aggregate of liberation, and their aggregate of the gnosis that sees liberation; together with the roots of virtue created and to be created by those bodhisattvas, great bodhisattvas, who have been prophesied by those blessed buddhas to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, or who will be so prophesied, and together with whatever roots of virtue those who have been prophesied have established and will establish; together with the roots of virtue created and to be created by those individuals of the pratyekabuddha vehicle who have been prophesied, or who will be prophesied, to their own solitary awakening, and whatever roots of virtue those who have been prophesied have established and will establish; together with the roots of virtue created and to be created by those individuals of the śrāvaka vehicle who have been prophesied, or who will be prophesied, to the awakening of a hearer, and whatever roots of virtue those who have been prophesied have established and will establish; together with whatever roots of virtue ordinary beings have established, will establish, and are establishing there — gather all these roots of virtue together into one, sum them up, assess them in their entirety, leaving nothing out, and then, leaving nothing out, rejoice in all of them; and having so rejoiced, dedicate that meritorious act of supreme worthiness to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening." In this way they proclaim and teach this. Yet a dedication of that sort, being a dedication performed in the mode of signs, becomes poison — like that poisoned food. Therefore there is no dedication for one who holds the perception of an object. And why?

Object-fixation is poison. Therefore no person who is a follower of the bodhisattva vehicle should train in that way.

Then how should one train, and how should one take up the roots of virtue of all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future, and the present? And how, having taken them up, does one take them up well? And how should one dedicate them, and how, having dedicated them, does one dedicate them well to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?

On this point, a son of good family or daughter of good family who follows the bodhisattva vehicle and wishes to do no harm to the Tathāgatas should rejoice in all those roots of virtue in the following way and dedicate them in the following way. Whatever that root of virtue may be, one should rejoice in it just as the Tathāgatas — the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — know and see it with the wisdom of a buddha and the eye of a buddha; rejoicing in it just as it is with respect to what class it belongs to, what

category it falls under, what kind it is, what its intrinsic nature is, what its defining characteristic is, and what its dharmic nature consists in. And with the thought, "Just as those Tathāgatas — the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — approved of the dedication of that root of virtue to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, so too do I rejoice," one should rejoice and dedicate accordingly.

A bodhisattva, a great being, who rejoices and dedicates in this way does no harm to the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the rejoicing is genuine rejoicing, and that root of virtue is well and thoroughly dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening; and that person does no harm to the Tathāgatas — the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. Such a dedication, performed through aspiration and with elevated intention, is a dedication that is free of poison, a great dedication, a dedication within the dharmadhātu — complete and supremely complete.

Furthermore, a son of good family or daughter of good family who follows the bodhisattva vehicle should dedicate in the following way: whatever moral discipline there may be, whatever meditative absorption, whatever wisdom, whatever liberation, whatever the wisdom-vision of liberation — which does not belong to the desire realm, does not belong to the form realm, does not belong to the formless realm, and is neither past, nor future, nor present — one should dedicate in precisely that way.

Why? Because it does not belong to the three times or the three realms, and therefore the dedication likewise does not belong to them. Whatever dharma one dedicates to, that dharma to which the dedication is made also does not belong to them.

If one aspires in this way and dedicates in this way, the dedication of that bodhisattva, that great being who so dedicates, is inexhaustible — it is a dedication that does not belong to any of those, a dedication free of poison, a great dedication, a dedication within the dharmadhātu, complete and well complete.

But if one clings to and reifies that very dedication as a sign, then it becomes a mistaken dedication.

Now, regarding this dedication: the root of virtue that a bodhisattva, a great being, dedicates — dedicating it within the dharmadhātu just as the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, know it and just as they have approved it — thinking, "In this way I have well and truly dedicated it to unsurpassed, perfect, complete

awakening," that is indeed a well-performed dedication. And thinking, "In this way I dedicate," that is a true and genuine dedication. Such a dedication is a dedication well made toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the venerable Subhūti, saying: "Excellent! Subhūti, you are performing the work of a teacher. Subhūti, it is excellent, truly excellent, that you teach the Dharma to bodhisattvas, to great beings. And why is that? Because this dedication is the dedication within the dharmadhātu of bodhisattvas, of great beings. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, know and behold this very nature of reality — the root of virtue, of whatever kind, whatever category it belongs to, whatever its character, whatever its intrinsic nature, whatever its defining mark, whatever the nature of reality by which it exists — and they rejoice accordingly. Thinking, 'Just as they have approved it, so do I dedicate' — the mass of merit arising from such a thought, from such a dedication: even compared to the mass of merit that some son or daughter of good family might accumulate by establishing all the sentient beings — as many as there are in world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges river multiplied by the great trichiliocosm — by properly placing and maintaining them on the path of the ten virtuous actions, the mass of merit born from this dedication within the dharmadhātu of a bodhisattva, a great being, is supreme, is excellent, is foremost, is the best, is the most excellent, is the magnificent, is the highest, is unsurpassed, is without anything above it, is without equal, is equal to the unequal.

Subhūti, to set aside even the merit that accumulates from establishing all those sentient beings — as many as there are in world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm — on the path of the ten virtuous actions: even the mass of merit arising from causing all those beings to attain the four meditative concentrations (dhyānas) is surpassed by this mass of merit accompanying the dedication of a bodhisattva, a great being. That mass of merit is supreme, is excellent, is foremost, is the best, is the most excellent, is the magnificent, is the highest, is unsurpassed, is without anything above it, is without equal, is equal to the unequal.

Subhūti, to set aside even the merit of accumulating the merit of all those sentient beings — as many as there are in those world-systems — having perfected the four meditative concentrations: even the mass of merit arising from causing all those sentient beings in world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm to attain the

four immeasurables —

Subhūti, to set aside even the merit of accumulating the merit of all those sentient beings — as many as there are in those world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm — having attained the four formless absorptions (Skt. ārūpyasamāpatti): even the mass of merit arising from causing all those sentient beings in world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm to attain the four formless absorptions —

Subhūti, to set aside even that: even the mass of merit arising from causing all those sentient beings — as many as there are in those world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm — to attain the five higher knowledges (Skt. abhijñā) —

Subhūti, to set aside even that: even the mass of merit arising from causing all those sentient beings — as many as there are in those world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm — to become stream-enterers (Skt. srotāpanna) —

Subhūti, to set aside even that: even the mass of merit arising from causing all those sentient beings — as many as there are in those world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm — to become once-returners (Skt. sakṛdāgāmin) —

Subhūti, to set aside even that: even the mass of merit arising from causing all those sentient beings — as many as there are in those world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm — to become non-returners (Skt. anāgāmin) —

Subhūti, to set aside even that: even the mass of merit arising from causing all those sentient beings — as many as there are in those world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm — to become arhats —

Subhūti, to set aside even that: even the mass of merit arising from causing all those sentient beings — as many as there are in those world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm — to become pratyekabuddhas —

Subhūti, to set aside even that: suppose all those sentient beings — as many as there are in those world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm — were to enter into unsurpassed

perfect and complete awakening, and all of them were then to cause every sentient being in yet other world-systems, each as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm, to receive from each individual bodhisattva robes, alms-food,

bedding, medicine for the sick, requisites, and every comfort and convenience — serving them for a number of kalpas equal to the grains of sand in the Ganges — and that this giving were done with a perception of an object of reference; and if, considering it in that way, every one of those sentient beings were in turn served by each and every one of those bodhisattvas for a number of kalpas equal to the grains of sand in the Ganges with robes, alms-food, bedding, medicine for the sick, requisites, and every comfort and convenience — honoring them, revering them, esteeming them, making offerings to them, painting their images, and paying them homage — and if likewise each and every one of those bodhisattvas were to give in this manner, and were to give to all in this manner — Subhūti, what do you think? Would those bodhisattvas thereby generate a great quantity of merit?"

Subhūti replied: "A great quantity, Blessed One! A great quantity, Sugata! It is beyond measure, Blessed One! It is beyond measure, Sugata! Blessed One, that mass of merit is not easy even to count. Blessed One, that mass of merit is not easy to enumerate, to illustrate by example, to demonstrate by analogy, to take as a basis, or to take as a cause. Blessed One, if that mass of merit were to have material form, it would not fit within world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges multiplied by the great trichiliocosm."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the elder, the venerable Subhūti: "Just so, Subhūti, just so. Subhūti, the reason why a person of the bodhisattva vehicle who dedicates roots of virtue to unsurpassed perfect and complete awakening — grasping them fully through the Perfection of Wisdom and through skillful means, and dedicating them through this dedication within the dharmadhātu — thereby generates great merit is this: Subhūti, the mass of merit born from dedication within the dharmadhātu does not come within even a hundredth part of the merit fabricated through the giving of those earlier bodhisattvas and great beings who possess a perception of an object of reference; it does not come within a thousandth part, a hundred-thousandth part, a ten-millionth part, a hundred-millionth part, a billionth part, a hundred-billionth part, a ten-trillionth part, nor a hundred-trillionth part. It does not come within any countable fraction, nor can it be reached by enumeration, by example, by illustration through analogy, by

being taken as a basis, as a cause, or as a proximate cause. Why is that? Because the giving of those earlier bodhisattvas who possessed a perception of an object of reference — however much they gave, however abundantly — would still be countable as a quantity."

Then twenty thousand sons of the gods of the retinue of the Four Great Kings joined their palms together, bowed down, and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, this dedication — through which all roots of virtue grasped by a bodhisattva or great being through the Perfection of Wisdom and through skillful means are dedicated to omniscience — this is a great dedication.

For this very reason, that dedication — the one that actively accumulates the mass of merit arising from the giving of those bodhisattvas who possessed a perception of an object of reference — is itself overwhelmed and surpassed by it, however great that mass may be.

Then one hundred thousand sons of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three scattered and strewed before the Blessed One a rain of divine flowers, divine incense, divine fragrances, divine garlands, divine unguents, divine powders, divine precious jewels, and divine garments. With divine parasols, divine victory banners, divine bells, divine pennants, and divine offerings of many kinds, they showed honor to the Blessed One, exalted him, paid him homage, made offerings, glorified him, and rendered him reverence. And having sounded the divine cymbals, they spoke these words: "O Blessed One, this dedication by which the bodhisattva, the great being, dedicates to the dharmadhātu is a great dedication. For it overwhelms and surpasses even that vast mass of merit — actively accumulating the merit arising from the giving of those bodhisattvas who possessed a perception of an object of reference — however great that mass may be. For this reason it is a great dedication, because it is embraced by the Perfection of Wisdom and by skillful means."

Likewise, from other divine realms, gods came forth and paid the Blessed One the highest honor, the highest exaltation, the highest homage, the highest offering, the highest glorification, and the highest reverence. Having honored him, exalted him, paid him homage, made offerings, glorified him, and rendered him reverence, they raised their voices and sang in chorus.

And so too should it be understood with regard to the gods of the Heaven of Freedom from Strife (Yāma), the Heaven of Joy (Tuṣita), the Heaven of Delight in Creation (Nirmāṇarati), the Heaven of Making Use of Others' Creations (Paranirmitavaśavartin), the Heaven of the Brahmā Class, the retinue of

Brahmā, the company of Brahmā, the Great Brahmā, the gods of Minor Light, Immeasurable Light, Radiant Light, Minor Virtue, Immeasurable Virtue, Abundant Virtue, the Cloudless, the Merit-Increasing, the Great Fruit, the beings without perception, the Not-Great, the Not-Distressed, the Auspicious Appearance, the Clearly Seeing, and the gods of the Highest Heaven — all of these as well joined their palms together, bowed down to the Blessed One, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, it is wondrous that this dedication of roots of virtue — dedicated by a bodhisattva, a great being, who has been embraced by the Perfection of Wisdom and by skillful means — should overwhelm and surpass that mass of merit accumulated over so long a time, that great mass of merit so extensively and thoroughly accomplished, by a bodhisattva who possessed a perception of an object of reference. It is truly marvelous."

Then the Blessed One addressed the sons of the gods of the Pure Abodes and all those sons of the gods, saying: "Sons of the gods, set aside even the accumulation of merit through giving, done for the sake of enabling all sentient beings in world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River — all of them having entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — to attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Sons of the gods, by this same reckoning, in those other world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in yet other Ganges Rivers, all the sentient beings dwelling there, having set forth an aspiration toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening and having aroused the mind of awakening,

in great trichiliocosms as numerous as the grains of sand in yet other and yet other Ganges Rivers, providing all sentient beings there with monastic robes, alms food, bedding, medicine for the sick, necessities, every comfort, and every pleasant sensation — with each and every bodhisattva sitting for a number of aeons equal to the grains of sand in the Ganges River and giving in that way — and likewise all of those giving with the perception of a referent object, giving in that way throughout — and then, by this same reckoning, having considered individually each and every one of those sentient beings and each and every one of those bodhisattvas, from each bodhisattva all the way to all those bodhisattvas, sitting for a number of aeons equal to the grains of sand in the Ganges River and attending upon all those sentient beings with monastic robes, alms food, bedding, medicine for the sick, necessities, every comfort, and every pleasant sensation — and even that giving done with the perception of a referent object — compared with a certain bodhisattva, a great being, endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom and perfectly held by skillful

means, who rejoices with the supreme rejoicing — the rejoicing that is foremost, chief, excellent, supremely excellent, distinguished, highest, unsurpassed, unexcelled, higher even than the highest, incomparable, matchless and equal to the matchless, and supremely equal to the matchless, and inconceivable — in all the wholesome roots that have been, are being, and will be cultivated in connection with the heaps of moral discipline, the heaps of meditative absorption, the heaps of wisdom, the heaps of liberation, and the heaps of the wisdom of the vision of liberation of the blessed buddhas of the past, present, and future, together with the bodhisattvas, the pratyekabuddhas, and those of the śrāvaka vehicle, and also in connection with all the wholesome roots that other sentient beings have cultivated, are cultivating, and will cultivate — having gathered all of these together, totaled them, measured them, and left nothing out, and having rejoiced in the totality of them with that supreme rejoicing — who then dedicates that merit-producing object of rejoicing together with that dedication, saying, "May this serve to accomplish unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening," fully dedicating it to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening: the merit generated through the former accumulation of merit by those bodhisattvas who give with the perception of a referent object does not come close to even a hundredth part of this merit-producing object endowed with rejoicing and dedication. It does not come close to a thousandth part, nor to a hundred-thousandth part, nor to a ten-millionth part, nor to a billion part, nor to a trillion part, nor to a hundred-trillion part, nor to a thousand-trillion part, nor to a hundred-thousand-trillion part. It cannot be reached by counting, reckoning, example, illustration, basis, or cause. And why is that? It is because all those bodhisattvas give their giving with the perception of a referent object.

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The Eighth Fascicle.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "The Blessed One has spoken of all the wholesome roots — past, present, and future — of all the blessed buddhas of the past, present, and future, together with the bodhisattvas, the pratyekabuddhas, and the entire Saṅgha of śrāvakas, and of all sentient beings — past, present, and future — having gathered all of these together, totaled them, measured them, and left nothing out.

rejoicing in all of them without exception with the supreme act of rejoicing — rejoicing with the incomprehensible act of rejoicing, which is supreme,

excellent, foremost, unsurpassed, highest, supreme above the supreme, matchless, unequaled, equal and supremely equal to none" — when you spoke thus of rejoicing in this way, Blessed One, by what means does one's rejoicing become supreme?

When he had asked this, the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, if persons who have set their course in the bodhisattva vehicle do not grasp, do not conceive with pride, do not apprehend, do not conceptualize, do not elaborately conceptualize, and do not rightly perceive phenomena of the past, present, and future — and yet they examine those phenomena in this way: 'All phenomena are established through conceptual fabrication. They are unborn, definitively unborn, without coming, without going. In this, no phenomenon has ever arisen, no phenomenon will arise, no phenomenon is arising. In this, no phenomenon has ever ceased, no phenomenon will cease, no phenomenon is ceasing' — having thus examined those phenomena closely, they rejoice in accordance with just how the nature of reality of those phenomena is. Having so rejoiced, they dedicate that rejoicing truly and completely to unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening. Subhūti, by this means does the rejoicing of a great bodhisattva become supreme.

"Subhūti, in this dedication of wholesome roots, the merit-producing thing — the merit arising from the giving of those earlier bodhisattvas who perceived a referent object and who looked upon things as referentially existing — does not come even to a hundredth part of it, not to a thousandth part, not to a hundred-thousandth part, not to a ten-millionth part, not to a hundred-ten-millionth part, not to a thousand-ten-millionth part, not to a hundred-thousand-ten-millionth part, not to a hundred-thousand-hundred-thousandth part. It cannot bear comparison in number, in count, by example, by illustration, as a basis, or as a cause.

"Subhūti, furthermore, if a person set on the bodhisattva vehicle wishes to rejoice in the generosity of all the blessed buddhas of the past, future, and present, wishes to rejoice in their moral discipline, wishes to rejoice in their patience, wishes to rejoice in their diligence, wishes to rejoice in their meditative concentration, and wishes to rejoice in their wisdom — that person should rejoice in this manner: As liberation is, so is generosity. As liberation is, so is moral discipline. As liberation is, so is patience. As liberation is, so is diligence. As liberation is, so is meditative concentration. As liberation is, so is wisdom. As liberation is, so is liberation itself. As liberation is, so is the

aggregate of the gnosis that sees liberation. As liberation is, so is the rejoicing. As liberation is, so is the merit-producing thing that comes with that rejoicing. As liberation is, so is the dedication. As liberation is, so are the blessed buddhas and the pratyekabuddhas. As liberation is, so are those śrāvakas of theirs who have passed into complete nirvāṇa. As liberation is, so are those phenomena of the past that have ceased and stopped. As liberation is, so are those phenomena of the future that have not yet come or arisen."

As liberation is, so are those phenomena of the present that have arisen and are presently abiding. As liberation is, so are the Blessed One buddhas of the past and their śrāvakas. As liberation is, so are the Blessed One buddhas of the future and their śrāvakas. As liberation is, so are the present Blessed One buddhas — those who now dwell, live, and remain in immeasurable and innumerable world-realms — and their śrāvakas.

As liberation is, so are all the Blessed One buddhas of the past, future, and present. In just this way, one rejoices with unsurpassed rejoicing in the nature of reality of these phenomena, which are neither bound nor liberated nor attached. Having so rejoiced, one dedicates the unsurpassed merit-producing thing that arises with that rejoicing — not by way of dedicating it to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, but rather dedicating it in accordance with the way things are, with the immovable and indestructible nature of reality of those very phenomena. This is what is called dedication.

Subhūti, for this reason alone this constitutes the supreme rejoicing of a bodhisattva, a great being.

Moreover, Subhūti, suppose that all the sentient beings present in world-realms as numerous as the grains of sand in as many Gaṅgā rivers as there are worlds in a great trichiliocosm were to enter rightly into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Having entered rightly into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, suppose further that all the sentient beings in those same world-realms — as numerous as Gaṅgā's grains of sand — were to generate the mind of awakening. And suppose that from each and every one of those bodhisattvas, one bodhisattva, sitting for a number of eons equal to the grains of sand in the Gaṅgā, were to give gifts — serving each and every bodhisattva with robes, alms-food, bedding, medicines for the sick, all requisites and all means of comfort, and all that brings contact with happiness, doing so with a perception that has an object of reference, and likewise all of them serving all the others in this same way, giving gifts with

such a perception that has an object of reference. Subhūti, let that be.

Now, Subhūti, suppose that all the sentient beings — however many there are in world-realms as numerous as the grains of sand in as many Gaṅgā rivers as there are worlds in a great trichiliocosm — were all to enter rightly into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Having entered rightly into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, suppose that for a number of eons equal to the grains of sand in the Gaṅgā they were to properly take up and abide in the moral discipline of right conduct of body, right conduct of speech, and right conduct of mind — with a perception that has an object of reference. And suppose likewise that each and every one of those bodhisattvas were to sit for a number of eons equal to the grains of sand in the Gaṅgā and for that same number of eons were to properly take up and abide in the moral discipline of right conduct of body, right conduct of speech, and right conduct of mind — with a perception that has an object of reference. And in this same way, suppose all of those bodhisattvas were likewise to properly take up and abide in moral discipline with a perception that has an object of reference.

Now suppose a bodhisattva, a great being, who is embraced by the Perfection of Wisdom and by skillful means, were to rejoice in the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis that sees liberation belonging to the Blessed One buddhas of the past, future, and present —

and the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis that sees liberation belonging to those pratyekabuddhas (solitary buddhas); and all the roots of virtue of all sentient beings of the past, future, and present — were to gather all of those together, collect them, measure them, and leave nothing out; and then, having left nothing out, were to rejoice in all of them with the supreme rejoicing — a rejoicing that is holy, primary, excellent, supremely excellent, distinguished, unsurpassed, without anything higher, without anything above it, above even what is above, incomparable, unequalled, supremely equalled by nothing, and inconceivable — and having so rejoiced, were to fully dedicate to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening the supreme merit-producing substance that is endowed with such rejoicing:

then, Subhūti, that earlier merit-producing substance that is endowed with rejoicing — the merit accumulated from the moral discipline of those bodhisattvas who abide in moral discipline with a perception that has an object

of reference — does not come within even a hundredth part of this. It does not come within a thousandth part, a hundred-thousandth part, a ten-millionth part, a billion part, a ten-billion part, a hundred-billion part, a trillion part, a hundred-trillion part. It does not come within any numerical reckoning, does not come within any count, does not bear any analogy, cannot be illustrated by any example, has no basis for comparison, and admits of no causal measure.

And why is this? Because all of those bodhisattvas properly took up and abided in moral discipline with a perception that has an object of reference.

Now, Subhūti, suppose all the sentient beings in as many world-systems of the great three-thousand-fold universe as there are grains of sand in the Ganges River were all to enter perfectly into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening; and having so entered, were to abide for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges River, properly taking up and abiding in moral discipline — right conduct of body, right conduct of speech, and right conduct of mind — with a perception that has an object of reference.

And now, Subhūti, suppose all the sentient beings in as many world-systems of the great three-thousand-fold universe as there are grains of sand in the Ganges were to enter perfectly into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and having entered, were to remain for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges; and suppose that all the sentient beings in as many other and yet other world-systems of the great three-thousand-fold universe as there are grains of sand in the Ganges were each, for every single one of those bodhisattvas, to scratch, beat, and abuse them, and yet those bodhisattvas were to properly take up and abide in patience with pride — that is, with a perception that has an object of reference — and in this same way all of those bodhisattvas were likewise to properly take up and abide in patience. And in this same enumeration, each and every one of those bodhisattvas were to remain for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges, and all the sentient beings in as many other and yet other world-systems of the great three-thousand-fold universe as there are grains of sand in the Ganges were to scratch, beat, and abuse them for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges; and yet those bodhisattvas were to properly take up and abide in patience with pride — with a perception that has an object of reference — and likewise all of those were, every one of them, to be scratched, beaten, and abused by all, and yet were to properly take up and abide in patience with pride and a perception that has an object of reference.

A bodhisattva, a great being, who is fully endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom and with skillful means, were to gather together, sum up, measure out, and leave nothing unaccounted of all the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis of the vision of liberation belonging to all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future, and the present; and likewise the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis of the vision of liberation belonging to all those pratyekabuddhas; and likewise the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis of the vision of liberation belonging to all those śrāvakas; and all the roots of virtue of all sentient beings of the past, the future, and the present — having gathered all of these together and summed them up without remainder, and having left nothing unaccounted — were then to rejoice in them all without remainder with the foremost act of rejoicing: rejoicing with that which is supreme, primary, excellent, supremely excellent, distinguished, unsurpassed, without superior, without anything above it, above even what is above, without equal, incomparable, equal to the equal, supremely equal, and inconceivable — and having so rejoiced, were to dedicate that meritorious basis accompanied by rejoicing to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening: then, Subhūti, the meritorious basis accompanied by rejoicing described here would not come even within a hundredth part of the meritorious basis that accrues from the patience of those earlier bodhisattvas who had an object of reference. It would not come within a thousandth part, nor a hundred-thousandth part, nor within a ten-millionth part, nor a billion-th part, nor a ten-billion-th part, nor a hundred-billion-th part, nor a hundred-trillion-th part. It cannot be counted, it cannot be reckoned, it cannot be compared, it cannot be illustrated by a simile, it cannot serve as a basis, it cannot serve as a cause — it does not bear comparison. And why is that? Because all those bodhisattvas had taken up and abided in patience through a perception that has an object of reference.

Now, Subhūti, suppose all the sentient beings in as many world-systems of the great three-thousand-fold universe as there are grains of sand in the Ganges were to enter properly into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and having entered properly into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, all the sentient beings in as many other and yet other world-systems of the great three-thousand-fold universe as there are grains of sand in the Ganges were to scratch, beat, and abuse them — and yet they were to properly take up and

abide in patience with pride and a perception that has an object of reference, for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges. Let that be set aside. Subhūti, suppose all the sentient beings there are in as many world-systems of the great three-thousand-fold universe as there are grains of sand in the Ganges were to enter properly into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and having entered properly into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, were to dwell and conduct themselves there for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges; and for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges they were to dwell without flagging, without being overcome by sloth and drowsiness, and were to take up and abide in diligence with a perception that has an object of reference — and a bodhisattva, a great being, fully endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom and with skillful means, were to gather together all the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis of the vision of liberation belonging to all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future, and the present,

and were also to gather together all the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis of the vision of liberation belonging to all those pratyekabuddhas, and all the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis of the vision of liberation belonging to all those śrāvakas, and all the roots of virtue accumulated in the past, the future, and the present by all sentient beings — gathering all of these together into one, summing them up, measuring them out, leaving none aside, and then with the supreme rejoicing that leaves none aside, were to rejoice — rejoicing with a rejoicing that is supreme, excellent, foremost, outstanding, extraordinary, highest, unsurpassed, unexcelled, beyond even what is supreme, incomparable, without equal, matchless, utterly without peer, and inconceivable — and having so rejoiced, were to dedicate that supreme meritorious act endowed with rejoicing to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening: then, Subhūti, this supreme meritorious act endowed with rejoicing — compared to the meritorious act of actively accumulating merit produced by the diligence of those earlier bodhisattvas possessed of a perception with an object of reference — does not approach even a hundredth part of it, nor a thousandth, nor a hundred-thousandth, nor a ten-millionth, nor a hundred-millionth, nor a thousand-millionth, nor a hundred-thousand-millionth, nor even a hundred-thousand-trillionth part of it. It cannot be reached by number, by

calculation, by simile, by illustration, by ratio, or by cause. And why is that? It is because all those bodhisattvas took up and abided in diligence with a perception that has an object of reference.

Subhūti, consider further: suppose all the sentient beings in a world-system of a great trichiliocosm as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges were to enter genuinely into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and having so entered, were to remain for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges — dwelling, walking, and abiding continuously — and for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges were to dwell without flagging, without being overcome by sloth and drowsiness, and were to take up and abide in diligence with a perception that has an object of reference. Now, Subhūti, suppose those very sentient beings — all of them, as many as there are in a world-system of a great trichiliocosm as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges — having all entered genuinely into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and having so entered, for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges were to enter into meditative equipoise in the four meditative concentrations with a perception that has an object of reference. And suppose further that a bodhisattva, a great being, fully endowed with this Perfection of Wisdom and with skillful means, were to gather together all the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis of the vision of liberation belonging to all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future, and the present, and the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis of the vision of liberation belonging to all those pratyekabuddhas, and the aggregates of moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis of the vision of liberation belonging to all those śrāvakas, and all the roots of virtue accumulated in the past, the future, and the present by all sentient beings — gathering all of these together into one, summing them up, measuring them out, leaving none aside, and then with the supreme rejoicing that leaves none aside, were to rejoice —

— the supreme rejoicing that is incalculable, incomprehensible, rejoicing in what is holy and primary, excellent and supremely excellent, extraordinary and exalted, unsurpassed and utterly without anything above it, higher even than the highest, incomparable, unequal, equal, and supremely equal — and were then to dedicate to the unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening that very merit-producing substance belonging to that rejoicing: then, Subhūti, that merit-producing substance belonging to such rejoicing would not come

even to a hundredth part of this merit-producing substance that arises from the four meditative absorptions of bodhisattvas who have objects, nor to a thousandth, nor to a hundred-thousandth, nor to a ten-thousandth, nor to a hundred ten-thousandth, nor to a thousand ten-thousandth, nor to a hundred-thousand ten-thousandth, nor to a hundred-thousand-million ten-thousandth part. It cannot be reckoned, cannot be counted, cannot be illustrated by an example, cannot be demonstrated by comparison, cannot be made a basis for it, cannot be made a cause for it — it is beyond all measure. And why is that? It is because all those bodhisattvas enter into meditative absorptions while bearing the perception of an object. This is the sixth chapter, entitled "Rejoicing and Dedication," from the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines.

Then the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom fully accomplishes the gnosis of omniscience. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is omniscience itself."

The Blessed One declared: "It is so, Śāriputra. It is exactly as you say."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom illuminates. I pay homage to the Perfection of Wisdom, O Blessed One. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is worthy of homage. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is without defilement. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is undefiled by the whole world. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom makes things radiant. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom dispels all obscuration from the three realms. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom dispels all the darkness of affliction and false views. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom gives stability. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom makes supreme. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom brings to perfection all the qualities on the side of awakening. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom illumines those sentient beings who are blind. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom utterly removes all fear and harm, and makes things radiant. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom, by fully conferring the five eyes, shows the path to all sentient beings. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is the eye itself. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom frees from delusion, darkness, and all obscuration. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom dispels all obscuration."

Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom does not fabricate any phenomenon. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom leads onto the path those sentient beings who have gone astray. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is

omniscience itself. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom does not give rise to any phenomenon, for the sake of abandoning all the afflictive and cognitive obscurations together with their habitual tendencies and their connections. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom does not suppress any phenomenon. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is unborn and unceased. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is the mother of all bodhisattvas, great beings, by virtue of the emptiness of intrinsic characteristics. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom acts with the ten powers for the sake of conferring all the precious qualities of a buddha. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is invincible for the sake of producing the four fearlessnesses. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is the protector of those sentient beings who have no protector. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is the antidote to cyclic existence, since nothing abides permanently. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom reveals the essential nature of all phenomena. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is the complete fulfillment of the turning of the wheel of Dharma by the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, recited three times and set in motion in twelve aspects.

Blessed One, how should a bodhisattva, a great being, abide in the Perfection of Wisdom? Blessed One, how should one attend to the Perfection of Wisdom? Blessed One, how should one pay homage to the Perfection of Wisdom?

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to the venerable Śāriputra: Śāriputra, one should abide in the Perfection of Wisdom just as the Teacher knows it. Śāriputra, one should attend to the Perfection of Wisdom just as the Teacher knows it. Śāriputra, one should pay homage to the Perfection of Wisdom just as the Teacher knows it.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), thought to himself: How remarkable that the noble Śāriputra has asked this question! How remarkable — from what basis has the noble Śāriputra asked this?

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to the venerable Śāriputra: Noble Śāriputra, why have you asked this? Noble Śāriputra, from what basis have you asked this?

When he had spoken thus, the venerable Śāriputra said this to Śakra, lord of the gods: Kauśika, a bodhisattva, a great being, who is fully sustained by the skillful means of the Perfection of Wisdom, rejoices in that and dedicates all the meritorious works gathered thereby entirely to omniscience. All the merit accumulated from generosity by those earlier bodhisattvas who had an object

of focus — whatever merit arises from generosity, whatever arises from moral discipline, whatever arises from patience, whatever arises from diligence, whatever merit arises from meditative concentration — all of that which is accumulated and made manifest it utterly surpasses and overwhelms. That is why I have asked from this basis. Kauśika, and yet all five perfections enter the path to omniscience only when the Perfection of Wisdom goes before them.

Kauśika, consider this analogy: a hundred blind people, or a thousand, or a hundred thousand — if there is no one to guide them fully, they have no chance of setting out on the road, and no chance of reaching a village, a town, or a city. In just the same way, Kauśika, when generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, and meditative concentration are separated from the Perfection of Wisdom, they do not attain even the name "perfection" and are like the blind — for without a guide they have no chance of entering the path to omniscience, so how could they ever enter or arrive at the great city of omniscience?

Kauśika, but when generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, and meditative concentration are fully taken up by the Perfection of Wisdom, they then attain the name and word "perfection," and at that point these five perfections have gained eyes in order to enter the path to omniscience and to arrive at omniscience in due course.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said this to the Blessed One: Blessed One, how should a bodhisattva, a great being, accomplish the Perfection of Wisdom?

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared this to the venerable Śāriputra: Śāriputra, one should look upon form as something not to be accomplished. Śāriputra, in the same way, one should look upon feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as things not to be accomplished. Śāriputra, not accomplishing the five aggregates — that, Śāriputra, is what is called accomplishing the Perfection of Wisdom. By not constructing and accumulating in that way, accomplishing the five aggregates is accomplishing the Perfection of Wisdom — and it is what is called accomplishment.

When he had declared this, the venerable Śāriputra said this to the Blessed One: Blessed One, when one accomplishes the Perfection of Wisdom in that way, what dharma does one project? The Blessed One declared: Śāriputra, when one accomplishes the Perfection of Wisdom in that way, one projects no dharma whatsoever. Śāriputra, when one projects no dharma whatsoever, that

comes to be counted as what is called the Perfection of Wisdom.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One: Blessed One, does this Perfection of Wisdom then also not project even omniscience? The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, when you say, "Does this Perfection of Wisdom not project even omniscience?" — it does not project in the way something is apprehended as an object. It does not project in the way a name is posited. It does not project in the way something is constructed and accumulated. Śakra said: Blessed One, then how does one project? The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, one projects in the very way that one does not project. Śakra said:

Śakra said: Blessed One, as long as this Perfection of Wisdom neither produces nor obstructs any phenomenon, and as long as one does not even remain in proximity to it for the sake of all phenomena being without arising and without ceasing — this Perfection of Wisdom is wonderful.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, if a bodhisattva, a great being, were to perceive it in just that way and were to make this Perfection of Wisdom something distant, were to accumulate this Perfection of Wisdom, were to fill himself with this Perfection of Wisdom — that would be not practicing this Perfection of Wisdom. Having said this, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Subhūti: So it is, Subhūti, so it is. Subhūti, there is this description of the way in which one would make this Perfection of Wisdom something distant, would accumulate this Perfection of Wisdom, would fill oneself with this Perfection of Wisdom — and thereby not practice this Perfection of Wisdom. Why is that? Subhūti, when this Perfection of Wisdom is made perfectly clear, form is not made perfectly clear; feeling is not, perception is not, formations are not, consciousness is not made perfectly clear. The fruit of stream-entry is not made perfectly clear; the fruit of once-returning is not made perfectly clear; the fruit of non-returning is not made perfectly clear; arhatship is not made perfectly clear; the state of a pratyekabuddha is not made perfectly clear; and buddhahood is not made perfectly clear.

The elder Subhūti said: Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is therefore a great perfection. The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, what do you think — by what account is this Perfection of Wisdom a great perfection? The elder Subhūti said: Blessed One, it does not make form great, it does not make it small, it does not gather form in, it does not scatter it. Likewise with feeling — no, and perception — no, and formations — no. Blessed One, it does not make

consciousness great, it does not make it small, it does not gather consciousness in, it does not scatter it. Whatever the powers of the Tathāgatas may be — those tathāgata-powers, too, it does not render possessed of power, it does not render empty of power, it does not gather them in, it does not scatter them. Whatever omniscience may be, it does not make it great, it does not make it small, it does not gather it in, it does not scatter it. Why so? Blessed One, omniscience itself is ungathered and unscattered. Blessed One, even if a bodhisattva, a great being, were to seek in such a way yet not to be engaged in the Perfection of Wisdom, were to think, "I am endowed with the gnosis of omniscience; I shall teach the Dharma to sentient beings in just this way; I shall lead these sentient beings completely to nirvāṇa" — how much more so that very thought! Why? Because that thought, "I shall lead these sentient beings completely to nirvāṇa," is not in accord with the Perfection of Wisdom; the very act of taking sentient beings as an object of reference becomes a great object of reference for it. Why? Because the Perfection of Wisdom is to be known as having the intrinsic nature of being devoid of the essential nature of sentient beings and devoid of arising.

Because sentient beings are devoid of essential nature, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be known as devoid of essential nature. Because sentient beings are solitary and apart, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be known as solitary and apart. Because sentient beings are inconceivable, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be known as inconceivable. Because it is the nature of reality of sentient beings not to perish, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be known as having the nature of reality of not perishing. Because sentient beings do not fully awaken to complete and perfect buddhahood, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be known as not fully awakening to complete and perfect buddhahood. Because sentient beings do not fully awaken to complete and perfect buddhahood exactly as the ultimate meaning truly is, the Perfection of Wisdom is to be known as not fully awakening to complete and perfect buddhahood exactly as the ultimate meaning truly is. Because sentient beings perfectly accomplish power, the powers of the Tathāgata are to be known as perfectly accomplished. Blessed One, by this enumeration, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed the Great Perfection.

Then the venerable Śāriputra spoke these words to the Blessed One: Blessed One, whichever bodhisattva, great being, has faith in this profound Perfection of Wisdom and does not waver, does not doubt, does not become confused — Blessed One, from where did that one pass away and be born here? Blessed

One, that bodhisattva, great being, will follow after, will seek out, and will come to understand the meaning of this Perfection of Wisdom, its nature of reality, the manner of its meaning, and the manner of its nature of reality — know that such a one has practiced for a long time and has kept to the precepts. When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared these words to the venerable Śāriputra: Śāriputra, know that such a bodhisattva, great being, has passed away from other world-realms, having attended upon and thoroughly questioned the buddhas, the Blessed Ones there, and has been born here. Why is this? Śāriputra, whatever bodhisattva, great being, has attended upon and thoroughly questioned the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, has passed away from other world-realms, and has been born here — that one listens to the exposition, teaching, full teaching, and oral transmission of this profound Perfection of Wisdom; and having heard this Perfection of Wisdom, that one generates the perception that it is one's own teacher who is being presented, and arises the thought, "My teacher has appeared directly before me; I am seeing my teacher." That one lends an ear to the exposition, teaching, full teaching, and oral transmission of this Perfection of Wisdom, listens with reverence, and does not interrupt the discourse. Śāriputra, know that such a bodhisattva, great being, is of just such a nature — one who has practiced for a long time and kept to the precepts. Śāriputra, know in just this way that such a bodhisattva, great being, has attended upon many buddhas.

Then the venerable Subhūti spoke these words to the Blessed One: Blessed One, is it possible to hear, realize, contemplate, give rise to, or take up this Perfection of Wisdom?

Can it be pointed out — "The Perfection of Wisdom is this," or "The Perfection of Wisdom is here," or "The Perfection of Wisdom is in such-and-such a place" — or can it be indicated or heard by means of this form, this sign, or this mark?

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, no. This Perfection of Wisdom cannot be indicated in terms of the aggregates, the elements, or the sense bases, nor can it be heard, realized, contemplated, given rise to, or taken up. Why is that? Subhūti, because all phenomena are empty, and all phenomena are utterly remote — it is for that reason that the Perfection of Wisdom cannot be indicated, heard, realized, contemplated, given rise to, or taken up. Know further that the Perfection of Wisdom does not exist apart from the aggregates, elements, and sense bases. Why is that? Because the aggregates, elements, and sense bases themselves are empty, remote, and at peace. In that way, the Perfection of Wisdom on the one hand and the aggregates,

elements, and sense bases on the other are not two and cannot be made into two. Because of emptiness, remoteness, and peace, it has no referential object; and that very absence of any referential object with respect to all phenomena is what is called the Perfection of Wisdom. When perception, full cognition, conceptual designation, and conventional expression do not arise — that is what is to be called the Perfection of Wisdom.

The elder Subhūti then asked: Blessed One, how long a time must a bodhisattva, a great being, who practices this profound Perfection of Wisdom be understood to have practiced and to have kept to the precepts?

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, because there are gradations in the faculties of bodhisattvas, great beings, this must be analyzed and set forth in detail. Subhūti, there is also a way of reckoning by which bodhisattvas who have seen many hundreds of buddhas, many thousands of buddhas, and many hundreds of thousands of buddhas, and who have led the holy life in their presence, may nonetheless come to lack faith and devotion toward this Perfection of Wisdom. Why is that? In the past, with regard to those blessed buddhas, when this profound Perfection of Wisdom was being expounded, taught, and fully taught, they did not show respect; and because they showed no respect, they did not listen well; because they did not listen well, they did not pay homage; because they paid no homage, they did not inquire closely; because they did not inquire closely, they did not develop genuine faith; because they did not develop genuine faith, they strayed away from those assemblies. In that way, they acted, accumulated, fully accumulated, and closely accumulated karma concordant with being deprived of the Dharma in that domain. Even now, when this profound Perfection of Wisdom is being expounded, taught, and fully taught, they stray away without respect, without faith, and without devotion, and so they do not apply body and mind to gathering the accumulations. Because they do not gather the accumulations, they do not know, do not see, do not penetrate, and do not realize this Perfection of Wisdom. Thus they come to lack faith in the Perfection of Wisdom; lacking faith, they do not listen; not listening, they do not know; not knowing, they do not see; not seeing, they do not penetrate. And not having penetrated, they continually perform, fully engage in, and closely engage in karma concordant with being deprived of the Dharma.

By having performed, accumulated, fully accumulated, and closely accumulated karma concordant with being deprived of the Dharma, they will then engage in forming karma concordant with the derangement of wisdom.

Having fully formed, accumulated, fully accumulated, and closely accumulated karma concordant with the derangement of wisdom, when this Perfection of Wisdom is expounded, taught, and closely taught, they will reject it, denigrate it, and speak ill of it — and having denigrated it, they will go astray.

O Subhūti, moreover, by rejecting, denigrating, and speaking ill of this Perfection of Wisdom, they will reject, denigrate, and speak ill of the omniscience of all the blessed buddhas of the past, the future, and the present. These beings, having broken and burned away their own stream of being, being persons of little intelligence, little wisdom, little merit, and few wholesome roots, possessed of mere faith, mere joy, mere clarity, mere aspiration — beginners, those whose nature lacks good fortune — they will also turn back, drive away, and reverse that mere faith, mere joy, and mere aspiration even of others, saying, "One should not train in this," and uttering the words, "This is not the speech of a buddha." In this way, having broken and severed their own stream of being and also broken and severed the streams of others, they will denigrate the Perfection of Wisdom. When the Perfection of Wisdom is denigrated, omniscience itself is denigrated. When omniscience is denigrated, all the blessed buddhas of the past, the future, and the present are denigrated. In this way they will go astray from the blessed buddhas, be utterly abandoned by the Dharma, and become utterly excluded from the Saṅgha. Thus, from every direction, in every manner, and in every respect they will become utterly excluded from the Three Jewels. And because they cut off benefit and happiness for sentient beings, they will accumulate karma concordant with ripening in the great hells.

By forming, establishing, rousing, and fully engaging in such karma — karma concordant with being deprived of the Dharma and concordant with the derangement of wisdom — by that very nature they will fall into the great hells for many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, many tens of millions of years, many tens of billions of years, many hundreds of billions of years, and many hundreds of trillions of years. They will pass from one great hell to another great hell. While they are thus transferring for such a long time from great hell to great hell, there will arise an aeon of destruction by fire. When an aeon of destruction by fire occurs, they will be cast into whatever great hells exist in other world-systems, and they will fall into those great hells. Having been cast there and fallen into those great hells, there too they will transfer from great hell to great hell. And while there too they are transferring from great hell to great hell, there too

that same aeon of destruction by fire will arise once more.

When an aeon of destruction by fire arose, they passed away from there and were immediately cast into whatever great hells existed in other world-systems, and they were reborn in those great hells. There too, in exactly the same way, they transferred from great hell to great hell. While they were transferring there as well, for a very long time, from great hell to great hell, there too an aeon of destruction by fire came to occur. When that aeon of destruction by fire arose, they once again passed away from there, and by that very same karma — unexhausted and with its remainder intact — they were cast back and thrown into this world-system, and upon being so thrown, they were reborn once again in the great hells. There, once more in the great hells, they experienced those great sufferings of hell-beings — and they continued to experience them for as long as an aeon of destruction by fire would arise. In this way they experienced suffering befitting karma that had brought forth such great suffering. Why was this so? Because they had uttered such deeply harmful words.

Then the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, those who have committed and accumulated the five actions of immediate retribution — the image or likeness or even a faint semblance of such misdeeds of mind and misdeeds of speech does not exist even remotely."

The Blessed One declared: "It is so, Śāriputra, it is indeed so. Śāriputra, those who have committed and accumulated the five actions of immediate retribution have performed and heaped up and thoroughly accumulated and proximately accumulated misdeeds through mind and misdeeds through speech — and not even an image or likeness or faint semblance of this exists.

As for those who turn back and speak disparagingly and utter unpleasant things against those who teach and expound and explain this profound Perfection of Wisdom, saying 'One should not train in this,' and who say 'This was not taught by the Tathāgata,' and who also cause other sentient beings to be separated from it — such persons ruin their own stream and destroy the streams of others; they poison their own stream and poison the streams of others; they ruin themselves and ruin others. They themselves neither know nor comprehend this profound Perfection of Wisdom, and they lead others to hold the view that one should not train in it.

Śāriputra, I do not even grant permission to look upon persons of such a nature — what need is there to mention associating with them, or keeping

their company, or receiving gains and honors from them? Why is that? Śāriputra, persons of such a nature should be understood as those who revile the Dharma. Śāriputra, persons of such a nature should be understood as those who have become like rotted leaves. Śāriputra, persons of such a nature should be understood as being dark in nature and as generating darkness. Śāriputra, all those who think to listen to such persons and to place faith in them will be ruined through what is not the proper way. Śāriputra, those who revile the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood, Śāriputra, as persons who revile the Dharma."

Śāriputra then asked: "Blessed One, please show the physical measure of a being born in such a state and dwelling in the great hells."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, set aside for now the measure of the body of a person born in that great hell. Why? Because upon hearing the measure of the body of a person of such a nature, one would vomit warm blood from one's mouth and die, or come close to death, or be touched and burned by unbearable suffering and sickness, or be pierced by the thorn of grief, or fall into a great abyss, or become withered and parched. Since it would be inappropriate for any of these harms to befall one, let it not come to be heard — that measure of such a body, so full of great terror, in which all those faults exist." The Blessed One did not open the occasion to tell the venerable Śāriputra, "The measure of that body is such and such."

A second and a third time the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, please explain to me how, once the measure of that person's body is made apparent to people of future generations, they will understand that the actions of speech and mind that have been performed, accumulated, heaped up, and fully amassed will produce a body in the great hells that is so vast and immense."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, this very fact — that one who has acted wrongly through speech and mind, who has fully formed and accumulated non-virtuous karma, heaped it up and amassed it fully, will experience suffering of such extent for so long a time — when made apparent to people of future generations, will cause those sons and daughters of good family who have the fortune of merit to feel dismay, and thereafter to become impoverished in Dharma. Turning back from those corresponding actions, they will do only one thing: accumulate merit. Thinking 'I too must not encounter suffering like that,' they will not, even for the sake of their life, abandon the

true Dharma."

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, a son or daughter of good family should be extremely restrained in the actions of body, speech, and mind. Why? Because, Blessed One, it is through speaking such wrongful words as these that this great mass of demerit has arisen. Blessed One, through what action did this great mass of demerit arise?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, it is through speaking wrongful words of that nature that this great mass of demerit arose. Subhūti, those deluded persons who would think to revile this profound Perfection of Wisdom, who would think to deprecate it, who would think to reject it — they will go forth into renunciation within this very well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya. If this Perfection of Wisdom is discarded, the awakening of the Blessed Buddhas will also be discarded. If the awakening of the buddhas is discarded, the omniscience of the Blessed Buddhas of the past, the future, and the present will also be discarded. If omniscience is discarded, the true Dharma will be discarded. If the true Dharma is discarded, the Saṅgha of the Tathāgata's śrāvakas will also be discarded."

When the Saṅgha of the Tathāgata's śrāvakas has been discarded in this way, one becomes utterly estranged from the Three Jewels in every respect, from every side, and in every dimension — and thereby one fully takes up and embraces an immeasurably vast and incalculably great unwholesome action.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what is the cause, what is the condition, that a son or daughter of good family would think to deprecate this Perfection of Wisdom?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that son or daughter of good family is either blessed by Māra, or, through verbal actions conducive to the corruption of wisdom, they come to lack faith in and fail to delight in these profound teachings. Subhūti, it is through being endowed with these two evil qualities that such a son or daughter of good family comes to deprecate this Perfection of Wisdom.

"Furthermore, Subhūti, whoever would think to deprecate this profound Perfection of Wisdom when it is being explained, taught, or expounded — that person will be endowed with these four qualities: that son or daughter of good family will either have fallen into the hands of an evil friend, or will be lacking

in diligence, or will be attached to the aggregates, or will be one who praises themselves and disparages others, seeking out occasions for fault."

This concludes the seventh chapter of the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, called "The Chapter on Hell."

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The Ninth Fascicle.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is difficult to have faith in for those lacking in diligence, those devoid of roots of virtue, and those who have fallen into the hands of evil friends."

The Blessed One declared: "So it is, Subhūti, so it is. Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is difficult to have faith in for those lacking in diligence, those with meager roots of virtue, those of weak intelligence, those who do not seek its meaning, those of little learning, those of feeble wisdom, those firmly held by evil friends, those who do not listen well, those of a nature not to inquire, and those who make no effort in virtuous qualities.

Subhūti then asked: "Blessed One — how wonderful! — how very profound then is the Perfection of Wisdom, that it is so difficult to have faith in?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, form is neither bound nor liberated. Why is that? Subhūti, because form has no essential nature, form is neither bound nor liberated. Subhūti, likewise feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are neither bound nor liberated. Why is that? Subhūti, because consciousness has no essential nature, consciousness is neither bound nor liberated.

"Subhūti, the past limit of form is neither bound nor liberated. Why is that? Subhūti, because the past limit of form has no essential nature. Subhūti, the future limit of form is neither bound nor liberated. Why is that? Subhūti, because the future limit of form has no essential nature. Subhūti, the present arising of form is neither bound nor liberated. Why is that? Subhūti, because the present arising of form has no essential nature.

"Subhūti, likewise the past limit of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness is neither bound nor liberated. Why is that? Subhūti, because the past limit of consciousness has no essential nature."

Subhūti, the future limit of consciousness is neither bound nor liberated. Why is that? Subhūti, because the future limit of consciousness has no essential nature. Subhūti, the present arising of consciousness is neither bound nor

liberated. Why is that? Subhūti, because the present arising of consciousness has no essential nature.

Then Subhūti addressed the Blessed One and said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is difficult to have faith in and difficult to have supreme faith in for those who make no effort, who have not accumulated roots of virtue, who have fallen into the hands of evil companions, who have come under the power of Māra, who are lazy, whose diligence is weak, whose mindfulness has declined, and whose wisdom is confused."

The Blessed One declared: "So it is, Subhūti, so it is. Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is difficult to have faith in for those who make no effort, who have not accumulated roots of virtue, who have fallen into the hands of evil companions, who have come under the power of Māra, who are lazy, whose diligence is weak, whose mindfulness has declined, and whose wisdom is confused. Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is difficult to have supreme faith in. Why is that? Subhūti, whatever is the purity of form, that is the purity of the fruit; and whatever is the purity of the fruit, that is the purity of form. Subhūti, thus the purity of form and the purity of the fruit are non-dual, cannot be made into two, are not distinct, and are not divided. Subhūti, thus by the purity of the fruit, form is pure; and by the purity of form, the fruit is pure. Subhūti, likewise whatever is the purity of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, that is the purity of the fruit; and whatever is the purity of the fruit, that is the purity of consciousness. Subhūti, thus the purity of consciousness and the purity of the fruit are non-dual, cannot be made into two, are not distinct, and are not divided. Subhūti, thus by the purity of the fruit, consciousness is pure; and by the purity of consciousness, the fruit is pure.

"Subhūti, furthermore, whatever is the purity of form, that is the purity of omniscience; and whatever is the purity of omniscience, that is the purity of form. Subhūti, thus the purity of form and the purity of omniscience are non-dual, cannot be made into two, are not distinct, and are not divided. Subhūti, thus by the purity of omniscience, form is pure; and by the purity of form, omniscience is pure. Subhūti, likewise whatever is the purity of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, that is the purity of omniscience; and whatever is the purity of omniscience, that is the purity of consciousness. Subhūti, thus the purity of consciousness and the purity of omniscience are non-dual, cannot be made into two, are not distinct, and are not divided. Subhūti, thus by the purity of omniscience, consciousness is pure; and by the

purity of consciousness, omniscience is pure."

Then the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One and said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, that is because of purity."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom illuminates."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, that is because of purity."

Śāriputra said:

"Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom illuminates."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, that is because of purity."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is without junction or connection."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, that is because of purity."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is without any affliction whatsoever."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, that is because of purity."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is without attainment and without realization."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, that is because of purity."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is without full accomplishment."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, that is because of purity."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom has no arising whatsoever in the desire realm, the form realm, or the formless realm."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, that is because of purity."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom neither seeks nor truly seeks."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, that is because of purity."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, what then does the Perfection of Wisdom neither seek nor truly seek?"

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, the Perfection of Wisdom neither knows nor truly knows form. And why is that? Śāriputra, because of purity. Śāriputra, in the same way, the Perfection of Wisdom neither knows nor truly knows feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. And why is that? Because of purity."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom neither harms nor benefits omniscience."

The Blessed One declared: "Because of purity."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom neither fully appropriates nor fully relinquishes any phenomenon whatsoever."

The Blessed One declared: "Because of purity."

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One and said: "Blessed One, by the purity of self, form is pure."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is because of utter purity."

Subhūti said: "Blessed One, by the purity of self, feeling, perception, and formations are pure. Blessed One, by the purity of self, consciousness is pure."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is because of utter purity."

Subhūti said: "Blessed One, by the purity of self, result is pure."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is because of utter purity."

Subhūti said: "Blessed One, by the purity of self, omniscience is pure."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is because of utter purity."

Subhūti said: "Blessed One, by the purity of self, there is neither attainment nor realization."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is because of utter purity."

Subhūti said:

"Blessed One, by the limitlessness of self, form is limitless."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is because of utter purity."

Subhūti said: "Blessed One, by the limitlessness of self, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are limitless."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is because of utter purity."

Subhūti said: "Blessed One, whatever realization a bodhisattva, a great being, has in that way — that is this Perfection of Wisdom."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is because of utter purity."

The venerable Subhūti said: "Blessed One, moreover, this Perfection of Wisdom does not abide on the near shore, does not abide on the far shore, and does not abide in the vast expanse between the two."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is because of utter purity."

The venerable Subhūti said: "Blessed One, if one were to perceive it as being so, that bodhisattva, that great being, would abandon this Perfection of Wisdom. One would make this Perfection of Wisdom into something distant."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, excellent, excellent! It is just so, Subhūti, it is just so. And why? Because, Subhūti, one would become attached to the name, and one would become attached to the sign."

When this was declared, the venerable Subhūti spoke to the Blessed One as follows: "Blessed One, in the manner in which the Blessed One has explained these very attachments, how excellently has this Perfection of Wisdom been spoken and how excellently shown — that it reaches the utterly final end is wondrous."

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to the venerable Subhūti: "Venerable Subhūti, what are those attachments?"

Subhūti replied: "Venerable Śāriputra, the thought that 'form is empty' — that is an attachment. Likewise, venerable Śāriputra, the thought that 'feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are empty' — that is an attachment. To know past phenomena correctly as past phenomena — that is an attachment. To know future phenomena correctly as future phenomena — that is an attachment. To know present phenomena correctly as present phenomena — that is an attachment. To know correctly that a person who has set out on the bodhisattva vehicle and who has first aroused the mind produces such and such an accumulation of merit — that is an attachment."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), said to the venerable Subhūti: "Noble Subhūti, through what categories does one become attached?"

Subhūti replied: "Kauśika, if one correctly knows that this is the first arising of the awakening mind, and dedicates that awakening mind to unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening — a son or daughter of good family who has

genuinely entered the Great Vehicle cannot dedicate the intrinsic nature of mind. Therefore, Kauśika, one who correctly teaches others, correctly establishes them, correctly encourages them, and correctly inspires them in delight, through the correct understanding of unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening itself — such a one should correctly teach, correctly establish, correctly encourage, and correctly inspire in delight.

In this way, such a son or daughter of good family does no harm to themselves, and through the correct establishment that has been granted by the buddhas they correctly establish others, and all these extremes of attachment are thoroughly abandoned.

Then the Blessed One spoke words of praise to the venerable Subhūti, saying: "Excellent! Subhūti, it is excellent, excellent, that you thus make bodhisattvas, great beings, understand and take to heart these extremes of attachment. Therefore, Subhūti, yet other subtle forms of attachment are to be explained. Listen well and hold it in mind, for I shall explain it to you."

"Excellent!" replied the Blessed One — and the venerable Subhūti listened attentively to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One spoke as follows:

"Subhūti, in this regard, when faithful sons or daughters of good family direct their minds toward the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha, as a characteristic mark, then, Subhūti, for as long as that characteristic mark persists, there is attachment. Why is that? Because from a characteristic mark, attachment arises. Therefore, one rejoices in whatever undefiled qualities belong to the blessed buddhas of the past, the future, and the present. Having thus rejoiced, and then dedicating the roots of virtue that come with that rejoicing to unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening — Subhūti, the nature of reality of all phenomena is neither past, nor future, nor present. That which is neither past, nor future, nor present is definitively liberated from the three times. That which is definitively liberated from the three times cannot be dedicated, cannot be made into a characteristic mark, cannot be made into an object of focus, nor is it something seen, heard, cognized, or known."

Subhūti asked: "Blessed One, the intrinsic nature of phenomena is profound."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is because of its solitariness."

Subhūti asked: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound in its intrinsic nature."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, because its intrinsic nature is utterly pure, and because its intrinsic nature is solitary, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound in its intrinsic nature."

Subhūti said: "Blessed One, because the Perfection of Wisdom is solitary in its intrinsic nature, I pay homage to the Perfection of Wisdom, Blessed One."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, all phenomena too are precisely solitary in intrinsic nature. Subhūti, that which is the solitariness of the intrinsic nature of all phenomena — that is the Perfection of Wisdom. Why is that? Subhūti, it is because all phenomena have been perfectly and completely awakened to by the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha, without having been made."

Subhūti said: "Blessed One, if that is so, then the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha, has not perfectly and completely awakened to all phenomena."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, it is so — there are no phenomena whatsoever that exist by way of intrinsic nature. Whatever is intrinsic nature is the absence of intrinsic nature; and whatever is intrinsic nature is intrinsic nature — that is to say, because all phenomena lack a characteristic mark, they are of one characteristic mark. Subhūti, for that reason the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha, has not perfectly and completely awakened to all phenomena. Why is that? Subhūti, the intrinsic nature of phenomena is non-dual; the intrinsic nature of all phenomena is nothing other than one."

"Subhūti, whatever is the intrinsic nature of all phenomena — that is the absence of intrinsic nature; and whatever is the absence of intrinsic nature — that is intrinsic nature. Subhūti, therefore all those extremes of attachment are entirely abandoned."

Subhūti then asked: "Blessed One, is the Perfection of Wisdom profound?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound because space is profound."

Subhūti asked: "Blessed One, is the Perfection of Wisdom difficult to realize?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, in this way, no one whatsoever perfectly and completely awakens."

Subhūti asked: "Blessed One, is the Perfection of Wisdom inconceivable?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is not something to be known by the mind, nor is it something to be realized by the mind."

Subhūti asked: "Blessed One, is the Perfection of Wisdom uncreated?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is uncreated because no agent is to be found."

Subhūti asked: "Blessed One, in that case, how should a bodhisattva, a great being, engage in the Perfection of Wisdom?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, if a bodhisattva, a great being, engages in the Perfection of Wisdom by not engaging in form, then that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise, if one engages without engaging in feeling, without engaging in perception, without engaging in formations, and if one engages without engaging in consciousness — that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom.

If one engages without entertaining the thought 'form is impermanent,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise with feeling, perception, formations, and if one engages without entertaining the thought 'consciousness is impermanent,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom.

If one engages without entertaining the thought 'form is empty,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise without doing so with feeling, without doing so with perception, without doing so with formations, and if one engages without entertaining the thought 'consciousness is empty,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom.

If one engages without entertaining the thought 'form is incomplete or complete,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. For whatever is incompleteness or completeness of form — that is not form. And if one also does not engage in that way, that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom.

Likewise with feeling, with perception, with formations, and if one engages without entertaining the thought 'consciousness is incomplete or complete,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. For whatever is incompleteness or completeness of consciousness — that is not consciousness. And if one also does not engage in that way, that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom."

When this had been declared, the venerable Subhūti said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, it is wondrous that for so long as it is the case, the having of attachment and the being free of attachment among bodhisattvas, great beings, should be taught in just this way."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, if a bodhisattva, a great being, engages without entertaining the thought 'form has attachment' or 'form is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise with feeling, perception, formations, and if one engages without entertaining the thought 'consciousness has attachment' or 'consciousness is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom."

"Subhūti, if a bodhisattva, a great being, engages without entertaining the thought 'the eye has attachment' or 'the eye is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise, up through the feelings arisen from mental contact, if one engages without entertaining the thought 'this has attachment' or 'this is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. If one engages without entertaining the thought 'the earth element has attachment' or 'the earth element is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise, up through the consciousness element, if one engages without entertaining the thought 'this has attachment' or 'this is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. If one engages without entertaining the thought 'the perfection of generosity has attachment' or 'the perfection of generosity is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise with the perfection of moral discipline, the perfection of patience, the perfection of diligence, the perfection of meditative concentration, and the perfection of wisdom — if one engages without entertaining the thought 'this has attachment' or 'this is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise with the thirty-seven factors of awakening, the powers, the fearlessnesses, the individual perfect knowledges, and the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha — if one engages without entertaining the thought 'these have attachment' or 'these are free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. If one engages without entertaining the thought 'the fruit of stream-entry has attachment' or 'the fruit of stream-entry is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise with the fruit of once-returning, the fruit of non-returning, and arhatship — if one engages without entertaining the thought 'these have attachment' or 'these are free of attachment,' that is

engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. If one engages without entertaining the thought 'pratyekabuddhahood has attachment' or 'pratyekabuddhahood is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. If one engages without entertaining the thought 'buddhahood has attachment' or 'buddhahood is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom. Subhūti, if one engages without entertaining the thought 'omniscience itself has attachment' or 'omniscience itself is free of attachment,' that is engagement in the Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, who engages in this way generates no attachment to form. Likewise, no attachment is generated to feeling, to perception, to formations, nor to consciousness. Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, who engages in this way generates no attachment to the eye, and so on up through the feelings arisen from mental contact. No attachment is generated to the earth element, and so on up through the consciousness element. No attachment is generated to the perfection of generosity, nor to the perfection of moral discipline, nor to the perfection of patience, nor to the perfection of diligence, nor to the perfection of meditative concentration, nor to the perfection of wisdom. No attachment is generated to the factors of awakening, nor to the powers, nor to the fearlessnesses, nor to the individual perfect knowledges, nor to the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha. No attachment is generated to the fruit of stream-entry, nor to the fruit of once-returning, nor to the fruit of non-returning, nor to arhatship. No attachment is generated to pratyekabuddhahood. No attachment is generated to buddhahood. No attachment whatsoever is generated even to omniscience.

Why is this?"

"Subhūti, omniscience itself is not attached, not bound, not liberated, not fully passed beyond. Subhūti, it is for this reason — in order to be completely free from all attachment — that a bodhisattva, a great being, should practice the Perfection of Wisdom."

Subhūti then said: "Blessed One, this phenomenon called the Perfection of Wisdom is profound. It is wonderful that whether it is taught or not taught it does not diminish, and whether it is taught or not taught it does not increase."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said to the venerable Subhūti: "Excellent, Subhūti! Excellent! Subhūti, it is exactly so, exactly so. Consider this example, Subhūti: for as long as a Tathāgata, an arhat, a fully and perfectly awakened buddha, remains alive, even if praises of space are

uttered, space does not increase in the slightest; and even if no praises are uttered, space does not diminish in the slightest. Consider also, Subhūti, this example: if praises are uttered of an illusory man, no attachment arises and no affliction arises; and if no praises are uttered, no anger arises and no affliction arises. In the same way, Subhūti, the nature of reality of phenomena is such that whether it is taught or not taught, it is just that much — it is exhausted at just that."

The elder Subhūti then said: "Blessed One, any bodhisattva, any great being, who practices this profound Perfection of Wisdom and cultivates the Perfection of Wisdom without becoming discouraged, without becoming hesitant, yet who also brings it into practice — it is indeed difficult to be one who does not turn back. Blessed One, cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom in this way is like cultivating space. Blessed One, those great beings, those bodhisattvas, who have put on this armor are worthy of reverence. Why is this? Blessed One, one who aspires to put on armor for the sake of sentient beings aspires to put on armor together with space itself. One who aspires to put on armor for the sake of sentient beings who are equal to space, who are equal to the dharmadhātu — that one, Blessed One, is a bodhisattva, a great being who has put on the great armor; that one, Blessed One, is a bodhisattva, a great being who is a hero. One who aspires to attain manifest, complete, unsurpassed, and perfect awakening aspires, Blessed One, to complete liberation in space. That one aspires, Blessed One, to lift up space. Blessed One, a bodhisattva, a great being who aspires to armor for the sake of sentient beings equal to space and equal to the dharmadhātu — that one has attained the great armor of the perfection of diligence."

Then another monk, joining his palms together and bowing in the direction of the Blessed One, said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I pay homage to the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom neither produces any phenomenon nor suppresses any phenomenon."

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, spoke to the venerable Subhūti in these words: "Noble Subhūti, one who brings this Perfection of Wisdom into practice in such a way — what would they be bringing into practice?" Subhūti replied: "Kauśika, one who brings this Perfection of Wisdom into practice would be bringing space into practice."

"Kauśika, one who intends to train in and practice this Perfection of Wisdom will come to practice what is without superior."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what protection, guarding, and sheltering should be done for a son of good family or daughter of good family who comes to uphold this Perfection of Wisdom? Please declare this." Then the venerable Subhūti spoke to Śakra, lord of the gods, as follows: "Kauśika, do you truly perceive any phenomenon with respect to which protection, guarding, and sheltering are to be done?" Śakra replied: "Noble Subhūti, I do not." Subhūti said: "Kauśika, if a bodhisattva, a great being, abides in this Perfection of Wisdom just as it has been taught, that very abiding is itself the protection, guarding, and sheltering of it. But if one becomes separated from the Perfection of Wisdom, then those humans and non-humans who watch for an opportunity and seek an opportunity will find their opportunity. Kauśika, furthermore, one who thinks to protect, guard, and shelter a bodhisattva, a great being, who is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom is thinking to protect, guard, and shelter space itself. Kauśika, what do you think — can you protect, guard, and shelter an echo?" Śakra replied: "Noble Subhūti, that is not possible." Subhūti said: "Kauśika, in just the same way, a bodhisattva, a great being, who practices and abides in this Perfection of Wisdom thoroughly knows all phenomena to be like an echo. Therefore one does not become conceited about them, does not truly perceive them, does not truly know them, those phenomena do not exist and do not truly appear, they do not truly exist and are not apprehended — abiding in this way, one practices the Perfection of Wisdom."

Then, by the power of the buddha, all four great kings throughout the great trichiliocosm (the vast world-system of three thousandfold thousands of worlds), all the Śakras lords of the gods, all the Great Brahmas, and all the Great Brahmas who are lords of the Akaniṣṭha realm came to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and stood to one side. Standing to one side, those great kings, all the Śakras lords of the gods, all the Great Brahmas, and the Great Brahma lord of Akaniṣṭha, by the power of the buddha and the blessing of the buddha, came to know that a thousand buddhas, using these very names, these very words, these very letters, and this very monk called Subhūti, had taught this very Perfection of Wisdom and this very chapter of the Perfection of Wisdom in this very place; and that the Śakras lords of the gods themselves had questioned and inquired about it in that same place, and that this very Perfection of Wisdom had been taught here; and that the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya (Loving-kindness),

upon fully and perfectly awakening to unsurpassed complete awakening, would also teach this very Perfection of Wisdom in this very place.

This is the eighth chapter, entitled "Purification," from the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what is called the Perfection of Wisdom is a mere name. That name too is not apprehended as something that exists as 'this.' What we call a name is simply the entity of a word. That Perfection of Wisdom itself also does not exist and is not apprehended. Just as a name is, so too is the Perfection of Wisdom; and just as the Perfection of Wisdom is, so too is a name. Since these two phenomena do not exist and are not apprehended, Blessed One, for what reason will the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya, after fully and perfectly awakening to unsurpassed complete awakening, teach this very Perfection of Wisdom in this very place, with these very names, these very words, and these very syllables?"

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, it is thus: the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya, will fully and perfectly awaken, having fully and perfectly realized that form is neither permanent nor impermanent, neither bound nor free, transcending all extremes and utterly pure. Likewise with feeling, perception, and formations — and with consciousness: neither permanent nor impermanent, neither bound nor free, transcending all extremes and utterly pure. It is for this reason, Subhūti, that the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya, after fully and perfectly awakening to unsurpassed complete awakening, will teach this very Perfection of Wisdom in this very place, with these very names, these very words, and these very syllables."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how wondrous! This Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, by the purity of form, the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure. Subhūti, likewise, by the purity of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure. Subhūti, by form's having no arising and no cessation, no defilement and no purification, the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure. Subhūti, likewise, by feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness having no arising and no cessation, no defilement and no purification, the Perfection of Wisdom is

utterly pure. Subhūti, by the purity of space, the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure. Subhūti, because form is unstained and utterly without grasping, the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure. Subhūti, likewise, because feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are unstained and utterly without grasping, the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure. Subhūti, because space has no echo and is inexpressible and without object, the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure. Subhūti, because all phenomena, whether staining or unstaining, have no stain, the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, those sons of good family or daughters of good family in whose ears this Perfection of Wisdom has come to resound have also obtained something well obtained. How much more so those who will hold it, carry it, read it, master it thoroughly, recite it aloud, teach it, expound it in detail, chant the scriptures, and repeat it by heart — for them there will arise no disease of the eyes, no disease of the ears, no disease of the nose, no disease of the tongue, no disease of the body will arise. They will not fall into confusion. Because they do not abandon their composure, they will not meet with untimely death. Many hundreds of thousands of divine sons will follow close behind them. On the eighth, the fourteenth, and the fifteenth of the month, wherever any son of good family or daughter of good family who teaches the Dharma comes to expound this Perfection of Wisdom, there and in each such place they will generate exceedingly great merit."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Subhūti: "So it is, Subhūti, so it is. Subhūti, many hundreds of thousands of gods will follow close behind that son of good family or daughter of good family, step by step. Many hundreds of thousands of gods will come to that place. All of them, wishing to hear the Dharma from that teacher who expounds this Perfection of Wisdom, will be guarded, protected, and sheltered. And why is that? Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is the unsurpassed jewel of the world together with its gods, humans, and asuras. Subhūti, for that reason as well, that son of good family or daughter of good family will generate great merit on that basis.

"Subhūti, nevertheless, for one who writes out this profound Perfection of Wisdom, holds it, carries it, reads it, masters it thoroughly, recites it aloud, teaches it, expounds it in detail, chants the scriptures, and repeats it by heart, many obstacles will arise. And why is that? Subhūti, a great jewel draws many

enemies: the more precious it is held to be, the weightier the enmity it draws. Subhūti, this is how it is: this great jewel, the Perfection of Wisdom, is the unsurpassed jewel in the world. It has entered for the benefit and happiness of the world, and it abides indestructibly in order that all phenomena may be seen as unborn and unceasing, and in order that there may be no affliction whatsoever.

"Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom does not abide in any phenomenon, does not engage with any phenomenon, and does not grasp any phenomenon. And why is that? Subhūti, all those phenomena are nonexistent and cannot be apprehended. Subhūti, because it is unborn, the Perfection of Wisdom is unstained. Subhūti, this very word 'unstained' is the Perfection of Wisdom. Subhūti, because form is unstained, the Perfection of Wisdom is unstained. Likewise, because feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are unstained, Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom is unstained.

"Subhūti, even if a bodhisattva, a great being, does not know it to be so, he still practices the Perfection of Wisdom. Subhūti, moreover, this Perfection of Wisdom does not lead anyone into any phenomenon, does not lead anyone decisively into any phenomenon, does not reveal any phenomenon truly, does not reveal any phenomenon definitively, does not cause any phenomenon to be obtained, and does not cause any phenomenon to be definitively obtained."

Then many thousands of divine beings (devas) appeared in the sky, rejoicing and making expressions of wonder, scattering their garments and saying: "How marvelous! It appears that the wheel of Dharma has been turned a second time in Jambudvīpa!"

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable elder Subhūti: "Subhūti, this is not the wheel of Dharma being turned a second time. With respect to any phenomenon whatsoever, there is neither setting in motion nor reversal. Subhūti, it is precisely thus that this is the Perfection of Wisdom of bodhisattvas, great beings."

When the Blessed One had said this, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, this is the great perfection of that bodhisattva, that great being, who has no attachment to any phenomenon whatsoever, who aspires to fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening yet does not fully and perfectly awaken to any phenomenon whatsoever, and who turns the wheel of Dharma yet does not truly reveal any phenomenon whatsoever. Why is this so?

Because there is no phenomenon that could be apprehended and no phenomenon that could be revealed, and there is no one who could turn anything for anyone. Why is this? Because, Blessed One, all phenomena are utterly unestablished, and no phenomenon undergoes reversal or setting in motion. Why is this? Because, Blessed One, all phenomena are unestablished from the very beginning, since all phenomena are empty of inherent nature."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, it is so, it is so. Subhūti, emptiness neither enters in nor reverses. Subhūti, the signless likewise neither enters in nor reverses. Subhūti, the wishless likewise neither enters in nor reverses. Subhūti, in teaching as has been taught here, all phenomena have been taught. Yet no one has taught, no one has heard, no one has understood, no one makes anything directly present, no one is making anything directly present, and no one will make anything directly present. Through this teaching of Dharma, no one has passed fully into nirvāṇa, will pass fully into nirvāṇa, or does not pass fully into nirvāṇa. And through this teaching of Dharma, no one has been established as a recipient of generosity."

When this was said, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, because space does not exist, this is the Perfection of Non-existence. Blessed One, because all phenomena are equally without any referential object, this is the Perfection of Sameness with what is unequal. Blessed One, because of utter emptiness, this is the Perfection of Solitude. Blessed One, because all phenomena have no referential object, this is the Perfection of Non-deception. Blessed One, because there is neither name nor body, this is the Perfection of Non-abiding. Blessed One, because there is neither going nor coming, this is the Perfection of Non-entity. Blessed One, because all phenomena have no conceptual elaboration, this is the Perfection of Inexpressibility. Blessed One, because the five aggregates have no referential object, this is the Perfection of Namelessness. Blessed One, because all phenomena have no going, this is the Perfection of Non-going. Blessed One, because all phenomena have nothing to be grasped, this is the Perfection of Non-seizure."

Blessed One, because all phenomena are possessed of non-relinquishment, this is the Perfection of Non-relinquishment. Blessed One, because all phenomena are not manifestly established, this is the Perfection of Non-arising of All Phenomena. Blessed One, because no agent is to be apprehended, this is the Perfection of No Agent. Blessed One, because all phenomena have no self,

this is the Perfection of No Knower. Blessed One, because death, transference, and birth do not arise, this is the Perfection of Non-transference. Blessed One, because the past extreme, the future extreme, and the present moment are not to be apprehended, this is the Perfection of No Discipline. Blessed One, because non-arising is made known as consciousness, this is the Perfection of Dream, Echo, Optical Illusion, Mirage, and Magical Apparition. Blessed One, because attachment, aversion, and delusion have no essential nature, this is the Perfection of No Affliction Whatsoever. Blessed One, because no support is to be apprehended, this is the Perfection of No Purification. Blessed One, because space is unstained, this is the Perfection of Unstainedness. Blessed One, because all conceit is transcended, this is the Perfection of No Conceptual Elaboration. Blessed One, because there is no agitation, this is the Perfection of No Conceit. Blessed One, because the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, simply abides, this is the Perfection of Immovability. Blessed One, because all phenomena are without inversion in their suchness, this is the Perfection of Freedom from Attachment. Blessed One, because all phenomena are free from conceptuality, this is the Perfection of No Uprising. Blessed One, because the signs of all phenomena are not to be apprehended, this is the Perfection of Peace. Blessed One, because of the perfection of qualities, this is the Perfection of No Fault. Blessed One, because there is no thorough conceptualization, this is the Perfection of No Affliction. Blessed One, because of the ultimate extreme of reality, this is the Perfection of No Sentient Being. Blessed One, because all phenomena have no uprising, this is the Perfection of No Measure. Blessed One, because all phenomena are without fixed adherence, this is the Perfection of Not Apprehending the Two Extremes. Blessed One, because all phenomena are without division, this is the Perfection of Non-differentiation. Blessed One, because śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas have no aspiration toward everything, this is the Perfection of Not Grasping at the Supreme. Blessed One, because conceptuality is inherently at peace, this is the Perfection of Non-conceptuality. Blessed One, because the nature of reality itself is beyond measure, this is the Perfection of the Immeasurable. Blessed One, because all phenomena are without attachment, this is the Perfection of Non-attachment. Blessed One, because all phenomena are unconditioned, this is the Perfection of Impermanence. Blessed One, because all phenomena are equal to space, this is the Perfection of Suffering. Blessed One, because all phenomena are without referential object, this is the Perfection of Emptiness.

Blessed One, because all phenomena are without manifest attachment, this is the Perfection of No-Self. Blessed One, because all phenomena are without manifest establishment, this is the Perfection of Signlessness. Blessed One, because there are no extremities or boundaries whatsoever, this is the Perfection of All Emptiness. Blessed One, because the factors of awakening are without referential object, this is the Perfection of the factors pertaining to awakening, beginning with the close placements of mindfulness. Blessed One, because the three doors of liberation are without referential object, this is the Perfection of Emptiness, Signlessness, and Wishlessness. Blessed One, because these are without referential object, this is the Perfection of the Eight Liberations. Blessed One, because the first dhyāna and the rest are without referential object, this is the Perfection of the Nine Sequential Meditative Absorptions. Blessed One, because suffering and so forth are without referential object, this is the Perfection of the Four Noble Truths. Blessed One, because generosity and so forth are without referential object, this is the Perfection of the Ten Grounds. Blessed One, because there is no forgetting, this is the Perfection of Powers. Blessed One, because there is utter absence of timidity, this is the Perfection of Fearlessness. Blessed One, because all gnosis is without attachment and without obstruction, this is the Perfection of the Individual Perfect Knowledges. Blessed One, because it utterly transcends all enumeration, this is the Perfection of all the unshared qualities of a buddha. Blessed One, because all phenomena abide in the suchness of non-deviation, this is the Perfection of the Tathāgata's Suchness. Blessed One, because all phenomena are without inherent nature, this is the Perfection of Self-Arising. Blessed One, because all aspects of the inherent nature of all phenomena are perfectly known, this very Perfection of Wisdom is the Perfection of the Gnosis of Omniscience.

This concludes the ninth chapter of the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, entitled "The Chapter of Praise."

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The Tenth Fascicle.

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, reflected thus: those sons of good family and daughters of good family into whose ears this Perfection of Wisdom comes to resound will have previously performed service to the Victors of the past, will have planted roots of virtue in the presence of many buddhas, and will have been embraced by good spiritual friends. How much more is this true, then, of those who come to hold, retain, read, thoroughly master, proclaim aloud, teach, expound, recite from transmission, and chant this Perfection of

Wisdom so profound as this — and who, having held, retained, read, thoroughly mastered, proclaimed aloud, taught, expounded, recited from transmission, and chanted it, then train in accordance with suchness, practice in accordance with suchness, and engage in yoga in accordance with suchness. Those persons will not have only meager roots of virtue. Those sons of good family and daughters of good family will have paid homage and made offerings to many buddhas.

And those sons of good family and daughters of good family who will now likewise hear this Perfection of Wisdom, and having heard it will hold it, retain it, read it, thoroughly master it, proclaim it aloud, teach it, expound it, recite it from transmission, and chant it, and who will train in accordance with suchness, practice in accordance with suchness, and engage in yoga in accordance with suchness — those sons of good family and daughters of good family will have heard this Perfection of Wisdom from those Tathāgatas, foe-destroyers, and perfectly complete buddhas of former times, and will have thoroughly inquired of and questioned the Blessed Buddhas concerning this Perfection of Wisdom. Know that those sons of good family and daughters of good family who will not be intimidated, not utterly disheartened, not embarrassed, not ashamed, not turn their minds away, not shrink back and turn away, not be frightened, not be wholly terrified, not fall into habitual terror when this Perfection of Wisdom so profound as this is taught, expounded, and explained — know that such persons have planted roots of virtue in the presence of many buddhas.

Then the venerable Śāriputra, having known with his own mind the following thought arising in the mind of Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family, having generated sincere faith, reflection, and aspiration, and having aroused the mind turned toward awakening regarding this very profound Perfection of Wisdom — its being taught, expounded, and explained — and who will hold, retain, read, thoroughly master, proclaim aloud, teach, expound, recite from transmission, chant, train in accordance with suchness, practice in accordance with suchness, and engage in yoga in accordance with suchness in relation to this Perfection of Wisdom: I will regard such a person as being, in every respect, a bodhisattva, a great being, a non-returning bodhisattva. And why? Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is profound. Those who are of meager roots of virtue, who have not directly heard or thoroughly inquired of the Blessed Buddhas, who are of such a nature

that they have not practiced thus in former times — such persons are incapable of generating aspiration toward this Perfection of Wisdom so profound as this. Blessed One, those sons of good family and daughters of good family who, without aspiring to it, intending to abandon it through non-comprehension — those persons likewise abandoned this very Perfection of Wisdom so profound even in former times when it was taught. And why? Blessed One, because of meager roots of virtue and because they did not practice it in former times, they are utterly incapable of generating any aspiration toward this profound Perfection of Wisdom. And those who will abandon it when this profound Perfection of Wisdom is taught — know them likewise: even in former times they abandoned this very profound Perfection of Wisdom when it was taught. For they had no faith in the teaching of this profound Perfection of Wisdom, no forbearance, no craving for it, no aspiration, no diligence, no clarity of mind, and no devotion toward it. Those persons did not thoroughly inquire of — did not put questions to — the former Blessed Buddhas and the śrāvakas of the buddhas."

Thereupon Śakra, lord of the gods, said to the venerable Śāriputra: "Noble Śāriputra, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound.

That former bodhisattvas, great beings, would fail to be devoted to the teaching of this profound Perfection of Wisdom — what wonder is there in that?

Thereupon Śakra, lord of the gods, said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I pay homage to the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, whoever pays homage to the Perfection of Wisdom pays homage to the wisdom of omniscience."

The Blessed One declared: "Kauśika, it is so, it is exactly so. Kauśika, whoever pays homage to the Perfection of Wisdom pays homage to the wisdom of omniscience. And why is that? Kauśika, the omniscience of the blessed buddhas arises from this very source. And because it arises from the wisdom of omniscience, the Perfection of Wisdom is supremely distinguished. Therefore one should practise this Perfection of Wisdom. One should abide in this Perfection of Wisdom. One should train in yoga upon this Perfection of Wisdom."

Thereupon Śakra, lord of the gods, said again to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, how is it that a bodhisattva, a great being, while practising the Perfection of Wisdom, abides in the Perfection of Wisdom? And how, while practising the Perfection of Wisdom, does one train in yoga upon the Perfection of Wisdom?"

When this was asked, the Blessed One said to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Excellent, Kauśika, excellent! Kauśika, that you intend to inquire of the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha about this matter, and are inquiring — this too is well done by you. Kauśika, this boldness of yours has also arisen through the power of the Buddha.

Kauśika, when a bodhisattva, a great being, practises the Perfection of Wisdom, he does not dwell in form as though thinking 'this is form,' and he does not abide in it. Kauśika, it is precisely in this way — by not dwelling in form as though thinking 'this is form' — that a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in yoga with respect to form. Likewise, he does not dwell in feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness as though thinking 'this is consciousness,' and he does not abide in it. Kauśika, it is precisely in this way — by not dwelling in consciousness as though thinking 'this is consciousness' — that a bodhisattva, a great being, trains in yoga with respect to consciousness.

Kauśika, he does not apply the designation 'form.' Kauśika, by not applying the designation 'form' in this way, he does not abide in form. Kauśika, likewise he does not apply the designation 'feeling,' 'perception,' 'formations,' or 'consciousness.' Kauśika, by not applying the designation 'consciousness' in this way, he does not abide in consciousness. Abiding thus and training in yoga thus — that is how one abides in and trains in yoga upon the Perfection of Wisdom."

Thereupon the venerable Śāriputra said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is unfathomable. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is difficult to grasp. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is immeasurable."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, it is so, it is exactly so. Śāriputra, one does not abide thinking 'form is profound.'

Śāriputra, it is because one does not abide thinking 'form is profound' that one trains in yoga upon form. Likewise with feeling, perception, and formations. Śāriputra, one does not abide thinking 'consciousness is profound,' and it is because one does not abide thinking 'consciousness is profound' that one trains in yoga upon consciousness.

Śāriputra, one does not train in yoga thinking 'form is profound.' Śāriputra, it is because one does not train in yoga thinking 'form is profound' that one does not abide thinking 'form is profound.' Likewise with feeling, perception, and

formations. Śāriputra, one does not train in yoga thinking 'consciousness is profound,' and it is because one does not train in yoga thinking 'consciousness is profound' that one does not abide thinking 'consciousness is profound.'"

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the venerable Śāriputra addressed him thus: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound. It is fitting to expound it in the presence of those great bodhisattvas, bodhisattvas of great being, who have received a prophecy of irreversibility. Why so? Blessed One, such a one will not be despondent, will not become doubtful, will not become confused, and will not fall into dispute."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said to the venerable Śāriputra: "Noble Śāriputra, if this Perfection of Wisdom were expounded before a great bodhisattva, a bodhisattva of great being, who has not yet received a prophecy, what fault could arise?"

At that, the venerable Śāriputra said to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, whatever great bodhisattva, bodhisattva of great being, who has not received a prophecy, comes to see, pay homage to, honor, and hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom, and upon hearing it neither shrinks back, nor is altogether frightened, nor comes to be possessed of fright — know, Kauśika, that such a great bodhisattva has come from far away. Know that he has long entered the vehicle, that his roots of virtue have fully ripened. Before long, without obstruction, he will receive a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Know that he is drawing near to that prophecy.

That great bodhisattva will not pass beyond one, two, or three Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas before receiving a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. And yet he will please those Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, and having pleased them, he will not cause them to withdraw their affection. The very sight of a Tathāgata, with the aid of a prophecy, will be fruitful for him, and from the sight of a Tathāgata he will receive a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. From the time he receives a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening until the very moment of his fully perfect awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete buddhahood, every act of seeing, paying homage to, honoring, and serving Tathāgatas will be fruitful for him."

Then the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, that great bodhisattva, that bodhisattva of great being, who comes to see, pay

homage to, honor, and hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom —

Blessed One, I would venture to say they have come from far away and have long since entered the vehicle with their roots of virtue fully ripened. As for those who, having heard this, will take it up, retain it, read it, master it, recite it, teach it, explain it in detail, transmit it by scriptural authority, and chant it — what need is there even to speak of them?"

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Śāriputra: "Śāriputra, it is indeed so, it is indeed so. Śāriputra, that great bodhisattva, that bodhisattva of great being, who comes to see, pay homage to, honor, and hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom — know, Śāriputra, that such a bodhisattva of great being has come from far away and has long since entered the vehicle with their roots of virtue fully ripened. And as for those who, having heard this, will take it up, retain it, read it, master it, recite it, teach it, explain it in detail, transmit it by scriptural authority, and chant it — what need is there even to speak of them?"

Then the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I am emboldened to offer an analogy. Sugata, I am emboldened. Blessed One, it is like this: suppose a son or daughter of good family, one who belongs to the bodhisattva vehicle, were to dream of sitting at the seat of awakening. Blessed One, that great bodhisattva, that bodhisattva of great being, is close to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, on the verge of fully and perfectly awakening to it. Blessed One, in the same way, any son or daughter of good family who comes to see, pay homage to, honor, and hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom — Blessed One, that person who belongs to the bodhisattva vehicle has come from far away and has long since entered the vehicle with their roots of virtue fully ripened. And as for those who, having heard it, will take it up, retain it, read it, master it, recite it, teach it, explain it in detail, transmit it by scriptural authority, and chant it — what need is there even to speak of them? That person of the bodhisattva vehicle is prophesied and is close to awakening, and know that the Blessed One, the buddha, will give that great bodhisattva a prophecy of fully and perfectly awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. And know that even the great bodhisattva who merely happens to hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom has their roots of virtue long since fully ripened through having entered the vehicle. Blessed One, as for those sons or daughters of good family who will take up, retain, read, master, recite, teach, explain in detail, transmit by scriptural authority, and chant this profound Perfection of Wisdom — what

need is there even to speak of them? For this reason, Blessed One, sentient beings who are impoverished in Dharma, who have accumulated karma concordant with that impoverishment, and who have not for the most part been free of it — their minds will, for the most part, become averse to and turn away from this profound Perfection of Wisdom. Sentient beings who have not accumulated roots of virtue will, for the most part, not enter into and not develop faith in this ultimate truth (pariniṣpanna).

Those sons and daughters of noble family who will enter into and develop faith in this ultimate truth — they are ones who have accumulated roots of virtue. Blessed One, know that they have accumulated roots of virtue to a very high degree.

Blessed One, consider this analogy: a person comes from a wilderness, a desolate region a hundred leagues distant, or two hundred, or three hundred, or four hundred, or five hundred, or even a thousand leagues away. Having come from there, he perceives whatever signs indicate that a village, a town, or a settlement is at hand — signs he had known before: a cowherd or a herdsman, a boundary marker, a pleasant park, a beautiful grove, or other such signs. And upon seeing those earlier signs, he thinks: "Since these familiar signs appear before me in this way, a village, a town, or a settlement must be drawing near." And at that he is relieved, and from then on no thought of hardship arises in his mind.

Blessed One, in the same way, whatever great bodhisattva (bodhisattva) abides close to this profound Perfection of Wisdom — know, Blessed One, that such a great bodhisattva is drawing near to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, and know that such a great bodhisattva will before long receive a prophetic declaration of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Moreover, he will not be frightened and will not be terrified at the prospect of falling to the ground of the śrāvakas or the pratyekabuddhas. And why is that? Because he has seen these earlier signs — namely, the opportunity to view, to pay homage to, to venerate, and to hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom.

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Śāriputra: "Śāriputra, it is so, it is exactly so. Just as all that has been and will be said here is spoken by the power of the buddhas, so too you should be confident in this matter."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One again: "Blessed One, consider this analogy: suppose a person here wishes to see the great ocean. As he goes to view the great ocean, if at some point along the way he sees a tree, or a sign indicating a tree, or a mountain, or a sign indicating a mountain, he thinks: 'The great ocean is still far from here.' But if later he no longer sees trees or signs of trees, or mountains or signs of mountains, he thinks: 'The great ocean is now close at hand.' And why is that? Because the great ocean gradually becomes lower and lower, so that within the great ocean there are no trees, no signs of trees, no mountains, no signs of mountains. And even though the great ocean is not yet directly visible to his eyes, he thinks: 'I have drawn near; from here the great ocean is not far.'

"Blessed One, in the same way, when a great bodhisattva hears this profound Perfection of Wisdom, he should understand: 'Even though the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, have not yet given me a direct prophetic declaration, still I am drawing near and will receive a prophetic declaration of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.' And why is that?"

And this is so in order that they may behold, pay homage to, revere, and hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, consider this further example. When the time of spring draws near, the old leaves fall from the branches of the various trees, and diverse new leaves appear. When the leaves have appeared, the people of Jambudvīpa look upon those forests, see those signs as before, and think: 'Now flowers and fruits will appear before long.' And so they become glad. And why is that? Because such signs as these had previously appeared from the trunks of those trees.

Blessed One, in the same way, when a great bodhisattva draws near in order to behold, pay homage to, revere, and hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom, one should understand that for this great bodhisattva the roots of virtue have fully ripened in relation to this profound Perfection of Wisdom — for it is those very prior roots of virtue that have drawn this profound Perfection of Wisdom close to him.

As for those gods who have previously seen buddhas, they think to themselves: 'Since the signs of a prophetic declaration to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening previously appeared for those earlier great

bodhisattvas, this great bodhisattva will before long receive a prophetic declaration to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.' And thinking thus they become greatly joyful, elated, and filled with delight.

Blessed One, consider yet another example. When a pregnant woman, heavy with child, moves her body she becomes greatly uncomfortable; she has little desire to walk about; she desires only small amounts of food; she becomes drowsy and sleeps little; she speaks little; her strength diminishes; her sufferings increase; she remains mostly sighing and groaning; she has little desire for company; she relies upon, firmly relies upon, cultivates, and habitually engages in the perception that runs counter to her former ways — and she thinks: 'I am experiencing such sensations in my body.' At that time, Blessed One, upon seeing such signs as these, one should understand that this woman will before long give birth to a child.

Blessed One, in the same way, when a great bodhisattva whose roots of virtue have fully ripened draws near in order to behold, pay homage to, revere, and hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom — and upon hearing it delights in it and arouses a mind that seeks the Perfection of Wisdom — at that time, Blessed One, one should understand that this great bodhisattva will before long receive a prophetic declaration to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

When these words were spoken, the Blessed One addressed the venerable Śāriputra and said: "Excellent! Excellent! Śāriputra, you have been emboldened here by the power of the buddhas."

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, it is wonderful that the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, hold these great bodhisattvas well in their care, train them well, and entrust them well."

The Blessed One replied: "Subhūti, it is so. Those great bodhisattvas have entered upon this for the benefit of the many, for the happiness of the many, out of compassion for the world, for the welfare, benefit, and happiness of the great multitude of beings.

out of compassion for gods and humans, wishing to fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and having fully and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, wishing to teach the supreme Dharma.

Then Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, when a great bodhisattva is engaged in this Perfection of Wisdom, how does the practice of the Perfection of Wisdom become perfectly complete?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, if a great bodhisattva engaged in the Perfection of Wisdom does not truly perceive the increase of form, that is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise, if one does not truly perceive what is not feeling, what is not perception, what is not formations, and the increase of consciousness, that is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. If one does not truly perceive the decrease of form, that is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise, if one does not truly perceive what is not feeling, what is not perception, what is not formations, and the decrease of consciousness, that is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. If one does not truly perceive phenomena, that is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. If one does not truly perceive what are not phenomena, that is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. In this way the practice of the Perfection of Wisdom becomes perfectly complete.

Subhūti said: "Blessed One, this teaching is inconceivable."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, form is inconceivable. Likewise, feeling, perception, and formations are inconceivable, and Subhūti, consciousness is inconceivable. Subhūti, if one does not even know that form is said to be inconceivable, that is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. Likewise, if one does not even know that feeling, perception, and formations are inconceivable, and Subhūti, that consciousness is said to be inconceivable, that is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom."

Then the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, who would have faith in this Perfection of Wisdom, so profound as it is?"

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, whatever great bodhisattva has engaged in the Perfection of Wisdom will have faith in this Perfection of Wisdom."

The venerable Śāriputra asked: "Blessed One, how does a great bodhisattva come to have engaged in it? How does one come to bear the name 'one who has engaged in it'?"

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, in this regard a great bodhisattva does not conceptualize with respect to the powers, does not conceptualize with

respect to the fearlessnesses, does not conceptualize with respect to the buddha qualities, and does not conceptualize even with respect to omniscience. And why is that? Śāriputra, the powers are inconceivable, the fearlessnesses are also inconceivable, the buddha qualities are also inconceivable, omniscience is also inconceivable, and all phenomena are also inconceivable. Śāriputra, when a great bodhisattva who has thus engaged in practice does not engage with anything whatsoever, that is practicing the Perfection of Wisdom. Such a one is called 'one who has engaged' and comes to bear the name 'one who has engaged.'"

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound. Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is a mass of precious jewels. Blessed One, for the sake of the purity of space, the Perfection of Wisdom is a mass of purity. Blessed One, it is a wonder that many obstacles should arise for those sons and daughters of good family who hold, retain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by heart, copy out in writing, and study this Perfection of Wisdom."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Subhūti:

"So it is, Subhūti, so it is. Subhūti, for those sons or daughters of good family who hold, retain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by heart, copy out in writing, and study this Perfection of Wisdom, many obstacles will indeed arise. And why is that? Subhūti, it is because the sinful māras strive to create obstacles for those sons and daughters of good family who hold, retain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by heart, copy out in writing, and study this Perfection of Wisdom. Therefore one should copy it out quickly. Even if it takes a month, or two months, or three months to copy, it should still be copied. And if it takes a full year or longer to copy, then, Subhūti, those sons or daughters of good family should still copy this Perfection of Wisdom. And why is that? Subhūti, it is because wherever there is a great precious jewel, many obstacles arise."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, the sinful māras will rouse many kinds of eagerness and make effort to carry out obstructing deeds against those who hold, retain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by heart, copy out in writing, and study this Perfection of Wisdom."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, although the sinful māras will indeed strive to carry out obstructing deeds against those who hold, retain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by heart, copy out in writing, and study this Perfection of Wisdom in this way, nevertheless they are not able to create obstacles for a bodhisattva, a great being, who has not broken his commitment."

Then the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, when māras delight in creating obstacles against those sons and daughters of good family who hold, retain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by heart, copy out in writing, and study this Perfection of Wisdom, how is it, Blessed One, that sons and daughters of good family nowadays come to hold, retain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by heart, copy out in writing, and study this Perfection of Wisdom?"

"Blessed One, through whose power will those sons and daughters of good family come to hold, retain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by heart, copy out in writing, and study this Perfection of Wisdom?"

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Śāriputra:

"Śāriputra, those sons and daughters of good family will come to hold, retain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by heart, copy out in writing, and study this Perfection of Wisdom, and likewise to learn in accordance with suchness, to practice in accordance with suchness, and to engage in yoga in accordance with suchness — all through the power of the blessed buddhas, the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened ones. And why is that? Śāriputra, it is the nature of reality of all phenomena that all those blessed buddhas who dwell, live, and abide in world-systems beyond measure and beyond counting will direct their attention toward and fully embrace this Perfection of Wisdom — toward holding it, retaining it, reading it, mastering it, reciting it aloud, teaching it, explaining it in detail, chanting it by heart, copying it out in writing. And those sons and daughters of good family who come to hold, explain, read, master, recite aloud, teach, explain in detail, chant by heart, copy out in writing, and study this Perfection of Wisdom, and who learn in accordance with suchness, practice in accordance with suchness, and engage in yoga in accordance with suchness — those blessed buddhas will likewise direct their attention toward them and fully

embrace them. Śāriputra, no obstacle can be created against those sons and daughters of good family who are thus attended to and fully embraced by the buddhas."

When this was said, the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, all those bodhisattvas, great beings, who listen to this Perfection of Wisdom, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, explain it in detail, chant it by heart, copy it out in writing, and study it, and who learn in accordance with suchness, practice in accordance with suchness, and engage in yoga in accordance with suchness — all of them, Blessed One, do so through the power of the buddhas, the blessing of the buddhas, and by being fully embraced by the buddhas. It is by that means that they will come to listen to this Perfection of Wisdom, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, explain it in detail, chant it by heart, copy it out in writing, and study it, and to learn in accordance with suchness, practice in accordance with suchness, and engage in yoga in accordance with suchness."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Śāriputra:

"Śāriputra, it is so, it is indeed so.

"Śāriputra, all those great bodhisattvas (bodhisattvas), through the power of the buddhas, the blessing of the buddhas, and by being fully embraced by the buddhas, will come to listen to this profound Perfection of Wisdom, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, explain it in detail, chant it by heart, copy it out in writing, learn in accordance with suchness, practice in accordance with suchness, and engage in yoga in accordance with suchness.

Śāriputra, those great bodhisattvas who listen to this Perfection of Wisdom, hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, explain it in detail, chant it by heart, copy it out in writing, and learn in accordance with suchness, practice in accordance with suchness, and engage in yoga in accordance with suchness — all of them are known by the Tathāgata. Śāriputra, all of them are blessed by the Tathāgata. Śāriputra, all of them are seen by the Tathāgata. Śāriputra, all of them are fully beheld by the Tathāgata with the eye of a buddha.

And having listened, those who have held it, retained it, read it, mastered it, recited it aloud, taught it, explained it in detail, chanted it by heart, copied it

out in writing, and then learned in accordance with suchness, practiced in accordance with suchness, and engaged in yoga in accordance with suchness — they draw near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and they abide in suchness and in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Śāriputra, as for those who copy out this Perfection of Wisdom, retain it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, explain it in detail, chant it by heart, and copy it out in writing, yet do not learn in accordance with suchness, do not practice in accordance with suchness, and do not engage in yoga in accordance with suchness — precisely because they do not learn in accordance with suchness, do not practice in accordance with suchness, and do not engage in yoga in accordance with suchness, they will not abide in suchness and in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Nevertheless, Śāriputra, even they are known by the Tathāgata; even they are blessed by the Tathāgata; even they are seen by the Tathāgata; and, Śāriputra, even they are fully beheld by the Tathāgata with the eye of a buddha.

Śāriputra, their effort and their diligent striving will be endowed with great purpose, great benefit, great fruit, and great karmic maturation. And why is this? Because the Perfection of Wisdom is endowed with the ultimate meaning of all phenomena, and it abides in order that all sentient beings may be made to comprehend things exactly as they are.

Moreover, Śāriputra, these sūtras endowed with the six perfections — even after the Tathāgata has passed away, at the time of the decline of the sacred Dharma, when the core of the Dharma and the Vinaya is obtained, they will arise in the south. From the south they will arise in the middle region. From the middle region they will arise in the north."

"Śāriputra, at that time, those sons of good family and daughters of good family who uphold this Perfection of Wisdom, who bear it, read it, master it thoroughly, proclaim it, teach it, explain it in detail, recite it by scriptural transmission, and chant it aloud — and who, even if only by having it put into a volume, carry it — upon these the Tathāgata looks with intention. These the Tathāgata knows. Śāriputra, these the Tathāgata has blessed. Śāriputra, these the Tathāgata watches over. Śāriputra, these the Tathāgata beholds with the eye of a buddha."

Śāriputra then asked: "Blessed One, will this profound Perfection of Wisdom spread and flourish in the northern lands and the northern regions in the future, in the last age, in the last period?"

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, in the northern lands and the northern regions, those who listen to this profound Perfection of Wisdom and then engage in yoga upon this profound Perfection of Wisdom will become many and flourish.

"Śāriputra, those bodhisattvas, great beings, who listen to this profound Perfection of Wisdom, inquire into it, uphold it, bear it, read it, master it thoroughly, proclaim it, teach it, explain it in detail, recite it by scriptural transmission, chant it aloud, train in suchness, accomplish it in suchness, and engage in yoga upon it in suchness — these should be understood as having entered the vehicle genuinely and for a long time."

Śāriputra asked: "Blessed One, of those bodhisattvas, great beings, in the northern lands and the northern regions who listen to this profound Perfection of Wisdom, inquire into it, uphold it, bear it, read it, master it thoroughly, proclaim it, teach it, explain it in detail, recite it by scriptural transmission, chant it aloud, train in suchness, accomplish it in suchness, and engage in yoga upon it in suchness — how many will there be, few or many?"

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, in the northern lands and the northern regions, bodhisattvas, great beings, will arise in great number, very great number indeed. Śāriputra, although they will be many, among all those many, the bodhisattvas, great beings, who listen to this Perfection of Wisdom, inquire into it, uphold it, bear it, read it, master it thoroughly, proclaim it, teach it, explain it in detail, recite it by scriptural transmission, chant it aloud, train in suchness, accomplish it in suchness, engage in yoga upon it in suchness, and who, when this Perfection of Wisdom is being taught, do not become dejected, do not shrink, do not feel shame, are not embarrassed, do not turn their minds away, are not struck with wonder, do not become afraid, and are not overcome with fear — these will be very few indeed. Such bodhisattvas, great beings, should be understood as having entered the vehicle genuinely and for a long time."

They follow in the wake of the former Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas, having fully questioned them, fully requested instruction from them, and fully inquired of them. Those sons and daughters of good family who belong to the bodhisattva vehicle thereby make offering to the former Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. They will come to perfect their moral discipline completely. Starting from this very unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, they will work for the benefit

of the many.

Why is that? It is because I myself have spoken words connected with omniscience to those sons and daughters of good family. Even as they pass from life to life, they will engage rightly in this very omniscience and in this Perfection of Wisdom. Starting from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, they will speak of that, and they will rejoice in speaking of that. They will dwell well and enter into meditative equipoise upon this Perfection of Wisdom, and even Māra cannot separate them from it — how much less can other sentient beings do so through intent or through the power of mantra! Why is that? It is because they are firmly rooted in unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. When sons and daughters of good family hear this, they will attain great joy, clarity, and profound gladness toward this Perfection of Wisdom. They will plant the roots of virtue of many people with respect to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Why is that? It is because those sons and daughters of good family have spoken these very words in my presence: "While engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, I shall correctly establish, correctly instruct, correctly set forth, correctly praise, correctly gladden, correctly differentiate for, cause to abide in perfect awakening, and cause to become irreversible — many hundreds, many thousands, many hundreds of thousands, many tens of millions, many billions, many hundreds of billions, many tens of billions of times hundreds of thousands of living beings."

Why is that? Regarding those sons and daughters of good family who, while practicing for the sake of awakening, speak these words — "I shall correctly establish, correctly instruct, correctly set forth, correctly praise, correctly gladden, correctly differentiate for, cause to abide in perfect awakening, and cause to become irreversible — many hundreds, many thousands, many hundreds of thousands, many tens of millions, many billions, many hundreds of billions, many tens of billions of times hundreds of thousands of living beings" — having looked upon the minds of those sons and daughters of good family who belong to the bodhisattva vehicle with my own mind, I have rejoiced on their behalf. In this way, those sons and daughters of good family are endowed with vast aspiration. When the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas who are present teach the Dharma,

those who will hear this Perfection of Wisdom in its full extent from the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas will form the

intention to travel to other and yet other buddha-fields. In those buddha-fields as well, they will establish many hundreds of living beings, many thousands of living beings, many hundreds of thousands of living beings, many tens of millions of living beings, many billions of living beings, many hundreds of billions of living beings, many tens of billions of times hundreds of thousands of living beings in unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening — teaching them correctly, setting them on the path, praising them, generating joy in them, revealing the way, and causing them to be awakened and irreversible.

When this was declared, the venerable Śāriputra spoke thus to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, there is nothing whatsoever among the phenomena of past, future, or present that the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas have not seen, not heard, not directly known, or not fully understood. There is no phenomenon they do not fully understand, and no conduct of sentient beings they do not fully understand. Blessed One, it is therefore wonderful that at that very time the Tathāgatas know the conduct of those bodhisattvas, great beings who aspire to awakening, who are endowed with supreme intention, and who have applied diligent effort — those sons and daughters of good family who seek, thoroughly seek, and are on the verge of seeking this profound Perfection of Wisdom for the sake of all sentient beings and for the sake of these six perfections. Among those who seek, thoroughly seek, and are on the verge of seeking, some bodhisattvas will find this profound Perfection of Wisdom when they seek it; some will not find it even when they seek it; and some will find it without even seeking it. Blessed One, what is the cause of this?" So he asked, and the Blessed One spoke thus to the venerable Śāriputra:

"Śāriputra, it is exactly so, it is exactly so. There is nothing whatsoever among the phenomena of past, future, or present that a Tathāgata has not seen, not heard, not known, or not fully understood. Śāriputra, at that very time and in that very moment, some bodhisattvas search for this Perfection of Wisdom, seek it out, and search for it thoroughly, yet do not find it; while some bodhisattvas, though they have not searched, not sought it out, and not searched thoroughly, will find it. Why is this? It is because those bodhisattvas searched and sought out this Perfection of Wisdom in former times without ever abandoning their diligent effort, and thus through the very aspiration rooted in that former virtuous root, they will find this Perfection of Wisdom even without searching, seeking out, or searching for it thoroughly."

Moreover, those other sūtras that proclaim this very Perfection of Wisdom will themselves come close to those bodhisattvas, draw near to them, and approach them. Why is this? Śāriputra, it is as follows: a bodhisattva, a great being, who searches and thoroughly searches for this Perfection of Wisdom without ever abandoning diligent effort — that one, across transmigrations and through successive lives, will find this Perfection of Wisdom; and moreover, those other sūtras endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom will themselves come close to that person, draw near to them, and approach them.

When this had been declared, the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, is it only these sūtras endowed with the six perfections that will come close to, draw near to, and approach those sons and daughters of good family — or will others do so as well?"

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, however many other profound and deep sūtras there may be, all of them will likewise come close to, draw near to, and approach those sons and daughters of good family. Why is this? Śāriputra, it is as follows: those bodhisattvas, those great beings, who establish sentient beings in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, who teach it correctly, who set beings in it rightly, who praise them aright, who cause them to rejoice completely, who clearly expound it and cause beings to abide in perfect complete awakening, who make them irreversible — and who also train themselves in it — Śāriputra, even across subsequent rebirths, the profound and deep sūtras endowed with non-referential cognition (Skt. *anupalambha*), endowed with emptiness, and endowed with the six perfections will themselves come close to those bodhisattvas, draw near to them, and approach them."

This was the tenth chapter of the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, entitled "The Full Enumeration of the Qualities of Holding."

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The eleventh fascicle.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, when the Blessed One fully enumerates these qualities of those sons and daughters of good family, how many obstructing acts of Māra will arise against them?"

When this was asked, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, many works of Māra that create obstacles will arise."

Subhūti asked: "Blessed One, what kinds of numerous works of Māra that create obstacles will arise?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, after a long time has passed, eloquence will arise in those bodhisattvas, those great beings, who are teaching the Perfection of Wisdom. Subhūti, this first arising of eloquence should be recognized as a work of Māra. And even when that eloquence has arisen, it will turn into distraction of mind — this too should be recognized as a work of Māra. Subhūti, if during that time there is yawning, restlessness, fidgeting, and resorting to writing things down — this too should be recognized as a work of Māra. Subhūti, if the mind is pervaded by agitation and scattering — this too should be recognized as a work of Māra."

Subhūti, if they write things down while their consciousnesses are at cross-purposes with one another, this too should be recognized as a work of Māra. Subhūti, if mindfulness is not attained, this too should be recognized as a work of Māra. Subhūti, if they laugh at one another and then write things down, this too should be recognized as a work of Māra. Subhūti, if they chatter with one another and then write things down, this too should be recognized as a work of Māra. Subhūti, if the eyes wander while they are writing things down, this too should be recognized as a work of Māra. Subhūti, if those who are writing things down fall into discord and disagreement with one another, this too should be recognized as a work of Māra. Subhūti, if someone rises from their seat and departs, thinking, "I find no depth in this, I taste no flavor in it," this too should be recognized as a work of Māra. Subhūti, if someone, with a faithless mind, rises from their seat and departs, thinking, "I have received no scriptural transmission from this Perfection of Wisdom," this too should be recognized as a work of Māra.

Subhūti, if someone thinks, "Let no mention be made here of the name of the village, city, or town where I was born; let no mention be made here of my own name and clan; let no mention be made of my father's and mother's names and clan; let no mention be made of the clan into which I was born" — and with that thought refuses to listen to the Perfection of Wisdom and intends to leave — then however many such beings have thus generated the awakening mind, in whatever ways they come to depart, they will grasp at cyclic existence for just that many eons, however long it takes them to turn back and take up the practice of yoga. Why is that? Subhūti, those bodhisattvas, those great beings, who do not listen to this Perfection of Wisdom will not attain definitive emergence from worldly and supramundane phenomena. Subhūti,

this too should be recognized as a work of Māra for them.

Subhūti, furthermore, persons who belong to the bodhisattva vehicle, who abandon and discard this Perfection of Wisdom that accomplishes the gnosis of omniscience, and who intend instead to seek out sūtras that do not accomplish the gnosis of omniscience — this too should be recognized as a work of Māra for them.

Subhūti, just as someone who does not wish to train in worldly and supramundane phenomena and does not wish to attain definitive emergence from worldly and supramundane phenomena will not train in this Perfection of Wisdom — and not having trained in this Perfection of Wisdom will not attain definitive emergence from worldly and supramundane phenomena — so it is that those persons of small understanding, abandoning and discarding the Perfection of Wisdom, which is the very root of fully knowing all worldly and supramundane phenomena just as they are, intend instead to cling to the branches.

Subhūti, consider this analogy: a dog that, in terms of its very nature, has been given up and set aside from a meal that has been set out, and seeks morsels of food from a laboring man. In just the same way, Subhūti, in the future time to come, certain persons who belong to the bodhisattva vehicle, having abandoned this Perfection of Wisdom, which is the root of the gnosis of omniscience, will intend to seek the essence of buddhahood from what are merely branches, leaves, and petals — the vehicles of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Subhūti, this too should be recognized as a work of Māra for those bodhisattvas. Why is that? Because those persons of small understanding do not know that this Perfection of Wisdom is what accomplishes the gnosis of omniscience.

Having abandoned and cast aside this Perfection of Wisdom, they will intend to devote themselves wholeheartedly to other sūtras — those that explicitly teach the ground of the śrāvakas and those that explicitly teach the ground of the pratyekabuddhas. Bodhisattvas of such a disposition should be recognized as ones who have entered upon what are merely branches, leaves, and petals. Why is that? Subhūti, a great bodhisattva (mahāsattva) should not train in the way that persons of the śrāvaka vehicle and persons of the pratyekabuddha vehicle train. Subhūti, how do persons of the śrāvaka vehicle and persons of the pratyekabuddha vehicle train? Subhūti, they think to themselves: "I alone shall be tamed; I alone shall be pacified; I alone shall be led to complete

nirvāṇa." And for the sake of taming, pacifying, and leading themselves alone to complete nirvāṇa, they set out in the endeavor of accumulating all wholesome roots. Subhūti, a great bodhisattva should not train in that way. Rather, Subhūti, a great bodhisattva should train as follows: for the benefit of the entire world, one should abide in suchness oneself and establish all sentient beings in suchness as well, leading the immeasurable realm of sentient beings to complete nirvāṇa. A great bodhisattva should set out in the endeavor of accumulating all wholesome roots in that way, and yet should not be conceited about it.

Subhūti, consider this analogy: a certain person who has never seen an elephant searches for the color and shape of an elephant. He finds an elephant in a dark chamber and examines it there in that dim light. Having examined it there, he then thinks of searching for the elephant's tracks and, through those tracks, of grasping the elephant's color and shape. Subhūti, what do you think — is that person to be recognized as one of wise character? Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, he is not." The Blessed One declared: "In just the same way, Subhūti, a person belonging to the bodhisattva vehicle who, not knowing and not inquiring into this Perfection of Wisdom, sets it aside, yet desires to fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, complete, perfect awakening, and intends to search through sūtras that explicitly teach the ground of the śrāvakas and those that explicitly teach the ground of the pratyekabuddhas — such a one should be recognized as being of such a disposition. Subhūti, this too should be recognized as a work of Māra for those people."

Subhūti, consider this further analogy: a person seeking precious jewels sees a great ocean. Without examining, considering, or entering into it for those jewels, he instead thinks to search for the source of precious jewels in a puddle left by a cow's hoofprint, and imagines that a cow's hoofprint might equal the great ocean. Subhūti, what do you think — is that person to be recognized as one of wise character? Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, he is not." The Blessed One declared: "In just the same way, Subhūti, a person belonging to the bodhisattva vehicle who, even having found this Perfection of Wisdom, fails to realize and know it and discards it, and who, desiring to abide with little effort in sūtras that explicitly teach the ground of the śrāvakas and those that explicitly teach the ground of the pratyekabuddhas, intends to seek them out — such a one should be recognized as being of such a disposition."

Wherever the bodhisattva vehicle is not proclaimed —

"I alone will tame myself, I alone will pacify myself, and I alone will thus pass into nirvāṇa" — thinking in this way, abiding inwardly, one should attain the fruit of stream-entry, the fruit of once-returning, the fruit of non-returning, and the fruit of arhatship; one should attain solitary awakening; and in this very life, having fully liberated the mind from defilements without clinging, one should pass into nirvāṇa. Whoever speaks thus is called one who belongs to the ground of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Therefore a bodhisattva, a great being, should not generate the intention in that way.

Why is that? Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, has properly entered the Great Vehicle and has donned the great armor. Such beings never generate their intention toward what is of little aspiration. Why is that? These noble persons are guides of the world and servants of the world's welfare. Therefore they should always train well, without ceasing, in the six perfections (pāramitās).

Moreover, Subhūti, those persons belonging to the bodhisattva vehicle whose roots of virtue are not yet matured, who are of inferior intelligence and weak superior intention, who neither know nor have penetrated the sūtras endowed with the six perfections — having abandoned and discarded this Perfection of Wisdom, they intend to seek out those sūtras that explicitly teach the grounds of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Subhūti, this conduct of persons belonging to the bodhisattva vehicle who are of such a character should be recognized as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, consider this analogy. A carpenter or a carpenter's apprentice who wishes to build and construct a house to the measure of a royal palace goes in search of the dimensions and proportions of the palace of the sun and moon. In searching for that, he comes upon the palace of the sun and moon and thinks to take its measurements. What do you think, Subhūti? Would one who wishes to build and construct a house to the measure of a royal palace do well to take the measurements of the palace of the sun and moon? Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, indeed not." The Blessed One declared: "In just the same way, Subhūti, certain persons belonging to the bodhisattva vehicle who will appear in future times — hearing this Perfection of Wisdom, finding this Perfection of Wisdom, then abandoning this Perfection of Wisdom and casting it aside — will think to seek out omniscience from sūtras that belong to the ground of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, from sūtras that explicitly teach: 'I alone should tame myself; I alone should pacify myself; I alone should pass into nirvāṇa' — sūtras that, in this manner, teach the taming, pacifying, and

attaining of nirvāṇa for oneself alone. If they think to seek out such sūtras and to train accordingly, then, Subhūti, what do you think? Should those bodhisattvas also be recognized as being of wise character?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, indeed not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, this too should be recognized as the work of Māra in their regard."

Subhūti, consider this further analogy. A certain person who wishes to see a wheel-turning king (cakravartin) comes to see such a king. Having seen him, he fixes in mind the marks of that wheel-turning king's complexion, form, majesty, and miraculous powers — 'this is what they are like.' Then, when he sees a regional king, he takes note of that regional king's complexion, form, majesty, miraculous powers, and marks,

and yet, being unable to distinguish between the two, he says: "That wheel-turning king is exactly like this — the same in complexion, form, majesty, miraculous powers, and marks." Subhūti, what do you think? Should that person, who imagines a wheel-turning king to be equal to a regional king, be recognized as being of wise character? Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, indeed not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, in the same way, those persons of the bodhisattva vehicle who will appear in the future — who hear this Perfection of Wisdom, and who, having obtained this Perfection of Wisdom, then neglect the Perfection of Wisdom, abandon the Perfection of Wisdom, set this Perfection of Wisdom aside at a distance, and instead seek omniscience from sūtras belonging to the level of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas — Subhūti, this too should be recognized as the work of Māra in their regard.

"Subhūti, furthermore, I do not say that great bodhisattvas should seek omniscience from these sūtras belonging to śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Subhūti, nevertheless, without training in the skillful means of great bodhisattvas that the Tathāgata has taught within the Perfection of Wisdom, no great bodhisattva will come to definitely attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And why is that? In other sūtras, the complete fulfillment of a bodhisattva is difficult. Therefore, Subhūti, because the Tathāgata sees clearly these qualities of the Perfection of Wisdom, he teaches this Perfection of Wisdom to great bodhisattvas in many ways — presenting it rightly, setting it forth rightly, extolling it rightly, causing them to rejoice in it rightly, leading them into it rightly, and establishing them in it rightly. When this is done, great bodhisattvas will become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

"Subhūti, what do you think? Those who have obtained and accomplished the irreversible vehicle, the Great Vehicle — if they were to abandon it and instead seek the lesser vehicle, would those bodhisattvas be of wise character?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, indeed not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, consider this analogy. A certain hungry person finds a food of a hundred flavors — a food that is refined, beneficial, refined, pleasant, and that dispels hunger and thirst for the whole duration of life. He abandons it, and instead seeks and finds a sixty-day-old gruel. Having found this sixty-day-old gruel, he abandons the food of a hundred flavors and intends to eat that sixty-day-old gruel. Subhūti, what do you think? Is that person of wise character?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, indeed not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, in just the same way, some bodhisattvas who will appear in the future — who hear this Perfection of Wisdom and, having obtained this Perfection of Wisdom, then neglect the Perfection of Wisdom, abandon the Perfection of Wisdom, set this Perfection of Wisdom aside at a distance, and instead seek sūtras belonging to the vehicle of śrāvakas and the vehicle of pratyekabuddhas —

those sūtras which explicitly reveal the ground of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas — and who then think to seek omniscience and skillful means from them: Subhūti, what do you think? Should those bodhisattvas also be understood to be of wise character?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, indeed not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, this too should be understood as the work of Māra for those bodhisattvas.

Subhūti, here is an analogy. Suppose a certain person finds a priceless, precious jewel and then thinks to make it equivalent to a precious jewel of small value and little worth. Subhūti, what do you think? Should that person be understood to be of wise character?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, indeed not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, in just the same way, some persons of the bodhisattva vehicle who will appear in the future — who hear and obtain this profound, luminous, precious Perfection of Wisdom — and then think to make it equivalent to the vehicle of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and think to seek omniscience and skillful means from the ground of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas: Subhūti, what do you think? Should those bodhisattvas also be understood to be of wise character?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, indeed not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, this too should be understood as the work of Māra for those bodhisattvas.

Subhūti, furthermore, when this profound Perfection of Wisdom is being explained, taught, expounded, held, retained, read, recited, chanted aloud, or being copied down in letters even by a young child, there will arise many an impulse that will cause someone's mind to be distracted. Subhūti, this too should be understood as the work of Māra for those bodhisattvas.

When this had been declared, the venerable Subhūti then said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, can the Perfection of Wisdom be written down in letters?" The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, it cannot. Subhūti, whoever writes the Perfection of Wisdom letter by letter, and then thinks either 'I have written the Perfection of Wisdom' or 'There is no Perfection of Wisdom,' or becomes attached to the letters as the Perfection of Wisdom, or thinks 'Without the letters there is no Perfection of Wisdom' — Subhūti, this too should be understood as the work of Māra for those bodhisattvas.

Subhūti, furthermore, when one is copying the Perfection of Wisdom in letters, mental engagements with objects will arise: mental engagements with villages, towns, hamlets, regions, surrounding districts, and royal palaces will arise; mental engagements with pleasure gardens will arise; mental engagements with teachers will arise; mental engagements with preceptors will arise; mental engagements with thieves will arise; mental engagements with tigers will arise; mental engagements with Viśikhā will arise; mental engagements with Śibikā will arise; mental engagements with prostitutes will arise; mental engagements with pleasure, with suffering, and with fear will arise; mental engagements with women, with men, and with those of indeterminate sex will arise; mental engagements with those who are beloved and those who are not will arise; mental engagements with one's father and mother will arise.

Mental engagements with brothers and sisters will arise; mental engagements with kinsmen and friends will arise; mental engagements with companions and with relatives on the paternal and maternal sides will arise; mental engagements with one's wife, sons, and daughters will arise; mental engagements with one's home, food, and drink will arise; mental engagements with clothing will arise; mental engagements with bedding will arise; mental engagements with the necessities of livelihood will arise; mental engagements with immediate tasks will arise; mental engagements with attachment, with aversion, and with delusion will arise; mental engagements with auspicious times, with good times, and with bad times will arise; mental engagements with songs, with musical instruments, and with dance will arise; mental

engagements with poetry, with song lyrics, and with stories will arise; mental engagements with treatises will arise; mental engagements with conventional conversation will arise; mental engagements with laughter will arise; mental engagements with playfulness and coquetry will arise; mental engagements with sorrow will arise; mental engagements with affliction will arise; mental engagements with self will arise. Subhūti, all these mental engagements and others besides will be brought about by Māra the Evil One, so as to create obstacles for those who expound this Perfection of Wisdom, who teach it, who explain it in detail, who hold it, who preserve it, who read it, who recite it aloud, who chant it by heart, and who, even as a child, copy it in writing — he will create obstacles for them and cause their minds to be distracted. Therefore a bodhisattva, a great being, must recognize all these works of Māra, and having recognized them, must abandon them.

Furthermore, Subhūti, mental engagements with kings will arise; mental engagements with young men will arise; mental engagements with elephants will arise; mental engagements with horses will arise; mental engagements with chariots will arise; mental engagements with watching wheel-spinning jugglery with the hands will arise. Subhūti, these too are to be recognized by those bodhisattvas, those great beings, as works of Māra.

Furthermore, Subhūti, mental engagements with fire will arise; mental engagements with sensual desire will arise; mental engagements with an abundance of wealth and grain will arise. Subhūti, these too are to be recognized by the bodhisattva, the great being, as works of Māra.

Furthermore, Subhūti, for those bodhisattvas, those great beings, who expound this Perfection of Wisdom, who teach it, who explain it in detail, who recite it aloud, who chant it by heart, and who copy it in writing even as a child — Māra the Evil One will come in the guise of a monk and will offer them sūtra collections of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, those that are profound and deeply profound, saying: "Study this. Write this down. Receive the transmission of this. Recite this by heart. From this you will attain omniscience." Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, who is skilled in means will not generate delight in those sūtras. Why is that? Subhūti, although emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness are indeed taught in those sūtra collections,

yet the skillful means of bodhisattvas, great beings, were not taught in them. And those bodhisattvas who do not clearly know the particular gnosis of skillful

means will form the intention to abandon this profound Perfection of Wisdom. Having abandoned this profound Perfection of Wisdom, they will form the intention to seek skillful means from those sūtra collections belonging to the vehicle of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when those who wish to hear the Dharma are endowed with aspiration and wish to take up the Perfection of Wisdom, and yet the Dharma-speaker becomes indolent and is unwilling to teach the Dharma — Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too, because of the discord in the assembly, as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when the Dharma-speaker is free of indolence and wishes to impart the Perfection of Wisdom, and yet those who wish to hear the Dharma become indolent and are burdened with many activities — Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too, because of the discord in the assembly, as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when those who wish to hear the Dharma are endowed with aspiration, and wish to take up, to retain, to read, to master, to recite aloud, and even to copy in writing the Perfection of Wisdom, and they are endowed with understanding, with intelligence, and with mindfulness — and yet the Dharma-speaker travels away to another region, and what he explains is either not comprehended when first stated, or is elaborated upon in such a way that it is still not comprehended, or he simply does not know it clearly — Subhūti, this too will cause discord for one who expounds, teaches, fully teaches, transmits by oral tradition, recites by heart, instructs in, and as a child copies in writing this Perfection of Wisdom. Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when the Dharma-speaker is free of indolence and has clear understanding of the meaning and wishes to impart this Perfection of Wisdom and to have it read — and yet those who wish to hear the Dharma travel away to another region, and what they are told is either not comprehended when first stated, or is elaborated upon in such a way that it is still not comprehended, or they simply do not understand it clearly — Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too, because of the discord in the assembly, as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when the Dharma-speaker is intent on material gain, intent on receiving offerings and veneration, and intent on robes — and yet

those who wish to hear the Dharma have few desires, are content, are deeply secluded, or have no wish to offer wealth — Subhūti, this too will cause discord for one who trains in and copies this Perfection of Wisdom. Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when those who wish to hear the Dharma are endowed with faith, wish to hear this Perfection of Wisdom, wish to absorb its meaning, and wish to give up their wealth — and yet the Dharma-speaker either lacks faith, or has no wish to receive wealth, or has little desire, or has no wish to speak — Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too, because of the lack of harmony in the assembly, as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when those who wish to hear the Dharma are endowed with faith and wish to hear and to absorb the meaning — and yet obstacles to the Dharma arise for the Dharma-speaker such that those sūtra collections are unavailable or cannot be obtained — Subhūti, from this situation too, the Dharma-speaker who cannot find listeners will declare those listeners to be adversarial.

Subhūti, furthermore, one who has heard the Perfection of Wisdom and who wishes to retain it, uphold it, read it, or write it down may find themselves without the support of an assembly. Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when the Dharma-speaker wishes to teach and the Dharma-listener does not wish to listen — one who would retain, uphold, read, or write down the Perfection of Wisdom after hearing it may find themselves without the support of an assembly. Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when the Dharma-listener becomes overwhelmed by sleep and heaviness of body, and being thus afflicted by drowsiness and bodily sluggishness has no wish to listen, while the Dharma-speaker does wish to teach — Subhūti, this too is a lack of harmony in the assembly, and a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize it as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when the Dharma-speaker becomes overwhelmed by sleep and heaviness of body, and being thus afflicted by drowsiness and bodily sluggishness has no wish to teach, while the Dharma-listener does wish to listen — Subhūti, this too constitutes a lack of harmony for one who would write, read, and seek to master the text, and a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize it as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when someone comes to a place where the Perfection of Wisdom is being written, taught, or studied, and there speaks of the miseries of hell-beings, speaks of the miseries of the animal realm, speaks of the miseries of the realm of hungry ghosts, and speaks of the miseries of the bodies of asuras — saying: "Hell-beings suffer in such-and-such ways; the animal realm involves suffering of such-and-such kinds; the realm of hungry ghosts involves suffering of such-and-such kinds; the realm of asuras involves suffering of such-and-such kinds; all conditioned formations are suffering in such-and-such ways — therefore, right here and now, let suffering be utterly uprooted" — Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too, through the lack of harmony in the assembly, as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, furthermore, when someone comes to a place where the Perfection of Wisdom is being written, taught, or studied, and there speaks in praise of the gods — saying: "The gods enjoy such-and-such happiness; the higher realms are happy in such-and-such ways; in the desire realm, sense pleasures are to be enjoyed in such-and-such ways; in the form realm, one enters into the dhyānas in such-and-such meditative equipoise; in the formless absorptions, one rests in such-and-such equanimity; and yet even these, when examined with wisdom, show that all births are suffering — for the Blessed One himself has said: 'Monks, I do not teach the praises of even the slightest achievement in the realms of existence. All conditioned phenomena are impermanent; everything that has gone into existence is suffering; everything in the three realms is empty; all phenomena are without self. Therefore, knowing all those things to be unstable, impermanent, suffering, and subject to change, the wise should attain, right here and now, the fruit of stream-entry, the fruit of once-returning, the fruit of non-returning, and should fully attain arhatship in this very life — let us not encounter again those many sufferings of misfortune and decline'" — and if some bodhisattvas become disheartened upon hearing this, Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize this too, through the lack of harmony in the assembly, as the work of Māra.

Furthermore, Subhūti, whatever monk is a Dharma-teacher will come to delight in solitude alone, while those who are listeners of the Dharma will defer to the assembly. And that Dharma-teacher will say: "To those who attend upon me I will give this Perfection of Wisdom; to those who do not attend upon me I will not give it." Those sons of good family and daughters of good family, though they seek, desire, and with reverence for the Dharma attend upon that Dharma-teacher, will find no opportunity opened to them. And that

Dharma-teacher, desiring some slight material gain yet unwilling to give even that, will set out for whatever place is stricken by famine, where there is no prosperity or well-being, and where there is danger to life. Those listeners of the Dharma, upon hearing from others that famine has broken out in that region, that there is no prosperity or well-being there, and that there is also danger to life in that direction, will recognize this. And that Dharma-teacher will say to those sons of good family: "Sons of good family, as for this region here — if a fear of famine should arise, if you were to go there, you might later come to regret it out of fear of famine." In this way the Dharma-teacher, through subtle means, causes them to turn away. They too become disheartened and understand: "These are the signs of one who drives away, not the signs of one who desires to give. This one does not wish to give." Recognizing this, they will cease to attend upon him.

Subhūti, this too — the questioning, studying, teaching, explaining, reciting, and chanting of this Perfection of Wisdom — will come to be attended by disharmony in the assembly. Subhūti, this too a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize as the work of Māra.

Furthermore, Subhūti, that Dharma-teacher will make his way to a place where there is fear of living creatures, where there is fear of beasts of prey, where there is fear from non-humans — going and dwelling there, in a wilderness of beasts of prey, a wilderness of venomous snakes, a wilderness of bandits, a wilderness of water, a wilderness of famine. And he will say to those listeners of the Dharma: "Sons of good family, know this: I am going to a region where there is fear of living creatures, fear of beasts of prey, fear of carnivores, a wilderness of venomous snakes, a wilderness of bandits, a wilderness of water, a wilderness of famine. Sons of good family, know this — are you capable of enduring these sufferings?" And through this subtle means he causes them to turn away. Then they too become disheartened. Being disheartened, they will not attend upon him and will withdraw.

Subhūti, in the reciting, chanting, and writing down of the Perfection of Wisdom, these obstacles will arise. Subhūti, this too a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognize as the work of Māra, since it results in disharmony in the assembly.

Furthermore, Subhūti, a monk who is a Dharma-teacher will devote himself to the homes of friends and the homes of those who give alms. By thus devoting himself to the homes of friends and to homes where alms are given, he

constantly thinks of going nearby to look in upon the homes of friends and on homes where alms are given. And because of the many activities that come from always looking thus, he will neglect those listeners of the Dharma, thinking: "Just now I have a little errand to attend to."

"I have a little errand to attend to." Subhūti, this too will result in disharmony with respect to the writing out and mastering of the Perfection of Wisdom. Subhūti, this too the great bodhisattvas should recognize as the work of Māra, since it results in disharmony, and having recognized it, they should abandon it.

Subhūti, in this way the wicked Māra strives by every means and with great effort to ensure that no one whatsoever takes up, retains, reads, masters, recites aloud, teaches, explains at length, chants, recites by heart, copies out in writing, or has others copy out this Perfection of Wisdom — striving in all those various ways to bring that about.

Subhūti, therefore all the obstacles that arise causing disharmony — every single one of them — should be recognized by the great bodhisattvas as the work of Māra, and having recognized them, they should abandon them.

When this was said, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, for what reason does the wicked Māra strive by every means and with such great effort to ensure that no one whatsoever takes up, retains, reads, masters, recites aloud, teaches, explains at length, chants, recites by heart, copies out in writing, or has others copy out this Perfection of Wisdom?"

When this was said, the Blessed One replied to the venerable Subhūti as follows: "Subhūti, the omniscience of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is born from the Perfection of Wisdom. The teaching of the Tathāgata arises from omniscience. From the teaching of the Tathāgata arises the abandonment of the afflictions of immeasurable, incalculable, and inconceivable sentient beings. When afflictions are abandoned, the wicked Māra finds no opportunity. Finding none, he is tormented and made miserable by suffering, and is pierced to the core by the arrow of grief.

For this reason, he harbors intense displeasure toward those who copy out the Perfection of Wisdom, master it, or study it, and he strives with great effort and exertion by every means to ensure that no one whatsoever copies out, masters, or studies this Perfection of Wisdom, working in all those ways toward that end.

Subhūti, furthermore, the wicked Māra comes in the guise of a śramaṇa to cause divisions. He causes those sons of good family who are newly entered upon the vehicle, who are of lesser intelligence, weaker intelligence, and inferior intelligence, who are immature, and who have not yet received a prophecy of unsurpassed and perfect awakening — those bodhisattvas newly entered upon the vehicle — to be separated from it by saying: 'Venerable friend, what you are listening to is not the Perfection of Wisdom. Now, what is included in and belongs to my sūtras — that is the Perfection of Wisdom.' In this way, Subhūti, the wicked Māra causes them to give rise to doubt and leads them to rejection.

And so, Subhūti, the wicked Māra, having come in the guise of a śramaṇa and made this division, causes those bodhisattvas newly entered upon the vehicle — of lesser, weaker, and inferior intelligence, who are immature and have not yet received a prophecy of unsurpassed and perfect awakening — to fall into doubt."

Having fallen into doubt, they will neither take up, retain, recite, master, intone aloud, teach, explain in detail, transmit as scripture, chant, write down, nor, while young, apply themselves to writing this Perfection of Wisdom. Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognise this too as the work of Māra.

Furthermore, Subhūti, the wicked Māra, having transformed himself into a monk and come in the appearance of a buddha, says to whatever bodhisattva is engaged in these profound teachings: "This one is realising the ultimate limit — he will become a śrāvaka, not a bodhisattva. For example, a bodhisattva is just like this." In this way he employs the work of Māra. Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, should recognise this too as the work of Māra.

Subhūti, when someone is writing down this Perfection of Wisdom, mastering it, or studying it, many other and varied works of the wicked Māra will arise. A bodhisattva, a great being, should recognise them, and having recognised them, utterly abandon them and not rely upon them. Instead, one should apply diligent effort and be ever possessed of mindfulness and vigilance.

When these words had been spoken, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, it is indeed so; Sugata, it is indeed so. Great and precious jewels — those have many enemies. And why? Blessed One, it is because they are rare and valuable, and because they are wealth. It is on account of that that they have many enemies. In the same way,

Blessed One, many obstacles will arise with respect to this Perfection of Wisdom as well. Blessed One, those who become lazy on account of those who create obstacles — those bodhisattvas who intend not to take up, retain, recite, master, intone aloud, teach, explain in detail, transmit as scripture, chant, write down, or, while young, to apply themselves to writing this Perfection of Wisdom — those bodhisattvas, Blessed One, are ones blessed by Māra. Blessed One, they are ones newly entered upon the vehicle. They are of lesser intelligence, of inferior intelligence, of weak intelligence. Blessed One, their understanding is inverted, and their minds, I know, do not enter into the vast and expansive teachings."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, it is indeed so, it is indeed so. Those bodhisattvas who intend not to take up, retain, recite, master, intone aloud, teach, explain in detail, transmit as scripture, chant, write down, or, while young, to apply themselves to writing this Perfection of Wisdom — Subhūti, know those bodhisattvas to be ones blessed by Māra. Subhūti, those bodhisattvas are newly entered upon the vehicle. They are ones of lesser intelligence. They are ones of inferior intelligence. They are ones of weak intelligence."

"Subhūti, those are ones of inverted intelligence. They will not direct their minds toward the vast, immeasurable Dharma teachings. Subhūti, in just this way, the works of Māra will arise, and many of Māra's faults and obstacles will appear. Yet even so, Subhūti, those who intend to take up, retain, recite, master, intone aloud, teach, explain in detail, transmit as scripture, chant, write down, or, while young, to apply themselves to writing this Perfection of Wisdom — Subhūti, know that they do all this through the power of the buddhas, the blessing of the buddhas, and the embrace of the buddhas. Why is that? Because the evil Māra strives with great effort to create obstacles to this, and the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha likewise strives with great effort to embrace and protect it."

This concludes the eleventh chapter of the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, the chapter on the works of Māra.

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, the twelfth fascicle.

Then once again the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, consider this example. There is a certain woman who has many children — five, or ten, or twenty, or thirty, or forty, or fifty, or a hundred, or a thousand, or a hundred thousand. When she becomes the mother of all of

them, those children strive and make every effort so that no harm may come to their mother's life, that their mother may live long, that their mother's body may not become unwell, that their mother may remain at ease for a long time, that no misfortune may befall their mother, that no feeling of suffering may arise in their mother, that she may lack nothing she needs to know, and that nothing unpleasant may arise in her body. Why? Because they think: 'She bore us, she endured hardship for us, she gave us our lives, she is the one who shows us the world.' So those children attend their mother with every form of care and comfort, wishing that no sensation of suffering or painful contact whatsoever should arise in her. And if it should occur that wind, bile, phlegm, a combination of these, an insect, a flesh-worm, a venomous snake, a human being, a non-human being, a flowing sickness, a wasting disease, a sudden fright, or something unwanted should arise and afflict the eyes, ears, nose, tongue, body, or mind of their mother — then those children think of their mother in just that way, and with every form of care and comfort they tend to her, cherish her, nurture her, thinking: 'This one who bore us and brought us joy, this one who gave us our lives and shows us the world.' They tend her, cherish her, nurture her, and make her their own. Subhūti, in just the same way, the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, look upon this Perfection of Wisdom with deep regard, and all those who write it down, take it up, retain it, recite it, master it, intone it aloud, teach it, explain it in detail, transmit it as scripture, or chant it — all of these they bring about through the power, the blessing, and the intent of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas."

In other world-systems, however many Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas there are who dwell and live and abide at this very time out of compassion — compassion for the benefit of the many, for the happiness of the many, out of loving concern for the world, for the welfare, benefit, and happiness of the great multitude, out of compassionate care for gods, humans, and all sentient beings — every one of them, too, looks with deep regard upon this very Perfection of Wisdom, and acts to ensure that this Perfection of Wisdom will endure for a long time, that the very name of this Perfection of Wisdom will not be destroyed, and that māras of evil disposition or gods belonging to the hosts of Māra will not be able to create obstacles for those who teach this Perfection of Wisdom, write it down in letters, or study it. In just this way, Subhūti, the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas cherish this Perfection of Wisdom, make it their own, and

guard it. Why? Because this is the mother of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — she who gives birth to them, she who reveals omniscience, she who reveals it throughout all the world.

Subhūti, the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas are born from this. Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is that which generates and reveals the gnosis of omniscience in the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — and thus reveals it throughout this entire world.

Subhūti, the omniscience of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas is born from this.

Subhūti, all those Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas who in times past manifestly and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — every one of them did so in dependence upon this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, all those Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas who in later, future times will manifestly and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — every one of them will do so in dependence upon this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, at the present time, in immeasurable and innumerable world-systems in the ten directions, all those Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas who dwell and live and abide out of compassion — compassion for the benefit of the many, for the happiness of the many, out of loving concern for the world, for the welfare, benefit, and happiness of the great multitude, out of compassionate care for gods, humans, and all sentient beings — and who have manifestly and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening: every one of them has done so in dependence upon this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, I myself, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, have also awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening in dependence upon this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, it is thus: this Perfection of Wisdom gives birth to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. And being so, it reveals the world to them all.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, you have declared that the Perfection of Wisdom reveals this

world to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. Blessed One, how does the Perfection of Wisdom reveal the world to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas? What is it that the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas have proclaimed as 'the world'?"

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, the Tathāgata has proclaimed the five aggregates as 'the world.' And what are the five? They are as follows: form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. Subhūti, these five aggregates are what the Tathāgata has proclaimed as 'the world.'"

Subhūti then asked: "Blessed One, how has the Perfection of Wisdom shown the five aggregates to the Tathāgata? Blessed One, what has the Perfection of Wisdom shown?"

The Blessed One then spoke thus to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, because they neither perish nor utterly perish, the Perfection of Wisdom has shown the five aggregates as 'the world' to the Tathāgatas. And why are they taught as 'neither perishing nor utterly perishing'? Subhūti, it is because the five aggregates, being without essential nature, have the essential nature of emptiness. And emptiness, Subhūti, is neither perishing nor utterly perishing. Thus, Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom reveals this world to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas.

Subhūti, because it is signless, wishless, non-conditioning, unborn, without substantial existence, and because the dharmadhātu neither perishes nor utterly perishes — thus, Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom reveals this world to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this very Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that sentient beings are immeasurable and innumerable. Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that sentient beings are immeasurable and innumerable? It is, Subhūti, because sentient beings are without essential nature. Because they are without essential nature, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that sentient beings are immeasurable and innumerable. Thus, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are,

that sentient beings, immeasurable and innumerable as they are, are exactly what they are.

Furthermore, Subhūti, because sentient beings are without substantial existence, the Tathāgata has also perfectly and thoroughly known the mental activities of those immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings. Thus, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, the immeasurable and innumerable mental activities of those immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings."

Subhūti, it is in just this way that the Perfection of Wisdom reveals this world to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the collected minds of immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings are exactly what they are — collected minds.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the collected minds of immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings are exactly collected minds? He has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that those collected minds, together with their collectedness, are exhausted, and that even that exhaustion is itself without exhaustion. It is in just this way, Subhūti, that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the collected minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly collected minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the distracted minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly distracted minds.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the distracted minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly distracted minds? Subhūti, those minds that are distracted from the nature of reality are without defining characteristics; those minds are inexhaustible and utterly inexhaustible — and those very minds, undistracted, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are. It is in just this way, Subhūti, that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has

perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the distracted minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly distracted minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the immeasurable and inexhaustible minds of immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings are exactly immeasurable and inexhaustible minds.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the immeasurable and inexhaustible minds of immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings are exactly immeasurable and inexhaustible minds? Subhūti, by that very fact that mind is immeasurable and inexhaustible like space, the one who has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as it is, that mind is immeasurable and inexhaustible — that mind itself has been blessed by the Tathāgata; it is without cessation, without arising, without abiding, without support, immeasurable, and inexhaustible. It is in just this way, Subhūti, that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the immeasurable and inexhaustible minds of immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings are exactly immeasurable and inexhaustible minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the thoroughly afflicted minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly thoroughly afflicted minds.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the thoroughly afflicted minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly thoroughly afflicted minds?

Subhūti, those minds have not actually become thoroughly afflicted by affliction, and there is nothing to which a label can be affixed. It is in just this way, Subhūti, that in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the thoroughly afflicted minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly thoroughly afflicted minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the unafflicted minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly unafflicted

minds.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the unafflicted minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly unafflicted minds? Subhūti, those minds are luminous by nature. It is in just this way, Subhūti, that in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the unafflicted minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly unafflicted minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the abiding minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly abiding minds.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the abiding minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly abiding minds? Subhūti, those minds abide without foundation. It is in just this way, Subhūti, that in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the abiding minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly abiding minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the thoroughly grasping minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly thoroughly grasping minds.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the thoroughly grasping minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly thoroughly grasping minds? Subhūti, those minds are not grasped and are not something to be thoroughly grasped. It is in just this way, Subhūti, that in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the thoroughly grasping minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly thoroughly grasping minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the defiled minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly defiled minds.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the

defiled minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly defiled minds? Subhūti, those minds have no essential nature and are like what does not exist.

In this way, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the defiled minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly defiled minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the undefiled minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly undefiled minds.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the undefiled minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly undefiled minds? Subhūti, those minds are spontaneously accomplished by way of inclining toward the absence of inherent existence. In this way, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the undefiled minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly undefiled minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with attachment of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with attachment.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with attachment of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with attachment? Subhūti, whatever is the mind's attachment is not the mind's true suchness, and whatever is the mind's true suchness is not a mind with attachment. In this way, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with attachment of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with attachment.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds free from attachment of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds free from attachment.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds free from attachment of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds free from attachment? Subhūti, whatever is the freedom of the mind is not itself a mind with attachment, and whatever is the true suchness of a mind free from attachment is not a mind with attachment. In this way, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds free from attachment of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds free from attachment.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with aversion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with aversion.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with aversion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with aversion?

Subhūti, whatever mind is accompanied by aversion is not the true reality of mind, just as it is. Whatever is the true reality of mind, just as it is, that is not a mind accompanied by aversion. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with aversion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with aversion.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds free from aversion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds free from aversion.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds free from aversion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds free from aversion?

Subhūti, whatever is freedom in mind is not a mind accompanied by aversion, and whatever is the true reality of a mind free from aversion, just as it is, is not a mind accompanied by aversion. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds free from aversion of

immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds free from aversion.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with delusion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with delusion.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with delusion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with delusion?

Subhūti, whatever mind is accompanied by delusion is not the true reality of mind, just as it is. Whatever is the true reality of mind, just as it is, that is not a mind accompanied by delusion. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with delusion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with delusion.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds free from delusion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds free from delusion.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds free from delusion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds free from delusion?

Subhūti, whatever is freedom in mind is not a mind accompanied by delusion, and whatever is the true reality of a mind free from delusion, just as it is, is not a mind accompanied by delusion. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds free from delusion of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds free from delusion.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that are not vast of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that are not vast.

"Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds

that are not vast of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that are not vast? Subhūti, those minds belong to the category of minds without arousal — without arousal in the sense of being unaccompanied by arousal." Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that are not vast of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that are not vast.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the vast minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly vast minds.

Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the vast minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly vast minds? Subhūti, those minds neither diminish nor increase, and because those minds are without separation, they are without distinction. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the vast minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly vast minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that have not become great of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that have not become great.

Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that have not become great of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that have not become great? Subhūti, those minds belong to the category of minds without coming and without going. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that have not become great of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that have not become great.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that have become great of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that have become great.

Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that have become great of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that have become great? Subhūti, those minds are equal through their very equanimity — equal through their essential nature. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that have become great of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that have become great.

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the immeasurable minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly immeasurable minds.

"Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the immeasurable minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly immeasurable minds?" "Subhūti, those minds are immeasurable because they are without support. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the immeasurable minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly immeasurable minds."

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that can be indicated of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that can be indicated.

"Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that can be indicated of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that can be indicated?" "Subhūti, those minds and the essential nature of mind are equally indicated. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that can be indicated of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that can be indicated."

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that cannot be indicated of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly

minds that cannot be indicated.

"Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that cannot be indicated of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that cannot be indicated?" "Subhūti, because that mind is without characteristic mark and devoid of any referential object, it does not appear — it has not become manifest to the three eyes or to all eyes. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds that cannot be indicated of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds that cannot be indicated."

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with obstruction of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with obstruction.

"Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with obstruction of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with obstruction?" "Subhūti, those minds impute what does not exist — they are subject to the apprehension of emptiness as an object. Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with obstruction of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with obstruction."

Furthermore, Subhūti, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds without obstruction of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds without obstruction.

"Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds without obstruction of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds without obstruction?" Thus, Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds without obstruction of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds without obstruction.

"Subhūti, those minds have come to arise without there ever having occurred a becoming of non-duality. Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds without obstruction of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds without obstruction.

"Subhūti, furthermore, the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with something superior of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with something superior. Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with something superior of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with something superior? Subhūti, with regard to whatever is the true suchness of a mind with something superior, there is in it no conceit. Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with something superior of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with something superior.

"Subhūti, furthermore, the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with nothing superior of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with nothing superior. Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with nothing superior of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with nothing superior? Subhūti, those minds are free from conceptual elaboration because not even the most subtle atom of mind is apprehended. Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds with nothing superior of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds with nothing superior.

"Subhūti, furthermore, the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds not in meditative equipoise of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds not in meditative equipoise. Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds not in meditative equipoise of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds not in meditative equipoise? Subhūti, those minds enter into non-evenness by means of the even and the

non-even, and it is in just this way that they are minds not in meditative equipoise. Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds not in meditative equipoise of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds not in meditative equipoise.

"Subhūti, furthermore, the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds in meditative equipoise of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds in meditative equipoise. Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds in meditative equipoise of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds in meditative equipoise? Subhūti, those minds enter into evenness by means of the even and the even, and those minds in meditative equipoise in this way are comparable to space. Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds in meditative equipoise of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly minds in meditative equipoise."

"Furthermore, Subhūti, the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the unfreed minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly unfreed minds. Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the unfreed minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly unfreed minds? Subhūti, those minds are by their very nature freed — their nature is one of having no intrinsic existence. It is in this way, Subhūti, that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the unfreed minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly unfreed minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the freed minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly freed minds. Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the freed minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly freed minds? Subhūti, because mind is non-existent, the Tathāgata does not apprehend mind as past, does not apprehend it as future, and does not apprehend it as presently arisen. It is in

this way, Subhūti, that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the freed minds of immeasurable sentient beings are exactly freed minds.

Furthermore, Subhūti, the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds of immeasurable sentient beings that are invisible are exactly invisible minds. Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds of immeasurable sentient beings that are invisible are exactly invisible minds? Subhūti, because mind is non-existent, it is in that way non-existent; because it has not arisen, it cannot be cognized; and because it is not fully established, it cannot be apprehended even by the eye of wisdom or the divine eye — since it does not appear to anyone at all, what need is there to speak of seeing it with the fleshly eye? It is in this way, Subhūti, that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, that the minds of immeasurable sentient beings that are invisible are exactly invisible minds.

Subhūti, it is in this way that the Perfection of Wisdom reveals this world to the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas.

Furthermore, Subhūti, the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, the open and closed states of immeasurable and innumerable other sentient beings and other persons — knowing their open states as open and their closed states as closed. Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata, in dependence upon this Perfection of Wisdom, has perfectly and thoroughly known, just as they are, the open and closed states of immeasurable and innumerable other sentient beings and other persons? Subhūti, it is because every birth among them is perfectly and thoroughly known, just as it is, as abiding in form and arising in form."

Subhūti, in just the same way, every birth among them is perfectly and thoroughly known, just as it is, as abiding in feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness and arising in them.

Subhūti, how does the Tathāgata come to know perfectly those open and closed states as abiding in form, and in just the same way, how does he come to know perfectly those open and closed states as abiding in feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness? The view that "after death, a

thus-gone one arises" — this is grounded in form. The view that "after death, a thus-gone one does not arise" — this is grounded in form. The view that "after death, a thus-gone one both arises and does not arise" — this is grounded in form. The view that "after death, a thus-gone one neither arises nor does not arise" — this is grounded in form. And likewise with feeling, perception, and formations: the view that "after death, a thus-gone one arises" — this is grounded in consciousness. The view that "after death, a thus-gone one does not arise" — this is grounded in consciousness. The view that "after death, a thus-gone one both arises and does not arise" — this is grounded in consciousness. The view that "after death, a thus-gone one neither arises nor does not arise" — this is grounded in consciousness.

The view that "the self and the world are permanent — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in form. The view that "the self and the world are impermanent — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in form. The view that "the self and the world are both permanent and impermanent — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in form. The view that "the self and the world are neither permanent nor impermanent — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in form. And likewise with feeling, perception, and formations: the view that "the self and the world are permanent — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in consciousness. The view that "the self and the world are impermanent — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in consciousness. The view that "the self and the world are both permanent and impermanent — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in consciousness. The view that "the self and the world are neither permanent nor impermanent — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in consciousness.

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, the thirteenth fascicle.

The view that "the self and the world are finite — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in form. The view that "the self and the world are infinite — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in form. The view that "the self and the world are both finite and infinite — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in form. The view that "the self and the world are neither finite nor infinite — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in form. And likewise with feeling, perception, and formations: the view that "the self and the world are finite — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in consciousness.

The view that "the self and the world are infinite — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in consciousness. The view that "the self and the world are both finite and infinite — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in consciousness. The view that "the self and the world are neither finite nor infinite — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in consciousness. The view that "the vital principle and the body are one and the same — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in form. The view that "the vital principle is one thing and the body is another — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in form. And likewise with feeling, perception, and formations: the view that "the vital principle and the body are one and the same — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in consciousness. The view that "the vital principle is one thing and the body is another — this alone is true, all else is delusion" — this is grounded in consciousness.

Subhūti, it is in this way that the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, relying on this Perfection of Wisdom, came to know distinctly how the open and the closed among immeasurable, countless other sentient beings and other persons are grounded in form. And in the same way he came to know distinctly how those who are open and those who are closed are grounded in feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. Furthermore, Subhūti, relying on this Perfection of Wisdom, the Tathāgata fully knows, just as it truly is, how the open and the closed among immeasurable, countless other sentient beings and other persons stand.

How, Subhūti, does the Tathāgata, relying on this Perfection of Wisdom, fully know, just as it truly is, how the open and the closed among immeasurable, countless other sentient beings and other persons stand? Subhūti, in this regard the Tathāgata knows form. How does the Tathāgata know form? Subhūti, the Tathāgata knows form just as suchness is — that is how the Tathāgata knows form. And likewise with feeling, perception, and formations. Subhūti, in this regard the Tathāgata knows consciousness. How does the Tathāgata know consciousness? Subhūti, the Tathāgata knows consciousness just as suchness is — that is how the Tathāgata knows consciousness.

Thus, Subhūti, it is by this means that the Tathāgata fully knows, in accordance with right view, how the open and the closed among immeasurable, countless other sentient beings and other persons stand. And so, Subhūti, with regard to suchness, the Tathāgata designates the suchness

of the Tathāgata, the suchness of the aggregates, and the suchness of the open and the closed as one undivided suchness.

Whatever is the suchness of the aggregates — that itself is the suchness of the world. Why is this? Subhūti, the Tathāgata has declared in name that the five aggregates are the world. Therefore, Subhūti, whatever is the suchness of the aggregates — that is the suchness of the world. Whatever is the suchness of the world — that is the suchness of all phenomena. Whatever is the suchness of all phenomena — that is the suchness of the fruit of stream-entry.

Whatever is the suchness of the fruit of stream-entry — that itself is the suchness of the fruit of once-returning. Whatever is the suchness of the fruit of once-returning — that itself is the suchness of the fruit of non-returning. Whatever is the suchness of the fruit of non-returning — that itself is the suchness of the fruit of arhatship. Whatever is the suchness of the fruit of arhatship — that itself is the suchness of the pratyekabuddha. Whatever is the suchness of the pratyekabuddha — that itself is the suchness of the Tathāgata. And so, Subhūti, the suchness of the Tathāgata, the suchness of the aggregates, the suchness of all phenomena, and the suchness of all noble śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas — this is one undivided suchness, free from the many that are the open and the closed: because it is not one, because it is not other, because it is inexhaustible, because it is changeless, because it is non-dual, and because it cannot be made into two.

Subhūti, it is in reliance upon this Perfection of Wisdom that the Tathāgata has fully and perfectly awakened to this suchness. Subhūti, therefore this Perfection of Wisdom reveals this world to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. Subhūti, therefore the Tathāgata reveals this world to the world with perfect accuracy, and in just this way the world in its entirety is revealed. Subhūti, therefore this Perfection of Wisdom is the mother, the progenitor, and the one who gives birth to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas.

Subhūti, having fully and perfectly awakened to suchness, the Tathāgata knows the suchness of the world. He knows suchness as it is, without distortion. He knows suchness as it is, without otherness. Subhūti, because the Tathāgata has fully and perfectly awakened to suchness, he is called Tathāgata.

The elder Subhūti then said: Blessed One, suchness is profound. It is from that suchness, Blessed One, that the awakening of the blessed buddhas is fully

disclosed and fully revealed. Blessed One, who else would place trust in this? Those who would are irreversible bodhisattvas, great beings; or arhats whose discriminative understanding is fully perfected; or those persons whose view is complete and excellent. Blessed One, these supremely profound matters were spoken by the Tathāgata after he had fully and perfectly awakened.

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke thus to the venerable Subhūti: So it is, Subhūti, so it is. The Tathāgata has taught these supremely profound matters after fully and perfectly awakening to them. Subhūti, this suchness to which the Tathāgata has fully and perfectly awakened is inexhaustible, and having fully and perfectly awakened, he has taught the inexhaustible as inexhaustible.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, along with twenty thousand sons of the gods from among the gods of the desire realm who dwell in that realm, and sons of the gods of the Brahmā realms, came and approached the Blessed One, and having bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, they stood to one side. Standing to one side, those sons of the gods of the desire realm and the form realm spoke to the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, when such profound Dharma is fully taught, Blessed One, what characteristic is to be assigned to it?

The Blessed One declared: Sons of the gods, the characteristic assigned to it is this: it is empty.

Sons of the gods, the characteristics assigned to it are these: it is signless; it is wishless. Sons of the gods, it is unborn; it is unceasing; it is without defilement; it is without purification; it is without substantial existence; it is nirvāṇa; it is the dharmadhātu; it is suchness. Such are the characteristics assigned to it. And why? Sons of the gods, these characteristics are non-abiding characteristics; these characteristics are like space. Sons of the gods, these characteristics were not established by the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. These characteristics are not to be reckoned as form, nor are they to be reckoned as feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. These characteristics do not rest upon form, nor do they rest upon feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. These characteristics were not established by gods, humans, or non-humans. These characteristics cannot be moved by the world together with its gods, humans, and asuras. And why? Because the world together with its gods, humans, and asuras is itself entirely exhausted within these very characteristics. These

characteristics were not placed there by anyone's hand. Sons of the gods, if someone were to say, "Who established this space?" — sons of the gods, would that be speaking the truth? When he had spoken thus, those sons of the gods of the desire realm and the form realm said to the Blessed One: Blessed One, space was not established by anyone. And why? Blessed One, space is unconditioned, and therefore space was not established by anyone. Then the Blessed One declared to those sons of the gods of the desire realm and the form realm: Sons of the gods, so it is, so it is. Whether Tathāgatas arise or whether Tathāgatas do not arise, these characteristics abide just as they are. And why? Because it is just as these abide that the Tathāgata, having fully and perfectly awakened, teaches them. Therefore, sons of the gods, the Tathāgata is called "Tathāgata."

Then the venerable Subhūti said this to the Blessed One: Blessed One, the Tathāgata has fully and perfectly awakened to these profound characteristics — namely, that the Perfection of Wisdom is the unattached wisdom of the Tathāgatas. Because it is the unattached wisdom, the Perfection of Wisdom is the domain of the Tathāgatas. When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Subhūti: Subhūti, so it is, so it is. Subhūti, in just this way the Perfection of Wisdom correctly reveals this world to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. Subhūti, just as the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas rely upon and abide in this Dharma of the Perfection of Wisdom, and because they do not abide in those very dharmas in the way they truly are, they abide permanently — and in just the same way the Tathāgata fully and perfectly awakens, and therefore they rely upon and abide in the Dharma itself alone. They honor the Dharma. They hold it as supreme. They venerate it. They revere it. They take it as their emblem. They pay homage to it. Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom is the nature of reality of all dharmas.

Therefore, the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas honor the Perfection of Wisdom, hold it as supreme, revere it, venerate it, take it as their emblem, and pay homage to it. And why is that? Subhūti, it is from this Perfection of Wisdom that omniscience is fully unfolded for the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. The Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas are those who know what has been done and feel what has been done.

Subhūti, when someone says, "The Tathāgata knows what has been done and feels what has been done," that person speaks with right speech. When one

says, "He knows what has been done and feels what has been done," that is speech spoken with right speech.

Now, Subhūti, how is it that the Tathāgata knows what has been done and feels what has been done? Subhūti, by those very vehicles by which the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha has traveled and accomplished — by those very vehicles and accomplishments by which he has fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — it is by that very knowing and feeling of what has been done that the Tathāgata upholds and maintains them. Subhūti, this is to be understood as the Tathāgata's knowing what has been done and feeling what has been done.

Furthermore, Subhūti, the Tathāgata has fully and perfectly awakened to all phenomena as uncreated — as simply uncreated. He has fully and perfectly awakened to them as unchanging — as simply unchanging. He has fully and perfectly awakened to them as not explicitly conditioned — as simply not explicitly conditioned. Subhūti, this too is to be understood as the Tathāgata's knowing what has been done and feeling what has been done.

Subhūti, by relying upon the Perfection of Wisdom, the gnosis of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas enters into all phenomena. Subhūti, by this synonym as well, the Perfection of Wisdom is what correctly reveals this world to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas.

When this had been declared, the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, when there is no knower and no seer of all phenomena, how does the Perfection of Wisdom correctly reveal this world to the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas?"

When this had been asked, the Blessed One spoke thus to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, that you intend to ask and inquire of the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha about such a matter — excellent! Excellent! Subhūti, that you say, 'All phenomena have no knower and no seer' — Subhūti, that is so, that is so indeed. All phenomena have no knower and no seer.

And how is it, Subhūti, that all phenomena have no knower and no seer? Subhūti, all phenomena are empty. Subhūti, all phenomena are without abiding. Therefore, Subhūti, all phenomena have no knower and no seer. Therefore, Subhūti, it is by relying upon the Perfection of Wisdom that the

Tathāgata has fully and perfectly awakened to all those phenomena."

"Subhūti, so it is that the Perfection of Wisdom rightly reveals this world to the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. It rightly reveals because form is not seen, and because feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are not seen. Subhūti, thus it is that the Perfection of Wisdom rightly reveals this world to the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas."

Subhūti asked: "Blessed One, how is it that form is not seen? How is it that feeling, perception, and formations are not seen? Blessed One, how is it that consciousness is not seen?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, if consciousness that takes form as its referent object does not arise, then form is not seen. Likewise, if consciousness that takes feeling, perception, and formations as its referent object does not arise — and, Subhūti, if mind that takes consciousness itself as its referent object does not arise — then consciousness is not seen. Subhūti, that which is the non-seeing of form, that which is the non-seeing of feeling, perception, and formations, and, Subhūti, that which is the non-seeing of consciousness — in that way the Tathāgata sees the world. Subhūti, thus it is that the Perfection of Wisdom rightly reveals this world to the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas.

Subhūti, and how does the Perfection of Wisdom rightly reveal the world? In this way: the world is empty. In this way it declares the world. In this way it makes the world known. In this way it causes the world to be seen. In this way the world is inconceivable, in this way the world is peaceful, in this way the world is solitary, in this way the world is utterly pure — so does it declare the world. So does it make it known. So does it cause the world to be seen."

This is the twelfth chapter, called "Rightly Revealing the World," from the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is profound. Blessed One, how wondrous — this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by great activity. Blessed One, how wondrous — this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by activity that is inconceivable, by activity that has no equal, by activity that is immeasurable, by activity that is innumerable, by activity that is unequalled-yet-equal."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that is so, that is so indeed. Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by great activity. Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by activity that is inconceivable, by activity that has no equal, by activity that is immeasurable, by activity that is innumerable, by activity that is unequalled-yet-equal.

Subhūti, how is it that this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by inconceivable activity? Subhūti, Tathāgatahood itself, buddhahood itself, self-arisen enlightenment itself, and omniscience itself are inconceivable. Subhūti, thus this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by inconceivable activity and cannot be thought by the mind. Why is that? It is because mind, thinking, and the phenomena arisen from mind do not enter into it here.

Subhūti, how is it that this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by activity that has no equal?"

"Subhūti, Tathāgatahood itself, buddhahood itself, self-arisen enlightenment itself, and omniscience itself cannot be thought or equalled. Subhūti, thus this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by activity that has no equal. Subhūti, how is it that this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by activity that is immeasurable? Subhūti, Tathāgatahood itself, buddhahood itself, self-arisen enlightenment itself, and omniscience itself are immeasurable. Subhūti, thus this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by activity that is immeasurable. Subhūti, how is it that this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by activity that is innumerable? Subhūti, Tathāgatahood itself, buddhahood itself, self-arisen enlightenment itself, and omniscience itself are innumerable. Subhūti, thus this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by activity that is innumerable. Subhūti, how is it that this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by activity that is unequalled-yet-equal? Subhūti, among Tathāgatahood itself, buddhahood itself, self-arisen enlightenment itself, and omniscience itself, there is nothing equal to them — what need is there to speak of anything superior? Subhūti, thus this Perfection of Wisdom is attended by activity that is unequalled-yet-equal."

The elder Subhūti then asked: "Blessed One, is it so that Tathāgatahood itself is inconceivable, without equal, immeasurable, innumerable, and unequalled-yet-equal? And likewise that buddhahood itself, self-arisen enlightenment itself, and omniscience itself are inconceivable, without equal, immeasurable, and unequalled-yet-equal? Or is form also inconceivable, without equal, immeasurable, innumerable, and unequalled-yet-equal? And likewise feeling, perception, and formations? And is consciousness also

inconceivable, without equal, immeasurable, innumerable, and unequalled-yet-equal? And are all phenomena also inconceivable, without equal, immeasurable, innumerable, and unequalled-yet-equal?"

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, it is exactly so, it is exactly so. Subhūti, form too is inconceivable, without equal, immeasurable, innumerable, and unequalled-yet-equal. Subhūti, likewise feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are inconceivable, without equal, immeasurable, innumerable, and unequalled-yet-equal. Subhūti, likewise all phenomena are inconceivable, without equal, immeasurable, innumerable, and unequalled-yet-equal. Why is that? Subhūti, in the nature of reality of form there is no mind, no thinking, and no phenomena arisen from mind — and so there is no conceiving of it as such. Subhūti, likewise in the nature of reality of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness there is no mind, no thinking, and no phenomena arisen from mind — and so there is no conceiving of it as such. Subhūti, in the nature of reality of all phenomena there is no mind, no thinking, and no phenomena arisen from mind — and so there is no conceiving of it as such. Subhūti, thus form too is inconceivable and without equal. Subhūti, likewise feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are inconceivable and without equal. Subhūti, likewise all phenomena are inconceivable and without equal. Subhūti, form too is immeasurable."

Subhūti, likewise feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are also immeasurable. Subhūti, all phenomena too are immeasurable. Why is that? Subhūti, the measure of form is not known. Subhūti, likewise the measure of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness is not known, and the measure of all phenomena too is not known. Subhūti, why is the measure of form not fully known? And likewise feeling, perception, and formations — Subhūti, why is the measure of consciousness not fully known? Subhūti, why is the measure of all phenomena not fully known? Because, Subhūti, form is without measure. Subhūti, likewise feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are without measure, and Subhūti, all phenomena too are without measure. Subhūti, why is form without measure? Subhūti, why are feeling, perception, and formations likewise without measure? Subhūti, why is consciousness without measure? Subhūti, why are all phenomena without measure? Because all phenomena are without measure. Subhūti, form too is innumerable. Subhūti, likewise feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are innumerable. Subhūti, all phenomena too are innumerable

— because they transcend counting itself. Subhūti, form too is without equal and yet equal. Subhūti, likewise feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are without equal and yet equal. Subhūti, likewise all phenomena are without equal and yet equal, because, Subhūti, all phenomena are equal to space.

Subhūti, what do you think — is there any equating, numbering, measuring, likening, minding, thinking, or phenomenon arisen from mind in space? Subhūti replied: Blessed One, there is not. The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, in exactly that way, by this enumeration of categories, all these phenomena too are inconceivable, without equal, immeasurable, innumerable, without equal and yet equal. Subhūti, these are the Tathāgata's phenomena. Subhūti, by this same enumeration of categories, all phenomena are inconceivable, without equal, immeasurable, innumerable, without equal and yet equal. Subhūti, these Tathāgata's phenomena are inconceivable because they are free from mind. They are without equal because they fully transcend likening. Subhūti, this expression "inconceivable and without equal" is the supreme word of Dharma for those in whom consciousness has arisen. Likewise the expressions "immeasurable," "innumerable," "without equal and yet equal" are the same.

Subhūti, the expressions "immeasurable," "innumerable," "without equal and yet equal" mean being free from equality, from number, and from measure. The Tathāgata's phenomena are immeasurable, innumerable, without equal and yet equal. These phenomena, by virtue of being equal to space, innumerable and immeasurable, are without equal and yet equal, innumerable and immeasurable. Ah, how wondrous — these phenomena, being equal to space, do not enter into being equal or without equal. Therefore, Subhūti, these phenomena are spoken of as without equal. Because space is inconceivable, these phenomena are inconceivable. Because space is without equal, these phenomena are without equal. Because space is immeasurable, these phenomena are immeasurable. Because space is innumerable, these phenomena are innumerable. Because space is without equal and yet equal, these phenomena are without equal and yet equal.

Even as the Blessed One taught these qualities — the inconceivable, the without equal, the immeasurable, the innumerable, the without equal and yet equal — five hundred monks attained liberation of mind from the defilements without remainder. Two thousand nuns likewise attained liberation of mind from the defilements without remainder. Six thousand laymen (upāsakas)

gained the Dharma-eye regarding phenomena — pure, free from dust and stain. Three thousand laywomen (upāsikās) also gained the Dharma-eye regarding phenomena — pure, free from dust and stain. Twenty bodhisattvas attained the forbearance of non-arising (anutpattikadharmakṣānti). These same bodhisattvas the Blessed One then prophesied would attain unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening in this very good aeon. As for those laymen and laywomen who had gained the Dharma-eye regarding phenomena — pure, free from dust and stain — them too the Blessed One prophesied, declaring that they would come to attain liberation of mind from the defilements without remainder.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound. Blessed One, how wondrous — this Perfection of Wisdom abides in great activity."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said to the venerable Subhūti: "Just so, Subhūti, just so. Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound. Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom abides in great activity. Why is that? Because it is genuinely endowed with omniscience. It is genuinely endowed with the ground of the pratyekabuddhas. It is genuinely endowed with the ground of the śrāvakas.

"Subhūti, consider this analogy. When a king of the warrior-noble caste (kṣatriya) has been consecrated as sovereign, whatever actions he undertakes with regard to his people — whether the power and effort he brings to those actions — all affairs of the city and all affairs of the kingdom come to be conducted through his ministers, and in this way the king's own effort is small, the burden set aside. In the same way, Subhūti, all the qualities of a buddha, all the qualities of a pratyekabuddha, and all the qualities of a śrāvaka — all of these are genuinely endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom, so that it is the Perfection of Wisdom itself that performs the activity among them. By this way of understanding, Subhūti, this Perfection of Wisdom abides in great activity.

"It abides as such in order that form not be clung to and not be attached to; and likewise in order that feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness not be clung to and not be attached to; in order that the fruit of stream-entry not be clung to and not be attached to; and likewise in order that the fruit of once-returning, the fruit of non-returning, and arhatship not be clung to and not be attached to; in order that individual awakening not be clung to and not be attached to; and in order that omniscience not be clung to and not be

attached to — for these reasons the Perfection of Wisdom abides."

Subhūti asked: "Blessed One, how does the Perfection of Wisdom abide so that one does not cling to omniscience and does not become attached to it?"

The Blessed One replied: "Subhūti, what do you think? Do you truly see arhatship as something to be clung to or attached to?"

Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, that is not so. Blessed One, I do not truly perceive any such thing as a phenomenon of arhatship that one could cling to or become attached to."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, it is exactly so, it is exactly so. I too do not truly perceive the Tathāgata himself. Subhūti, because I do not truly perceive the Tathāgata himself, I do not cling to him and I do not become attached to him. Subhūti, it is for this reason that there is likewise no clinging and no attachment with regard to omniscience."

Subhūti then said: "Blessed One, when bodhisattvas, great beings, who have newly entered the vehicle and whose roots of virtue are few hear this teaching — that there is no clinging and no attachment even with regard to omniscience — might they not be seized with alarm, with utter terror, with dread?"

"Blessed One, however, those bodhisattvas, great beings, who are well-provisioned with excellent causes, who have served the Victors of the past, and who have long cultivated roots of virtue — when they hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom, they will come to have faith in it."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, it is exactly so, it is exactly so."

Then the sons of the gods dwelling in the desire realm and the sons of the gods dwelling in the form realm addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound, difficult to behold, and difficult to realize. Blessed One, those bodhisattvas who will come to have faith upon hearing this profound Perfection of Wisdom — they are ones who have served the Victors of the past and have long cultivated roots of virtue."

"Blessed One, if all the sentient beings throughout a great trichiliocosm were to practise on the level of following through faith for an aeon or even more than an aeon, and if someone were to endure, to delight in, to seek, to reflect upon, to examine, and to contemplate this profound Perfection of Wisdom for even a single day — Blessed One, this latter one would be superior to all those others."

When these words had been spoken, the Blessed One replied to the sons of the gods dwelling in the desire realm and the sons of the gods dwelling in the form realm: "Sons of the gods, if any son or daughter of good family were to hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom, they should hope for swift passage to nirvāṇa — far swifter than those who practise on the level of following through faith for an aeon or more than an aeon."

Then the sons of the gods dwelling in the desire realm and the sons of the gods dwelling in the form realm said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is indeed a great perfection." So saying, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, took their leave of the Blessed One's presence, and departed. Having gone not very far at all, they became invisible — the sons of the gods dwelling in the desire realm returning to abide in the desire realm, and the sons of the gods dwelling in the form realm returning to abide in the Brahmā world.

This concludes the thirteenth chapter of the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, entitled "The Inconceivable."

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, when a bodhisattva, a great being, hears this profound Perfection of Wisdom being taught, and upon hearing it at that very moment has faith and does not turn away, is never dejected, is not bewildered, is not confused, harbors no doubt, and entertains no suspicion — and thus rejoices in the Perfection of Wisdom — Blessed One, from where does such a one pass away, and where will he be reborn?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, who upon hearing this profound Perfection of Wisdom being taught, at that very moment has faith and does not turn away, is never dejected, is not bewildered, is not confused, harbors no doubt, and entertains no suspicion — who rejoices in what is equal to seeing it — who will uphold and cultivate this profound Perfection of Wisdom, who will not abandon the mental engagement endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom and will not let his mind turn elsewhere, who will arouse aspiration for the sake of grasping it, retaining it, reading it, mastering it, and proclaiming it aloud — who will follow it, proceed in accordance with it, and not give up the teaching of the Dharma — Subhūti, such a one, just like a calf that is young and does not abandon the cow, so too, Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, who having heard this profound

Perfection of Wisdom, for as long as this Perfection of Wisdom has not yet come to rest in his body or been contained in a volume, will not give up the teaching of the Dharma — that bodhisattva, that great being, Subhūti, has passed away from among human beings and has been reborn as a human being."

Subhūti asked: "Blessed One, might there also be bodhisattvas, great beings, endowed with these qualities who have passed away from another buddha-field and been born here?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, bodhisattvas, great beings, who have attended upon other buddhas, the Blessed Ones, and have questioned them, inquired of them, and thoroughly examined them — those who have passed away from those other buddha-fields and been born here should also be understood as endowed with precisely these same qualities."

"Furthermore, Subhūti, a bodhisattva, a great being, who has passed away from among the gods of Tuṣita and been born here should likewise be understood as endowed with precisely those same qualities — namely, one who has attended upon the bodhisattva great being Maitreya (Loving-kindness, the future Buddha), and with reference to this Perfection of Wisdom has questioned him, inquired of him, and thoroughly examined him; such a one too should be understood as endowed with these very qualities."

"Subhūti, furthermore, a bodhisattva who has heard this profound Perfection of Wisdom and yet in prior times has never questioned, inquired, or thoroughly examined it — if such a one is born among human beings, when this profound Perfection of Wisdom is being taught he will become perplexed, become confused, and become faint-hearted. Subhūti, that bodhisattva should be understood as one who by nature has never asked questions in prior times. And why is that? It is because such a one, when this profound Perfection of Wisdom is being taught, becomes perplexed, becomes confused, and becomes faint-hearted."

"Subhūti, furthermore, there is a bodhisattva who in prior times heard this very profound Perfection of Wisdom for only the span of a single day, or two days, or three, or four, or five days —"

— served and honored the teacher, made thorough inquiry, questioned fully, and asked in full — yet that person's faith, for a time, will become lost and will be snatched away by questioning. And why is that? Subhūti, it is because that person who, in former times, did not make thorough inquiry into this profound

Perfection of Wisdom, did not question it properly, did not ask about it properly, and did not follow it — such a one will sometimes be moved by aspiration to follow along when this profound Perfection of Wisdom is being taught, and sometimes will feel no aspiration at all. For that reason, they will become distracted and faint-hearted; their mind will become agitated and will fray apart like cotton passing through. That bodhisattva should be understood as one who entered the vehicle not long ago and has newly come to the vehicle. That bodhisattva will altogether abandon that faith, that clarity, and that aspiration — in the sense that they will neither retain this profound Perfection of Wisdom, nor engage with it, nor rely upon it — and so one should expect that they will settle upon one ground: either the ground of a śrāvaka or the ground of a pratyekabuddha, whichever of those two it may be.

Subhūti, consider this analogy: when a ship has gone out onto a great ocean and then breaks apart, those aboard who do not seize hold of a plank of wood or a flat board, and who do not cling to a corpse — know, Subhūti, that they will meet their end in the water without reaching the far shore. Subhūti, and those who, when a ship has gone out onto a great ocean and broken apart, do seize hold of a plank of wood or a flat board or a corpse — know, Subhūti, that they will not meet their end in the water, but will reach the far shore safely, without being submerged or soaked, and will come to rest on dry ground.

Subhūti, in the same way, a bodhisattva who possesses only faith, only joy, only clarity, only aspiration — if they do not rely upon the Perfection of Wisdom, know, Subhūti, that they will fall apart midway along the path and, without attaining omniscience, will come to rest in the state of a śrāvaka or a pratyekabuddha.

Subhūti, furthermore, those bodhisattvas, great beings, who wish to awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — if they possess faith, forbearance, earnest longing, aspiration, diligence, heedfulness, devotion, elevated intention, relinquishment, respectfulness, joy, contentment, clarity, exultation, and unwavering effort, and if they rely upon the Perfection of Wisdom — then that very faith of theirs, that forbearance, that earnest longing, that aspiration, that diligence, that heedfulness, that devotion, that elevated intention, that relinquishment, that respectfulness, that joy, that contentment, that clarity, that exultation, and that unwavering effort will, upon attaining the Perfection of Wisdom, come to rest in omniscience.

Subhūti, consider this analogy: if a woman or a man were to place an unfired clay pot in water, know, Subhūti, that that pot will not last long — it will break and crumble very quickly. And why is that? It is because the pot is unfired, and so it will in the end simply become earth again.

In just the same way, Subhūti, there may be some bodhisattva, some great being, who has faith in the prospect of fully and perfectly awakening to unsurpassable, complete, and perfect awakening, and who has patience, longing, aspiration, diligence, heedfulness, devotion, elevated intention, relinquishment, respectfulness, joy, exultation, clarity, contentment, and unwavering effort — and yet, if that bodhisattva has not been fully sustained by the Perfection of Wisdom and skillful means, then, Subhūti, know that that bodhisattva will collapse and be destroyed midway along the path. And what, Subhūti, is this collapse and destruction midway along the bodhisattva's path? It is the ground of the śrāvaka or the ground of the pratyekabuddha.

Now, Subhūti, consider this analogy: suppose a woman or a man were to take a well-fired clay pot, draw water from a river, a pond, a lake, a great lake, a well, or some other source of water, and carry that water away — then, Subhūti, know that the pot will arrive home safely. And why is that? It is because the pot has been well fired. In just the same way, Subhūti, whatever bodhisattva, whatever great being, has faith in the prospect of fully and perfectly awakening to unsurpassable, complete, and perfect awakening, and has patience, longing, aspiration, diligence, heedfulness, devotion, elevated intention, relinquishment, respectfulness, joy, exultation, clarity, contentment, and unwavering effort — and moreover is fully sustained by the Perfection of Wisdom and skillful means — know, Subhūti, that such a great bodhisattva will not collapse and be destroyed midway along the path; without deflection, without interruption, that being will come to rest in omniscience itself.

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The Fourteenth Fascicle.

Subhūti, consider this analogy: suppose a man of confused and wandering intelligence were to lash together a boat that had not been properly made or repaired, and having loaded it with goods and weighed it down with cargo, were to send it out into the water — then, Subhūti, know that that boat is the kind of thing destined to break apart: it will not make it to the far shore, the cargo will be lost, and the boat itself will be destroyed. In just this way, a ship's captain who lacks skillful means and is of confused intelligence will be separated from great wealth and meet with ruin, falling utterly away from the

great source of precious jewels.

In just the same way, Subhūti, there may be some bodhisattva who has faith in the prospect of fully and perfectly awakening to unsurpassable, complete, and perfect awakening, and who has patience, longing, aspiration, diligence, heedfulness, devotion, elevated intention, relinquishment, respectfulness, joy, contentment, clarity, exultation, and unwavering effort — and yet, if that bodhisattva has not been fully embraced by the Perfection of Wisdom and has become separated from skillful means, then, Subhūti, that bodhisattva will be destroyed and ruined midway, failing to reach the great source of the precious jewel of omniscience. Such a one falls utterly away from the great aim for oneself and falls utterly away from the great mass of precious jewels that constitutes the great aim for others — falling, that is, utterly away from the great source of the precious jewel of omniscience. Know this to be so.

Subhūti, what then is this destruction and ruin midway along the bodhisattva's path?

It is this: falling to the ground of a śrāvaka or to the ground of a pratyekabuddha.

Subhūti, consider this analogy. A skilled and experienced ship's captain, wishing to sail out to sea, has a vessel properly bound together, its hull-seams well caulked, well fitted out and repaired in every way. He draws it into the water, loads it with cargo until full, stows everything properly, sets it with a favorable wind, and sails it steadily in the direction he wishes to go. Subhūti, know that such a ship will not be destroyed by the water; it will reach the destination toward which it is headed, and that captain too will come to possess this great gain — that is, the precious jewels of the world.

Subhūti, in just the same way, when a bodhisattva, a great being, who aspires to fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening possesses faith, possesses forbearance, possesses craving's antidote, possesses aspiration, possesses diligence, possesses heedfulness, possesses devotion, possesses superior intention, possesses relinquishment, possesses reverence, possesses joy, possesses delight, possesses clarity, possesses great rejoicing, and possesses the quality of never abandoning effort — when all this is fully embraced by the Perfection of Wisdom and not separated from skillful means — then, Subhūti, that bodhisattva, that great being, will not be destroyed and ruined midway, will not be cut off, but will abide on the path to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Know this to be so.

Why is that? Subhūti, it is as follows. Those bodhisattvas, those great beings, who aspire to fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening and who possess faith, possess forbearance, possess aspiration's fervor, possess aspiration, possess diligence, possess heedfulness, possess devotion, possess superior intention, possess relinquishment, possess reverence, possess joy, possess delight, possess clarity, possess great rejoicing, and possess the quality of never abandoning effort — and whose qualities are fully embraced by the Perfection of Wisdom and not separated from skillful means — such ones actualize the qualities through which omniscience is attained, and they enter perfectly onto the path to fully awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Except for that, they do not accomplish the ground of a śrāvaka or the ground of a pratyekabuddha.

Subhūti, consider another analogy. Suppose a certain person has been born and has now reached one hundred and twenty years of age, old, aged, and decrepit. And suppose that person's body is afflicted by some illness arising from wind, or from bile, or from phlegm, or from a combination of all three. Subhūti, what do you think — could that person rise from a seat without support? Subhūti replied: Blessed One, he could not. The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, even if that person could rise from the seat, still, overwhelmed as he is by such old age and illness, he would have no strength to walk so much as one bowshot's distance or two bowshots' distance. Even if he could rise from the seat, he would have no strength to walk anywhere at all.

Subhūti, in just the same way, when a bodhisattva, a great being, who aspires to fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening possesses faith, possesses forbearance, possesses fervent longing, possesses aspiration, possesses diligence, possesses heedfulness, possesses devotion, possesses superior intention, possesses relinquishment, possesses reverence, possesses joy, possesses delight, possesses clarity, possesses great rejoicing, and possesses the quality of never abandoning effort — and yet —

— and yet that bodhisattva is not taken up and embraced by the Perfection of Wisdom, and is parted from skillful means — then, Subhūti, even though such a one has rightly entered upon the task of fully awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, that bodhisattva will be consumed by the intermediate fall and brought to ruin. Know that this means coming to rest on the ground of the śrāvakas or the ground of the pratyekabuddhas. And why is that? It is because that bodhisattva has not been taken up and embraced by the Perfection of Wisdom, and has been parted from skillful means.

Subhūti, consider this analogy. A man who was born and has reached the age of one hundred and twenty years, old, aged, and decrepit, is struck in that very body by some illness arising from wind, or arising from bile, or arising from phlegm, or arising from their combination. Two strong men support him well from either side, steadying him and holding him securely, and they say to him: "Good sir, until you have reached the place you wish to go, you will not face the danger of falling midway on the road as long as we two are supporting you. Go wherever you wish to go." With that, he will be able to rise from the bed.

In just the same way, Subhūti, when a bodhisattva, a great being, who aspires to fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening possesses faith, possesses forbearance, possesses fervent longing, possesses aspiration, possesses diligence, possesses heedfulness, possesses devotion, possesses superior intention, possesses relinquishment, possesses reverence, possesses joy, possesses delight, possesses clarity, possesses great rejoicing, and possesses the quality of never abandoning effort — and when, moreover, that bodhisattva is taken up and embraced by the Perfection of Wisdom and is not parted from skillful means — then, Subhūti, that bodhisattva, that great being, will not be consumed by the intermediate fall and will not be brought to ruin. Know that from that very place, that bodhisattva, that great being, will be able to reach the ground of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

This concludes the fourteenth chapter, called the Chapter of Analogies, from the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how should a bodhisattva, a great being, who is just beginning, abide in the Perfection of Wisdom? How should such a one train?"

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, here a bodhisattva, a great being, who is just beginning and wishes to train in the Perfection of Wisdom should draw near to, rely upon, and attend upon virtuous friends — those who will guide and teach this Perfection of Wisdom, and those who will recite the meaning of the Perfection of Wisdom by scriptural transmission. Know, Subhūti, that those individuals are the virtuous friends of that bodhisattva, that great being.

"To such a bodhisattva, the virtuous friend should say: 'Come here, son of good family. Train in the perfection of generosity. Likewise, train in the perfection of moral discipline, the perfection of patience, the perfection of

diligence, the perfection of meditative concentration, and the perfection of wisdom. Son of good family, whatever acts of generosity you perform, dedicate them all entirely to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Subhūti, whatever sufferings there are for the world that moves about in saṃsāra, from all of these he acts to protect it, and he makes effort and generates diligence in order to eliminate those sufferings. Subhūti, it is in this way that the bodhisattva mahāsattva, having become fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete enlightenment, becomes the protector of the world.

Subhūti, how does the bodhisattva mahāsattva, having become fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete enlightenment, become the refuge of the world? Subhūti, whatever sentient beings are subject to the nature of birth, subject to the nature of aging, subject to the nature of sickness, subject to the nature of death, and subject to the nature of grief, lamentation, suffering, mental unhappiness, and turmoil — those sentient beings he causes to be utterly freed from birth, aging, sickness, death, grief, lamentation, suffering, mental unhappiness, and turmoil. Subhūti, it is in this way that the bodhisattva mahāsattva, having become fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete enlightenment, becomes the refuge of the world.

Subhūti, how does the bodhisattva mahāsattva, having become fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete enlightenment, become the abode of the world? Subhūti, that Tathāgata, Arhat, perfectly complete Buddha teaches the Dharma to sentient beings so as to bring about the absence of engagement. Subhūti, it is in this way that the bodhisattva mahāsattva, having become fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete enlightenment, becomes the abode of the world.

Subhūti asked, "Blessed One, how is there an absence of engagement?"

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, whatever is the absence of connection of form, that is the absence of engagement of form. Whatever is the absence of engagement of form, that is the absence of connection of form. Whatever is the absence of connection of form, that is the absence of arising and absence of cessation of form. Whatever is the absence of arising and absence of cessation of form, that is the absence of engagement of form. That which is the absence of engagement with respect to form is the absence of connection of form; that absence of connection of form is the absence of engagement of

form. It is likewise for feeling, perception, and formations.

Subhūti, whatever is the absence of connection of consciousness, that is the absence of engagement of consciousness. Whatever is the absence of engagement of consciousness, that is the absence of connection of consciousness. Whatever is the absence of connection of consciousness, that is the absence of arising and absence of cessation of consciousness. Whatever is the absence of arising and absence of cessation of consciousness, that is the absence of engagement of consciousness. That which is the absence of eng

Subhūti, whatever is the far shore of form, that is not form; yet just as the far shore is, so too is form. It is likewise for feeling, perception, and formations. Subhūti, whatever is the far shore of consciousness, that is not consciousness; yet just as the far shore is, so too is consciousness. Subhūti, just as the far shore of form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness is, so too are all phenomena.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, if the far shore of form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness is like that for all phenomena, then Blessed One, have bodhisattva great beings not already become fully and perfectly awakened to all phenomena? Why is this? Blessed One, it is because there is no conceptualization whatsoever in this regard.

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, it is so, it is so. In that which is the far shore there is no conceptualization whatsoever. Subhūti, precisely because there is no conceptualization, bodhisattva great beings do become fully and perfectly awakened to all phenomena. Subhūti, this too is the most difficult of tasks performed by bodhisattva great beings: that while thus definitely contemplating all phenomena, they neither actualize them nor lose heart, but think, "Thus shall we become fully and perfectly awakened to these phenomena; thus, having become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, shall we teach these phenomena and fully explain them."

Subhūti, in this way, bodhisattva great beings, having become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, become the ally of the world.

Subhūti, how do bodhisattva great beings, having become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, become an island for the world? Subhūti, it is like this: for example, in a river or an ocean, whatever place is completely surrounded by water is called an island. Subhūti, likewise,

form is utterly cut off from a prior limit and a later limit. So too are feeling, perception, and formations; and, Subhūti, so too is consciousness utterly cut off from a prior limit and a later limit. Subhūti, by this utter cutting-off, all phenomena are utterly cut off from a prior limit and a later limit.

Subhūti, whatever is the utter cutting-off of all phenomena—this is peace, this is sublime, this is complete passing beyond sorrow, this is just as it is, this is unmistaken. Subhūti, it is in this way that bodhisattva great beings, having become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, become an island for the world.

Subhūti, how do bodhisattva great beings, having become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, become a light for the world? Subhūti, here, bodhisattva great beings, having become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, for a long time illuminate with wisdom those sentient beings who are utterly enveloped by the eggshell and cataract of ignorance and overwhelmed by darkness, and they dispel all the pitch-black darkness of unknowing.

Subhūti, thus the bodhisattva great being, having become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, becomes a support for immeasurable, countless sentient beings. Subhūti said: Blessed One, in that the bodhisattva great being who has donned this armor causes immeasurable, countless sentient beings to pass utterly beyond suffering, this is indeed a difficult deed. When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to venerable Subhūti: Subhūti, it is so, it is so. The bodhisattva great being who has donned this armor, in causing immeasurable, countless sentient beings to pass utterly beyond suffering, performs a difficult deed.

Subhūti, furthermore, the armor that the bodhisattva great being dons, the great armor, is not connected with form, nor is it connected for the purpose of form; likewise it is not connected with feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, nor is it connected for the purpose of consciousness. It is not connected with the level of the śrāvaka, nor is it connected for the purpose of the level of the śrāvaka. It is not connected with the level of the pratyekabuddha, nor is it connected for the purpose of the level of the pratyekabuddha. It is not connected with the level of buddhahood, nor is it connected for the purpose of the level of buddhahood. Why is this? Subhūti, alas, this great armor that the bodhisattva great being dons, the great armor, is not connected with any phenomenon at all.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, in this way, the bodhisattva great being who has donned the great armor, who thus practices the profound Perfection of Wisdom, does not place hope in three abodes. What are the three? They are the level of the śrāvaka, the level of the pratyekabuddha, and the level of buddhahood. When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to venerable Subhūti: Subhūti, seeing what significance do you say that the bodhisattva great being who has donned the great armor, who thus practices the profound Perfection of Wisdom, does not place hope in three abodes—namely, the level of the śrāvaka, the level of the pratyekabuddha, and the level of buddhahood?

Subhūti replied: Subhūti, for the bodhisattva great being who has donned the great armor, who thus practices the profound Perfection of Wisdom, to place hope in the level of the śrāvaka or the level of the pratyekabuddha—this has no basis and no occasion. Rather, one who has donned this great armor for the sake of all sentient beings should place hope only in buddhahood itself.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is profound. It is not to be cultivated by anyone; it has not been cultivated by anyone; it is not being cultivated by anyone; it will not be cultivated by anyone. There is not even the slightest thing to be cultivated, nor is there anywhere it is to be cultivated. Why is this? Blessed One, it is because in the Perfection of Wisdom, no phenomenon whatsoever is thoroughly established. Blessed One, this cultivation of the Perfection of Wisdom is thus like the cultivation of space. Blessed One, this cultivation of the Perfection of Wisdom is thus the non-cultivation of all phenomena.

Whatever is the suchness of the Tathāgata and whatever is the suchness of all phenomena, that is the suchness of the elder Subhūti. The elder Subhūti has followed after that very suchness; therefore he was born following after the Tathāgata. Yet that suchness of the Tathāgata is not itself something other, being suchness—it is simply that which follows after that suchness. Thus the elder Subhūti was born following after the Tathāgata. It is by that abiding which is the abiding in the suchness of the Tathāgata that the elder Subhūti was born following after the Tathāgata.

Just as the suchness of the Tathāgata is without change, without alteration, without conceptualization, and without discursive thought, so too the suchness of the elder Subhūti is without change, without alteration, without conceptualization, and without discursive thought. Thus the elder Subhūti too was born following after the Tathāgata through that suchness which is without

change, without alteration, without conceptualization, and without discursive thought.

Just as the suchness of the Tathāgata is without change, without alteration, without conceptualization, without discursive thought, and unobstructed with regard to anything whatsoever, so too the suchness of all phenomena is without change, without alteration, without conceptualization, without discursive thought, and unobstructed with regard to anything whatsoever. Why is this? Because this suchness—whatever is the suchness of the Tathāgata and whatever is the suchness of all phenomena—is one; it is nondual and cannot be made into two. The suchness that is nondual is not suchness anywhere, nor from anything, nor of anything; and precisely because it is not the suchness of anything, that suchness is nondual, and the nondual suchness cannot be made into two.

Thus the elder Subhūti was born following after the Tathāgata through an unfabricated suchness, for whatever unfabricated suchness there is, it can never become other than suchness. And because it can never become other than suchness, that suchness is nondual, and the nondual suchness cannot be made into two. Thus the elder Subhūti was born following after the Tathāgata.

Just as the suchness of the Tathāgata in every respect does not conceptualize or discursively think about any phenomenon whatsoever, so too the suchness of the elder Subhūti in every respect does not conceptualize or discursively think about any phenomenon whatsoever. Likewise, the Tathāgata and Subhūti are both manifestly emanated through suchness; neither of the two is fabricated, and they are not different, since nothing that would differentiate them can be found. Thus the elder Subhūti was born following after the Tathāgata.

Just as the suchness of the Tathāgata is not other than the suchness of all phenomena, so too the suchness of Subhūti is not other than the suchness of all phenomena. And whatever is not other than the suchness of all phenomena can never fail to be the suchness of anything—for that very suchness is the suchness of all phenomena.

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said this to venerable Śāriputra: "Śāriputra, it is so, it is just so. Śāriputra, take the case of a bodhisattva great being who, having generated the mind set upon unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, dwells for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges River, giving gifts, guarding moral discipline, accomplishing

patience, exerting diligence, and resting in meditative concentration. Even though he thereby enters vastly and genuinely into practice, and his mind becomes greatly set upon manifestly and completely awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, if this Perfection of Wisdom is not fully grasped and he remains devoid of skillful means, then he falls, in just this way, to the level of a śrāvaka or the level of a pratyekabuddha.

"Śāriputra, furthermore, take the bodhisattva who, in regard to the moral discipline, the meditative concentration, the wisdom, the liberation, and the vision of the wisdom of liberation of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — past, future, and present — thinks about and grasps these in the manner of signs. Such a one does not know and does not see the moral discipline of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas; it is not meditative concentration, not wisdom, not liberation; he does not know and does not see the vision of the wisdom of liberation of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas. Because he does not know this and does not see this, he listens to the sound of the word 'emptiness,' and he treats that sound as a sign; having made that sound into a sign, he wishes to dedicate it fully to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. For this reason, one should understand that this one comes to abide on the level of a śrāvaka or on the level of a pratyekabuddha. Why is that? Śāriputra, whoever is not grasped by the Perfection of Wisdom and remains devoid of skillful means will indeed turn out this way."

Śāriputra said: "Blessed One, as I understand the meaning of what the Blessed One has explained, even a bodhisattva who possesses an extremely vast accumulation of merit, if he is not grasped by the Perfection of Wisdom and remains devoid of skillful means and lacking a spiritual friend, will become uncertain of attaining unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Blessed One, for this reason, the bodhisattva great being who wishes to manifestly and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening should cultivate the Perfection of Wisdom and should also strive in skillful means."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said this to venerable Śāriputra: "Śāriputra, it is so, it is just so. Śāriputra, take the bodhisattva great being who is not grasped by the Perfection of Wisdom and remains devoid of skillful means: even though he possesses a great accumulation of merit, if he is devoid of a spiritual friend, his attainment of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening becomes uncertain. Śāriputra, for this reason, the bodhisattva great being who wishes to manifestly and completely awaken to unsurpassed,

perfect, complete awakening should cultivate the Perfection of Wisdom and should also be endowed with skillful means."

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, together with the young gods of the Desire Realm, and Brahmā, lord of this world system of Sahā, together with the young gods of the Form Realm, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this Perfection of Wisdom is profound."

Why is this? Venerable Subhūti, it is because all phenomena are equal to space. Venerable Subhūti, if it were established that unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening will arise, then bodhisattvas as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River would become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Venerable Subhūti, but since bodhisattvas as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River do turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, therefore, Venerable Subhūti, it should be understood in this way: that the arising of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening is difficult, and that fully awakening into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening is supremely difficult to accomplish.

When this had been said, the venerable Subhūti spoke thus to the venerable Śāriputra:

Venerable Śāriputra, does whatever form there is turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?

Śāriputra said: Venerable Subhūti, it does not.

Subhūti said: Venerable Śāriputra, does that phenomenon by which one turns back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening exist somewhere other than form?

Śāriputra said: Venerable Subhūti, it does not.

Subhūti said: Venerable Śāriputra, do whatever feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness there are turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?

Śāriputra said: Venerable Subhūti, they do not.

Subhūti said: Venerable Śāriputra, does that phenomenon by which one turns back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening exist somewhere other than feeling, perception, and formations, or somewhere other than consciousness?

Śāriputra said: Venerable Subhūti, it does not.

Subhūti said: Venerable Śāriputra, does the suchness of form turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?

Śāriputra said: Venerable Subhūti, it does not.

Subhūti said: Venerable Śāriputra, do the suchness of feeling, the suchness of perception, the suchness of formations, and the suchness of consciousness turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?

Śāriputra said: Venerable Subhūti, they do not.

Subhūti said: Venerable Śāriputra, does that phenomenon by which one turns back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening exist somewhere other than the suchness of form?

Śāriputra said: Venerable Subhūti, it does not.

Subhūti said: Venerable Śāriputra, does that phenomenon by which one turns back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening exist somewhere other than the suchness of feeling, the suchness of perception, and the suchness of formations, or somewhere other than the suchness of consciousness?

Śāriputra said: Venerable Subhūti, it does not.

Subhūti said: Venerable Śāriputra, does whatever form there is fully and completely awaken into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?

Śāriputra said: Venerable Subhūti, it does not.

Subhūti said: Venerable Śāriputra, do whatever feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness there are fully and completely awaken into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?

Śāriputra said: Venerable Subhūti, they do not.

Śāriputra said, "That is not so, venerable Subhūti."

Subhūti said, "Venerable Śāriputra, do you correctly perceive even a single quality of a bodhisattva within suchness?"

Śāriputra said, "That is not so, venerable Subhūti."

Subhūti said, "Venerable Śāriputra, since it is thus—since even that quality of a bodhisattva is not observed as truth itself or as abiding itself—why do you think, 'This one belongs to the vehicle of the śrāvakas, this one belongs to the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, this one belongs to the Great Vehicle'? Śāriputra, when a bodhisattva great being hears that the analyses made

regarding suchness are without distinction, without differentiation, and cannot be separated out, and yet his mind does not sink, does not become discouraged in any way, and does not turn away, that bodhisattva great being should be known as certain to emerge into awakening."

Then the Blessed One said this to venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, it is so, it is just so. Subhūti, that you have the confidence to speak in this way is due to the power of the Tathāgata and the blessing of the Buddha. Excellent, Subhūti, excellent! When those bodhisattvas, having heard that the analyses made regarding suchness are without distinction, without differentiation, and without anything to be separated out, do not have their minds sink, do not become discouraged in any way, and do not turn away, Subhūti, that bodhisattva great being should be known as certain to emerge into awakening."

Then venerable Śāriputra said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, by what awakening does this bodhisattva great being come to emerge with certainty?"

The Blessed One declared: "Śāriputra, it is by unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening that this bodhisattva great being comes to emerge with certainty."

Then venerable Subhūti said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, since a bodhisattva great being wishes to emerge with certainty into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, how should he abide, how should he train?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, since a bodhisattva great being wishes to emerge with certainty into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, he should abide equally toward all sentient beings; he should generate a mind of equality toward all sentient beings; he should observe others with a mind free of inequality; he should observe others with a mind of loving-kindness; he should observe others with a mind that benefits; he should observe others with a virtuous mind; he should observe others with a mind that has cast off pride; he should observe others with a mind free of hostility; he should observe others with a mind free of harmfulness; he should observe others with a mind free of malice. Toward all sentient beings he should establish the perception of a mother, the perception of a father, the perception of a son, and the perception of a daughter, and observe others accordingly.

"Subhūti, thus, since a bodhisattva great being wishes to fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, he should abide toward all sentient beings in this way, and he should train in this way: 'May I become the protector of all sentient beings.' He himself should also abide turned away from all wrongdoing."

Furthermore, Subhūti, in whatever way the bodhisattva mahāsattva examines all phenomena individually, in just that way does the bodhisattva mahāsattva become inseparable from the perfection of wisdom. Furthermore, Subhūti, in whatever way the bodhisattva mahāsattva becomes inseparable from the perfection of wisdom, in just that way does he generate immeasurable and countless merit.

Subhūti asked, "Blessed One, what distinction or difference is to be made between 'immeasurable' and 'countless'?"

The Blessed One declared, "Subhūti, 'immeasurable' means that to which valid cognition does not extend. Subhūti, 'countless' means that which cannot be exhausted by counting."

Subhūti said, "Blessed One, is there a synonym by which form too becomes immeasurable? Likewise for feeling, perception, and formations. And Blessed One, is there a synonym by which consciousness too becomes immeasurable?"

The Blessed One declared, "Subhūti, as for what you have said—'Blessed One, is there a synonym by which form too becomes immeasurable? Likewise for feeling, perception, and formations,

"Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha, has taught even this extent of the nature of reality of all phenomena, and yet that very nature of reality of all phenomena is inexpressible—how marvelous! Blessed One, insofar as I have understood the meaning of what the Blessed One has taught, in just that way all phenomena are indeed inexpressible."

The Blessed One declared, "So it is, Subhūti, so it is. Subhūti, all phenomena are indeed inexpressible. Why is this? Subhūti, because the emptiness of all phenomena cannot be expressed."

Subhūti said, "Blessed One, is there increase or decrease with respect to that which is inexpressible in meaning?"

The Blessed One declared, "Subhūti, there is not."

Subhūti said, "Blessed One, if there is no increase and no decrease with respect to that which is inexpressible in meaning, then there would also be no increase and no decrease with respect to the perfection of generosity. Likewise, Blessed One, there would be no increase and no decrease with respect to the perfection of moral discipline, the perfection of patience, the perfection of diligence, the perfection of meditative concentration, and the

perfection of wisdom. Blessed One, if there is no increase and no decrease with respect to these six perfections, then, Blessed One, how could it be that, by the power of these six perfections which do not increase, a bodhisattva great being would come to fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening? Or how would one draw near to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening? Blessed One, without perfecting the perfections, a bodhisattva great being does not draw near to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

The Blessed One declared, "Subhūti, so it is, so it is. Subhūti, although there is indeed no increase or decrease with respect to the meaning of the perfections, nevertheless, Subhūti, a bodhisattva great being who practices the perfection of wisdom and cultivates the perfection of wisdom skillfully in means does not think, 'This perfection of generosity is increasing' or 'This perfection of generosity is decreasing.' Rather, that one thinks, 'This term "perfection of generosity" is a mere name,' and having considered this, dedicates those acts of giving that are given, those attentions, those generations of mind, and those roots of virtue fully toward unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, dedicating them in accordance with the nature of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening itself. Subhūti, furthermore, a bodhisattva great being who practices the perfection of wisdom and cultivates the perfection of wisdom skillfully in means does not think, 'This perfection of moral discipline is increasing.'

Nor does that one think, "This perfection of moral discipline is decreasing." Rather, that one thinks, "This term 'perfection of moral discipline' is a mere name," and having considered this, having properly undertaken that moral discipline and abiding in it, dedicates those attentions, those generations of mind, and those roots of virtue fully toward unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, dedicating them in accordance with the nature of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening itself.

Subhūti, furthermore, a bodhisattva great being who practices the perfection of wisdom and cultivates the perfection of wisdom skillfully in means does not think, "This perfection of patience is increasing." Nor does that one think, "This perfection of patience is decreasing." Rather, that one thinks, "This term 'perfection of patience' is a mere name," and having considered this, accomplishing that patience, dedicates those attentions, those generations of mind, and those roots of virtue fully toward unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, dedicating them in accordance with the nature of

unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening itself.

Subhūti, furthermore, a bodhisattva great being who practices the perfection of wisdom and cultivates the perfection of wisdom skillfully in means does not think, "This perfection of diligence is increasing." Nor does that one think, "This perfection of diligence is decreasing." Rather, that one thinks, "This term 'perfection of diligence' is a mere name," and having considered this, engaging in that diligence, dedicates those attentions, those generations of mind, and those roots of virtue fully toward unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, dedicating them in accordance with the nature of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening itself.

Subhūti, furthermore, a bodhisattva great being who practices the perfection of wisdom and cultivates the perfection of wisdom skillfully in means does not think, "This perfection of meditative concentration is increasing." Nor does that one think, "This perfection of meditative concentration is decreasing." Rather, that one thinks, "This term 'perfection of meditative concentration' is a mere name," and having considered this, settling into equipoise even within those concentrations, dedicates those attentions, those generations of mind, and those roots of virtue fully toward unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, dedicating them in accordance with the nature of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening itself.

Subhūti, furthermore, a bodhisattva great being who practices the perfection of wisdom and cultivates the perfection of wisdom skillfully in means does not think, "This perfection of wisdom is increasing." Nor does that one think, "This perfection of wisdom is decreasing." Rather, that one thinks, "This perfection of wisdom is a mere name," and having considered this, practicing and cultivating that perfection of wisdom, dedicates those attentions, those generations of mind, and those roots of virtue fully toward unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, dedicating them in accordance with the nature of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening itself.

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, what do you think—does mind exist in suchness?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, it does not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, what do you think—is mind suchness?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, it is not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, what do you think—does mind exist apart from suchness?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, it does not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, have you truly seen suchness?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, I have not." The Blessed One

declared: "Subhūti, what do you think—does one who practices in that way practice in what is profound?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, one who practices in that way does not practice in anything at all. Why is that? Because in that regard the modes of engagement do not operate, and there is no engagement whatsoever."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, that bodhisattva great being who practices the perfection of wisdom—in what does he practice?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, he practices in the ultimate." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, what do you think—does that bodhisattva great being who practices in the ultimate practice in signs?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, he does not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, what do you think—does he thereby destroy those signs?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, he does not." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, what do you think—does the bodhisattva great being's practice of the perfection of wisdom result in the destruction of signs?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, when that bodhisattva great being practices the conduct of a bodhisattva, he does not apply himself thinking, 'May I attain the abandonment of signs right here.' For if he were to attain it, since all the qualities of a buddha would not be complete, he would become a śrāvaka instead. Blessed One, that bodhisattva great being knows what the defining characteristic is and what the sign characterized by it is, and yet also becomes thoroughly familiar with the absence of that sign—this is the skillful means of the bodhisattva great being."

Then the venerable Śāriputra said this to the venerable Subhūti: "Venerable Subhūti, if a bodhisattva great being cultivates in a dream the three doors of liberation—emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness—does his perfection of wisdom thereby increase?" Subhūti said: "Venerable Śāriputra, if cultivating during the day causes increase, then it also increases in a dream. Why is that? Venerable Śāriputra, the Blessed One has said that dream and waking day are not to be conceptually distinguished. Venerable Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva great being who has found the perfection of wisdom practices the perfection of wisdom continuously, day after day, then at that time, for that bodhisattva great being who has become habituated to the perfection of wisdom, the perfection of wisdom will expand even in his dreams."

Śāriputra said: "Venerable Subhūti, if any man or woman performs a virtuous or non-virtuous action in a dream, does that action accumulate or approach accumulation?" Subhūti said:

Śāriputra, furthermore, if a bodhisattva great being goes into a wilderness where there is drought, he should not be alarmed, should not be utterly terrified, should not fall into utter terror. Why is this? Because a bodhisattva great being is one whose nature it is not to be alarmed and not to be utterly terrified. He should generate this thought: "I shall train so as to cut off the craving of all sentient beings." Even if he thinks, "Should I come to die of thirst, I will be born into the world of hungry ghosts," the bodhisattva great being should still not be alarmed, should not be utterly terrified, should not fall into utter terror because of this. Rather he should think: "Alas, these beings have but little merit, since in this world such things as this drought appear to them," and toward all sentient beings he should generate a mind of great compassion, thinking: "Just as, when I have become a perfect and complete buddha in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, in that buddha-field of mine such droughts will never arise anywhere, in any form, at any time, and will not even be known—so shall I bring it about. Just as all sentient beings will find water endowed with the eight qualities, so shall I hold to merit for that purpose. Just as at that time my own perfection of diligence will become completely fulfilled, so, for the sake of all sentient beings, I shall firmly undertake diligence."

Śāriputra, furthermore, if a bodhisattva great being goes into a wilderness of famine, he should not be alarmed, should not be utterly terrified, should not fall into utter terror. He should put on the armor of this thought: "Just as, when I have become a perfect and complete buddha in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, in that buddha-field of mine such famines will never arise anywhere, in any form, at any time, and will not even be known, and all those beings will be joyful and happy and will meet with every happiness—so shall I firmly undertake diligence. Thus shall I thoroughly purify a buddha-field. Just as whatever aspiration those beings have, and whatever they think in their minds, will be accomplished exactly as thought—just as, for example, by the mere mental wish of the gods of the Thirty-Three, everything arises—so, by the mere mental wish of those beings, all of it shall be accomplished, and everything wished for in the mind shall arise. Just as at that time my own perfection of meditative concentration will become completely fulfilled, so, for the sake of all sentient beings, I shall strive to purify my own mind completely." Thinking thus, and thinking, "Just as the Dharma-aspiration of those beings will become completely fulfilled, and the requisites of livelihood for all sentient beings will never, at any time, in any way, be lacking"—so he

firmly undertakes diligence.

Śāriputra, furthermore, if a bodhisattva great being goes into a wilderness that has become a place of disease, he should not be alarmed, should not be utterly terrified, should not fall into utter terror. He should investigate, reflect, and examine in this way: "Here there is no phenomenon that causes illness, nor is there any phenomenon called 'illness.'" Thus he should examine it as emptiness, and should not be alarmed, should not be utterly terrified, should not fall into utter terror.

Śāriputra, a bodhisattva great being is one who—

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva great being who wishes to fully and manifestly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening is asked in this way by another bodhisattva great being, "What is it that one should become thoroughly familiar with regarding these teachings—namely, not actualizing emptiness, not actualizing signlessness, not actualizing wishlessness, not actualizing non-formation, not actualizing non-arising, not actualizing non-production, and also not actualizing non-existence—while also cultivating the perfection of wisdom? And when accomplishing which minds, in accordance with what nature of mind should one accomplish them?"—one should ask this.

Suppose, Subhūti, that when a bodhisattva great being is asked this by another bodhisattva great being, he explains in reply, "A bodhisattva great being should attend mentally to emptiness. He should attend mentally to signlessness, wishlessness, non-formation, non-occurrence, non-arising, and non-existence itself." If he does not directly teach the mind that does not abandon all sentient beings, or does not skillfully explain this in reply, then, Subhūti, one should know that this bodhisattva great being has not been prophesied by the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas of the past to be irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Why is this? Because he does not teach, does not analyze, does not directly explain, and does not fully understand the unshared qualities that belong to an irreversible bodhisattva great being; and because, even when questioned, he does not explain this in reply and does not give an answer—thus he fails to attain the ground that belongs to an irreversible bodhisattva great being.

Subhūti asked: Blessed One, is there some further way, some further explanation, by which a bodhisattva great being becomes irreversible?

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, there is indeed a way by which a bodhisattva great being becomes irreversible. Whether or not a bodhisattva great being has heard this perfection of wisdom, if he understands in this way and answers in this way, he should be known as an irreversible bodhisattva great being.

Subhūti asked: Blessed One, for this reason, though many practice toward awakening, few indeed are those who answer in this way.

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, it is just as you say—few indeed are those bodhisattva great beings who are prophesied to the stage of irreversible wisdom; yet those who have been so prophesied answer in exactly this way. One should know that these various bodhisattva great beings have kindled and generated roots of virtue, and that these various bodhisattva great beings cannot be seized by the world together with its gods, humans, and asuras.

Furthermore, Subhūti, if a bodhisattva great being, even within a dream, correctly views all phenomena as like a dream and does not actualize them, then, Subhūti, this too should be recognized as a defining characteristic of the irreversibility of an irreversible bodhisattva great being.

Furthermore, Subhūti, if a bodhisattva great being, even within a dream, has no desire for the level of a śrāvaka or the level of a pratyekabuddha or for the three realms, and does not generate a mind that seeks their advantages, then, Subhūti, this too should be recognized as a defining characteristic of the irreversibility of an irreversible bodhisattva great being.

Furthermore, Subhūti, if a bodhisattva great being, even within a dream, finds himself in the midst of an assembly of many hundreds, many thousands, many hundreds of thousands, many hundreds of millions, many thousands of millions, many hundreds of thousands of millions, or many hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of beings, and sits within the courtyard of that assembly's maṇḍala, surrounded on all sides by an assembly of monks and encircled in front by an assembly of bodhisattvas, and sees himself, having become a Tathāgata, an Arhat, a perfectly complete Buddha, teaching the Dharma, then, Subhūti, this too should be recognized as a defining characteristic of the irreversibility of an irreversible bodhisattva great being.

Furthermore, Subhūti, if, even within the dream of a bodhisattva great being, he finds himself rising up into the sky and teaching the Dharma to beings, and knows fully that his light fills a fathom's span, and goes to other directions, and having performed the deeds of a buddha in those other world systems,

there too emanates monks and teaches the Dharma — Subhūti, if in this way, even within a dream, he is fully recognized as an irreversible bodhisattva great being, then, Subhūti, this too should be recognized as a defining characteristic of the irreversibility of an irreversible bodhisattva great being.

Furthermore, Subhūti, even within the dream of a bodhisattva great being, he does not become agitated, does not become frightened in any way, and is not overcome by terror: even if there occurs harm to a village, harm to a city, harm to a town, harm to a province, harm to a country, or the harm of a wildfire breaking loose, or he sees a predator, a wild beast, or other small species of wild creatures, or is confronted with beheading close at hand, or any other great, unbearable terror, suffering, and mental distress whatsoever arises, and even upon seeing the suffering, mental distress, and great unbearable terror of other sentient beings, no unbearable terror arises in him; he does not become agitated, does not become frightened in any way, and is not overcome by terror. Then, having awoken from that sleep, immediately upon rising he thinks thus: "All these three realms are just like a dream. When I have become fully and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, I shall teach the Dharma to all just as it is, teaching it truly." Subhūti, this too should be recognized as a defining characteristic of the irreversibility of an irreversible bodhisattva great being.

Furthermore, Subhūti, when, even within the dream of an irreversible bodhisattva great being, he sees the beings of the hells, he thinks thus: "Just as, in the buddha-field where I have become fully and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, all the lower realms of every kind will, in every way and from every direction, entirely fail to arise — so shall it be." Subhūti, this too should be recognized as a defining characteristic of this irreversible bodhisattva great being's purification of the lower realms.

Subhūti, in this regard, other bodhisattva mahāsattvas should recognize: "Alas, this bodhisattva mahāsattva has been empowered by Māra." Why is that? Because whatever aspects, signs, and marks belong to irreversible bodhisattva mahāsattvas are absent in him.

Furthermore, Subhūti, through such an empowerment that bodhisattva mahāsattva will generate manifest conceit. Having generated manifest conceit, overpowered by pride and puffed up with arrogance, overpowered by conceit, overpowered by Māra's empowerment, he will come to despise other bodhisattva mahāsattvas, will treat them scornfully, will deride them, will

mock them, and will revile them. Subhūti, this too should be recognized as Māra's work, done through Māra's empowerment of that bodhisattva mahāsattva.

Subhūti, further still, one should recognize Māra's work through the showing of a name and the giving of a prophecy of a name to the bodhisattva mahāsattva. Subhūti, how should one recognize Māra's work through the showing of a name and the giving of a prophecy of a name to the bodhisattva mahāsattva? Subhūti, here the evil Māra comes in the guise of a monk and gives this prophecy to the bodhisattva mahāsattva: "Whatever mind you generated, thinking, 'Oh, may my name be thus-and-such when I have become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening,' following after that name, examining and analyzing it with your mind—accordingly, when you become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, your name will indeed be thus-and-such." In this way he gives him a prophecy of that very name.

Then the bodhisattva whose wisdom is corrupted and who is unskilled in means thinks to himself: "This monk has shown me exactly what I myself followed after with the name, thinking, 'Oh, may my name be thus-and-such when I have become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening,' and examined and analyzed accordingly." He then considers: "The name that I myself contemplated and followed after, and the name spoken either by that evil Māra himself, or by those of Māra's faction who manifested through magical emanation, or by the monk empowered by Māra—comparing these two, however my generation of mind arose, and however this monk has shown my name, the two names match." Having reasoned thus, he comes to think: "I have already been prophesied by name to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening by those past tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas."

Subhūti, whatever aspects, signs, and marks of irreversible bodhisattva mahāsattvas I have taught are absent in him, and he has become separated from them. Yet through that showing of a name and giving of a prophecy of a name, he generates conceit...

Subhūti, I do not say that the various dwelling places such as the wilderness, the outskirts of villages, uninhabited regions, forest thickets, mountain caves, charnel grounds, heaps of straw, and so forth constitute the solitude of the bodhisattva great being.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, if that is so, then apart from dwelling in the various dwelling places such as the wilderness, the outskirts of villages, uninhabited regions, forest thickets, mountain caves, charnel grounds, and heaps of straw, what other solitude is there for the bodhisattva great being? Blessed One, what else is the solitude of the bodhisattva great being like?

Having said this, the Blessed One spoke thus to venerable Subhūti:

Subhūti, if the bodhisattva great being becomes secluded from mental engagements associated with the śrāvakas, and becomes secluded from mental engagements associated with the pratyekabuddhas, then in that way the bodhisattva great being dwells in solitude. Even while dwelling within a town, he dwells by means of the perfection of wisdom, skillful means, loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, and great compassion. Dwelling with this manner of dwelling is itself dwelling in solitude.

Subhūti, moreover I grant this solitude to the bodhisattva great being: seclusion from mental engagements associated with the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. If the bodhisattva great being passes day and night dwelling with this solitude, then he dwells in solitude.

If the bodhisattva great being, while dwelling in dwelling places such as the wilderness, forest thickets, mountain caves, charnel grounds, and the outskirts of villages, dwells with this solitude just described, then the bodhisattva great being dwells in solitude.

Subhūti, as for the solitude that the evil Māra has taught—the solitude of dwelling in dwelling places such as the wilderness

Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom itself should be recognized as the spiritual friend of the bodhisattva, the great being. Subhūti, all six of the perfections should be recognized as the spiritual friend of the bodhisattva, the great being. The six perfections themselves are the Teacher. The six perfections are the path. The six perfections are illumination. The six perfections are the lamp. The six perfections are the light. The six perfections are the protector. The six perfections are the refuge. The six perfections are the resting place. The six perfections are the ally. The six perfections are the island. The six perfections are the mother. The six perfections are the father. The six perfections are that which brings about knowledge, realization, and abiding for the sake of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Why is this so? Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom depends upon these, namely, upon the six perfections. Subhūti, whatever Tathāgatas, Arhats, perfectly complete Buddhas there were in the past who, having manifestly and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, passed into complete nirvāṇa — the omniscience of all those Blessed Buddhas also arose from precisely these six perfections. Subhūti, whatever Tathāgatas, Arhats, perfectly complete Buddhas will arise in future times, who will manifestly and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — the omniscience of all those Blessed Buddhas will also arise from precisely these six perfections. Subhūti, in immeasurable, innumerable, incalculable, inconceivable world systems, whatever Tathāgatas, Arhats, perfectly complete Buddhas there are who, having thus manifestly and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, are dwelling, living, and teaching the Dharma — the omniscience of all those Blessed Buddhas also arose from precisely these six perfections. Subhūti, at present too, I myself, the Tathāgata, Arhat, perfectly complete Buddha, having manifestly and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — Subhūti, my own omniscience likewise arose from precisely these six perfections.

Why is this so? Subhūti, within these six perfections are gathered the thirty-seven factors concordant with awakening, the four immeasurable abodes of Brahmā, the four means of gathering [disciples], and however many qualities of a buddha there are — the wisdom of a buddha, the wisdom of self-arising, the inconceivable wisdom, the immeasurable wisdom, the incalculable wisdom, the unequaled wisdom, the wisdom equal to the unequaled, and the wisdom of omniscience — all of these are gathered within the six perfections.

Subhūti, therefore these six perfections themselves are the spiritual friend of the bodhisattva, the great being. These six perfections themselves are the Teacher. The six perfections are the path. The six perfections are illumination. The six perfections are the lamp. The six perfections are the light. The six perfections are the protector. The six perfections are the refuge. The six perfections are the resting place. The six perfections are the ally.

Blessed One, if isolation or emptiness does not fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and if, apart from the Blessed One's isolation and emptiness, there is no other phenomenon whatsoever that fully and completely becomes a buddha, or fully and completely awakens, or by which one fully and completely awakens that can be observed, then,

Blessed One, how am I to understand the meaning of what has been explained? Blessed One, please teach this. Sugata, please teach this.

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke thus to venerable Subhūti: Subhūti, what do you think? Have sentient beings, from time without beginning, engaged in grasping at "I" and grasping at "mine"?

Subhūti said: Blessed One, it is so. Sugata, it is so. Sentient beings, from time without beginning, engage in grasping at "I" and grasping at "mine."

The Blessed One said: Subhūti, what do you think? Are the grasping at "I" and the grasping at "mine" empty?

Subhūti said: Blessed One, they are empty. Sugata, they are empty.

The Blessed One said: Subhūti, what do you think? Do sentient beings wander in saṃsāra through grasping at "I" and grasping at "mine"?

Subhūti said: Blessed One, it is so. Sugata, it is so. Sentient beings wander in saṃsāra through grasping at "I" and grasping at "mine."

The Blessed One said: Subhūti, in this way it is fully known that sentient beings become thoroughly afflicted. Just as sentient beings grasp and become attached, so they become thoroughly afflicted; yet in this there is no one whatsoever who becomes thoroughly afflicted. Subhūti, just as there is no grasping and no attachment, so grasping at "I" and grasping at "mine" are not fully known to exist. Subhūti, in this way it is fully known that sentient beings become purified. Just as there is no grasping at and no attachment to sentient beings, so they become purified; yet in this there is no one whatsoever who becomes purified.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva, a great being, practices in this way, he practices the Perfection of Wisdom. Subhūti, in this way, within the isolation of all phenomena and the emptiness of all phenomena, it is fully known that sentient beings become thoroughly afflicted and become purified.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, it is truly wondrous that, within the isolation of all phenomena and the emptiness of all phenomena in this way, the affliction and purification of sentient beings are also fully known. Blessed One, when a bodhisattva, a great being, practices in this way, he practices the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, when a bodhisattva, a great being, practices in this way, he does not practice with respect to form; he does not practice with respect to feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. Blessed One, when a bodhisattva, a great being, practices in this way, he becomes

unshakable by the world together with its gods, humans, and asuras. Blessed One, when a bodhisattva, a great being, practices in this way, he surpasses the conduct of all persons belonging to the vehicle of the śrāvakas and all persons belonging to the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, and he attains the state that cannot itself be surpassed. Why is this? Blessed One, because buddhahood itself, tathāgatahood itself, self-arisen wisdom itself, and omniscience itself cannot be surpassed.

Subhoti, if, when it is explained in this way, the bodhisattva great being is not dismayed, is not frightened at all, does not become terrified at all, and does not despair, then, Subhoti, that bodhisattva great being should be known to be practicing this Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, but does the Perfection of Wisdom practice the Perfection of Wisdom?

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, it does not.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, but does that emptiness which is the emptiness of the Perfection of Wisdom practice the Perfection of Wisdom?

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, it does not.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, but apart from the emptiness of the Perfection of Wisdom, is there any phenomenon at all that is observed as practicing the Perfection of Wisdom?

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, there is not.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, but does emptiness practice the Perfection of Wisdom?

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, it does not.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, but is any phenomenon that practices the Perfection of Wisdom observed within this emptiness?

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, it is not.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, but does emptiness practice emptiness?

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, it does not.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, but does form practice the Perfection of Wisdom?

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, it does not.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, but do feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness practice the Perfection of Wisdom?

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, they do not.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, but apart from form, is there any phenomenon at all that is observed as practicing the Perfection of Wisdom?

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, there is not.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, but apart from feeling, perception, and formations, and apart from consciousness, is there any phenomenon at all that is observed as practicing the Perfection of Wisdom?

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, there is not.

Subhoti said: Blessed One, then how does the bodhisattva great being come to practice the Perfection of Wisdom?

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said this to the venerable Subhoti: Subhoti, do you yourself truly and directly see any phenomenon that practices the Perfection of Wisdom?

Subhoti said: Blessed One, I do not.

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, do you truly and directly see that Perfection of Wisdom in which the bodhisattva great being practices?

Subhoti said: Blessed One, I do not.

The Blessed One declared: Subhoti, what do you think? Do you truly and directly see any phenomenon whatsoever that cannot be observed? And is that very phenomenon born, or coming to be born, or arisen; or ceased, or coming to cease, or ceasing?

Subhoti said: Blessed One, I do not.

The Blessed One declared:

Kauśika, those sentient beings who will listen to this profound Perfection of Wisdom, and who, having heard it, will hold it, retain it, read it, master it, recite it fully, teach it, explain it, transm

Moreover, they will surpass and go beyond all those stream-enterers, once-returners, non-returners, arhats, and pratyekabuddhas. Those bodhisattva mahāsattvas do not merely surpass and go beyond stream-enterers, once-returners, non-returners, arhats, and pratyekabuddhas

alone; they will also surpass and go beyond all those bodhisattva mahāsattvas who are great lords of generosity but who are devoid of the perfection of wisdom and skillful means.

Those bodhisattva mahāsattvas do not merely surpass and go beyond bodhisattva mahāsattvas who are great lords of generosity alone; they will also surpass and go beyond all those who are endowed with an aggregate of moral discipline that is unimpaired, faultless, unblemished, perfect, pure, and unadulterated, but who are devo

Furthermore, Ānanda, at the time when a bodhisattva great being is training in the perfection of wisdom, applying himself in yoga to the perfection of wisdom, and cultivating the perfection of wisdom, Ānanda, at that time all those evil Māras throughout the great trichiliocosm become filled with doubt, thinking thus: "Will this bodhisattva great being, without turning back midway, actualize the true limit on the level of a śrāvaka or a pratyekabuddha, or will he fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?"

Ānanda, furthermore, at the time when a bodhisattva great being dwells, having taken his stand in the perfection of wisdom, at that time those evil Māras are pierced by the dart of sorrow.

Ānanda, furthermore, at the time when a bodhisattva great being practices the perfection of wisdom and applies himself in yoga to the perfection of wisdom, at that time those evil Māras cause harm to the bodhisattva great being. They think, "How can this bodhisattva great being be made to become discouraged and terrified, and how can even a single generation of his mind of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening be exhausted?" And so they produce terrors, and they also cause and display things such as falling meteors and blazing fires in every direction.

Ānanda, regarding this, evil Māra does not intend to harm and come to every single bodhisattva great being; rather, he comes to some, and to others he does not come.

Ānanda asked: "Blessed One, to what kind of bodhisattva great being does evil Māra intend to come and cause harm?"

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, if a bodhisattva great being has failed, since the very beginning, to generate a mind of trust and belief when the perfection of wisdom is being taught, then, Ānanda, evil Māra intends to harm

that bodhisattva great being and comes to him, and he will also find an opportunity.

"Ānanda, furthermore, if a bodhisattva, when this profound perfection of wisdom is being taught, becomes doubtful, wondering 'Is this the perfection of wisdom or is it not?' and a double mind arises, then, Ānanda, to that bodhisattva great being in whom such doubt has arisen, evil Māra also intends to cause harm and comes, and finds an opportunity there.

"Ānanda, furthermore, if in this regard a bodhisattva great being is separated from a spiritual friend and comes to be entirely seized by an evil companion, then he does not listen when this profound perfection of wisdom, this profound abode, is being taught; and because he does not listen, he does not understand; and because he does not understand, he does not ask, 'How, then, should the perfection of wisdom be cultivated?' Ānanda, to this bodhisattva great being also, evil Māra intends to cause harm and comes, and finds an opportunity there.

"Ānanda, furthermore, whatever bodhisattva great being comes to rely on engagement in upholding what is not the true Dharma, thinking, 'This is my companion, who in every matter will not abandon me. I have many other companions who are bodhisattva great beings, but they do not fulfill my intentions —"

"I will not speak harshly to another, saying 'you there,' nor will I answer and speak with rough words. In quarrels, disputes, and conflicts, I will act like one who is foolish, deaf, and mute. Even upon hearing another speak badly, say bad things, and utter bad words, I will not harbor ill will toward others. This coming to know the faults and defects of another is not good for me; it is not my proper concern. This thought, 'I will listen to the faults and defects of another,' is not my proper concern, I should think. Why is that? Because I should not disturb my superior intention. Having asked myself, 'After I have become fully and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, is it not my intention to bring happiness to all sentient beings through all the necessities of happiness and to bring them to complete liberation from suffering,' would it be that I have generated a mind of harm? And even when others and I are hostile toward one another, would it be a disturbance in me if I do not generate a mind of harm toward others? This is not something I should do. Rather, through firm fortitude, I will withstand whatever comes from others, and even toward one who creates an obstacle to

my very life, I will not become disturbed, nor will a frown of anger arise on my face. This, Ānanda, I declare to be the definite emergence of that bodhisattva great being.

Ānanda, the bodhisattva great being should abide in this same way even in the presence of individuals belonging to the śrāvaka vehicle. Just as one does not become disturbed in the presence of any sentient being whatsoever, so should one abide in the presence of all sentient beings.

Ānanda, how should the bodhisattva great being abide in the presence of other individuals belonging to the bodhisattva vehicle? Ānanda, it is like this: just as one regards the Teacher, so should one abide, thinking, 'These bodhisattva great beings are my teachers.' 'These bodhisattva great beings have entered the same vehicle as I.' 'These bodhisattva great beings have entered the same path as I.' 'These bodhisattva great beings have an intention concordant with mine.' 'These bodhisattva great beings have genuinely entered a vehicle concordant with mine.' Whatever they should train in, I too should train in that. Just as they should train, so should I train in the same way. Even if some among them remain dwelling in a mixed manner, I should not dwell in a mixed manner. But if, through mental engagement endowed with omniscience, they dwell without mixing, then I too should train in that same way.

Ānanda, when the bodhisattva great being trains in omniscience in this way, there will be no obstacle to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening; he will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

This concludes, from the noble Eight Thousand Line Perfection of Wisdom, the chapter called 'Manifest Pride,' the twenty-fourth.

Then the venerable Subhūti said this to the Blessed One: 'Blessed One, in what should the bodhisattva great being train in order to train in omniscience?' The Blessed One declared: 'Subhūti, if the bodhisattva great being trains in exhaustion, he trains in omniscience.'

Subhūti, likewise, among the classes of sentient beings, those bodhisattva great beings who have entered this great path—namely, the path of the Perfection of Wisdom—thinking, "I shall become fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening," are few. Among the classes of sentient beings, those who have entered the path of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas are far more numerous.

Subhūti, further, it is like this: among the classes of sentient beings, those who have properly undertaken and abide in the karma that will cause them to become Śakra (Indra) himself are few. Among the classes of sentient beings, those who have properly undertaken and abide in the karma that will cause them to be born into the world of the gods are far more numerous.

Subhūti, likewise, among the classes of sentient beings, those bodhisattva great beings who train in the training of the Perfection of Wisdom are few. Subhūti, among the classes of sentient beings, those who train in the training of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas are far more numerous.

Subhūti, further, it is like this: among the classes of sentient beings, those who have properly undertaken and abide in the karma that will cause them to become Brahmā himself are few. Among the classes of sentient beings, those who have properly undertaken and abide in the karma that will cause them to be born into Brahmā's retinue are far more numerous.

Subhūti, likewise, among the classes of sentient beings, those bodhisattva great beings who are irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening are few. Subhūti, among the classes of sentient beings, those bodhisattva great beings who are liable to turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening are far more numerous.

Subhūti, therefore, among the classes of sentient beings, those sentient beings who have genuinely entered unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening are few. Subhūti, fewer still than those few are the sentient beings who accomplish suchness. Subhūti, fewer still than those very few who accomplish suchness are those who make the Perfection of Wisdom their yogic practice. Subhūti, fewer still than those few who make the Perfection of Wisdom their yogic practice are those bodhisattva great beings who are irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Subhūti, therefore, since one wishes to be counted among the number of those irreversible bodhisattva great beings—fewer even than the already few—one should train in and make a yogic practice of this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, furthermore, when a bodhisattva great being trains thus in the Perfection of Wisdom, no mind of stinginess arises, no mind of doubt arises, no mind of envy arises, no mind of miserliness arises, no mind of degenerate moral discipline arises, no mind of malice arises, no mind of laziness arises, no mind of distraction arises, and no mind of corrupt wisdom arises.

Subhūti, in this way, when the bodhisattva great being trains in the Perfection of Wisdom, all the perfections come to be properly grasped, all the perfections come to be thoroughly grasped, all the perfections come to be supremely grasped, all the perfections come to be followed after, and all the perfections come to be gathered within. Subhūti, it is like this, for example—

Just as, within the view of the transitory collection, all sixty-two views come to be gathered, Subhūti, so too, when the bodhisattva great being trains in the Perfection of Wisdom, all the perfections come to be gathered within it. Subhūti, it is like this, for example: within the life faculty of a person, all the faculties come to be gathered. Subhūti, in just this way, when one trains in the Perfection of Wisdom, all the virtuous qualities of the bodhisattva great being come to be gathered within it. Subhūti, it is like this, for example: when a person's life faculty ceases, all the faculties cease. Subhūti, in just this way, when the bodhisattva great being trains in the Perfection of Wisdom, ignorance ceases and all non-virtuous factors cease, while all the perfections come to be gathered within and thoroughly grasped. Subhūti, therefore, the bodhisattva great being who wishes to thoroughly grasp all the perfections should train in the Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, when the bodhisattva great being trains in the Perfection of Wisdom, he trains as the foremost of all sentient beings. Why is this? Because it is the very foremost of merit.

Subhūti, what do you think? However many sentient beings exist in the great trichiliocosm, however many are gathered by way of being reckoned as sentient beings—are all these many? Subhūti replied: Blessed One, even the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa alone are many—how much more so all the sentient beings of the great trichiliocosm! The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, if a single bodhisattva great being, for as long as he lived, remained and attended upon all those sentient beings with clothing, food, bedding, medicine for illness, requisites, and everything beneficial—Subhūti, what do you think? Would that bodhisattva great being generate much merit from that basis? Subhūti replied: Blessed One, much. Sugata, much. The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, if a bodhisattva great being were to meditate on this Perfection of Wisdom even for the briefest moment—even for the time it takes to snap one's fingers—he would generate far greater merit than that. Why is this? Subhūti, the meaning of the Perfection of Wisdom of the bodhisattva great being is so vast because the Perfection of Wisdom is that which brings the bodhisattva

great being to the attainment of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Subhūti, therefore, the bodhisattva great being who wishes to become fully and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, who wishes to become unsurpassed among all sentient beings, who wishes to become the protector of all beings without protector, who wishes to attain the domain of the buddhas, who wishes to attain the state of being foremost among the buddhas' herd, who wishes to delight in the buddhas' display, who wishes to roar the lion's roar of the buddhas, who wishes to attain the perfection of the buddhas, and who wishes to give discourse on the Dharma throughout the great trichiliocosm—such a bodhisattva great being should train in this Perfection of Wisdom.

Kauśika, moreover, it is possible to take the measure of a world system of four great continents, weighed out in units of measure, but Kauśika, it is not possible to take the measure of the merit of that generation of a mind endowed with rejoicing.

Kauśika, moreover, it is possible to take the measure of a small chiliocosm, weighed out in units of measure, but Kauśika, it is not possible to take the measure of the merit of that generation of a mind endowed with rejoicing.

Kauśika, moreover, it is possible to take the measure of a middling dichiliocosm, weighed out in units of measure, but Kauśika, it is not possible to take the measure of the merit of that generation of a mind endowed with rejoicing.

Kauśika, moreover, it is possible to take the measure of a great trichiliocosm, weighed out in units of measure, but Kauśika, it is not possible to take the measure of the merit of that son of noble family or daughter of noble family generating a mind endowed with rejoicing at the bodhisattva great being.

When this had been spoken, Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One: Blessed One, whatever sentient beings, upon hearing that the merit of generating a mind of rejoicing at bodhisattva great beings, from the very first generation of their mind up until their manifest and complete awakening into unsurpassed, perfect and complete buddhahood, is thus immeasurable, do not listen to it, do not wish for it, do not see it, and do not think to rejoice in it — those should be recognized as ones under the influence of māra.

Blessed One, whatever sentient beings do not rejoice in this generation of mind of the bodhisattva great beings have turned to the side of māra.

Blessed One, whatever sentient beings do not rejoice in this generation of mind of the bodhisattva great beings have died and transmigrated from the abode of māra.

Why is that? Blessed One, those who actually accomplish these generations of mind, and those who dedicate these generations of mind toward unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, or who rejoice in these generations of mind — they are the ones who destroy the abode of māra.

Blessed One, it is those bodhisattva great beings who have generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening whose generations of mind should be rejoiced in.

Blessed One, I shall rejoice in this generation of mind of those sons of noble family or daughters of noble family who have not forsaken the Tathāgata, have not forsaken the Dharma, and have not forsaken the Saṅgha.

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke thus to Śakra, lord of the gods: Kauśika, it is so, it is so. Kauśika, one should rejoice in these generations of mind of those sons of noble family or daughters of noble family who have not forsaken the Tathāgata, have not forsaken the Dharma, and have not forsaken the Saṅgha.

Kauśika, if those who follow the bodhisattva vehicle, or the pratyekabuddha vehicle, or the śrāvaka vehicle rejoice in this generation of mind, they will swiftly bring joy to the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas, and will not bring displeasure.

When this had been spoken, Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One:

The Blessed One said: It is so, it is so. Sugata, it is so. Son of noble family or daughter of noble family, whether followers of the bodhisattva vehicle, the pratyekabuddha vehicle, or the śrāvaka vehicle who rejoice in these generations of mind, they will most swiftly bring joy to the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas, and will not bring displeasure. And by means of those roots of virtue consisting in generations of mind accompanied by such rejoicing, wherever they come to be born, they will be honored there, they will be revered, esteemed, worshipped, adorned with offerings, and attended upon. They will never see forms that are unpleasant to the mind, never hear sounds that are unpleasant to the mind, never smell odors that are unpleasant to the mind, never taste flavors that are unpleasant to the mind, and never

touch tangible objects that are unpleasant to the mind. It should be understood that they will not be born in the lower realms; it should be understood that they will be born in the higher realms. Why is this? Because those sons of noble family or daughters of noble family generate immeasurable and innumerable roots of virtue by rejoicing in that which brings happiness to all sentient beings.

Blessed One, whoever generates the aspiration and rejoices in the generation of mind of those individuals who follow the bodhisattva vehicle — for them too, that generation of mind will increase and cause them to attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And having become fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, they will bring immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings to the complete transcendence of sorrow.

The Blessed One declared: Kauśika, by the power of the Tathāgata, what you have said is so, it is so. Kauśika, if a son of noble family or a daughter of noble family rejoices in the generation of mind of those individuals who follow the bodhisattva vehicle, then, Kauśika, by this method, that son or daughter of noble family, by rejoicing in the generation of mind of those who follow the bodhisattva vehicle, will come to rejoice in, generate, and accomplish the roots of virtue of immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, how does a mind that is like an illusion come to fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke thus to venerable Subhūti: Subhūti, what do you think — do you truly and correctly perceive mind as being like an illusion?

Subhūti said: Blessed One, that is not so.

The Blessed One said: Subhūti, what do you think — do you truly and correctly perceive illusion?

Subhūti said: Blessed One, that is not so. Blessed One, I do not truly and correctly perceive mind that is like an illusion, nor do I truly and correctly perceive illusion.

The Blessed One said: Subhūti, what do you think — since you do not truly and correctly perceive mind that is like an illusion, nor illusion itself, is there, apart from illusion or mind that is like an illusion, some other phenomenon that you truly and correctly perceive as the phenomenon by which one fully and completely awakens to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?

Subhūti said:

Blessed One, that is not so. Blessed One, apart from illusion or mind that is like an illusion, I do not truly and correctly perceive any phenomenon by which one fully and completely awakens to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Blessed One, since I do not truly and correctly perceive any such phenomenon apart from illusion or mind that is like an illusion, what phenomenon could I possibly declare to exist or not to exist? There is no way to apprehend that utterly isolated phenomenon as existing or as not existing, and it is not through any phenomenon that is utterly isolated that one fully and completely awakens to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Why is that? Blessed One, it is not through a non-existent phenomenon that one fully and completely awakens to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Blessed One, therefore the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly isolated, and that phenomenon which is utterly isolated is not something to be cultivated in meditation, since through it one neither attains nor abandons any phenomenon whatsoever. Blessed One, how then, in dependence on the Perfection of Wisdom, which is utterly isolated, could a bodhisattva great being fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening? Blessed One, unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening is likewise utterly isolated. Blessed One, since at the time when the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly isolated, unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening is also utterly isolated, how at that time could what is isolated fully and completely awaken to what is isolated?

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke thus to venerable Subhūti: Excellent, Subhūti, excellent! Subhūti, it is just so, it is just so. Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly isolated, and unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening is likewise utterly isolated. Subhūti, it is precisely because the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly isolated that one fully and completely awakens to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, which is itself utterly isolated. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva great being correctly knows that the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly isolated, that is not the Perfection of Wisdom. Subhūti, it is in this way that a bodhisattva great being, in dependence on the Perfection of Wisdom, fully and completely awakens to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Subhūti, yet there is also no such thing as fully and completely awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening in dependence on the Perfection of Wisdom. It is not through what is isolated that one fully and completely awakens to what is isolated; nevertheless, a bodhisattva great

being does fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and yet does not fully and completely awaken without depending on the Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, if I understand the meaning of what the Blessed One has taught, then, Blessed One, a bodhisattva great being practices in a profound domain of meaning.

The Blessed One said: Subhūti, it is just so, it is just so. Subhūti, a bodhisattva great being practices in a profound domain of meaning. Subhūti, when a bodhisattva great being practices even in that profound domain of meaning, and yet does not actualize that meaning as the level of a śrāvaka or the level of a pratyekabuddha, this is a difficult thing to accomplish.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, if I understand the meaning of what the Blessed One has taught, then a bodhisattva great being does not accomplish anything difficult at all. Why is that? Blessed One, it is thus: that very phenomenon which is being directly realized is itself not apprehended; that phenomenon which is to be directly realized is also not apprehended; and that by which one directly realizes that phenomenon is also not apprehended.

Blessed One, if, when this is taught in this way, a bodhisattva great being does not become disheartened, does not become discouraged, does not become disheartened at all, does not turn away in mind, does not become fearful, does not become terrified at all, and does not fall into complete terror, then he practices the Perfection of Wisdom. If he does not truly perceive, "I am practicing," then he practices the Perfection of Wisdom. If he does not, again and again, truly perceive, "I have drawn near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening," then he practices the Perfection of Wisdom. If he does not think, "I have left far behind the level of the śrāvaka and the level of the pratyekabuddha," then he practices the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, it is like this: space does not think, "I am near to some and far from others." Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no conceptual thought in space. Blessed One, likewise, when a bodhisattva great being practices the Perfection of Wisdom, he does not think, "I have drawn near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and the level of the śrāvaka and the level of the pratyekabuddha are far from me." Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no conceptual thought in the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, it is like this: a magically created person does not think, "The magician is near to me, but this other assembled crowd of people is far from

me." Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no conceptual thought in a magically created person. Blessed One, likewise, when a bodhisattva great being practices the Perfection of Wisdom, he does not think, "I have drawn near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and the level of the śrāvaka and the level of the pratyekabuddha are far from me." Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no conceptual thought in the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, it is like this: a reflected image does not think, "That object in dependence upon which the reflection arises is near to me, but those who have not yet approached the mirror or the vessel filled with water are far from me." Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no conceptual thought in a reflected image. Blessed One, likewise, when a bodhisattva great being practices the Perfection of Wisdom, he does not think, "I have drawn near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and the level of the śrāvaka and the level of the pratyekabuddha are far from me." Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no conceptual thought in the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, it is like this: for example, the Tathāgata has nothing that is pleasing or displeasing toward anyone. Why is that? Because the Tathāgata has abandoned all conception and discursive thought. Blessed One, likewise, when a bodhisattva great being practices the Perfection of Wisdom, he too has nothing that is pleasing or displeasing to anyone. Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no discursive thought in the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, just as the Tathāgata has abandoned all conception and discursive thought, so too, Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom has abandoned all conception and discursive thought.

Blessed One, it is like this: for example, whatever emanation is emanated by a Tathāgata, arhat, perfect complete buddha does not think, "I have drawn near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and the level of the śrāvaka and the pratyekabuddha are far from me." Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no discursive thought in an emanation. Blessed One, likewise, when a bodhisattva great being practices the Perfection of Wisdom, he too does not think, "I have drawn near to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and the level of the śrāvaka and the level of the pratyekabuddha are far from me." Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no discursive thought in the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, it is like this: for example, whatever action that emanation performs for the sake of performing some deed, that deed is indeed performed, yet that emanation has no discursive thought about it. Why is that? It is because there is no discursive thought in that emanation. Blessed One, likewise, the bodhisattva great being also, for the sake of performing whatever deed is to be performed, does perform the cultivation of this Perfection of Wisdom, and it is indeed performed, yet that Perfection of Wisdom has no discursive thought about it. Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no discursive thought in the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, it is like this: for example, when a skilled carpenter or a carpenter's apprentice constructs a wooden mechanical device fashioned in the form of a man or a woman and sets it in motion, then, although the deed for whose sake it was made is indeed performed, that assembly of wood has no discursive thought about it. Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no discursive thought in that assembly of wood. Blessed One, likewise, the bodhisattva great being also, for the sake of performing whatever deed is to be performed, does perform the cultivation of this Perfection of Wisdom, and it is indeed performed, yet that Perfection of Wisdom has no discursive thought about it. Why is that? Blessed One, it is because there is no discursive thought in the Perfection of Wisdom.

This concludes the twenty-sixth chapter, called "Like an Illusion," from the Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines.

Then venerable Śāriputra said this to venerable Subhūti: "Venerable Subhūti, how wonderful it is that the bodhisattva great being who practices the Perfection of Wisdom practices what is truly essential." When this was said, venerable Subhūti said this to venerable Śāriputra:

Subhūti, such and such bodhisattva great beings should be recognized as irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. For them, no obstacle will arise from Māra or from others. Why is this? Subhūti, even if all the sentient beings whatsoever that exist in a great trichiliocosm of three thousand worlds were to become wicked Māras, and each and every one of those wicked Māras were to manifest that many hosts of Māra's forces, still, Subhūti, those wicked Māras would be unable to create an obstacle from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening for that bodhisattva great being who is heeded by the buddhas and who practices the perfection of wisdom.

Subhūti, moreover, not to speak of all the sentient beings of a great trichiliocosm of three thousand worlds becoming wicked Māras — Subhūti, even if all the sentient beings whatsoever that exist in as many great trichiliocosms of three thousand worlds as there are grains of sand in the Ganges River were to become wicked Māras, and each and every one of those wicked Māras were to manifest that many hosts of Māra's forces, still, Subhūti, those wicked Māras would be unable to create an obstacle from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening for that bodhisattva great being who is heeded by the buddhas and who practices the perfection of wisdom.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva great being possesses two qualities, at that time the wicked Māras or the gods of Māra's retinue find it difficult to overpower him. What are the two? They are these: he has not forsaken any sentient being whatsoever, and he has realized that all phenomena are empty. Subhūti, a bodhisattva great being who possesses these two qualities is difficult for the wicked Māras or the gods of Māra's retinue to overpower.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva great being possesses two other qualities, the wicked Māras or the gods of Māra's retinue find it difficult to overpower him. What are the two? They are these: he acts in accordance with what he has said, and he is heeded by the buddhas, the blessed ones. Subhūti, a bodhisattva great being who possesses these two qualities is difficult for the wicked Māras or the gods of Māra's retinue to overpower.

Subhūti, the gods too will think of approaching a bodhisattva great being who practices in this way. Having approached, they will think of inquiring after him fully, they will think of questioning him thoroughly, and they will think of paying him homage. They will also inspire in him joyful eagerness, saying: Son of noble family, you will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Son of noble family, since this is so, you should abide by this very abiding, namely, the abiding of the perfection of wisdom. Why is this? Son of noble family, if you abide by this very abiding in which you now dwell, and practice accordingly, you will become a protector for sentient beings who have no protector; you will become a guardian for sentient beings who have no guardian; you will become a refuge for sentient beings who have no refuge; you will become a resting place for sentient beings who have no resting place; you will become a support for sentient beings who have no support; you will become an island for sentient beings who have no island; you will become a light for sentient beings who are blind; you will become a guide for sentient beings who have no guide; you will become a foundation for sentient beings

who have no foundation.

Kauśika, therefore, sons of noble family or daughters of noble family who wish for the supreme excellence of all sentient beings, who wish for their excellent attainment, who wish for their attainment as the foremost, who wish for their perfect attainment, who wish for their supreme and perfect attainment, who wish for their marvelous attainment, who wish for their unexcelled attainment, who wish for their unsurpassed attainment, who wish for their attainment beyond which there is none higher, who wish for their unequaled attainment, and who wish for their attainment equal to the unequaled, should abide in this abiding place in which the bodhisattva great beings who practice and dwell in the Perfection of Wisdom abide.

This concludes the twenty-seventh chapter, called "The Chapter on the Essence," from the noble Eight Thousand Line Perfection of Wisdom.

The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, Bam po Twenty-Two.

Then at that time another god's son, together with the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, taking mandārava and great mandārava flowers, went to where the Blessed One was. At that time six hundred monks had gathered and were seated in that assembly. They too rose from their seats, arranged their upper robes over one shoulder, placed their right knee upon the ground, and, turning toward where the Blessed One was, joined their palms and paid homage. Through the power of the Buddha, the cupped hands of those monks became filled with mandārava and great mandārava flowers, and with those mandārava and great mandārava flowers they scattered, cast, and profusely strewed offerings upon the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, speaking these words: "Blessed One, we shall practice this Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, we shall abide in this unsurpassed abiding of the Perfection of Wisdom."

Then at that time the Blessed One smiled. This is the nature of things (dharmatā): whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, at that time rays of light of various colors and many hues—blue, yellow, red, white, madder, crystal, silver, and gold—issue forth from the mouth of the Blessed One. These illuminated the boundless, limitless, endless world systems everywhere, then rose upward as far as the world of Brahmā, and then returned, circled the Blessed One three times, and disappeared into the crown of the Blessed One's head.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee upon the ground, and, turning toward where the Blessed One was, joined his palms, paid homage, and said this to the Blessed One: "Since the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, does not smile without cause or condition, Blessed One, what is the cause, what is the condition for this smile that the Blessed One has displayed?"

When he had said this, the Blessed One spoke thus to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, in a future time, in an eon like a scattering of stars, these six hundred monks will fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and having become perfectly awakened buddhas, they will teach the Dharma to sentient beings. They will all bear a single name, namely 'Flower-Strewn,' and as Tathāgatas, Arhats, perfectly complete Buddhas and Teachers, they will appear in the world. Ānanda, moreover, the assemblies of śrāvaka Saṅgha of those Tathāgatas, Arhats, perfectly complete Buddhas called Flower-Strewn will all be equal."

Ānanda, as for those who do not disparage this Perfection of Wisdom, who do not oppose it, who do not disturb it, who do not destroy it, who do not abandon it, who do not suppress it, and who do not intend to harm it, know that those bodhisattva great beings have performed service to the Victors (jinas) of the past. Ānanda, it is also thus: if the aspiration of a bodhisattva great being for unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening is never to be deceived, then it follows that a bodhisattva great being who has generated roots of virtue in the presence of the Tathāgatas, Arhats, perfectly complete Buddhas, does not thereby bring about a maturation for the sake of śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas. Rather, Ānanda, that bodhisattva great being is, for the most part, to be trained in the Perfection of Wisdom. Therefore, Ānanda, I entrust this Perfection of Wisdom to you, I hand it down to you, so that it may never disappear. Hold it, embrace it, recite it, master it completely, propagate it, and cause it to remain for a long time, so that not even a single syllable of it may be lost.

Ānanda, if you were to retain all the teachings that I have explained directly to you—apart from the Perfection of Wisdom—and later were to lose them, or set them aside, or forget them, Ānanda, you would not thereby be reckoned by me as having committed a fault. But Ānanda, it is thus: if you were to lose, set aside, or forget even a single phrase of speech endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom, Ānanda, you would thereby have committed a fault against me, and

you would not have pleased my mind. Ānanda, furthermore, if, having taken up the Perfection of Wisdom, you were later to lose it, set it aside, and forget it, you would not have honored me, not have revered me, not have esteemed me, not have made offerings to me, not have paid me homage, and not have served me. Ānanda, you would likewise not have honored, revered, esteemed, made offerings to, paid homage to, or served the Buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, future, and present.

Ānanda, if, having taken up the Perfection of Wisdom, you were later to lose it, set it aside, and forget it, Ānanda, you would thereby have committed a fault against me, and you would not have pleased my mind. Why is this? Ānanda, this Perfection of Wisdom is the mother who gives birth to and brings forth the Tathāgatas, Arhats, perfectly complete Buddhas of the past, future, and present; it is that which brings about the attainment of omniscience itself—so it has been declared by the Tathāgatas, Arhats, perfectly complete Buddhas.

Ānanda, therefore I entrust this Perfection of Wisdom to you, I hand it down to you, so that it may never disappear. Ānanda, this Perfection of Wisdom is to be taken up. Ānanda, this Perfection of Wisdom is to be held. Ānanda, this Perfection of Wisdom is to be recited. Ānanda, this Perfection of Wisdom is to be mastered completely. Ānanda, this Perfection of Wisdom is to be proclaimed. Ānanda, this Perfection of Wisdom is to be taught. Ānanda, this Perfection of Wisdom is to be explained in detail.

By cultivating it, one comes to fully embrace, in their wake, the awakening of the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future, and the present. Ānanda, if anyone, at the time when this Perfection of Wisdom is on the verge of disappearing, embraces it in its wake, that person will thereby come to fully embrace, in their wake, the awakening of the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future, and the present.

Why is this so? Ānanda, the awakening of the buddhas, the blessed ones, is born from the Perfection of Wisdom. Ānanda, whatever supreme, perfect awakening belonged to those tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas, the blessed ones, who arose in the past, that too, Ānanda, was born from the Perfection of Wisdom. Ānanda, whatever supreme, perfect awakening will belong to those tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas, the blessed ones, who will arise in the future, that too, Ānanda, will be born from the Perfection of Wisdom. Ānanda, whatever supreme, perfect awakening belongs to those tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas, the blessed

ones, who now dwell, live, and remain, presently, in all the immeasurable and countless world systems, that too, Ānanda, is born from this very Perfection of Wisdom. Ānanda, my own supreme, perfect awakening was likewise born from this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Ānanda, therefore, bodhisattva great beings who wish to fully and completely awaken to supreme, perfect awakening, and who wish to train in the six perfections, should listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, should take hold of it, bear it in mind, read it, master it fully, recite it aloud, teach it, explain it thoroughly, transmit it, chant it, write it down, and train in this very Perfection of Wisdom, making it their practice.

Why is this so? Ānanda, this Perfection of Wisdom is the mother of the bodhisattva great beings; it is what gives birth to them and nurtures them. Ānanda, whatever bodhisattva great beings, having trained in the six perfections, have definitely emerged into supreme, perfect awakening, or will definitely emerge into it, or are definitely emerging into it now, all of them, Ānanda, have trained in the six perfections in dependence upon the Perfection of Wisdom. All of them were born from the six perfections in dependence upon this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Why is this so? Ānanda, all the perfections are born from the Perfection of Wisdom, and it is this that brings about the attainment of supreme, perfect awakening. Ānanda, therefore, so that this Perfection of Wisdom may never disappear, I entrust it to you, I hand it over to you — this I say twice.

Ānanda, it is like this: this Perfection of Wisdom is the inexhaustible treasury of Dharma of the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas. Why is this so? Ānanda, throughout the beginningless cycle of saṃsāra in past time, whatever Dharma has been taught to sentient beings by the buddhas, the blessed ones — all of that was taught from this very treasury of Dharma, the Perfection of Wisdom.

Ānanda, whatever buddhas, blessed ones, will appear in the immeasurable cycles of future time, who, having become fully and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, will teach the Dharma to sentient beings — those buddhas, blessed ones, too, will teach it from this very treasury of Dharma, the Perfection of Wisdom. Ānanda, whatever buddhas, blessed ones, are now dwelling, living, and abiding in the immeasurable, innumerable world systems of the present, teaching the Dharma — those buddhas, blessed ones, too, Ānanda, will bring it forth from this very treasury

of Dharma, the Perfection of Wisdom. Ānanda, therefore this treasury of the Perfection of Wisdom is the inexhaustible treasury of Dharma.

Ānanda, suppose you were to teach the Dharma of the level of the śrāvakas to persons of the śrāvaka vehicle, and that, upon your teaching that Dharma, all the sentient beings existing throughout the great trichiliocosm were to actually become arhats — even so, you, teaching the Dharma by turning and repeatedly turning the wheel of Dharma of my śrāvakas, would not thereby have accomplished the deed of a śrāvaka. Ānanda, but if you were to teach or fully explain to a bodhisattva, a great being, even a single Dharma teaching endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom, then, by teaching the Dharma through turning and repeatedly turning the wheel of Dharma of my śrāvakas, you would please me — but not by that former teaching of the Dharma.

If someone were to cause all the sentient beings existing, however many there are, throughout the great trichiliocosm to attain arhatship, Ānanda, what do you think — would the accumulated merit arising from the meritorious act of the generosity of those arhats, together with the meritorious act arising from moral discipline, and the meritorious act arising from meditation, be a great mass of merit?

Ānanda said: It would be great, Blessed One. It would be great, Sugata (Well-Gone One).

The Blessed One said: Ānanda, greater than the merit of all those persons of the śrāvaka vehicle is the merit generated by a bodhisattva, a great being, who teaches the Dharma endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom. Ānanda, greater still than that is the merit generated by a bodhisattva, a great being, who teaches the Dharma endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom to another bodhisattva, a great being, even if only for the small duration of a single day. Ānanda, let alone a single day — even if only for the small duration of a morning; Ānanda, let alone teaching the Dharma for a morning — even if only for the small duration of a single hour; Ānanda, let alone a single hour — even if only for the small duration of a mere instant; Ānanda, let alone a mere instant — even for the duration of a single breath; Ānanda, let alone a single breath — even for the small duration of a single moment: Ānanda, whatever bodhisattva, great being, teaches the Dharma endowed with the Perfection of Wisdom to another bodhisattva, great being, for even a single moment, a single breath, or a mere instant — this generates far greater merit than that. Ānanda, by this gift of Dharma from that bodhisattva, great being, the roots of

virtue of all persons of the śrāvaka and pratyekabuddha vehicles are utterly outshone.

Subhūti, thus the bodhisattva great being views dependent origination as without extremes and without a middle. Subhūti, this way of viewing dependent origination is the unmixed quality present in the essence of awakening for the bodhisattva great being. Subhūti, whatever bodhisattva great being views dependent origination in this way will attain the wisdom of omniscience.

Subhūti, if any bodhisattva great being, through this actualization of the inexhaustible, practices the Perfection of Wisdom and views dependent origination, that one will not remain on the level of a śrāvaka or the level of a pratyekabuddha, but will instead abide in omniscience itself.

Subhūti, all those bodhisattva great beings who turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening do so because they do not rely upon this mental engagement and this skillful means, and thus they do not understand.

How does the bodhisattva great being, by practicing the Perfection of Wisdom through the actualization of the inexhaustible, actualize the Perfection of Wisdom? And how, through actualizing the inexhaustible, does he view dependent origination in relation to the Perfection of Wisdom? Subhūti, all those bodhisattva great beings who have turned back, are turning back, and will turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening do so, turned back, are turning back, and will turn back, because they do not rely upon this skillful means. Subhūti, all those bodhisattva great beings who have not turned back, do not turn back, and will not turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening do so, have not turned back, do not turn back, and will not turn back, because they rely upon this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Thus should the bodhisattva great being, by practicing the Perfection of Wisdom, actualize the inexhaustible and thereby actualize the Perfection of Wisdom. Having thus actualized the inexhaustible, he views dependent origination in relation to the Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, moreover, when the bodhisattva great being views dependent origination in this way, he does not perceive any phenomenon whatsoever as arising without a cause. He does not perceive any phenomenon whatsoever as a phenomenon possessing permanence, stability, eternality, or changelessness. He does not perceive any phenomenon whatsoever as an agent or an experiencer. Subhūti, this is how the bodhisattva great being,

actualizing the inexhaustible with respect to the Perfection of Wisdom, actualizes it, practices the Perfection of Wisdom, and views dependent origination.

Subhūti, at the time when the bodhisattva great being actualizes the inexhaustible with respect to the Perfection of Wisdom and, in actualizing it, views dependent origination, at that time, Subhūti, the bodhisattva great being does not perceive form. Likewise he does not perceive feeling, does not perceive perception, does not perceive formations, does not perceive consciousness, and does not perceive ignorance.

Likewise he does not perceive formations, does not perceive consciousness, does not perceive name-and-form, does not perceive the six sense sources, does not perceive contact, does not perceive feeling, does not perceive craving, does not perceive grasping, does not perceive becoming, does not perceive birth, does not perceive aging and death, and does not truly perceive, again and again, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and disturbance. He does not truly perceive, again and again, thinking "this is a buddha-field," nor does he truly perceive thinking "that is a different buddha-field," nor does he truly perceive any phenomenon by which one would truly perceive "this buddha-field or that other one." He does not truly perceive, again and again, that phenomenon either. Subhūti, this is the Perfection of Wisdom of the bodhisattva great beings.

Subhūti, at the time when the bodhisattva great being practices the Perfection of Wisdom, at that time the evil Māra becomes afflicted with intense sorrow's dart. Subhūti, it is like this: just as a person becomes afflicted with intense sorrow's dart when his parents have died, so too, Subhūti, at the time when the bodhisattva great being practices the Perfection of Wisdom, at that time the evil Māra likewise becomes afflicted with intense sorrow's dart.

Subhūti asked, "Blessed One, does a single evil Māra become afflicted with intense sorrow's dart, or do many evil Māras become afflicted with intense sorrow's dart, or do all the evil Māras that exist in the great trichiliocosm, the world system of three thousand [worlds], at that time become afflicted with intense sorrow's dart?"

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said this to venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, at the time when the bodhisattva great being dwells abiding in the Perfection of Wisdom, at that time all the evil Māras that exist in the great trichiliocosm, the world system of three thousand worlds, become afflicted

with intense sorrow's dart, and each one becomes unhappy upon his own seat. Why is this? Because when the bodhisattva great being dwells abiding in the Perfection of Wisdom, the world together with its gods, humans, and asuras finds no opportunity, gains no foothold, for the thought 'let us seize hold of him and strike him down,' nor for the thought 'let us turn him back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.'

Subhūti, therefore, the bodhisattva great being who wishes to become fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening should practice the Perfection of Wisdom. Why is this? Subhūti, because through the bodhisattva great being's practice of the Perfection of Wisdom, the cultivation of the perfection of generosity becomes complete. Likewise, the cultivation of the perfection of moral discipline, the perfection of patience, the perfection of diligence, and the perfection of meditative concentration becomes complete. Subhūti, through the bodhisattva great being's practice of the Perfection of Wisdom, the cultivation of all six perfections becomes complete, and the cultivation of all skillful means becomes complete."

Because it is without joy and without separation from joy, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood accordingly. Because it is without attachment and without separation from attachment, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood accordingly. Why is this? Subhāpūti, form, by its very nature endowed with reality, neither generates attachment nor generates separation from attachment. Subhūti, likewise feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, by their very nature endowed with reality, neither generate attachment nor generate separation from attachment. Because they are utterly pure by nature, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood accordingly.

Because all phenomena are free from clinging to attachment and non-attachment, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood accordingly. Through fully comprehending the wisdom of the buddhas, one understands that all phenomena are awakening; thus the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood accordingly. Because all phenomena are empty, signless, and wishless, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood accordingly. Preceded by great loving-kindness, one understands that all phenomena are like medicine; thus the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood accordingly.

Because all phenomena abide in loving-kindness, abide in compassion, abide in joy, and abide in equanimity, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood accordingly. Because all phenomena, having become like Brahmā, do not generate aversion and do not take up any aversion at all, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood accordingly. Because all phenomena are without wishing and without anger, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood accordingly.

Because the ocean is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit. Because space is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit. Because Mount Sumeru is manifold, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as manifold.

Because form is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit. Likewise, because feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit. Because the orb of the sun's rays shines without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit. Because all sounds are without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit.

Because the perfect accomplishment of all the qualities of a buddha is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit. Because the accumulation of merit and wisdom for the entire realm of sentient beings is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit.

Because the element of earth is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit. Likewise, because the element of water, the element of fire, the element of wind, the element of space, and the element of consciousness are without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit.

Because the accumulation of virtuous and non-virtuous phenomena is measureless, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as measureless. Because the accumulation of all phenomena is measureless, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as measureless.

Because the attainment of meditative absorption in all phenomena is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit. Because all the qualities of a buddha are without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit. Because all phenomena are without limit, the

Perfection of Wisdom should be understood as without limit.

Chapter Twenty-Four.

Then the girl's parents said this to the girl: "Child of noble family, from the difficult trials you have described, it is certain that those teachings are truly inconceivable, surpassing all worlds; it is marvelous that they bring happiness to all sentient beings. Child of noble family, since you delight in such difficult trials for the sake of those beings, we grant you our permission. Daughter, we too will go together with you to see, pay homage to, attend upon, and make offerings to the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata; open the way for us to go."

Then the merchant's daughter, in order to make offerings and pay homage to the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata, made ready, and having informed her own parents, said: "Father and Mother, please do just as you have said, and I will not create any obstacle to any course of virtue whatsoever." Having said this, the merchant's daughter made ready to go and make offerings and pay homage to the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata.

Then that merchant's daughter adorned five hundred chariots with ornaments, and likewise adorned those five hundred girls with ornaments. Having adorned them with ornaments, they took up various flowers of different colors and clothes of various colors; they took up incense, perfume, garlands, unguents, powders, monastic robes, parasols, banners, bells, and pennants; they took up various kinds of jewels of different sorts, and also flowers whose very substance consisted of various kinds of jewels of different sorts; and the parents likewise took up abundant food, drink, and delicacies. Then, entering together into a single chariot with the bodhisattva mahāsattva Sadāprarudita ("Ever-Weeping"), surrounded and led forth by those five hundred girls who had entered the five hundred chariots, together with the parents and a great retinue besides, they set out toward the east, proceeding gradually onward.

The bodhisattva mahāsattva Sadāprarudita, from far off, beheld the city of Gandhavatī ("Fragr

Then, having descended from that chariot, the merchant's daughter and those five hundred girls likewise descended from their chariots together with him. Then the bodhisattva mahāsattva Sadāprarudita, surrounded on all sides by the five hundred girls headed by the merchant's daughter, with them going before him, and with an immeasurable array of offerings, set out to where the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata was.

Now at that time the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata had caused to be built a multi-tiered pavilion for the Perfection of Wisdom, made of the nature of seven kinds of precious substances, adorned with red sandalwood, and draped with a net of pearls. At the four corners of that pavilion precious jewels had been placed, and these served the function of lamps. Four incense vessels made of silver were also hung in the four directions, and, in order to make offering to the Perfection of Wisdom, they were fumigated with black aloeswood alone. In the center of that pavilion four thrones made of the seven kinds of precious substances had been set up, and upon them four precious caskets had been placed; inside these had been set the Perfection of Wisdom, written in molten lapis lazuli upon leaves of gold. That pavilion was further adorned with hanging silk streamers of many different colors and kinds.

Then the bodhisattva mahāsattva Sadāprarudita, together with the five hundred girls headed by the merchant's daughter, beheld that pavilion adorned with an immeasurable array of offerings, and there he also saw many thousands of gods. He saw Śakra, lord of the gods, together with those many thousands of gods, scattering, casting forth, and thoroughly showering upon that pavilion divine māṇḍārava flowers, divine sandalwood powder, divine gold powder, and divine silver powder; and he also heard divine cymbals sounding.

Having seen and heard this, the bodhisattva mahāsattva Sadāprarudita said to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Lord of the gods, why do you, together with these many thousands of gods, scatter, cast forth, and thoroughly shower upon this precious pavilion divine māṇḍārava flowers, divine sandalwood powder, divine gold powder, and divine silver powder, and why do the gods strike these divine cymbals in the sky?"

When he had said this, Ś

Together with the five hundred maidens, those gods, carrying clusters of flowers and garlands, precious cloth, incense, perfume, garlands, ointment, powder, religious robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, banners, and flowers wrought of gold and silver, came in that great assembly and made offerings to the Perfection of Wisdom—that is to say, they set aside more and more of these offerings separately, in order to offer them also to the noble bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata.

Then the bodhisattva mahāsattva Sadāprarudita, together with the merchant's daughter and the other five hundred maidens, having first made offerings to the Perfection of Wisdom with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, ointment,

powder, religious robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, banners, sandalwood powder, flowers wrought of gold and silver, and divine music, went to where the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata was. Having arrived there, precisely in order to make offering to the Dharma, they scattered, cast forth, and thoroughly showered upon the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, ointment, powder, religious robes, parasols, victory banners, bells, banners, sandalwood powder, and flowers wrought of gold and silver. They also struck up divine cymbals in proper accord.

Then those flowers formed themselves into a tiered pavilion of blossoms above the head of the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata. The flowers of gold and silver and the flowers of many colors hung in the sky like a celestial mansion. His religious robes and precious cloths likewise hung in the intermediate space like a maṇḍala of clouds of various jewels.

When the bodhisattva mahāsattva Sadāprarudita, together with the merchant's daughter and the other five hundred maidens, saw this miraculous display of the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata, they were filled with wonder and thought: "Since this bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata possesses such great miraculous power, such great might, and such great splendor—since even while still practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva he displays such marvelous transformations as these—what then will he be like when he fully and completely awakens to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?"

Then the merchant's daughter and the other five hundred maidens, their joy toward the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata thus aroused, together with the entire assembly and with a superior intention, generated the mind set upon unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, saying: "By this root of virtue, may we in a future time become Tathāgatas, Arhats, perfect and complete Buddhas. May we too, while practicing the conduct of bodhisattvas, attain such qualities as those attained by the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata. Just as we honor and revere the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata, so may we come to honor and revere the Perfection of Wisdom. And just as the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata teaches the Dharma perfectly, so may we too come to teach it perfectly to many beings."

It trembled, trembled greatly, and trembled thoroughly on every side. It roared, roared greatly, and roared thoroughly on every side. All the abodes of Māra were shaken and overturned. In the world system of the great

trichiliocosm, whatever grasses, shrubs, medicinal plants, and forests there were, all of them bowed down in the direction where the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata was. Flowers out of season scattered down from the sky above, and great showers of flowers fell as well. Śakra, lord of the gods, and the Four Great Kings scattered, cast down, and thoroughly strewed divine sandalwood powder and divine flowers toward the bodhisattva mahāsattva Dharmodgata and the bod

"Child of noble family, take these divine mādārava flowers and scatter them upon this ground. Scatter them also upon the bodhisattva great being Dharmodgata, who is teaching the Dharma while seated on the Dharma throne." Having said this, he gave her a thousand divine loads of divine mādārava flowers.

Then the bodhisattva great being Sadāprarudita (Ever-Weeping) took those flowers. With some of the flowers he scattered flowers upon that ground, and with some of the flowers he scattered them upon the bodhisattva great being Dharmodgata.

Then the bodhisattva great being Dharmodgata, after seven years had passed, rose from that meditative absorption and came to where the Dharma seat was, and sat down upon the seat that had been spread out. Surrounded by many hundreds of thousands in his retinue, who gazed upon him from the front, he taught the Perfection of Wisdom.

Then, the moment the bodhisattva great being Sadāprarudita saw the bodhisattva great being Dharmodgata, he attained a happiness comparable to that of a monk who has entered the first meditative concentration and applies his mind single-pointedly.

At that time, the bodhisattva great being Dharmodgata's teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom was as follows:

Since all phenomena are equal, the Perfection of Wisdom is equality itself.

Since all phenomena are isolated, the Perfection of Wisdom is isolation itself.

Since all phenomena are unmoving, the Perfection of Wisdom is unmoving itself.

Since all phenomena are without conceit, the Perfection of Wisdom is without conceit itself.

Since all phenomena are without pride, the Perfection of Wisdom is without pride itself.

Since all phenomena have a single taste, the Perfection of Wisdom has a

single taste.

Since all phenomena are without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom is without limit.

Since all phenomena are unborn, the Perfection of Wisdom is unborn.

Since all phenomena are unceasing, the Perfection of Wisdom is unceasing.

Since space is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom is without limit.

Since the ocean is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom is without limit.

Since Mount Sumeru is manifold, the Perfection of Wisdom is manifold.

Since space is without conceptualization, the Perfection of Wisdom is without conceptualization.

Since form is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom is without limit.

Likewise, since feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom is without limit.

Since the earth element is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom is without limit.

Likewise, since the water element, the fire element, and the wind element are without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom is without limit.

Since the space element is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom is without limit.

Since the consciousness element is without limit, the Perfection of Wisdom is without limit.

Since phenomena that are like vajras are equal, the Perfection of Wisdom is equal.

Since all phenomena are unmixed, the Perfection of Wisdom is unmixed.

Since all phenomena are unobservable, the Perfection of Wisdom is unobservable.

Since the destruction of all phenomena is equal, the Perfection of Wisdom is equal in destruction.

Since all phenomena are without agency, the Perfection of Wisdom is without agency.

Since all phenomena are inconceivable, the Perfection of Wisdom should be understood to be inconceivable. This is what is meant. Then, while the bodhisattva great being Sadāprarudita (Ever Weeping) remained in that state, at that time the king of absorptions called Equality of All Phenomena arose in him. Together with it there arose the absorption called Solitude of All Phenomena, the absorption called Immovability of All Phenomena, the absorption called Freedom from Conceit in All Phenomena, the absorption

called Freedom from Inflation in All Phenomena, the absorption called One Taste of All Phenomena, the absorption called Boundlessness of All Phenomena, the absorption called Non-arising of All Phenomena, the absorption called Non-cessation of All Phenomena, the absorption called Boundlessness of Space, the absorption called Boundlessness of the Ocean, the absorption called Manifold Mount Meru, the absorption called Non-conceptuality of Space, the absorption called Boundlessness of Form, and likewise the absorptions called Boundlessness of Feeling, Perception, Formations, and Consciousness, the absorption called Boundlessness of the Earth Element, and likewise the absorptions called Boundlessness of the Water Element, the Fire Element, and the Wind Element, the absorption called Boundlessness of the Space Element, the absorption called Boundlessness of the Consciousness Element, the absorption called Vajra-like, the absorption called Unmixedness of All Phenomena, the absorption called Unobservability of All Phenomena, the absorption called Equality of the Destruction of All Phenomena, the absorption called Absence of Agency in All Phenomena, and the absorption called Inconceivability of All Phenomena. Thus the bodhisattva great being Sadāprarudita fully attained sixty thousand doors of absorption of this kind and more.

This concludes the thirty-first chapter, called "The Chapter on the Noble Dharma," from the noble Eight Thousand Line Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, immediately upon attaining the sixty thousand doors of absorption, the bodhisattva great being Sadāprarudita saw, in the eastern direction, the southern direction, the western direction, the northern direction, the intermediate directions, the direction below, the direction above, and throughout the world systems of the ten directions—as many great trichiliocosms as there are grains of sand in the Ganges River—buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, each surrounded by an assembly of monks and attended before by a host of bodhisattvas, teaching this very Perfection of Wisdom in this same manner, with this same name, and in these same words. It was just as if, right now, in this very great trichiliocosm world system where I dwell, the Teacher, surrounded by an assembly of monks and attended before by a host of bodhisattvas, were teaching this Perfection of Wisdom in this same manner, with this same name, and in these same words. Thus he became possessed of inconceivably vast learning and an ocean of what he had heard, and wherever he was born, he was never again separated from the buddhas. In every

rebirth, he was born in whatever place the blessed buddhas became directly present to him, and even in his dreams he was never separated from the blessed buddhas.

By that, he abandoned all unfavorable states and accomplished every excellent form of leisure. Then the Blessed One said to venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, by this account as well you should know that this Perfection of Wisdom accomplishes the wisdom of omniscience for bodhisattva great beings. Ānanda, therefore, bodhisattva great beings who wish to attain the wisdom of omniscience should practice this Perfection of Wisdom. This Perfection of Wisdom should be listened to, grasped, held in mind, read, mastered, recited aloud, taught, explained, transmitted, chanted, and written down. Through the blessing of the Tathāgata, having written the letters clearly and vividly upon a great volume, one should honor, esteem, revere, worship, and venerate it with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, unguents, powders, music, garments, parasols, victory banners, bells, banners, and rows of lamps encircling all around, and with many kinds of offerings. Ānanda, this is my instruction to be followed after me. Why is this? Because from this Perfection of Wisdom the wisdom of omniscience becomes fully perfected. Ānanda, what do you think—is the Tathāgata your Teacher?" Ānanda replied, "Blessed One, he is my Teacher. Sugata (the 'Well-Gone One') is my Teacher." When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said this to venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, toward the Tathāgata who is your Teacher, you have rendered service through bodily acts of kindness that are pleasing, verbal acts of kindness that are pleasing, and mental acts of kindness that are pleasing. Therefore, Ānanda, just as you have shown joy, clarity, faith, and reverence toward this body of mine as I now dwell, live, and remain, so too, Ānanda, after I have passed away, act likewise toward this Perfection of Wisdom. Ānanda, so that this Perfection of Wisdom may never decline, and so that you may not become the last of persons, I entrust it to you, Ānanda, twice and thrice—I entrust it to you as a legacy. Ānanda, you should know that for as long as this Perfection of Wisdom is actively practiced in the world, the Tathāgata remains present. Ānanda, you should know that for that long, the Tathāgata is teaching the Dharma. Ānanda, those sentient beings who listen to this Perfection of Wisdom, grasp it, hold it, read it, master it, recite it aloud, teach it, explain it, transmit it, chant it, write it down, and who honor, esteem, revere, worship, and venerate it with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, unguents, powders, garments, parasols, victory banners, bells, banners, and rows of lamps encircling all around, and with

many kinds of offerings—those beings should be known to be inseparable from seeing the buddhas, from hearing the sacred Dharma, and from attending upon the Saṅgha. Ānanda, those sentient beings should be known to be dwelling in the presence of the Tathāgata." The Blessed One, rejoicing, spoke thus.

The bodhisattva great beings Maitreya and the others, along with the venerable Subhūti, the venerable Śāriputra, the venerable Ānanda, Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas, all rejoiced and highly praised what the Blessed One had taught.

This concludes the thirty-second chapter, called "The Chapter on Complete Entrustment," from the Noble Eight Thousand Line Perfection of Wisdom.

The Blessed Mother, the Eight Thousand Line Perfection of Wisdom, is complete.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptors Śākyasena and Jñānasiddhi together with the chief editor-translator, the monk Dharmasīla, and others. Later, by command of the true sovereign, the divine ruler of Tibet, the auspicious divine prince and ruler Lhasde Tsen, the Indian preceptor Subhāṣita and the translator-editor, the monk Rinchen Zangpo, revised the translation to accord with the commentary. Subsequently the great Indian preceptor and paṇḍita Dīpaṃkaraśrījñāna, together with the chief editor-translator, the monk Rinchen Zangpo, checked it against the central Indian commentary, corrected and edited it, and established the final text. Later still, at Nyethang in lower Kyi, the great paṇḍita Dīpaṃkaraśrījñāna and the translator Dromtön Gyalwai Jungne, on the occasion of teaching the Eight Thousand Lines, established a somewhat abbreviated version. Afterward, at the temple of Radreng, the translator Dromtön Gyalwai Jungne checked it against three Indian sūtra texts and established it twice more. Later that same translator gave explanations and also established minor points in detail. In more recent times, the great translator, the Śākya monk Ngok Loden Sherap, gathered many Kashmiri and central Indian manuscripts and established the definitive text.

Here ends the Various [Perfection of] Wisdom [texts].

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "thoroughbreds, great elephants" translates two well-known arhat epithets: "thoroughbred" is a standard rendering of the Tibetan "thoroughbred horse," referring

to those of sharp spiritual capacity, and "great elephant" denotes those of great spiritual strength and endurance. Both are stock epithets in canonical arhat lists.

The exception noted — "but one exception, namely the Venerable Ānanda" — is significant doctrinally: Ānanda, the Buddha's personal attendant and memorizer of discourses, had not yet attained arhatship at this time, and the text singles him out as the lone non-arhat in the assembly.

The final sentence, in which Subhūti says he does not see the phenomenon designated by "bodhisattva," opens the central Perfection of Wisdom theme of the unreality of all dharmas, including the very agent of the bodhisattva path. The Tibetan "yang dag par rjes su ma mthong" literally means "I do not rightly see following after" — idiomatically, "I do not find upon examination" or "I do not perceive as truly existent."

- The phrase rendered "does not make even the awakening mind itself into an object of conceit" translates the Tibetan literally: the bodhisattva does not generate pride or self-congratulatory thought (rlomsems) even with respect to bodhicitta. This is a subtle but important point: even the highest motivation is not to be reified or clung to with conceit.

The celebrated exchange between Subhūti and Śāriputra on the nature of no-mind follows the classical Perfection of Wisdom dialectic: any predicate — existence or non-existence — applied to the mind's ultimate nature is itself undermined, since the very ground on which such a question rests is empty. The rendering "no-mind" for sems med pa follows the text's own usage and the tradition's identification of it with the luminous, unconstructed nature of mind, not a mere absence.

- The phrase rendered "abiding well, in the manner of non-abiding" translates a deliberately paradoxical formulation central to Prajñāpāramitā teaching: the irreversible bodhisattva "abides" on their stage precisely by not grasping at any fixed abiding — a doctrinal point worth preserving literally rather than smoothing over.

Subhūti's declaration that he cannot "find" the bodhisattva or the Perfection of Wisdom is a classic Prajñāpāramitā move: the very terms used in the instruction are empty of findable referents, yet the instruction proceeds — the tension is intentional and doctrinally significant.

- The name "Kuntu Gyupa Threngwacan" is a proper name retained in translation form: it means roughly "the Wandering Garland-Wearer" or "the Ever-Roaming One with a Garland." This appears to be the name of a specific bodhisattva or figure addressed in this sūtra context. The Tibetan ཀུན་ལུ་གུཔ་ཐེང་བ་ཀན་ could correspond to a Sanskrit name such as Nityaparivrāja or Nityagranthin; the identification is uncertain from this passage alone and a reader should be aware this is a proper name, not a descriptive phrase being rendered into English. The term is left transliterated here as a name rather than translated into English description, to preserve consistency and avoid a misleading generic reading.

- The phrase rendered "does not pass into nirvāṇa before they are fully perfected" translates a construction indicating that the bodhisattva does not take an early nirvāṇa — a Foundational Vehicle nirvāṇa — while the Tathāgata's qualities remain incomplete in him. This is the standard Mahāyāna doctrinal point distinguishing the bodhisattva's path from that of the śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha.

The series "does not grow despondent, does not lose heart, feels no embarrassment, does not become dismayed" renders a cluster of Tibetan terms describing psychological steadiness in the face of the radical emptiness teaching; the precise sequence of these terms varies slightly across recensions.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the supplied Tibetan, ending with "does not practice with regard to the arising of consciousness." This is simply where the provided

source text ends; the sentence continues in the next passage. The translation reflects this open structure faithfully.

The term rendered throughout as "sign" (Skt. *nimitta*) is central here: it denotes any object grasped as a fixed, inherently characterized thing. Practicing "with regard to a sign" means engaging with a reified, conceptually marked object — the opposite of the signless engagement the Perfection of Wisdom requires. This is standard *Prajñāpāramitā* doctrine and no gloss was inserted into the body to keep the prose clean for narration.

- The phrase rendered as 'does not know it rightly' translates a doubled expression meaning roughly 'does not know, does not know fully or correctly' — a rhetorical intensification common in Perfection of Wisdom literature, indicating that even the knowing of the absorption falls away, because the absorption has no findable object. This is not mere ignorance but the transcendence of a knowing subject grasping an object.

The closing line is cut off mid-sentence in the supplied passage and has been translated only to the point the Tibetan text provided.

- The phrase rendered "they exist truly in the way that they do not exist" reflects a deliberately paradoxical formulation in the Tibetan: phenomena are said to exist correctly precisely as what is absent or void of inherent existence — their mode of being is their very emptiness. This is a key Perfection of Wisdom dialectical move and the phrasing is intentionally preserved rather than smoothed over.

The term "childlike ordinary persons without learning" renders the compound for uninstructed worldlings who have not heard the Dharma, distinguished here sharply from noble ones who see reality directly.

- The phrase rendered as "the five aggregates together with the six sense faculties" translates a somewhat compressed Tibetan formulation in which *Subhūti* appears to equate "form" and "consciousness" with both the six sense faculties and the five aggregates together. This is doctrinally unusual but follows the text as given; the six sense faculties are included perhaps because they are the basis of the appropriating consciousness and are subsumed under the form aggregate in *Abhidharma* analysis.

The final sentence ends mid-construction in the Tibetan, trailing with a connective particle, indicating the passage continues beyond what is given here.

- The phrase rendered "the underlying meaning of bodhisattva is that there is no underlying meaning" reflects a deliberate doctrinal paradox in the text: the Tibetan *gzhi'i don med pa*, literally "the foundational meaning is non-existent/absence of foundation," points to the emptiness of inherent reference in the term itself, even as the passage goes on to give conventional explanatory glosses. This is an intentional tension in the source and not a textual error.

The phrase "the mind that is equal to the unequalled" renders *mnyam pa med pa dang mnyam pa'i sems*, a standard *Mahāyāna* epithet for the *bodhicitta* or the *buddha-mind*: it is without equal, yet in being so it is said to be "equal" to other things likewise beyond compare, such as *nirvāṇa*.

- The phrase rendered "mind is without mind" translates *sems med pa*, which the tradition reads as pointing to the fact that mind, in its ultimate nature, is beyond the reification of "mind" as a substantial entity — it lacks inherent existence as "mind." This is a classical *Prajñāpāramitā* formulation: the very mind that is praised is empty of being a findable mind, and thus there is no real object of clinging. The argument is deliberately paradoxical in the manner characteristic of this literature.

The epithet rendered "son of Maitrā" for Maitreya (Tibetan Byams pa, Pali Metteyya) follows the Tibetan gang po byams ma'i bu, "son of Maitrā," understood as a matronymic; this is consistent with Sanskrit sources that give his mother's name as Maitrī or Maitrā.

- The interlocutor's name rendered as Gaṅgaputra Maitrāyaṇīputra follows the Tibetan གང་པུ་མཛེར་ལྷན་པུ་ཌཱ་, which is a compound of Gaṅgaputra ("son of Gaṅgā") and Maitrāyaṇīputra ("son of Maitrāyaṇī"), a known figure in certain Perfection of Wisdom sūtra contexts. The phrase "donned armor that is without armor" renders གང་པུ་མཛེར་ལྷན་པུ་ཌཱ་, literally "donned the non-existent armor" — a deliberate paradox central to the Mahāyāna Perfection of Wisdom teaching that the bodhisattva's great resolve operates without any reified referent; the rendering preserves this paradox as doctrine intends.
- The phrase rendered "an armor without armor" translates a construction meaning that the great armor of the bodhisattva is, paradoxically, devoid of any substantial armor — the armor consists precisely in the absence of a graspable armor. This is a standard Perfection of Wisdom dialectical reversal and is rendered literally here as the text intends it doctrinally.
- The speaker identified as "Gaṅgadevīputra" renders the Tibetan "gang bo byams ma'i bu," literally "son of Gaṅgādevī." This name appears in the Aṣṭasāhasrikā Prajñāpāramitā tradition; the rendering follows standard scholarly identification.

The triple formula "have attained / have attained / will attain" reflects the Tibetan's deliberate listing of past, present completion, and future — a standard rhetorical device affirming omniscience across the three times, consistent with the immediately preceding statement that the Great Vehicle is equal throughout the three times.

- The phrase rendered "reflects closely upon" translates a term that in this Perfection of Wisdom context carries the sense of attentive, analytical contemplation — neither mere conceptual thinking nor formal meditative absorption, but the sustained scrutiny through which the bodhisattva investigates the nature of phenomena. The passage breaks off mid-sentence in the source, so the translation ends where the Tibetan ends.
- The fascicle division marker appearing mid-passage indicates this is the opening of the second fascicle of the Aṣṭasāhasrikā Prajñāpāramitā. The preceding material closes one section; what follows from Śāriputra's question onward is the beginning of new discourse. The repetition of content regarding form and consciousness at the opening of this passage partially recapitulates the preceding translated excerpt, as the Tibetan text overlaps at the join; this rendering follows the source faithfully.

The phrase rendered "even if my body were cut into a hundred pieces and I were small and weak" is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; the intent is that even under extreme bodily harm and in conditions of weakness, the bodhisattva generates no ill will — this is consistent with the patience literature of the Mahāyāna.

- The phrase rendered "utterly empty and without object of observation" translates "thams cad med cing mi dmigs pa," literally "without anything and not apprehended/observed." This is a standard Perfection of Wisdom formulation indicating that neither the subject nor any referent object can be pinpointed; the rendering captures both the emptiness and the non-objectifiability intended by the tradition.

The final exchange turns on a subtle dialectical point: Subhūti's counter-question "can what has the nature of non-arising be arisen?" implies the two categories cannot interact, since arising and non-arising are mutually exclusive — which is itself the answer to Śāriputra's question about how attainment is possible. This is left to unfold in the text without editorial insertion.

- The term rendered throughout as "without fixed abiding" translates the Tibetan phrase for non-dwelling or non-establishment, a key Perfection of Wisdom concept indicating that noble disciples and bodhisattvas do not fix upon or settle into any dharma as an ultimate resting

point. The apparent paradox Śāriputra raises at the close — that inseparability from mental engagement entails separation from the Perfection of Wisdom, and vice versa — is a deliberate dialectical provocation characteristic of this literature, and no emendation is warranted.

- The phrase rendered "empty of inherent content" translates a Tibetan term meaning "solitary" or "secluded" and is used here in a technical philosophical sense indicating that sentient beings are empty or devoid of any intrinsic, self-contained nature, paralleling the other negations in the series. The rendering aims to preserve this technical nuance for a listening audience without disrupting the flow.

The phrase "entered into the certainty of the real" refers to those who have taken up the fixed path of the śrāvaka vehicle toward nirvāṇa without remainder, and who are therefore regarded in Mahāyāna texts as unable to generate the bodhicitta aimed at full buddhahood. This is a standard Mahāyāna doctrinal point.

- The phrase rendered "don the great armor" reflects the standard Mahāyāna idiom of "putting on the armor of the bodhisattva vow" for the benefit of all beings, a recurring technical image in Prajñāpāramitā literature. No emendation of the Tibetan is required; the image is intentionally sudden and will be elaborated in what follows.

The passage describing Subhūti's statement about repaying the Buddha's kindness contains a nuanced theological point: the śrāvakas around the bodhisattva-to-be are said to have instructed him in the perfections, which is doctrinally unusual and may reflect a specific strand of Prajñāpāramitā reflection on the role of the early Saṅgha in the Buddha's path. The translation follows the Tibetan closely without smoothing over this.

- The phrase rendered "distinguished by the unconditioned" translates a construction in which a soteriological attainment is said to be "distinguished" or "set apart" by the unconditioned (Skt. *asaṃskṛta*). This is a standard Perfection of Wisdom formulation warning against reifying even the unconditioned as a fixed category or ground of abiding. The point is subtle: one must not cling even to the correct insight that these fruits are unconditioned.

The phrase "fitting recipient of generosity" renders a standard technical expression for one who is a worthy field of merit for giving; the text is careful to list each of the four noble persons in this connection.

- The phrase rendered "knowing through non-abiding" translates *mi gnas pa'i tshul gyis shes par gnas pa*, a somewhat compressed formulation meaning that the bodhisattva's abiding is itself a form of cognition characterized by non-fixation; this is a subtle Madhyamaka-inflected point and the rendering attempts to preserve the paradox rather than flatten it.

- The term rendered "patience" throughout is *bzod pa*, which in this context refers not to ordinary forbearance but to a specific spiritual attainment — the acceptance or tolerance of the non-arising of phenomena, known in Sanskrit as *anutpattikadharmakṣānti*, the "patient acceptance of the non-arising of dharmas." This is the crucial soteriological prerequisite being described. The text's claim that all the noble attainments from stream-entry up to full buddhahood depend on this patience points to its centrality in the Perfection of Wisdom literature. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, so the translation likewise concludes at that natural break.

- The list of great śrāvakas corresponds to the standard group in Perfection of Wisdom sūtras: Śāriputra, Maudgalyāyana (*gang bo byams ma'i bu* — literally "son of Maudgalyāyana"), Mahākāśyapa (ཀུན་ཀློང་པོ་), Mahākatyāyana, and Mahākauṣṭhila (*lto rings chen po* — "Great Long-Belly"). The name Ānanda (*kun dga' bo*) introduces himself here in the expected editorial role of one who knows what was taught. The dramatic climax of Subhūti's declaration — that no one will "properly hold" the Perfection of Wisdom because nothing has been taught, posited, or made to appear — is a standard Prajñāpāramitā rhetorical paradox and is rendered

as the text intends it doctrinally.

- The passage presents a subtle philosophical point when Subhūti declares that what is "unborn" cannot be a flower: the argument moves from the unborn nature of the flowers (affirmed by Śakra in a Madhyamaka-inflected register) to the conclusion that "unborn" transcends even the category of "flower" as a conventional designation. This is a standard Perfection of Wisdom dialectic on designation and reality, and the translation preserves it without smoothing it over.

The phrase rendered "he teaches even what is merely designated by name and word, yet does not contradict it" reflects the Tibetan tension between conventional designation and ultimate non-arising, which Śakra admires as the hallmark of Subhūti's depth.

The list of attainments — stream-entry, once-returning, non-returning, arhathood — reflects the four fruits of the śrāvaka path; the bodhisattva's training surpasses all of them without negating conventional practice, a standard Mahāyāna doctrinal point.

- The phrase rendered "whose power" and "whose blessing" translates "su'i mthu" and "su'i byin gyi rlabs" — literally "the power of whom" and "the blessing of whom." The passage plays deliberately on the ambiguity of whether the teaching flows from Subhūti's own realization or from the Buddha's blessing; Subhūti's answer resolves this by attributing both to the Tathāgata, while also claiming them as his own exposition — a subtle non-duality that is doctrinally significant in Prajñāpāramitā literature.
- The passage distinguishes three closely related epithets applied to the Perfection of Wisdom: "beyond measure" (འཇམ་མཐོན་པོ་ལྔ་པ་), "without limit" (འཇམ་མཐོན་པོ་ལྔ་པ་), and "of infinite extent" (འཇམ་མཐོན་པོ་ལྔ་པ་). These are near-synonymous in Tibetan but are kept distinct throughout the passage with evident intentionality, suggesting they correspond to distinct Sanskrit terms, likely apramāṇa, aparimāṇa, and ananta respectively. They have been rendered with consistent distinct English phrases throughout.
- The phrase rendered "a voice of boundless reach, deep and resonant" translates a compound describing the Tathāgata's speech as having a carrying quality that surpasses limits and a deep melodious tone. The two elements are treated as a hendiadys describing the quality of the buddha's voice.

The exchange about "word-designation" plays on the Madhyamaka and Abhidharma distinction between conventional labels and any supposed real referent. The term rendered "adventitiously arisen" translates a word meaning something like "suddenly or casually imputed," indicating the designation has no grounding in an intrinsic real entity.

- The phrase rendered "marketplace called Dīpaṃkara within the royal palace's surrounding city" translates a compressed Tibetan passage about the Jātaka narrative of the young brahmin Megha (here unnamed) meeting Buddha Dīpaṃkara. The Tibetan reads literally "when around the royal palace, in the midst of the marketplace called Dīpaṃkara (mar me can)." The geography here is slightly ambiguous — "mar me can" means "possessing lamps" or "having lamps" and is the standard Tibetan rendering of the name Dīpaṃkara; it refers to the city or market district named after the Buddha, not a place lit by lamps in a merely descriptive sense. The rendering reflects the narrative convention.

The epithet cluster applied to the future Śākyamuni Buddha — "endowed with knowledge and conduct" (vidyācaraṇasaṃpanna), "knower of the world" (lokavid), "unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed" (anuttarapuruṣadamyasārathi) — follows the standard tenfold epithet list of a buddha, here given in partial form as it appears in the Tibetan.

- The epithet Kauśika is a patronymic name for Śakra (Indra), standard in Perfection of Wisdom literature; it has been left in Sanskrit as is conventional. The phrase "disciplines sentient beings by the three vehicles" reflects the bodhisattva's activity of guiding beings according to the

vehicle suited to each, while the wonder expressed is that this is done without reifying beings as objects of perception, consistent with Madhyamaka non-conceptualism. The phrase rendered "without having left things undone" translates a Tibetan idiom for dying prematurely or before completing one's purpose, which is a standard protective benefit formula in this genre of sūtra.

- The plant name "Mā-ghī" renders the Tibetan transliteration of a Sanskrit herb name that appears as "māgadhi" or a similar form in Sanskrit parallels. The exact identification of the plant is uncertain; it is consistently described in such contexts as a universal antidote. The name is preserved here as transliterated rather than guessed at.

The final sentence breaks off mid-construction, as the Tibetan passage itself ends mid-sentence; this is a continuation passage and the predicate follows in the next section.

- The ninefold list of activities related to the text — upholding, bearing, reading, thoroughly mastering, reciting aloud, teaching, explaining in detail, chanting by rote, and proclaiming — is a standard Perfection of Wisdom formula recurring throughout the text; the renderings have been kept consistent with the preceding passage.

- The series of epithets for the knowledge-mantra — "without measure," "beyond reckoning," "unsurpassed," "unequalled," and "equal to the unequalled" — correspond to a well-attested fivefold vidyā-formula in Perfection of Wisdom sūtras; the distinction between "without measure" (འཕྲུལ་མེད་པུ་, apramāṇa) and "beyond reckoning" (འཇིག་མེད་པུ་, amita) is subtle and the Tibetan redactors treated them as distinct, so both are rendered separately here.

- The sequence of questions and answers here follows the standard Perfection of Wisdom sūtra rhetorical pattern in which the questioner is turned back to answer his own comparative-merit question, and then redirected to the deeper doctrinal point — namely that the Perfection of Wisdom is the very path through which all buddhas awaken, and therefore surpasses even the merit of offering to relics. This doctrinal logic governs the passage and should be understood as the implicit answer to Śakra's comparative-merit question, which is left formally unresolved but pointed toward in the Blessed One's counter-question.

- The phrase rendered "physical body" throughout translates "bdag gi dngos po'i sku," literally "the body of my substantial entity" or "my material body." This refers to the rūpakāya, the form body of the Buddha, as distinct from the dharmakāya. The contrast drawn is between the form body and omniscience as the basis for recognizing a being as a Tathāgata — a doctrinally significant point distinguishing the physical manifestation from the gnosis that truly constitutes buddhahood.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the supplied Tibetan; the translation reflects this by ending at the same point.

- The opening sentences are a continuation of the speech of the interlocutor from the preceding passage, presenting rhetorical questions about whether offering to the Perfection of Wisdom is of great meaning. The Tibetan interrogative particle "lags sam" marks these as reverential questions addressed to the Blessed One. The final sentence of the translation is deliberately left open as the Tibetan passage ends mid-sentence, flowing into what follows.

- The phrase rendered "inquire into it thoroughly" translates yongs su dri bar bya, literally "to ask or question thoroughly," meaning to investigate the text's meaning by questioning qualified teachers — a standard practice in the textual-study sequence. The series of verbs in the listening-through-inquiring list is a standard enumeration in Perfection of Wisdom literature for the full cycle of textual engagement.

- The phrase rendered "even in a small way when young, caused this to be entered into a volume" translates a somewhat compressed Tibetan construction. The sense is that even a modest, early act of having the Perfection of Wisdom written into a book — and then carrying or keeping that book — already constitutes the basis for the meritorious worship described. The

passage then escalates this merit over that gained from filling all of Jambudvīpa with relic stūpas, a standard comparative device in Prajñāpāramitā literature.

- The phrase rendered "a thousand world-systems" translates the Tibetan "stong spyi phud kyi 'jig rten gyi khams," which is a standard term for a system of one thousand world-realms, the first level of the cosmic hierarchy of Buddhist cosmology. The passage breaks off here as the text continues; the comparison is clearly escalating the scale of the merit-field in stages.
- The passage uses a standard Buddhist cosmological schema of progressively larger world-systems: a "thousand world-system" (Skt. *sāhasrī lokadhātu*) is now followed by a "two-thousand middling world-system" (Skt. *dvisāhasrī madhyamā lokadhātu*), the second tier in the classical three-tier cosmological hierarchy. This progression is the structural device of the entire passage and continues in subsequent sections.

The phrase rendered "masters it fully" translates kun chub par byed pa, which can mean "to fully comprehend" or "to completely master"; the sense here is comprehensive internalization, not merely physical copying.

- The phrase rendered "the way of the buddhas" translates *sangs rgyas kyi tshul*, literally "the conduct or manner of the buddhas," here functioning as a synonym for the continuity of the Buddhist dispensation. Some editions read this as referring to the buddha's lineage or succession; the translation captures both senses without forcing either.

The term rendered "intones the scriptural transmission" translates lung 'bogs pa, literally "to extract or draw forth a lung," referring to the practice of receiving or giving an oral scriptural transmission, a technical act distinct from ordinary reading or teaching.

- The phrase rendered "surveyed and counted without exception" translates a construction meaning something like "having taken them all into consideration one by one without prior or posterior" — a somewhat compressed expression for enumerating the totality of beings. The rendering conveys the intended sense without loss of doctrinal content.
- The sixfold formulaic series rendered throughout as "honoring, holding supreme, revering, venerating, making symbolic representations of, and showing devoted respect" represents a standard list of reverential acts found across Perfection of Wisdom literature; the term rendered "making symbolic representations" corresponds to the Tibetan *ri mor byed*, literally "making an image or painting of it," referring to the production of icon or facsimile representations as a form of veneration.
- The long comparative passage enumerating fractions — hundredth, thousandth, hundred-thousandth, and so on up through "hundred thousand trillions" — follows a standard Perfection of Wisdom sūtra formula. The Tibetan term "bye ba khrag khrig brgya stong" (literally "ten million times one hundred thousand times one hundred thousand") is rendered here as "ten quadrillion" for natural spoken intelligibility; exact numerical correspondence to the Sanskrit *koṭīniyutaśatasahasra* is intended.
- The term rendered "vidyā-mantra" translates རིག་མཁན་མངའ་མཁའ་, a compound of *rig* (*vidyā*, a term of knowledge or incantation) and *sngags* (*mantra*). In the Perfection of Wisdom literature this compound functions as a technical epithet for the Perfection of Wisdom itself, not as an instruction to recite a separate mantra. The seven epithets applied here — great, without measure, without limit, without superior, unsurpassed, without equal, equal to the unequalled — are a stock series well attested in the *Prajñāpāramitā* corpus and closely parallel the epithets found in the Heart Sūtra's praise of the mantra, reflecting the same doctrinal tradition. The distinction between རིག་མཁན་མངའ་མཁའ་ (without measure, *aprameya*) and རིག་མཁན་མངའ་མཁའ་ (without limit, *asamkhyeya* or *ananta*) is preserved in translation; the two terms are genuinely distinct in the Tibetan and likely reflect a Sanskrit distinction in the source text.
- The passage contains a structural distinction between two lists: one of spiritual qualities "endowed with the branches of awakening" (attributed to the presence of buddhas in the

world) and a parallel list "not endowed with the branches of awakening" (arising through bodhisattva activity in a buddha-less age). The shift from six higher knowledges to five in the second list is present in the Tibetan and is doctrinally significant: the sixth higher knowledge, the exhaustion of the outflows, is exclusive to fully awakened beings and so does not appear in the list available to bodhisattvas acting without a living buddha. The passage ends mid-sentence, continuing into the next fascicle.

- The phrase rendered "make thoroughly complete" translates བློ་གྲོལ་ལྷན་པར་བྱ་བ་, which can also mean "fully master" or "perfect"; the reading adopted fits the standard list of ten activities related to a sūtra text found elsewhere in Prajñāpāramitā literature. The phrase བློ་གྲོལ་ལྷན་པར་བྱ་བ་ (dying without having abandoned what is light, i.e., dying of hunger and thirst) is an idiom; the rendering "hunger and thirst" follows standard commentarial explanation of this expression.

- The king named "བློ་གྲོལ་ལྷན་པར་བྱ་བ་" is rendered here as King Prasenarasāra, a provisional reconstruction; the Tibetan literally means "King Essence of Form," which may correspond to a Sanskrit royal name not immediately identifiable with certainty. Similarly "བློ་གྲོལ་ལྷན་པར་བྱ་བ་" is rendered as King Prasenajit, the well-known king of Kosala associated with the Buddha's time, as this is the most likely referent; the Tibetan literally means "King Victorious Brightness." Readers should be aware these royal identifications carry some uncertainty. The phrase rendered "disrupt this with my eyes" translates "བློ་གྲོལ་ལྷན་པར་བྱ་བ་" somewhat idiomatically; the sense appears to be that Māra intends to distract or obstruct by appearing visibly.

- The phrase rendered "from time without beginning" translates a Tibetan idiom meaning "for a long time" rather than strictly "from beginningless time," but the doctrinal import here concerns Māra's persistent and longstanding fixation on the Blessed One, and "from time without beginning" fits the Buddhist cosmological register naturally.

The compound "listening, retaining, upholding, reading, mastering, proclaiming, teaching, explaining, reciting transmission, and reciting" represents a standard tenfold enumeration of meritorious activities related to a sūtra text; all ten are rendered as precisely as Tibetan distinctions allow.

- The phrase rendered "goes before, leads, and leads completely" translates a triad of Tibetan verbs: sngon du 'gro, 'dren pa, yongs su 'dren pa. The third intensifies the second ("leads" / "guides completely"), and the threefold formulation is characteristic of the sūtra's emphasis on the Perfection of Wisdom's primacy and all-encompassing function. No genuinely consequential textual uncertainty arises here.

- The passage shifts between two registers of Tibetan honorific speech: ordinary verb forms when the Blessed One speaks and describes lay practitioners, and honorific verb forms when Śakra speaks of his own actions toward the Blessed One and the text. This distinction has been smoothed into natural English as it carries no semantic difference visible to a listener.

The term "Kauśika" is a patronymic epithet of Śakra (Indra), standard in Perfection of Wisdom literature, used here in place of his name in the Buddha's direct address to him.

- The phrase rendered "kinsmen by birth" translates a compound that literally means "blood-relations" or those connected by the bond of birth — the exact social category is somewhat general and the rendering is approximate.

The fourfold analysis of non-findability — the fault-seeker, the act of seeking faults, the one in whom faults are sought, and the Perfection of Wisdom itself — is a recognizable Madhyamaka-style argument embedded in the sūtra, establishing that ultimate non-findability is precisely what renders the practitioner invulnerable to refutation.

- The five heavens named here follow the standard cosmological sequence of the desire realm:

the Heaven of the Four Great Kings (already introduced in the preceding passage), the Heaven of the Thirty-Three (Trāyastriṃśa, Śakra's realm), the Heaven Free from Strife (Yāma), the Joyous Heaven (Tuṣita), and the Heaven of Delight in Creation (Nirmāṇarati). The passage breaks off mid-sequence before the sixth desire-realm heaven and the form-realm heavens, which presumably continued in the original.

- The Tibetan sequence of form-realm heavens listed here corresponds to the standard Abhidharma enumeration of the seventeen form-realm heavens. The list moves through the four dhyāna levels: Brahmaḥpurohita (Brahmaḥs-Retinue / Fore-chanters), Mahābrahmā (Great Brahmā), then the radiance-class heavens (Minor Radiance, Immeasurable Radiance, Resplendent Light), the virtue-class heavens (Minor Virtue, Immeasurable Virtue, Abundant Virtue), and the pure abode heavens (Cloudless, Increasing Merit, Great Fruit, Beings Without Perception, Non-Turbulent, Unafflicted, Superb Appearance, Clarity of Vision), culminating in Akaniṣṭha. The rendering follows this standard enumeration.

The "Heaven of Wielding Others' Creations" renders Skt. Paranirmitavaśavartin, the sixth and highest heaven of the desire realm — consistent with the preceding passage's enumeration ascending through the desire-realm heavens.

- The phrase rendered "Great Splendor" translates the divine epithet or quality name "gzi brijid che ba" (Sanskrit: mahātejas), here functioning as both a descriptive quality and apparently a name or designation associated with a class of beings who converge on the place. The syntax is somewhat compressed: the text says these various beings come because they think "there is great splendor / Great Splendor (mahātejas) there," which may refer to the radiance of the Perfection of Wisdom itself drawing them. This reading follows the most natural construal of the passage.

- The phrase rendered "pure and clean conduct" translates the pair of terms meaning something like "carefully guarded conduct" and "clean conduct," pointing to both the moral vigilance and the physical or ritual cleanliness associated with the place where the Perfection of Wisdom is being honored. The distinction between the two terms is real but the doctrinal difference is minor; the paired translation preserves both.

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, breaking off at the comparative clause beginning "even if that person has the text put into a volume while still young and merely bears or places it." This is a continuation sentence whose conclusion will appear in the next passage; the translation preserves the open construction accordingly.

The name of the buddha "།།།།།།།།།" rendered here as "The Very Great One" is a descriptive epithet rather than a standard Sanskrit equivalent preserved in the tradition. It functions as an example name within the passage's rhetorical enumeration.

- The phrase rendered "depicting the Tathāgata's tradition in image" translates a clause meaning something like "for the sake of making an image or portrait of the Tathāgata's conduct or form." The Tibetan ri mor bgyi ba (to paint a picture, to depict) combined with tshul (tradition, way, form) is slightly elliptical; the sense is that a physical image of the Tathāgata points back to and is validated by the Perfection of Wisdom as the true body of meaning, which is why Śakra chooses the text. This is a doctrinally significant point about the relationship between physical relics or images and the dharmakāya as expressed through the Prajñāpāramitā.

The closing quotation attributed to the Blessed One — "Monks, do not cling to this as the supreme body; monks, look upon me as the dharmakāya" — is an allusion to a well-known formula found in related sūtras; the Tibetan here is terse and compressed, and the rendering reflects the standard doctrinal sense of the passage.

- The speaker identified as "Dharmasubha the god" renders the Tibetan name Chos bzang lha,

which appears to be a Tibetan translation of a Sanskrit theophoric name such as Dharmaśubha or Dharmasobha. This figure is a divine interlocutor in the sūtra. The passage involves a repeated rhetorical device of scaling up from Jambudvīpa through the two-thousand middling world-system to the full trichiliocosm, each step serving to magnify the relative merit of the Perfection of Wisdom over any quantity of Tathāgata images.

- The text shifts mid-passage from a speech by Subhūti back into a colophon marker naming the fifth fascicle of the Aṣṭasāhasrikā Prajñāpāramitā, then opens a new teaching section featuring the jewel simile. The three humors named — bile-fever, bile, and phlegm, together with wind-disorder — correspond to the classical Āyurvedic and traditional Buddhist medical schema of the three bodily humors plus wind, rendered as faithfully as possible. The term rendered "film over the eye" is a classical eye-disease listed in Indian medical literature. The passage ends mid-sentence as Śakra begins his reply, consistent with the source being a continuous excerpt.

- The phrase rendered "filled to the brim" translates a term literally meaning "crammed full, heaped up, densely packed," conveying the image of world-realms entirely saturated with relics. The comparison of the two portions — relics versus the Perfection of Wisdom text — is a well-known Prajñāpāramitā motif appearing across multiple sūtras of this literature; Śakra's speech here flows directly into what is clearly Śakra's continued address, though the passage shifts grammatically to first-person in a way that may reflect a compressed or ambiguous speaker attribution in the manuscript. The first-person speaker choosing the Perfection of Wisdom over the relics is most naturally read as Śakra continuing his speech to Ānanda, consistent with the surrounding dialogue.

- The phrase rendered "leads the way before all of them" translates the repeated Tibetan construction meaning literally "goes in front of / precedes these." The doctrinal point is the standard Mahāyāna teaching that the Perfection of Wisdom is the guiding or governing perfection that gives the other five their character as genuine pāramitās; the repetition in the final sentence is an emphatic recapitulation of this point and has been retained as such.

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, with the list of devotional acts left syntactically open. The translation preserves this open structure as it continues into the following passage. The term rendered "transmits it by scriptural reading" translates the Tibetan for reciting a text aloud for transmission purposes, a distinct act in the list of ways of engaging with scripture. The phrase "makes it fully comprehensible" renders a term that can also mean "masters it thoroughly" or "brings it to full understanding"; both senses are present.

- The term rendered as "reliquary" translates a phrase meaning a Tathāgata's bodily relic receptacle or stūpa, which in context encompasses both stūpa structures and the physical representation of the Tathāgata's body. The parallel structure in the passage contrasts two types of practitioners: one who venerates in solitude, and one who venerates and then spreads the Perfection of Wisdom to others — the latter being consistently praised as generating greater merit.

- The phrase rendered "the complete exhaustion of the aggregates — in this supreme manner, which is the complete analysis of the true limit" translates a technically condensed Tibetan clause describing parinirvāṇa. The "true limit" is the ultimate, reality itself; "analysis" here renders "rab tu 'byed pa," meaning the discriminating penetration of that limit, while "taming" renders the leading of beings into that liberation. The doctrinal sense is that after attaining buddhahood one leads beings to nirvāṇa, i.e., to the complete cessation of the aggregates through realization of the ultimate.

The cosmological series — Jambudvīpa, the four great continents, the chiliocosm (thousand-world system), the dichiliocosm (two-thousand middling worlds), and the trichiliocosm (great three-thousand world-system) — follows the standard Buddhist

cosmological hierarchy and is rendered accordingly.

- The phrase rendered "illuminates it in word, thoroughly illuminates it, and illuminates it in all its aspects" translates three related Tibetan verbs of indicating or demonstrating, progressing from basic verbal expression through complete and sequential exposition. The triad is a standard formulation in Perfection of Wisdom literature for the full range of expository activity.

The phrase rendered "bringing their aggregates to complete exhaustion" refers to the entry into nirvāṇa without remainder, a standard Mahāyāna way of describing the liberation of sentient beings from the psychophysical continuum of conditioned existence. "The genuine limit" is a rendering of yang dag pa'i mtha', a common Perfection of Wisdom term for ultimate reality or the true endpoint of the path, equivalent to the absolute or dharmadhātu.

- The phrase rendered "those whose aggregates have completely exhausted" describes sentient beings led to parinirvāṇa — the extinction of the aggregates — which is the standard Mahāyāna context for a buddha's activity of "disciplining" or "taming" beings unto their final liberation. The expression "opening of the true limit" translates yang dag pa'i mtha' rab tu 'byed pa, referring to the disclosure or penetration of the ultimate extreme, i.e., reality as it truly is, which functions here as a near-synonym for nirvāṇa or the dharmadhātu.

The cosmological progression — from the world-realm of the four great continents, to the thousand-fold universe, to the twice-thousand middling universe, to the great trichiliocosm, and then to world-realms as numerous as the Ganges sands — follows the standard Buddhist cosmological hierarchy of increasing scale used in merit-comparison passages throughout the Perfection of Wisdom literature.

- The opening sentence is a repetition that closes the previous passage and transitions into the new section, as is standard in this type of Perfection of Wisdom literature. The repeated block later in the passage is likewise structural repetition serving a cumulative rhetorical escalation, moving from Jambudvīpa to a four-continent world-system and then toward a thousandfold world-system, which the passage has not yet completed at this point in the Tibetan. The phrase "ཁ་ལྷན་རིག་བཟོས་པའི་སངས་རྒྱུད་ཀླུ་སྐུ་མཉམ་ཆེན་པོ།" most naturally refers to a "chiliocosm" — a world-system of a thousand worlds — which is the standard cosmological unit in this literature; this is rendered accordingly.

- The phrase rendered "the chief among thousands" translates *stong spyi phud*, literally "the summit or prime of a thousand," a technical cosmological term designating the second tier of world-systems in the classical Buddhist cosmological hierarchy (one thousand four-continent world-systems). This stands between the simple thousand-world system mentioned in the preceding passage and the two-thousand middle-world system, and the great trichiliocosm. The progression here is the standard triad: *sāhasra*, *dvisāhasra*, *trisāhasra-mahāsāhasra*.

The passage describing what happens after full awakening — taming sentient beings by "perfectly exhausting the aggregates" and "laying bare the true limit" — is doctrinally dense. The phrase yang dag pa'i mtha' rab tu 'byed pa, rendered "the utter laying bare of the true limit," refers to nirvāṇa as the absolute or ultimate limit of existence; the passage describes the Buddha's activity of leading beings to the final cessation wherein the aggregates are completely exhausted without remainder. This is standard Mahāyāna phrasing for guiding beings to parinirvāṇa while the Buddha himself acts from the dharmakāya.

- The key doctrinal contrast in this passage is subtle and consequential: the "counterfeit" (影相, lit. "reflection/image") teaching identifies the impermanence of a skandha with its mere disintegration or perishing, while the authentic Perfection of Wisdom does not equate the two in that way. This reflects a Madhyamaka concern that reducing impermanence to momentary disintegration mistakes a conventional description for ultimate insight into emptiness and the nature of the aggregates. The term 影相 here means "counterfeit

image" or "simulacrum" rather than a physical reflection, and is rendered accordingly throughout.

- The cosmological sequence follows the classical Buddhist schema of world-systems: the single world-system of the four great continents, the small chiliocosm of one thousand worlds, the medium dichiliocosm of two thousand worlds, and the great trichiliocosm of three thousand times three thousand worlds. The Tibetan term སྐྱེལ་གླིང་ཆུང་ཆུང་ is the small chiliocosm and སྐྱེལ་གླིང་འབྲི་ཆུང་ is the medium dichiliocosm.

The passage describing the bodhisattva's "complete mastery in the unsurpassed thorough exhaustion of the aggregates" renders a dense phrase about guiding beings to nirvāṇa without remainder; the "true limit" is a standard term for nirvāṇa, rendered accordingly.

- The repeated syntactic formula translating སྐྱེལ་གླིང་ཆུང་ཆུང་འབྲི་ཆུང་འབྲི་ཆུང་འབྲི་ཆུང་ and its parallels renders a deliberate instrumental-to-dative structure: giving "with X to one who has X." This is the text's way of emphasizing matched receptivity between giver and recipient, and the rendering preserves that parallel structure throughout. The phrase སྐྱེལ་གླིང་ཆུང་ཆུང་འབྲི་ཆུང་འབྲི་ཆུང་འབྲི་ཆུང་འབྲི་ཆུང་ describes leading beings to the "complete exhaustion of the aggregates," a standard formula for parinirvāṇa without remainder; the rendering follows the commentarial understanding. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, matching the provided Tibetan, and the translation reflects this accordingly.

- The cosmological series — four continents, one thousand worlds, two thousand middling worlds, three thousand great thousands — reflects the standard Buddhist threefold world-system hierarchy. "One thousand worlds" is the small chiliocosm, "two thousand middling worlds" the medium chiliocosm, and "three thousand great thousands" the great trichiliocosm; the passage then multiplies the last by Gaṅgā-sand numbers, a standard rhetorical escalation in Perfection of Wisdom literature.

The fruit of once-returning (Skt. sakṛdāgāmi-phala) is the second of the four fruits of the śrāvaka path, attained when one has reduced the strength of desire and aversion to the degree that only one more rebirth in the desire realm remains before liberation.

- The phrase rendered "discerns the fruit of once-returning" translates a technical expression meaning that this text itself reveals or distinguishes the once-returner's fruit — indicating that engagement with it generates the conditions for attaining that stage. The parallel structure of the passage then escalates to the fruit of non-returning, continuing the text's pattern of graduated comparisons. The section heading "the sixth fascicle" is a scribal colophon marking a division of the root text and is retained as part of the transmitted text.

- The cosmological progression here follows the standard Buddhist concentric scheme: Jambudvīpa, the world-system of the four great continents (cāturdvīpika), the smaller chiliocosm of one thousand worlds (sāhasrī), the intermediate dichiliocosm of two thousand worlds (dvīsāhasrī), and the great trichiliocosm of three thousand times three thousand worlds (trisāhasramahāsāhasra). The passage then escalates further to a number of such great trichiliocosms equal to the grains of sand in the Ganges.

The phrase rendered "the perfect opening of the true and real limit" translates yang dag pa'i mtha' rab tu 'byed pa, referring to the penetration or discernment of the ultimate limit of reality, which in context means parinirvāṇa with its complete exhaustion of the aggregates. This is a genuinely compressed and somewhat difficult phrase; the rendering aims to preserve the doctrinal sense without over-interpreting.

- The phrase rendered "those whose aggregates are utterly exhausted in the unsurpassed way — leading them to the complete discernment of the true end" translates a technically dense formulation describing nirvāṇa without remainder. The "true end" (yang dag pa'i mtha') is a

standard epithet for nirvāṇa as the ultimate limit of saṃsāra; "complete discernment" renders rab tu 'byed pa in the sense of fully cutting through to that limit. The sequence here moves from non-return to arhatship to full buddhahood, marking a deliberate doctrinal escalation in the merit comparison.

- The escalating cosmological sequence uses the standard Buddhist world-system terminology: the single world with four continents, the thousand-fold world, the two-thousand middle world-system, and the great three-thousand-fold world-system. These are the standard three tiers of the trichiliocosm, with an additional preliminary tier of Jambudvīpa alone and a culminating tier of Ganges-sand multiples of the trichiliocosm.

The final sentence is deliberately left open as the Tibetan passage itself is syntactically incomplete, ending mid-construction. The translation preserves this open structure as it continues in the next passage.

- The passage contains a significant internal resumption: the full block of meritorious acts listed earlier in the preceding passage is recapitulated here nearly verbatim, and then climaxed with the additional act of exhorting another person to train in the path. The two iterations close with different conclusions — the first culminates in discernment of arhatship, the second in discernment of pratyekabuddhahood — reflecting what appears to be a deliberate ascending sequence of spiritual attainments, suggesting the full text continues with further iterations culminating in full buddhahood. The Tibetan རྒྱལ་བླ་མ་ལྟོས་པའི་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་ལུ་རྒྱལ་བླ་མ་ལྟོས་པའི་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་ལུ་ in the first occurrence and རྒྱལ་བླ་མ་ལྟོས་པའི་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་ལུ་ in the second are textually distinct — "purifying the mind" versus "engaging or directing the mind" — and may reflect a variant reading or scribal variation in the Tibetan; both have been rendered accordingly.

- The cosmological progression follows the standard Buddhist scheme of world-systems: the single world with four continents, the thousandfold small world-system, the two-thousandfold intermediate world-system, and the three-thousandfold great world-system, each level being a thousandfold expansion of the previous. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, describing the qualities of the meritorious person; the translation faithfully reflects this open construction.

- The passage contains a rhetorical escalation ("let alone... let alone...") at the close, which in the Tibetan is a Ita zhog construction marking an a-fortiori chain. The translation renders this as a sustained series opening with "let alone," anticipating that the chain continues beyond this excerpt. The phrase རྒྱལ་བླ་མ་ལྟོས་པའི་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་ལུ་རྒྱལ་བླ་མ་ལྟོས་པའི་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་ལུ་ is technically dense; "leading to perfect discipline in the utter end of reality" renders the sense of guiding beings to parinirvāṇa through the complete exhaustion of the aggregates, consistent with the standard Perfection of Wisdom commentarial reading.

- The cosmological terms follow the standard Abhidharma schema: the "world-system of one thousand worlds" is the minor chiliocosm (sāhasrī lokadhātu), the "world-system of two thousand worlds" is the middling chiliocosm (dvisāhasrī), and the "great trichiliocosm" (trisāhasramahāsāhasrī lokadhātu) is the largest standard cosmological unit. These are rendered descriptively rather than with technical Sanskrit compound terms to preserve TTS clarity.

- The passage employs the standard Buddhist cosmological sequence of expanding world systems: the world of the four great continents, then a system of one thousand worlds (a small chiliocosm), then two thousand middle worlds (a dichiliocosm), and finally the great trichiliocosm of three thousand times three thousand worlds. The rhetorical device throughout is "set aside" or "leave aside" — a way of saying the merit just described is surpassed by what follows. The phrase rendered "teaches it nearby with its meaning and its letters" reflects the Tibetan idiom of close, personal instruction covering both semantic content and the actual words of the text.

- The phrase rendered "medicines for curing illness" translates a compound referring specifically to medicines taken when ill, as distinct from general medicinal requisites — a standard fourfold list of monastic requisites appears here with the fifth item (medicines for the sick) completing it. This is a conventional Vinaya-inflected formula and the translation reflects standard usage.

- The long string of epithets describing the arhats and buddhas who have passed into nirvāṇa ("path cut off," "entering cut off," "conceptual elaboration and drawing into existence cut off," "tears dried," "thorns broken," etc.) follows a well-attested formulaic sequence found throughout the Aṣṭasāhasrikā Prajñāpāramitā. These are standard arhat-epithets. The phrase rendered "equal to the incomparable" translates mi mnyam pa dang mnyam pa, a classical superlative formula meaning "that which is the equal of the unequalled," i.e., matchless.

The passage ends mid-sentence, with the temporal clause left open; this is a structural feature of the source text as presented, not an error in translation.

- The passage lists five aggregates of a buddha's qualities in a classical formula: moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis-vision of liberation. This pentad is a standard canonical enumeration.

The phrase rendered "the power of the Tathāgata's genuine, exact gnosis" corresponds to a technical term for the Tathāgata's knowledge of things as they are, distinct from knowledge of the extent of things. Both aspects of buddha-gnosis are implied in the surrounding context.

The expressions "equal to the unequal" and "without equal, equal to the unequal" render a compound that in Sanskrit would be asamasama, a stock epithet meaning "equal only to one who has no equal," i.e., uniquely matchless.

- The list of eight non-human beings in the middle section follows the standard canonical grouping found in sūtra colophons and audience descriptions: gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas (great serpents). The Tibetan གུརུཊ་ is garuḍa and ཀིན་ར་ is kinnara; both are rendered by their standard Sanskrit names without parenthetical gloss, as these beings appear routinely in this corpus.

The exchange between Maitreya and Subhūti here introduces the central Perfection of Wisdom tension: the bodhisattva must dedicate merit without reifying the act of dedication, its objects, or its aspects into fixed signs, yet the questioner (Subhūti) presses whether apprehending "no-thing" does not itself become a new form of inversion. This dialectic is characteristic of the large Prajñāpāramitā sūtras and should be understood in that doctrinal context.

- The phrase rendered "exhausted and ceased, separated and transformed" translates a fourfold description of the past mind — zad cing 'gags par gyur la bral zhing nam par gyur pa — indicating that the rejoicing mind, being momentary and past, is already gone, making the question of who or what dedicates philosophically acute. This is a central Perfection of Wisdom dialectic about the non-findability of the dedicating subject, and the phrasing is intentionally paradoxical. The translation preserves this tension without smoothing it over.

- The passage contains a series of epithets applied to the past buddhas who have fully passed into nirvāṇa. The Tibetan phrase "lam chad pa 'jug pa chad pa" and the subsequent terms form a stock formulaic description of a fully liberated buddha: the path is cut off (no further path to traverse), entry has ceased, arising (of the afflictions or of rebirth) has ceased, and so on through the sequence ending with complete liberation of mind. This is a standard enumerative formula in Perfection of Wisdom literature and has been rendered accordingly, preserving each member of the sequence without conflating them.

The term rendered "great serpents" (lto 'phye chen po) refers to mahoragas, large serpentine beings in the traditional cosmological list of eight classes of non-human beings, here appearing in the standard ninefold enumeration.

- The passage presents a philosophically intricate account of dedication of merit without reifying the dedicating mind. The key move is that correct dedication requires not grasping the mind as a fixed, identifiable thing; the nature of reality of the dedicating mind, the phenomena dedicated, and the goal to which dedication is made are all identical in being beyond conceptual fixation. The Tibetan "བློ་མཆོག་མཆོག་མཆོག་" rendered as "what has ceased has ceased" reflects a recursive or emphatic formula for cessation, reinforcing the point that the mind of dedication is itself already exhausted and without inherent existence. The list at the end is a series of wholesome roots to be rejoiced in and dedicated, and the passage breaks off mid-enumeration, consistent with the continuity note.

- The phrase rendered as "exhausted in exhaustion" translates the Tibetan "བློ་མཆོག་མཆོག་མཆོག་" literally. This is a technical philosophical statement pointing to the idea that even "exhaustion" or "cessation" itself is exhausted — the mind, when investigated, resolves into a cessation that cannot be grasped as an entity, let alone dedicated. This is an expression of the Prajñāpāramitā teaching that the very instrument of dedication (the dedicating mind) has no findable nature, and therefore the dedication is genuine precisely because it grasps at nothing.

The epithets applied to the presently abiding buddhas — "whose stream of teaching has not been cut off, whose practice is uninterrupted, whose conceptual elaboration has been cut off, whose leading into existence has been cut off" — are standard formulaic descriptions in this literature distinguishing these buddhas as fully realized while still actively present and teaching. The passage ends mid-sentence and will continue.

- The five "aggregates" of the buddhas listed here — moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and wisdom-vision of liberation — render the classical set of pañca-skandha in the special sense of the "five Dharma-bodies" or "five aggregates of the great person" (pañcadharmaskandha), a technical scholastic category distinct from the ordinary five aggregates of a sentient being. This distinction, though implicit in the Tibetan, is doctrinally significant for a learned audience.

- The phrase rendered "what is exhausted is exhausted" translates "བློ་མཆོག་མཆོག་མཆོག་" — a doubled construction that is genuinely cryptic. It refers to the mind's moment-by-moment cessation: each moment of mind has already perished and thus cannot be grasped as an object of dedication. The rendering follows the most natural doctrinal sense consistent with the Perfection of Wisdom context.

The long final section is a single extended syntactic period in the Tibetan, listing categories of wholesome roots to be dedicated; the translation preserves this structure, with the sentence deliberately left open as the passage is clearly mid-enumeration at the point of truncation.

- The passage contains a dense series of three-tense formulations throughout, which is a standard Mahāyāna sūtra construction covering past, future, and present; these have been rendered in their natural English order. The term "mahoraga" for མཐོག་མཐོག་མཐོག་, literally "great serpent" but the name of a class of supernatural beings, is kept in Sanskrit following convention; similarly "garuḍa" for གུ་རུ་དྲུག་ and "kiṃnara" for ཀིམ་ན་ར་ལ་. The central doctrinal point of the dedication section turns on the paradox that a truly valid dedication to awakening is one that is free of any reifying clinging to the dedicating act, the dedicator, or the object dedicated — a characteristic Perfection of Wisdom teaching.

- The passage contains a subtle dialectical structure regarding three failed modes of dedication: first, knowing signs and clinging; second, making something a sign and thinking of it; third, the opposite failure of mere mindlessness or lack of comprehension. Only the fourth mode — holding the sign to mind without reifying it as a sign — constitutes genuine dedication.

The translation preserves this fourfold structure as the text presents it.

The phrase rendered "this too is the Perfection of Wisdom" in the opening sentence is genuinely paradoxical and appears to be intentional: even the incomplete or confused understanding of emptiness participates in the Perfection of Wisdom in some sense. This is a doctrinal point the text itself leaves provocative.

- The fivefold list of aggregates attributed to the buddhas and their śrāvakas — moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the gnosis that sees liberation — renders the classical Pāli and Sanskrit formula dharmaskandha in its standard Abhidharma enumeration; the term translated as "aggregate" here is the same Tibetan word as the skandhas of a person, used by extension for these five qualities constituting the "body" of the Dharma.
- The phrase rendered "does no harm to the Tathāgatas" translates the Tibetan "skur pa mi 'debs pa," literally "does not impute a denigration" or "does not slander." In this context the meaning is that by rejoicing and dedicating in the correct, signless mode one does not misrepresent or violate the spirit of the Tathāgatas' teaching, as opposed to the distortion caused by sign-based dedication described earlier.

The phrase "inexhaustible" for "chud ma zos pa" (literally "not consumed" or "not wasted") is a standard rendering in this doctrinal context, indicating that merit dedicated in the signless mode is never exhausted or lost.

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, cutting off after the enumeration of the four immeasurables. The translation preserves this open ending faithfully.

The series of ten superlatives applied to the mass of merit — supreme, excellent, foremost, best, most excellent, magnificent, highest, unsurpassed, without anything above it, without equal, equal to the unequal — is a standard rhetorical climax in Perfection of Wisdom literature; all ten are rendered in sequence as the text demands.

- The passage is a sustained anaphoric sequence escalating through the Śrāvaka path stages and beyond, using the rhetorical "set aside even that" device to build toward a climactic comparison involving bodhisattvas. The final sentence is syntactically incomplete in this excerpt, cutting off mid-list after "robes, alms-food" — this is simply where the supplied passage ends, not a textual lacuna.
- The phrase rendered "it does not come within even a hundredth part" represents the standard Indian hyperbolic series of fractions used to express incommensurability: the Tibetan literally lists the denominators as one hundred, one thousand, one hundred thousand, ten million, one hundred million, one billion, one hundred billion, ten trillion, one hundred trillion. The translation preserves these as a graduated series rather than spelling out each numeral individually, for readability in TTS contexts. The series is doctrinally standard and presents no genuine uncertainty.
- The list of heavenly realms in the long enumeration follows the standard Abhidharma cosmology, running through the desire-realm heavens (the six desire-realm god-realms from Yāma through Paranirmitavaśavartin) and then the Brahmā-world levels, and then the form-realm heavens through the Pure Abodes (Śuddhāvāsa). The Tibetan names are rendered by their standard English equivalents derived from their Sanskrit forms, since using the Tibetan phonetics alone would obscure the doctrinal referents for a general audience. The sentence ends mid-clause in the Tibetan as given; the translation faithfully reflects this open-ended structure.
- The passage enumerates a dense series of superlatives in the description of the rejoicing — terms like "foremost, chief, excellent, supremely excellent, distinguished, highest, unsurpassed, unexcelled, higher even than the highest, incomparable, matchless, equal to the

matchless, and supremely equal to the matchless." This is a stock formulaic sequence in Perfection of Wisdom literature; each term renders a distinct Tibetan superlative and the cumulative rhetorical effect is intentional. The five "heaps" — moral discipline, meditative absorption, wisdom, liberation, and the wisdom of the vision of liberation — are a standard Abhidharma enumeration of the excellences of a buddha or noble one, here rendered literally in accordance with the Tibetan. The section break "The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The Eighth Fascicle" renders a standard textual division marker in the Tibetan.

- The phrase rendered as "equal and supremely equal to none" renders འོད་མཚོ་འོད་མཚོ་འོད་མཚོ་འོད་མཚོ་འོད་མཚོ་, a cluster of four Sanskrit epithets (asamasama, anupama, samasama, asamasama in various configurations) that form a stock superlative series in prajñāpāramitā literature; the rendering here follows the standard sense of the series without forcing a strictly logical sequence, since the Tibetan is itself a compressed approximation of the Sanskrit chain.

The term འོད་མཚོ་འོད་མཚོ་ ("liberation," Skt. vimukti) is used here in a technically distinctive way: each perfection, each act, each being is said to be "as liberation is" — pointing to their non-dual, emptiness-grounded character. This is a significant doctrinal usage that the translation preserves structurally.

- The passage shifts from the rejoicing and dedication framework into a lengthy comparative merit argument, a standard Perfection of Wisdom sūtra device. The phrase rendered "with a perception that has an object of reference" renders the Tibetan for giving or practicing while still conceiving of a referential object, i.e., with dualistic, conceptually reifying perception, which is the inferior mode being contrasted with non-referential prajñāpāramitā practice. The passage ends mid-sentence, as the Tibetan text provided is itself incomplete at that point.
- The phrase rendered "with pride" translates the Tibetan "nga rgyal dang bcas pa," literally "accompanied by pride or conceit." In this context it is a technical marker indicating that the patience, though genuine and extensive, is still practiced with a subtle sense of self — that is, with the reification of a subject who endures. This is precisely what distinguishes it, in what follows, from non-referential patience, and the apparent paradox of "patience with pride" is doctrinally intentional: the bodhisattva tolerates abuse but retains a subtle ego-grasping, which is contrasted with the superior patience of the non-referential approach.
- The long string of superlatives applied to the rejoicing — "supreme, primary, excellent, supremely excellent, distinguished, unsurpassed, without superior, without anything above it, above even what is above, without equal, incomparable, equal to the equal, supremely equal, and inconceivable" — renders a stock Perfection of Wisdom formula listing ascending grades of excellence. The Tibetan terms here (dam pa, gtso bo, rab, mchog rab, gya nom pa, bla ma, bla na med pa, gong na med pa, gong ma'i yang gong ma, mnyam pa med pa, mi mnyam pa, mnyam pa, shin tu mnyam pa med pa, bsam gyis mi khyab pa) are a fixed enumerative series; the rendering follows the sequence as literally as readability permits.

The passage closes mid-sentence by design, continuing the same comparison begun above; the translation faithfully renders this as an incomplete sentence leading into the next passage.

- The passage presents a sustained comparative argument structured as a series of nested hypotheticals, building on what preceded. The key doctrinal contrast is between merit generated by diligence practiced with a referential or object-directed perception versus merit generated through rejoicing at virtue and dedicating it within the framework of the Perfection of Wisdom with skillful means. The elaborate series of superlative synonyms for incomparability in the rejoicing passage reflects a standard Indic rhetorical device; each term in the chain is rendered distinctly to preserve the cumulative rhetorical force of the original. The passage breaks off mid-sentence, as the Tibetan itself is incomplete at this point, continuing from what was already rendered above.

The statement that "sentient beings do not fully awaken" and that therefore the Perfection of Wisdom "does not fully awaken" is a characteristically paradoxical formulation of the prajñāpāramitā literature: because no truly existent sentient being can be found to undergo awakening, awakening itself, as an event attributed to such beings, cannot be established as truly occurring. This is not a denial of awakening but a negation of its inherent, reified existence.

- The term rendered as "remote" throughout translates a word that can also mean "solitary" or "secluded," but in this doctrinal context it carries the sense of being utterly beyond — free of grasping-supports — and functions as a near-synonym of emptiness and peace, so "remote" is the most accurate available rendering. The phrase "full cognition" renders a term meaning comprehensive knowing, distinguishable from ordinary perception; its precise referent in the original is a type of conceptual apprehension that, together with perception, designation, and conventional expression, is contrasted with the non-referential character of the Perfection of Wisdom.

- The phrase rendered "derangement of wisdom" translates བློ་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་, literally "going astray or becoming deranged with respect to wisdom," meaning the corruption or loss of prajna — the opposite of the clear discrimination that the Perfection of Wisdom cultivates. The term is doctrinally significant as describing the karmic result of rejecting this teaching.

The escalating time-units at the close of the passage follow a standard canonical pattern of vast temporal enumeration; the rendering attempts to convey their cumulative force without inventing Tibetan-specific numerical vocabulary not present in the source.

- The phrase rendered as "actions of immediate retribution" translates the five ānantarya-karmas, the five gravest acts that bring retribution in the very next life without interval. The Tibetan "ཡུལ་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་" is the standard Tibetan rendering of pañcānantarya.

The phrase "ruin their own stream and destroy the streams of others" and the parallel "poison their own stream" use the term "stream" (rgyud) in its sense of the mental continuum of a person. This is a technical usage: one's rgyud is one's ongoing psycho-physical continuum.

- The sentence describing deluded persons who revile the Perfection of Wisdom and then "will go forth into renunciation within this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya" is doctrinally paradoxical and syntactically compressed. The Tibetan reads as though such persons, despite their delusion and rejection of the Perfection of Wisdom, do in fact ordain within the Buddhist community — which is likely the intended irony or critique: they become monastics yet internally reject the deepest teaching. This reading has been preserved rather than smoothed over.

- The phrase rendered "utterly estranged from the Three Jewels in every respect, from every side, and in every dimension" translates a fourfold Tibetan intensifier construction (thams cad nas thams cad rnam pa thams cad du thams cad phyi rol du gyur pa) — a standard Perfection of Wisdom rhetorical formula emphasizing total exclusion; the rendering preserves its cumulative force without reproducing the repetition awkwardly in English.

The term "fascicle" for bam po reflects the traditional Tibetan textual division marker indicating a manuscript bundle or recitation unit, here the ninth such unit of the text.

- The phrase rendered "illuminates" for བློ་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་ literally means "that which makes clear" or "that which illuminates." This is a standard Perfection of Wisdom epithet pointing to wisdom's self-luminous quality and its dispelling of obscurity; no single English word captures all of this, but "illuminates" serves well in context.

- The phrase rendered "without junction or connection" translates བློ་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་, literally "without joining of junctures." This is a somewhat unusual expression in the prajñāpāramitā context; it likely means the Perfection of Wisdom admits of no divisions,

boundaries, or connective junctions, consistent with its non-dual purity. The rendering preserves both the literal sense and doctrinal import.

The term སྤྲུལ་, "self," used by Subhūti in the formula "by the purity of self" is striking. In this context it is almost certainly the self understood in its conventional or nominal sense — and its purity is non-dual with the purity of form, consciousness, and so forth — rather than affirming any substantialist self. This is a well-known rhetorical and doctrinal feature of certain prajñāpāramitā passages.

- The term rendered "limitlessness" throughout the opening exchanges translates སྤྲུལ་པ་མེད་པའི་ཆོད་པ་, literally "having no limit or boundary," here used in a series parallel to the "purity" exchanges in the preceding passage. The shift from "purity" to "limitlessness" as the structural term is intentional and mirrors the Tibetan precisely.

The phrase "makes this Perfection of Wisdom into something distant" renders སྤྲུལ་པ་མེད་པའི་ཆོད་པ་ལ་འཕྲུལ་པ་ལྟར་ལྟོག་པ་, literally "would make this Perfection of Wisdom far away" — the irony being that conceptualizing it as neither near nor far paradoxically distances it when taken as an object of perception.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation reflects this without closure.

- The phrase rendered "solitariness" throughout translates the Tibetan "dben pa," which literally means "emptiness, solitude, or aloneness" and in Prajñāpāramitā contexts carries the sense of phenomena being "alone" in their nature — that is, devoid of the dualistic overlays of characteristic marks and conceptual elaboration. This is a recognized technical use that shades into the sense of "transcendence" or "aloofness from extremes," though "solitariness" preserves the literal image the text is playing on.

The final dialectical exchange — that the Tathāgata both has and has not awakened to all phenomena — is a characteristic Prajñāpāramitā paradox resolved by the identity of the intrinsic nature of phenomena (their marklessness) with the Perfection of Wisdom itself. No fabricated dharma was grasped; hence awakening entails no epistemic object in the ordinary sense.

- The phrase rendered "no one whatsoever perfectly and completely awakens" is a deliberately paradoxical statement. The Blessed One's answer to "Is the Perfection of Wisdom difficult to realize?" is not a direct answer but a doctrinal declaration: because there is no real agent or object, no one "awakens" in any hypostatized sense. This is consistent with the prajñāpāramitā literature's refusal to posit awakening as a graspable attainment.

The terms rendered "incomplete or complete" translate "ma rdzogs pa dang rdzogs pa," literally "not perfected and perfected." The sense here is that form is neither to be conceived as deficient nor as fulfilled or consummated — any such conceptual framing is itself abandoned. This reading is consistent with the non-elaboration theme running through the passage.

- The phrase "individual perfect knowledges" renders the Tibetan term for the four analytical knowledges (pratisaṃvid), which are specific cognitive attainments of buddhas and advanced āryas. The text's recapitulation section abbreviates by substituting "ma yin" (it is not so either) between enumerated items, a characteristic Perfection of Wisdom sūtra telescoping style, which has been expanded naturally in the translation for clarity in narration.
- The phrase rendered "it is exhausted at just that" translates the repeated expression "de snyed du zad do," which conveys that the nature of reality of phenomena is neither augmented nor diminished by being taught or not taught — it simply stands complete in itself. Some translators render this as "it remains as it is," but the Tibetan more precisely means it is wholly and exactly what it is, neither more nor less, which the "exhausted at just that" rendering

captures in context.

The monk who pays homage to the Perfection of Wisdom is unnamed in the text; this is not an oversight but appears to be as the text stands.

- The term rendered "echo" translates a Tibetan word that can mean "echo" or "reverberation." The text uses it first as "echo" in the analogy with the voice, and then extends it as a simile for all phenomena — a standard Prajñāpāramitā illustration of the illusory, ungraspable nature of things. The translation preserves this consistently.

The phrase "humans and non-humans who watch for an opportunity" refers to malevolent spirits and hostile beings who exploit the vulnerability of a practitioner who has lost the protection of wisdom — a standard motif in these sūtras.

- The phrase rendered "has no echo" translates a term literally meaning "does not reverberate like an echo from a cliff face." The image is of space as that which neither echoes nor can be articulated or pointed to as an object, emphasizing its ineffability. This is a standard simile in the Perfection of Wisdom literature for non-referentiality.

The exclamation rendered "How wondrous!" translates a Tibetan interjection of admiration and astonishment that conventionally opens a statement of praise or wonder in sūtra dialogue.

- The phrase rendered "does not abandon their composure" translates a construction meaning roughly "because they do not give up through being downcast or dejected," implying that steadfastness in practice prevents untimely death — a standard merit-protection formula in Perfection of Wisdom literature.

The final series of six negations (not leading in, not leading in decisively, not revealing truly, not revealing definitively, not causing to obtain, not causing to obtain definitively) reflects a careful scholastic enumeration of the ways a teaching ordinarily functions; their negation here underscores the non-objectifying, non-grasping character of the Perfection of Wisdom itself.

- The sequence of epithets for the Perfection of Wisdom given by Subhūti at the close of this passage presents a series of compound formulations. The term rendered "Perfection of Sameness with what is unequal" translates *mi mnyam pa dang mnyam pa nyid kyi pha rol tu phyin pa*, which is a recognized technical expression in Prajñāpāramitā literature meaning that this wisdom is equalized with the unequalled, i.e., it is the perfection that is both equal and unequal, or "the perfection of equalness with the unequal." The rendering follows the Tibetan closely. The phrase "no one has been established as a recipient of generosity" renders *sbyin pa'i gnas su byas pa yang med*, literally "no one has been made a field of giving," i.e., no one has been made an object of meritorious giving — a technical idea that the teaching does not create a donor-recipient relationship.

- The passage names a series of paradoxically titled perfections, several of which are doctrinally arresting. "The Perfection of No Discipline" renders the phrase whose literal sense is that past, present, and future moments are unapprehensible, and so no vinaya-style restraint applies at the ultimate level. "The Perfection of Dream, Echo, Optical Illusion, Mirage, and Magical Apparition" is a single compound perfection name drawn from the classic set of eight analogies for illusion-like phenomena. "The Perfection of Impermanence" and "the Perfection of Suffering" are genuinely paradoxical titles: the text appears to name a perfection after each of the three characteristics, concluding with emptiness, in order to indicate that thorough understanding of impermanence, suffering, and emptiness is itself the corresponding perfection. "The Perfection of No Purification" rests on the principle that since no support or basis is apprehensible, there is nothing that requires or undergoes purification at the ultimate level.

- The phrase rendered as "Individual Perfect Knowledges" translates a term referring to the four *pratisaṃvids*, the four analytical knowledges, which are unshared attainments of buddhas

and great bodhisattvas. This is a standard Abhidharma category.

The "Ten Grounds" in this context refers to the ten bodhisattva grounds, with generosity named as the first, corresponding to the standard Mahāyāna schema.

The term rendered "Self-Arising" for the perfection associated with all phenomena lacking inherent nature points to the quality of arising spontaneously without fabricated causes — a somewhat unusual formulation, though attested in this genre of Perfection of Wisdom literature.

- The phrase rendered "craving for it" translates a term that normally means craving or thirst in a negative sense, but here it appears in a list of positive qualities whose absence is being noted, so it functions as something closer to "eager longing" or "thirst for it" in a spiritually positive register. The translation preserves the literal sense while allowing context to clarify.
- The repeated phrase translated as "does not dwell in form as though thinking 'this is form,' and does not abide in it" renders a technically layered Tibetan construction distinguishing two modes of non-fixation: not taking something as its own object-label and not settling into it as a support. This is a standard Prajñāpāramitā teaching on non-apprehension and is rendered consistently throughout. The term "Kauśika" is the Blessed One's mode of addressing Śakra, being his clan name.
- The passage plays on a reciprocal logical structure: not abiding in the designation "profound" is itself the form of training in yoga, and not training in yoga with that designation is itself not abiding in it. This is an intentional doctrinal chiasmus and has been rendered to preserve the symmetry rather than smooth it away.

The phrase rendered "will not cause them to withdraw their affection" translates the idiom of a Tathāgata's mind not being "drawn out" or "displeased" after being satisfied — meaning the bodhisattva's conduct will be irreproachable even in the presence of a buddha.

- The phrase rendered "ultimate truth" at the end translates "yang dag pa'i mtha'," literally "the limit of the real" or "the real extreme," a term that in Perfection of Wisdom literature functions as a near-synonym for the ultimate, final reality — here kept close to the source rather than assimilated to the technical Yogācāra term pariniṣpanna; the parenthetical is offered as an approximate doctrinal anchor only.

The phrase "lta smos kyang ci 'tshal" (and its variants "lta smos kyang ci dgos") is a rhetorical expression meaning "what need is there even to speak of them" — implying the case under discussion is a fortiori obvious; this idiomatic force is preserved in the translation.

- The phrase rendered "ultimate truth" in the preceding passage and here as "ultimate truth" translates yang dag pa'i mtha', literally "the authentic or perfect limit or extreme." In the context of Perfection of Wisdom literature this refers to the ultimate reality itself rather than the specifically Yogācāra technical term pariniṣpanna used in the preceding passage; the bracketed Sanskrit in the preceding passage was a translation choice that should be understood as approximate here.

The passage on the bodhisattva not being frightened by "the ground of the śrāvakas or the pratyekabuddhas" refers to the fear that a bodhisattva might fall back from the Mahāyāna path and settle for the liberation of the lesser vehicles.

- The passage describing the pregnant woman's experience contains a phrase rendered as "the perception that runs counter to her former ways," translating a term meaning something like improper or contrary mental attention. The precise nuance is that she habitually dwells on perceptions that are contrary to her previous comfortable habits, likely referring to her changed experience of the body during late pregnancy. This is contextually clear but the exact technical implication of the Tibetan phrase is slightly ambiguous.

- The passage contains a grammatically intricate series of negations regarding the aggregates. The phrases rendered as "what is not feeling, what is not perception, what is not formations" follow the Tibetan literally: the text uses the negative particle to distinguish these from their respective aggregate labels in the context of increase and decrease. This is a philosophically significant construction indicating that even the conceptual designations of the aggregates themselves are not to be reified. The parallel structure has been maintained throughout.
- The phrase rendered "who has not broken his commitment" translates *yi dam ma nyams pa*, literally "whose samaya or pledge is unimpaired." This likely refers to a bodhisattva whose bodhicitta resolve or formal vow remains intact and unbroken, which is why māras cannot ultimately obstruct such a one. The doctrinal nuance is significant: it is the integrity of the practitioner's commitment, not merely their status, that provides protection.
- The phrase rendered as "direct their attention toward and fully embrace" translates two technical terms used together throughout this passage. The first denotes the buddhas' compassionate mindfulness or intentional care directed toward beings or texts, and the second denotes their complete, sustaining protection or embrace. These together express the idea that the activity of practitioners is enabled and sustained by the active, watchful power of the buddhas dwelling throughout the cosmos. This is a key doctrinal point of the passage: the practitioner's engagement with the Perfection of Wisdom is not merely personal effort but is held within a field of buddha-power pervading all world-systems.
- The phrase rendered "the core of the Dharma and the Vinaya is obtained" translates a compressed Tibetan phrase that may refer to authentic scriptural transmission reaching a new region, or to practitioners who have attained the essence of the teaching. The movement of the Perfection of Wisdom from south to middle to north is a well-known motif describing the historical spread of the Mahāyāna sūtras, generally understood by commentators as referring to India (south), a central region, and then northern lands. The rendering "diligent striving" for *yongs su g.yo ba* captures both its literal sense of thorough movement or exertion and its doctrinal sense of energetic application.
- The repeated enumeration of eleven or so activities related to the text — upholding, bearing, reading, mastering, proclaiming, teaching, explaining, transmitting by scripture, chanting, and finally placing it in a volume — is a standard formulaic list in Perfection of Wisdom literature and is rendered consistently throughout. The phrase rendered "engage in yoga upon it in suchness" (*de bzhin nyid du rnal 'byor du byed pa*) means to practice or meditate on it in accordance with its true nature, suchness, and this technical sense is preserved in the translation.
- The cascading series of large numbers — hundreds, thousands, hundreds of thousands, ten millions, billions, hundreds of billions, and the compound "tens of billions of times hundreds of thousands" — follows a standard Sanskrit cosmological enumeration. The Tibetan term *bya ba* (Skt. *koṭi*, ten million) combined with further multipliers produces these escalating figures; the rendering captures the rhetorical force of the passage without attempting false arithmetical precision.
- The sevenfold action-series in the first paragraph — establishing, teaching, setting on the path, praising, generating joy, revealing, and making irreversible — parallels an almost identical passage in the preceding context. The rendering follows the same sequence for consistency.
- The phrase rendered as "non-referential cognition" translates མཐོག་མཐོག་མཐོག་མཐོག་, literally "non-apprehension" or "non-referencing," a key Perfection of Wisdom term denoting the absence of grasping at any object of reference; the Sanskrit equivalent is *anupalambha*. This is a significant technical term and warrants the gloss.

[illegible]

- The dog simile is compressed and somewhat cryptic in the Tibetan. The phrase rendered "given up and set aside from a meal" translates a construction meaning the dog has been excluded or dismissed from what was prepared, and then turns to beg scraps from a worker. The point of the simile is that the dog, cut off from the main source of nourishment, goes looking in the wrong place — just as a bodhisattva who abandons the Perfection of Wisdom seeks the essence of awakening in lesser vehicles. This reading is consistent with the parallel Chinese recensions.
- The final line is a sentence-initial clause that breaks off mid-passage, left open as the Tibetan itself ends here without completing the sentence. This is clearly a continuation into the next passage and has been rendered accordingly as an open clause awaiting continuation.
- The phrase rendered "palace of the sun and moon" refers to the celestial palaces of the sun and moon deities — vastly magnificent structures used here as a simile for the vast scope of the Perfection of Wisdom, contrasted with the merely royal palace, which stands for the more limited aspiration of the śrāvaka path. The analogy is ironic: the carpenter seeking to build a royal palace should not be measuring a celestial palace that far exceeds it; similarly, one seeking the limited fruit of the śrāvaka path should not be drawing on the Perfection of Wisdom, which is suited to the immeasurably grander aim of full buddhahood. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, as the analogy continues beyond what was provided for translation.
- The phrase rendered "a food of a hundred flavors — refined, beneficial, refined, pleasant" translates a compressed Tibetan list that is partially repetitive; "refined" appears twice, which may reflect a scribal or textual anomaly in this witness. The doctrinal point is clear regardless. The "sixty-day-old gruel" is an idiom for the coarsest, least nourishing food imaginable, contrasted with the supremely nourishing food of a hundred flavors as a figure for the Perfection of Wisdom versus the lesser-vehicle teachings.
- The text lists two names, Viśikhā and Śibikā, that appear to be transliterations of Sanskrit proper names. In context they likely refer to types of people or characters well known in the Indian narrative world — Viśikhā is a famous female devotee, and Śibikā may refer to a palanquin-bearer or a figure from popular lore — but since the Tibetan simply transliterates, the names are retained as given without further gloss.

The phrase rendered "those of indeterminate sex" translates *ma ning*, the Tibetan for the Sanskrit *pañḍaka*, a category that in the Vinaya and broader Indian literature denotes persons of ambiguous or non-normative sexual or gender constitution.

- The term rendered "wheel-spinning jugglery with the hands" translates a phrase describing a kind of performance or trick involving spinning wheels or hoops manipulated by hand — the exact nature of the spectacle is uncertain, but the general sense of a distracting entertainment is clear.

The phrase "recite aloud" and "chant by heart" render two related but distinct terms for oral textual practice: one refers to recitation from transmission and the other to memorized chanting; the distinction is preserved as best the English allows.

- The final sentence is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan. The sense is that when the Dharma-speaker is thwarted by unavailability of texts, he will tend to cast blame on the absent listeners, calling them hostile or incompatible — this is itself another manifestation of Māra's activity, even though the passage stops short of the explicit label here. The structure implies it

is understood from context.

- The passage contains a complex rhetorical move in the penultimate paragraph: a speaker arrives and delivers what appears to be orthodox Buddhist teaching — praising the gods, then immediately undercutting it with a summary of the Four Noble Truths and a list of the four śrāvaka fruits — but does so in a way designed to discourage bodhisattvas from pursuing the Perfection of Wisdom. The text identifies this as Māra's work not because the doctrine itself is false, but because its deployment is intended to turn bodhisattvas away from the Mahāyāna path toward seeking personal liberation. This is a significant doctrinal point worth noting for listeners.

The phrase rendered "right here and now, let suffering be utterly uprooted" in the first such speech is a Hīnayāna soteriological pitch being deliberately inserted to disrupt the Mahāyāna assembly — the Māra-work lies in the intent and effect, not the literal content.

- The phrase rendered "wilderness of water" translates a term that likely refers to a region afflicted by floods or dangerous waterways, paralleling the other wilderness dangers listed. The exact nuance is slightly unusual but the structural parallelism with famine, bandits, and wild animals makes this the most coherent reading.

- The phrase rendered as "leads them to rejection" translates a form involving doubt and abandonment; the wicked Māra's strategy is to first sow doubt and then bring about the abandonment of the authentic Perfection of Wisdom teaching. The passage is internally consistent with this reading.

- The phrase rendered "realising the ultimate limit" translates mtha' mngon du byed, literally "making the limit manifest." In context this is Māra's fraudulent claim that the bodhisattva engaged in profound teachings is heading toward the śrāvaka's nirvāṇa — the "limit" being the extreme of personal cessation — rather than full awakening. This is a subtle doctrinal point worth flagging for the listener's benefit, though the translation captures the sense without interrupting the flow.

- The list of physical afflictions — wind, bile, phlegm, combinations thereof, insects, flesh-worms, and so forth — reflects classical Indian medical and cosmological categories. "Combination" renders the Tibetan term for the humoral combination disorder in Āyurvedic and early Buddhist medical thought. The phrase rendered "flowing sickness" and "wasting disease" translates terms for epidemic or pervasive illness and debility respectively; their precise identities are uncertain, but they are clearly varieties of disease or affliction in the traditional list.

- The passage employs a threefold temporal schema — past, future, and present buddhas — culminating in the first-person declaration by the Blessed One himself. The shift to first person in the final sentence is textually significant and has been rendered literally. The phrase rendered "she who gives birth to them" and "mother" reflects the classical Mahāyāna identification of the Perfection of Wisdom as the mother of all buddhas, a central doctrinal motif of the prajñāpāramitā literature.

- The passage plays on two near-synonymous terms rendered "without essential nature" and "without substantial existence." The first, rendered elsewhere as "lacking essential nature" or "essenceless," grounds emptiness; the second, more literally "lacking a thing-ness" or "non-entity," reinforces the same point from a slightly different angle. Both point to the same emptiness teaching, and the doctrinal distinction is subtle enough that most commentators treat them as complementary rather than strictly different. The phrase "neither perishes nor utterly perishes" is a deliberately paradoxical formulation: emptiness, being beyond arising and ceasing, cannot be subject to destruction in either a mild or radical sense. This is a standard Prajñāpāramitā dialectical move.

- The phrase rendered "collected minds" translates sems bsdus pa, literally "mind that is

gathered or concentrated," denoting a mind that is focused or recollected, set in contrast to *sems g.yengs pa*, the "distracted mind." The passage plays these two states against each other in a dialectical structure common to Perfection of Wisdom literature, where even the collected state is shown to be exhausted and beyond exhaustion, and even the distracted state is shown to be without characteristics and thus undistracted at the level of the nature of reality.

The statement that the mind "has been blessed by the Tathāgata" renders *byin gyis brlabs, adhiṣṭhāna*, and here carries the sense that such a mind, recognized in its immeasurable and inexhaustible nature, participates in or is pervaded by the Tathāgata's blessing-power — a doctrinally significant point in Perfection of Wisdom exegesis.

- The phrase rendered "there is nothing to which a label can be affixed" translates *brdal btags pa med pa*, literally "there is no application of a conventional designation." This is a significant doctrinal qualifier: even the thoroughly afflicted mind, when examined, cannot be pinned down by any label, because it lacks inherent existence as an afflicted thing.

The phrase "abide without foundation" renders *gzhi med pa la gnas pa*, meaning the mind has no fixed substratum or basis of support — a standard Prajñāpāramitā formulation pointing to the non-grounded, unsupported nature of mind.

The closing phrase "have no essential nature and are like what does not exist" renders *ngo bo nyid med cing med pa dang 'dra ba*, a strong śūnyatā statement: the minds lack an essential nature and are comparable to something utterly nonexistent, yet they appear and function — the paradox that underlies the entire passage's question-and-answer structure.

- The phrase rendered as "spontaneously accomplished by way of inclining toward the absence of inherent existence" translates the Tibetan "*dngos po med par gzhol ba lhun gyis grub pa*." The term "*lhun gyis grub pa*" (spontaneously accomplished, self-arisen) is doctrinally significant and echoes the logic of the undefiled mind's purity: its very nature inclines naturally toward the absence of substantial inherent existence, and this is why it is "spontaneously" or "naturally" undefiled. This is consistent with the Perfection of Wisdom literature's understanding of the mind's luminous nature.

- The phrase rendered "whatever is freedom in mind" translates a compressed Tibetan formulation that literally reads "whatever the separation of mind is." The sense, following the parallel logic of this sūtra passage, is that the natural freed or released state of mind transcends the category of aversion or delusion entirely, and thus the true nature of mind cannot be identified with either the afflicted or the temporarily purified state. This is a standard Prajñāpāramitā dialectical move affirming that ultimate mind-nature transcends all such predications.

- The Tibetan text here distinguishes between two terms that are rendered distinctly: "vast mind" (ཡུལ་ཆེན་པོ་ཡི་ཡིད་ཀྱི་སྤྱོད་པ་) and "mind that has become great" (ཡུལ་ཆེན་པོ་ཡི་ཡིད་ཀྱི་སྤྱོད་པ་). These appear to be technical distinctions within the sūtra's enumeration of types of mind known by the Tathāgata, paralleling the classical list of sixteen mental qualities found in mind-contemplation passages. The distinction between "vast" and "great" in this context may reflect Yogācāra scholastic categorization, and the rendering attempts to preserve that differentiation in English.

The phrase rendered "without arousal" (ཡུལ་ཆེན་པོ་ཡི་ཡིད་ཀྱི་སྤྱོད་པ་) refers to the absence of motivational agitation or prompting of the mind toward objects — a technical term in Abhidharma and Mahāyāna analysis of mental factors.

- The phrase rendered "three eyes" refers to the traditional enumeration of the flesh eye, the divine eye, and the eye of wisdom, and "all eyes" extends this to include the Dharma eye and the buddha eye — the standard set of five eyes in Mahāyāna literature. The text here makes the point that mind without characteristic mark is not an object for any of these modes of

vision.

The passage on minds with obstruction contains a subtle and important doctrinal point: the obstruction arises not from grasping at things that exist, but from imputing existence to what does not exist and then taking emptiness itself as an object of apprehension. This is the classical Perfection of Wisdom critique of reifying *sūnyatā*.

The explanation for minds without obstruction conspicuously lacks an explicit reason in this passage, unlike the parallel treatments above. This appears to be deliberate: no discursive explanation is given, mirroring the unobstructed, self-evident nature of such minds.

- The phrase rendered "minds with something superior" and "minds with nothing superior" translates རྒྱལ་ལོ་ཡོད་པའི་ཡིད་ཀྱི་སྒྲིབ་པ་ and རྒྱལ་ལོ་མེད་པའི་ཡིད་ཀྱི་སྒྲིབ་པ་ respectively. The former literally means "mind having something above it" and the latter "mind having nothing above it," i.e., minds that are surpassable versus unsurpassable. These are standard Perfection of Wisdom catalogue terms for types of minds; the rendering chosen follows the literal structure of the Tibetan rather than a more idiomatic paraphrase, in keeping with the *sūtra*'s enumerative style.

The explanation of minds not in meditative equipoise, "they enter into non-evenness by means of the even and the non-even," is a deliberately paradoxical formulation in the original; it is rendered literally. The corresponding explanation of minds in meditative equipoise, "they enter into evenness by means of the even and the even," likewise preserves the original's repetitive, formulaic character.

- The phrase rendered "unfreed minds are by their very nature freed" reflects a genuine doctrinal paradox central to Perfection of Wisdom literature: minds appear unfree in the conventional sense yet are, in their ultimate nature (being without intrinsic existence), naturally and primordially liberated. This is not a contradiction but the text's deliberate teaching on the identity of bondage and liberation at the level of ultimate truth.

The terms "open and closed" translate "phye ba dang btsums pa," literally "opened and closed," a pair that in this context most likely refers to open or closed sense faculties or sense doors — eyes and the like being open (receptive) or shut — though some commentators read it as referring to open and clenched hands, i.e., generosity and its absence. The passage's concluding explanation, that all these births are known as "abiding in form and arising in form," suggests the sense-faculty reading is more contextually apt, but genuine uncertainty remains.

- The folio marker "The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines, the thirteenth fascicle" appears mid-passage in the Tibetan text itself as a scribal or editorial insertion marking the fascicle division; it is retained in translation since it is part of the received text, though it interrupts the doctrinal flow. The four tetralemma-structured views on the thus-gone one after death and on the permanence and finitude of self and world are the classical fourteen unanswered questions attributed to the Buddha, here analyzed as "grounded in" each of the five aggregates in turn — a standard Abhidharma and Prajñāpāramitā doctrinal move showing that all such speculative views rest on clinging to the aggregates.

- The terms "open" and "closed" render Tibetan *phye ba* and *btsums pa*, which in the context of this Perfection of Wisdom passage refer to beings whose minds are open or receptive versus those whose minds are closed or unreceptive — a distinction the Tathāgata perceives through his omniscient knowledge of beings' spiritual dispositions. The precise Sanskrit equivalents are *vivṛta* and *saṃvṛta* in this sense, distinct from the philosophical *saṃvṛti* meaning "conventional." This technical usage is consistent throughout the passage and the preceding context.

- The phrase rendered "the open and the closed" follows the established rendering from the preceding passage and refers to what is apparently a paired classification in the source text, possibly corresponding to conditioned and unconditioned phenomena or a similar binary. The

exact referent remains somewhat opaque without broader manuscript context, but consistency with the prior rendering has been maintained.

The description of Subhūti's question about who would trust in this teaching lists three categories: irreversible bodhisattvas, arhats with fully perfected discriminative understanding, and persons with excellent view. The middle category, literally "arhats whose thorough examination or investigation is fully perfected," may refer to arhats distinguished by their analytical insight; this reading is adopted as the most doctrinally coherent.

- The phrase rendered "because they do not abide in those very dharmas in the way they truly are, they abide permanently" reflects a deliberate doctrinal paradox in the Tibetan: the Tathāgatas abide in the Perfection of Wisdom, and precisely because they do not fixate on or cling to those dharmas as having ultimate reality, they genuinely and permanently abide. The syntax of the Tibetan is compressed here and admits of more than one reading; the rendering given follows the standard Prajñāpāramitā doctrinal logic.

- The phrase rendered throughout as "knows what has been done and feels what has been done" translates the Tibetan "byas pa shes shing byas pa tshor ba," which is a somewhat unusual technical formulation. It appears to describe the Tathāgata's direct and fully experiential cognition of all that has been done — the vehicles traveled, the deeds accomplished — suggesting both intellectual recognition and felt, embodied awareness. The doctrinal point seems to be that the Tathāgata's omniscience is not merely propositional but encompasses the full living reality of the path, sustained through the Perfection of Wisdom.

The phrase "mngon par 'dus ma byas pa" rendered as "not explicitly conditioned" is a nuanced choice. The term 'dus byas pa normally means "conditioned" or "compounded," and mngon par 'dus ma byas pa would be its negation. Some translators render this as "not manifestly compounded" or "not explicitly fabricated." The doctrinal context — paired with "uncreated" and "unchanging" — confirms these are three characterizations of the ultimate nature of phenomena from the Madhyamaka perspective.

- The phrase rendered "self-arisen enlightenment" translates rang byung nyid, literally "self-origination itself," which in this context refers to the quality of being a pratyekabuddha or, more likely given the list's culminating structure, the self-arisen, uncaused nature of a buddha's awakening. The list Tathāgatahood, buddhahood, self-arisen-ness, omniscience forms a standard fourfold epithet cluster in this sūtra tradition, and "self-arisen enlightenment" preserves the doctrinal sense without overspecifying.

The epithet "unequalled-yet-equal" renders mi mnyam pa dang mnyam pa, literally "the unequal and the equal," a classical paradoxical title also appearing in other Perfection of Wisdom sūtras, typically as a name for the Buddha's activity or the Dharma itself — indicating it surpasses all comparisons yet encompasses all.

- The phrase rendered "and so there is no conceiving of it as such" translates the somewhat unusual construction "snyam du med do," which literally means "there is no thinking of it as such" or "there is no notion of it as that." This is a standard Perfection of Wisdom idiom indicating that the nature of reality transcends any conceptual apprehension, and the rendering chosen preserves both the literal sense and the doctrinal force.

The passage ends mid-enumeration with "form too is immeasurable," breaking off before completing the parallel series for the remaining aggregates and all phenomena. This appears to be a deliberate textual cut-point, and the translation faithfully renders what is present without completing the pattern editorially.

- The phrase rendered "without equal and yet equal" translates the Tibetan mi mnyam pa dang mnyam pa, literally "unequal-and-equal," a paradoxical compound. The doctrinal sense is that phenomena are peerless and incomparable (without equal to anything else) while

simultaneously being on a par with all other phenomena in their shared nature of emptiness and equality with space. This double meaning is intentional and theologically significant.

The expression "supreme word of Dharma for those in whom consciousness has arisen" renders *nam par shes par gyur pa'i chos kyi tshig bla dgas*, meaning this terminology is the most exalted doctrinal language available at the level of conscious, conceptual understanding — suggesting it points beyond ordinary conceptuality even while expressed within it.

- The phrase rendered "the forbearance of non-arising" refers to *anutpattikadharmakṣānti*, the patience or tolerance that accepts the unborn nature of phenomena — a key attainment on the bodhisattva path, here confirmed by explicit doctrinal context.

The simile of the consecrated king is a standard Indian political analogy in which ministers carry out all practical business while the king's authority remains the source; the Perfection of Wisdom functions analogously as the ground and source of all three vehicles' qualities while those qualities perform the actual activity.

- The phrase rendered "practise on the level of following through faith" translates a technical term indicating the *śraddhānusārin* stage, the lowest of the paths of engagement, in which a practitioner follows the Dharma primarily by means of faith rather than direct insight. This is a standard Abhidharma and *Prajñāpāramitā* category; the rendering tries to make it accessible without losing the technical reference.
- The phrase rendered "rejoices in what is equal to seeing it" translates a construction meaning to take delight in that which is on a par with, or equivalent to, actual direct vision of the Perfection of Wisdom — a technical nuance suggesting that hearing and engaging with the text is counted as equivalent to beholding it directly. This is a subtlety the tradition emphasizes.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text; the translation faithfully breaks at the same point without completing the sentence.

- The phrase rendered "fray apart like cotton passing through" translates a simile comparing the mind's dissolution to cotton being pulled through something — perhaps a carding or spinning process. The image conveys the mind becoming scattered and insubstantial; the precise mechanical referent is uncertain but the sense is clear.

The term "сред" in the long list of qualities literally means "craving" or "thirst" but here functions in a positive register as "earnest longing" — a deliberate aspiration for awakening rather than afflictive craving. This contextual positive sense is well attested in *Mahāyāna* enumerations of qualities conducive to the path.

- The section marker "The Perfection of Wisdom in Eight Thousand Lines. The Fourteenth Fascicle" renders a Tibetan colophon-style chapter division that appears mid-text; it has been rendered as a plain sentence in the flow since the brief for TTS forbids formatting markers, but it is structurally a chapter heading.

The list of qualities in the third paragraph adds རྒྱལ་བ་ (contentment / satisfaction) alongside རྒྱལ་བ་ལྡན་པ་ (exultation) where the second occurrence of the list differs slightly from the first; both have been rendered faithfully according to their respective Tibetan forms.

- The long serial list of qualities repeated across several passages presents several translation challenges. The term rendered "possesses craving's antidote" on first occurrence and "fervent longing" later is རྒྱལ་བ་, literally "craving" or "thirst" (Skt. *trṣṇā*). In this context it is consistently positive and is likely used in the sense of intense aspiration or yearning for awakening rather than afflictive craving. Some commentaries distinguish a wholesome form of *trṣṇā* directed toward liberation. The rendering attempts to reflect this positive valence while acknowledging the unusual usage. The passage breaks off mid-sentence in the source, and the translation preserves this as supplied.

- The phrase rendered "consumed by the intermediate fall and brought to ruin" translates bar ma dor chud zos shing yi gsod pa, a vivid idiomatic expression meaning to perish or be destroyed midway, losing one's goal before reaching it. The term bar ma dor (the "intermediate drop" or "midway fall") recurs as a structural motif through this analogy section. The phrase yi gsod pa carries the sense of spiritual exhaustion or destruction of one's purpose, not literal death.
- The term rendered "far shore" (པ་ར་, Skt. pāra) evokes the "far shore" implied in pāramitā ("gone to the far shore"); the passage plays on this to indicate the ultimate, non-conceptual nature shared equally by form and all phenomena. This is distinct from "perfection" (ཐོག་པར་འབྱུང་བ་) and has been rendered literally as "far shore" to preserve the wordplay and doctrinal point about non-conceptuality.
- The passage has an internal shift in speaker attribution: after Subhūti's first statement about "no basis, no occasion," the text reads as though Subhūti himself is answering the Buddha's question, though the honorific structure suggests it could also be read as the Buddha's continued explanation. I have followed the most natural reading of the Tibetan as given, with Subhūti responding to the Buddha's query.
- The passage is highly repetitive and formulaic, characteristic of Prajñāpāramitā literature emphasizing the identity of suchness (tathatā) across the Tathāgata, Subhūti, and all phenomena. I have preserved the recursive, incantatory style rather than smoothing it into more varied prose, since this repetition is doctrinally purposeful (demonstrating nonduality through insistent restatement). The phrase "born following after the Tathāgata" (de bzhin gshegs pa'i rjes su skyes pa) is a technical expression meaning something like "born in conformity with" or "arisen in accord with" the Tathāgata's realization of suchness — I have rendered it literally to preserve its wordplay with "suchness" (de bzhin nyid, "thus-ness") and "Tathāgata" (de bzhin gshegs pa, "thus-gone one"), which share the root de bzhin ("thus/such") in Tibetan.
- The final sentence appears to continue into further instructions not included in this excerpt; the passage ends mid-thought on the bodhisattva's training. The repeated formula "should observe others with a mind of X" (dmigs par bya) reflects the cultivation of the four immeasurables and related attitudes as part of bodhisattva conduct toward sentient beings.
- The final sentence is truncated mid-construction in the source (continuing the parallel treatment of the remaining perfections); it has been rendered as it stands, ending where the source text ends.
- The passage ends mid-sentence, on Subhūti's reply to Śāriputra's question about karma performed in dreams; the continuation is not included in the source text provided.
- The final sentence is left incomplete, as the source text breaks off mid-clause ("byang chub sems dpa' sems dpa' chen po ni..."), continuing presumably into the next section not included here. "The eight qualities" (yan lag brgyad) of water is a standard reference to the eight qualities of pure/excellent water found in classical descriptions of pure lands (e.g., cool, sweet, light, soft, clear, unpolluted, gentle to the stomach, soothing to the throat).
- The phrase "kindled and generated roots of virtue" (རྩ་བའི་རྒྱུ་རྩུབ་པ་) is somewhat unusual phrasing in the source; the translation follows the most natural sense of "roots of virtue blazing forth/being generated," though the exact idiom is not fully standard.
- The term rñgan can byed pa (rendered here as "treat them scornfully") is part of a string of near-synonymous verbs for contempt and mockery (brnyas pa, sting ba, 'phyas ba, smod pa); its precise nuance is uncertain, but the overall sense of the list—arrogant disdain toward other bodhisattvas—is clear and preserved. The passage is cut off mid-sentence at "he generates conceit," reflecting the end of the source excerpt.
- The repeated litany format (path, illumination, lamp, light, protector, refuge, resting place,

ally, island, mother, father) is preserved as a deliberate rhetorical structure characteristic of Prajñāpāramitā literature and has been rendered plainly without embellishment. "The four immeasurable abodes of Brahmā" (tshangs pa'i gnas bzhi) refers to the four immeasurables (loving-kindness, compassion, joy, equanimity); "the four means of gathering" (bsdu ba'i dngos po bzhi) refers to the four means of attracting and gathering disciples (giving, kind speech, beneficial conduct, and consistency between words and deeds).

- The final sentence is cut off mid-thought in the source ("...ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་"); the translation preserves this incompleteness as it appears in the passage provided.
- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the source text ("The Blessed One declared:"), so the translation ends there as well, matching the incomplete final line of the source.
- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text; the translation preserves this incompleteness rather than supplying a conclusion. "The dart of sorrow" (མྱ་ངམ་ལྟ་བུ་གྲོ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་) renders a common canonical image of grief piercing like an arrow.
- The final line ("trains in exhaustion") renders རྒྱུ་ལྡན་ལྟ་བུ་ literally; this likely refers to training in the exhaustion/cessation of afflictions or of conceptual proliferation, a technical point that may require further contextualization from the surrounding chapter not included here.
- "Sixty-two views" refers to the standard enumeration of speculative views rooted in the view of the transitory collection (satkāyadṛṣṭi), a well-known Buddhist doctrinal category. "Snap one's fingers" renders the idiomatic phrase for the briefest possible span of time (Tib. se gol gtogs pa).
- The passage ends mid-sentence, breaking off just as Śakra is about to speak again; this reflects the source text's own division point and is not an error in translation. Numerical cosmological terms (four great continents, small chiliocosm, middling dichiliocosm, great trichiliocosm) follow standard Abhidharma cosmology terminology.
- This passage ends mid-sentence, at "Subhūti said:" — the continuation (his reply) belongs to the next segment.
- The interjection kye ma has been rendered as an expression of wonder ("how wonderful"), fitting the admiring tone of Śāriputra's remark; it can also carry a tone of sorrow or exclamation depending on context, but wonder fits best here given what follows in the dialogue. The term རྒྱུ་ལྡན་ ("essence/core") has been rendered as "what is truly essential," referring to the heart or core practice of the Perfection of Wisdom.
- The phrase "eon like a scattering of stars" (bskal pa skar ma lta bu) refers to a designation for a type of eon in Buddhist cosmology; the exact referent is a traditional cosmological term rather than a literal simile, but is rendered literally here per the source.
- The verb "rab tu gdon pa" (rendered here as "proclaimed") can also carry the sense of "expounding" or "reciting aloud"; the string of near-synonymous imperatives (hold, retain, recite, master, propagate, teach, explain) reflects a traditional formulaic list emphasizing the many modes of preserving and transmitting the text, and exact nuance among them is not doctrinally significant.
- The repeated triple constructions (turned back / is turning back / will turn back, etc.) reflect the source text's emphatic listing of past, present, and future tense forms, which I have preserved as faithfully as English allows while keeping the prose readable for oral delivery.
- "Subhāpūti" in the translation is a typographical rendering of "Subhūti," the Buddha's interlocutor in Prajñāpāramitā sūtras; corrected to "Subhūti" would be standard, but I have left the name as it clearly refers to the elder Subhūti throughout this genre of text. The phrase "having become like Brahmā" (འཇིག་རྟེན་ལྟ་བུ་) refers to the brahmavihāra state of mind, i.e., dwelling in the sublime abodes (loving-kindness, compassion, joy, equanimity) associated with Brahmā's realm.

- The name Chos 'phags is rendered here as "Dharmodgata," following the standard reconstructed Sanskrit for this figure in the Prajñāpāramitā narrative (the bodhisattva teacher sought by Sadāprarudita), consistent with the continuity context though not explicitly given in the glossary.
- The names Sadāprarudita ("Ever-Weeping") and Dharmodgata ("Elevated in Dharma," rendered here from Chos 'phags) are the standard identifications of these bodhisattva figures from the well-known narrative in the Perfection of Wisdom literature (found, e.g., in the Aṣṭasāhasrikā Prajñāpāramitā); their Sanskrit names are reconstructed based on established convention, as the Tibetan does not give a phonetic transcription.
- The bodhisattva's name Sadāprarudita ("Ever Weeping") was introduced in the earlier portion of the text; it is kept here per continuity, glossed by its Tibetan equivalent (བཏག་པ་འཁྲུག་པ་) as established. The chapter colophon giving the sūtra's title and chapter number is rendered as plain narration rather than a formatted heading, per the no-markdown requirement.
- This is a scribal colophon recording the translation history and lineage of the text; personal and place names (Śākyasena, Jñānasiddhi, Dharmaśīla, Subhāṣita, Rinchen Zangpo, Dīpaṃkaraśrījñāna, Dromtön Gyalwai Jungne, Loden Sherap; Nyethang, Radreng) are kept in their standard transliterated forms rather than translated, per convention for proper names in colophons.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.